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Explore Income and Employment Support

Income Support Program

Expected to Work/Barriers to Full Employment Policy

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01 Income Support Overview

Policy Governing All Benefits

Last updated on: Jul 09, 2019

INTENT

To provide general rules and considerations applying to all Income Support benefits.

POLICY

Arrears and Recovery

Benefits are not issued to pay off debts, loans or arrears. Benefits are not issued on a repayment basis.

Awaiting Appeal

Benefits that have been refused are not issued pending appeal.

No benefits are issued so that a client can attend an appeal hearing.

Authority for Issuing Benefits

[Authority for issuing benefits](#) resides with the Career and Employment Consultant (CEC) or the

Debt

A debt does **not** occur:

- For a benefit when the client was eligible for the benefit on the first of the month.
- When a Core Benefit is used for a purpose other than the one for which it was issued if the

Eligibility

An allowance may be issued to a household unit if all conditions are met, as outlined in the specific policy.

Least Cost Alternative

Unless otherwise specified in policy, the worker issues benefits by the most reasonable and effective method.

Mismanaged Benefits

Benefits are not reissued if mismanaged (i.e., used for a purpose other than intended).

Benefits may **only** be reissued if a [cheque](#) or [voucher](#) (not cash) was lost, stolen, or never received.

Rounding Benefits

See [Rounding Benefits](#) policy.

Retroactivity

Workers can issue [underpayment](#) benefits retroactively for all periods of assistance in which the initially deemed eligible for income support.

Standard Procedure for Issuing Benefits, and Entering Comments and Reminders

Unless otherwise stated in policy the standard procedure for issuing benefits and documenting

1. Reviews the **Scratch Pad** (if applicable).
2. If eligible, issues the benefit.

Records the circumstances into Compass Comments.

Documentation in Compass is based on the recognition that the information belongs to the client only to the detail required by policy.

Creates Reminders in Compass if needed.

Substantiation and Verification

Unless otherwise stated, verification of client circumstances requires staff to view the applicable be otherwise captured in any of the systems.

Documents provided by the client that are not listed in the Client File checklist are to be returned

Legislative Authorities

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2011

Legislative authority for the Income Support Program for Expected to Work (ETW) and Barriers

- *Income and Employment Supports Act (IESA)*
- Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation (ISTHB Regulation)
- Recovery Regulation

In accordance with the *Public Service Act*, the Minister may appoint one or more Directors to ac

The Director under *IESA*, ISTHB Regulation, and the Recovery Regulation responsible for Income Support Programs.

The Director under *IESA* responsible for health benefits is the Executive Director of Alberta Sup

The Director under *IESA* responsible for Child Support Services (Part 5) is the Executive Direct

The Director(s) delegates authority to regional and frontline staff only as stated in this manual.

- Staff do not have the authority to contravene the policy in this manual.
- The Director has the authority to make exceptions to policy, but not contrary to the legisla
- Appeal panels have authority equal to the Director.

Authority for Issuing Benefits

Authority for issuing benefits resides with the Career and Employment Consultant (CEC) or the

If a CEC or SFSC is unsure of how to apply policy, or requires clarification of policy in order to r
clarification is required, the supervisor may contact the Regional Income Support Specialist.

General Eligibility Rules

Last updated on: Aug 13, 2024

The following are the general eligibility rules for Income Support, including the legislative authority [Training and Health Benefits Regulation \(ISTHBR\)](#). These further support the Declaration section

IESA section 2

The Income Support program provides financial assistance to persons who are unable to meet well-being.

IESA section 5(1)

IESA section 15 1(c) & (d)

Applicants and recipients are to realize any and all [non-exempt assets](#) to reduce or prevent the person to become destitute to be eligible for Income Support.

IESA section 5(2)(a)(b)

ISTHBR Division 2, section 10-19

If a cohabiting partner is not covered by the Income Support program due to another program's (tourist), the assets and income of that partner are still calculated as a resource to meet the need

IESA section 6(2)(a)

The members of the household unit are in [Alberta](#).

IESA section 6(2)(b)

One of the members of the household unit is [18 years of age or older](#).

IESA section 6(2)(d)

IESA section 29(1)(a)

Income Support [clients must be willing to comply](#) with the [Child Support Services](#) requirements

IESA section 6(2)(e)

IESA section 6(3)(f)

Benefits are not issued when another person, agency or government program is responsible.

IESA section 6(2)(f)

IESA section 14(1)(a)-(c)

It is the client's responsibility to establish their identity and to provide any information or [substar](#)

IESA section 14(2)

Clients are required to report any [change in circumstances](#) in the household unit affecting eligib

IESA section 15(1)(a)(b)(d)-(e)

[Clients must follow](#) through with [expectations](#) to take [work](#), rehabilitation or training that will lea

IESA section 15(1)(a)(b)

Applicants and recipients are to [accept employment](#) for reasonable wages and are to maintain : employment are identified in policy.

IESA section 15(1)(c)(i) & (d)

Applicants and recipients are to [access all income](#) the applicant, recipient or a member of the h

receive under any other law.

ISTHBR section 1(2)(b)

Dependents of Income Support program recipients who are attending the regular school system community norm of families supporting their children to complete high school and supports the

ISTHBR Division 2, section 10-19

Income Support applicants must not be in an [ineligible group](#).

Income Support rules apply to persons applying or receiving Income Support who are [Barriers t](#)

Eligibility Impacts

Last updated on: Aug 13, 2024

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 15\(1\)\(a\) to \(j\)](#)

INTENT

Income Support clients maintain accountability by completing actions agreed to in their Individual

POLICY

As a condition of receiving Income Support benefits, both Expected to Work (ETW) and Barrier: Plan. An [Individual](#) Plan is a contract that is mutually developed and agreed upon by the client and the client's required course of action to advance towards greater independence, including:

- The client's goals,
- Agreed-upon steps necessary to achieve these goals, and
- Programs/services that the client has agreed to attend/utilize as part of attaining these goals.

It is **within the worker's discretion** to refuse, discontinue, suspend or reduce Income Support Individual Plan.

Workers **must** exercise reasonable judgment and consider clients' circumstances and history by working collaboratively with clients to ensure that they are realistically able to accomplish the goals of the client's unique circumstances and the policy on [Client Responsibilities](#) when deciding to refuse,

Workers may exercise their authority to refuse, discontinue, suspend or reduce Income Support requirements or to fulfill the terms/conditions of receiving Income Support benefits. This includes:

- Refuse to seek or to accept reasonable employment for reasonable wages;
- Terminate employment that they might have reasonably continued to hold;
- Refuse to make reasonable efforts to obtain compensation or to collect income that the client is entitled to;
- Refuse to make reasonable efforts to realize an asset or other financial resource that the client is entitled to;
- Refuse or neglect to avail themselves of advantages that they are entitled to under any other program or service;
- Refuse or neglect to take advantage of appropriate training or rehabilitative measures;
- Fail to maintain eligibility requirements for the assistance provided;
- Fail to comply with any term or condition of the assistance provided;
- Fail to comply with a direction under the [Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\)](#) regarding eligibility, including substantiation of information, if requested;
- Fail to comply with a direction under *IESA* section 14(2) and neglect to disclose a change in circumstances.

- Fail to comply with a requirement under Part 5 of *IESA*, and do not comply with Child Sup
- Refuse to provide complete information required to determine eligibility for assistance or p

A client must be notified when a decision is made that affects eligibility and/or the amount or va

- The details of the decision; **and**
- Specific reasons for the change in eligibility, **and**
- The date that benefits will cease or will be adjusted, **and**,
- The client's right to [appeal](#) this decision.

An individual receives notification when a worker notifies them:

1. Verbally, on the date that the conversation with the worker takes place; or,
2. In [writing](#), on the date that the notice is presented to the individual by the worker; or,
3. As outlined in [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#).

Eligibility Impacts in Two-Adult Households

When one member of a two-adult household is ineligible for Income Support benefits, based on include:

- Allowing the non-compliant adult to remain on the Income Support file,
- Changing **Budget Status** to **2** and **Health Benefit Coverage** to **N**, and
- Allowing core shelter benefits to remain unchanged while reducing core essential benefits

Or

- Allowing the non-compliant adult to remain on the Income Support file,
- Changing **Budget Status** to **2** and **Health Benefit Coverage** to **N**, and
- Reducing both core shelter and core essential benefits (manually) to reflect a one adult hc

Or

- [Discontinuing](#) Income Support benefits for the entire household unit and allowing for autor

When one member of a two adult household is ineligible for Income Support benefits because c
assets are considered to belong to the eligible household member and used to determine eligib
ineligible spouse is **not** added to the file.

Delegated Authority to Make Eligibility Decisions

Last updated on: Dec 11, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 6\(2\) and 15;](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1 \(1\)\(p\), 1\(2\)\(a\), 8 – 17, 19,](#)

INTENT

To outline the decision making authorities regarding eligibility decisions for Income Support.

POLICY

The authority/delegated authority to make decisions regarding eligibility for Income Support is a

Decision	Reference
For the purposes of program eligibility, determine:	
General Eligibility	
<i>Income and Employment Supports Act (IESA)</i>	
That at least one member of the household unit is at least 18 years of age.	Section 6(2)(b)
Whether an applicant or client is willing to comply with requirements under Part 5.	Section 6(2)(d)
Whether the applicant or client is entitled to receive similar benefits from any other income support regime.	Section 6(2)(e) (ISTHB Section 18)
Income Support, Training and Health Benefits (ISTHB) Regulation	
That the applicant's immigration status meets residency requirements.	Section 10
Whether the members of the household unit are in Alberta.	Section 11
Whether a refugee or refugee claimant is eligible for benefits.	Section 12

Whether a sponsored immigrant is eligible for benefits.	Section 13
Whether a First Nations Person is eligible for benefits.	Section 14
Whether a person involved in the Justice System is eligible for benefits.	Section 15
Whether a person is a recipient of AISH.	Section 16
Whether a person is participating in a full-time education or training program not approved by the director.	Section 17
Whether a person has been approved for student funding to attend full-time training.	Section 19
The start date of benefits for eligible applicants.	N/A
Financial Eligibility	
ISTHB Regulation	
Determine what savings programs could be an exempt asset for the purposes of determining eligibility for benefits.	Schedule 1 section 1(1)(h) MO 2016-21
Whether an asset, excluding a liquid asset, not specified in the Regulation should be exempted.	Schedule 1, section 1(1)(o) Section 1(2)
Determine the financial Resources (income) available to the household unit.	Section 23(1), (2), and (3)

Determine eligibility based on income.	Section 22
Whether an applicant or client meets the liquid asset test eligibility requirements for Income Support benefits.	Section 21
Whether an asset is a 'liquid asset'.	Section 1(1)(p)
If an applicant or client meets the asset eligibility requirements for Income Support benefits.	Section 20(1)
If an asset has been disposed of for less than fair market value to establish eligibility and should be included in a determination of assets.	Section 20(2)
If an applicant is an adult member of a client category.	Section 1(2)(a)
Designate an applicant to be a Barrier to Full Employment household.	Section 8
Designate an applicant to be an Expected to Work household.	Section 9
Whether an otherwise ineligible household unit is eligible for Income Support benefits to meet an emergent need.	Section 100(1)
Decide to Refuse, discontinue or suspend eligibility if it is determined that the client or applicant has:	
IESA	
Refused to seek or to accept reasonable employment for reasonable wages.	Section 15(1)(a)
Terminated employment that they might have reasonably continued to hold.	Section 15(1)(b)

Refused to make reasonable efforts to obtain compensation or to obtain compensation or to collect income that the client or another adult member of the household unit is entitled to or eligible for.	Section 15(1)(c)(i)
Refused to make reasonable efforts to realize an asset or other financial resource that the client or another adult member of the household unit may receive or be entitled to receive.	Section 15(1)(c)(ii)
Refused or neglected to avail themselves of advantages that they are entitled to under any other law.	Section 15(1)(d)
Refused or neglected to take advantage of appropriate training or rehabilitative measures.	Section 15(1)(e)
Failed to maintain eligibility requirements for the Income Support benefits provided.	Section 15(1)(f)
Failed to comply with any term or condition of the assistance provided.	Section 15(1)(g)
Failed to comply with a direction under section 14(1)(a) or (c) to provide information required to audit Income Support eligibility, including substantiation of information if requested.	Section 15(1)(h)
Failed to comply with a direction under section 14(2) to disclose a change in circumstances that would reduce the household's eligibility for Income Support benefits.	Section 15(1)(h)
Failed to comply with requirements under Part 5 of IESA to comply with Child Support Services program requirements.	Section 15(1)(i)
Refused to provide complete information required to determine eligibility for assistance or provide false information.	Section 15(1)(j)

*Minister's delegation, not subject to appeal

**Director's delegation, not subject to appeal

Assessing Need and Client Type

Last updated on: Mar 21, 2024

[Workers](#) use the following steps to assess whether or not an applicant is in need of income sup

1. Determine the identifying need of the applicant and whether it is under the Seniors, Comm
2. Establish whether the applicant belongs to a group that is eligible or ineligible for Seniors,
3. Refer the applicant to the appropriate internal or external resources/services.
4. If the need is Income Support, establish Income Support eligibility based on the applicant'
5. Apply all policy requirements to determine needs and services.
6. Advise the applicant of the variety of program services available to them to meet their nee

Client Type

Workers must ensure clients are appropriately assessed and [categorized](#) so that the following c

- Core Essential benefits
- Allowable assets
- Supplementary benefits
- Support services
- Health benefit coverage
- Employment or training expectations

Adding a Spouse/Partner to an Active File

When an Income Support client reports the addition of a spouse/partner to their household, the [Notice of Eligibility](#) to re-establish eligibility and ensure they are aware of program responsibility. An **Individual Plan** should also be completed with the spouse/partner.

Note

When adding the PID of the partner in LISA, the system automatically defaults the g manually update the gender of the partner if it is the same gender as the head of ho

If it is not practical to meet in person, the requirement to sign the [EMP 2004 Notice of](#)

Record the reason that the form was not signed in Compass Comments. Include details about a

Set a Compass Reminder to complete, at a later date, the policy requirement to sign the form, i

Just Cause for Leaving a Job

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

The following is a list of acceptable reasons for a client to leave employment and continue to be given just cause. This list refers to situations where the client can make or has made the decision to take training that leads to independence or an improved employment situation.

1. Danger to health or safety because of working conditions:

- The employer requires excessive hours of overtime
- The job threatens or adversely affects the client's health
- client gives credible and convincing explanation or provides doctor's advice
- The work threatens health or safety of pregnant woman or unborn child and employer refuses
- Employer provides unsanitary living accommodations, insufficient or contaminated food

2. Conflict with family responsibilities:

- Working conditions (e.g., duties, hours of work, responsibilities) interfere with client's obligations
- Relocation to specially adapted housing for a handicapped member of the family makes it impossible to continue working
- A partner secures full-time gainful employment that necessitates relocation of the family, and client cannot find suitable employment
- Client needs time off to care for a sick dependent child and employer refuses

3. Sexual or other harassment:

- Client receives abusive treatment from co-workers and employer refuses to intervene
- Employer takes excessive disciplinary action (penalty is clearly disproportionate)
- Client suffers discrimination within the meaning of the Alberta *Human Rights, Citizenship and Multiculturalism Act*

4. Moral or legal objections:

- Employer's practices are illegal or require illegal activities of the client
- Job requirements violate fundamental ethical values or professional ethics
- Job requirements clash with client's religious beliefs

5. Conditions of employment violate provincial Employment Standards legislation:

- Wages or salary are below minimum wage
 - Employer refuses or fails to pay salary, wages (including overtime), or commissions due to
 - Client has received a firm written offer of a better job in the immediate future.
-

Denying or Terminating Benefits

Last updated on: Nov 21, 2025

Benefits may be denied when:

- The client fails to meet eligibility criteria regarding needs, assets, and income **or**
- Expectations about becoming independent have not been met **or**
- The applicant is a member of an ineligible group.

Whenever eligibility or a benefit is denied, the worker must advise the applicant or client of the f

- Their right to appeal the decision, and
- The appeal process, **and**
- The time limit for appeal.

Notification may be in a written or verbal form but there must be documentation on file confirmir
[Support Application Decision letter](#).

Department Responsibilities to Clients

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

The department must provide equitable treatment to clients throughout the province of Alberta t

- Recognizing the person's inherent worth and that all people have strengths and abilities
 - Delivering services in a manner that treats a person with dignity and respect
 - Respecting a person's autonomy, dignity and right to personal choice
 - Responding to the nature and urgency of the need and providing benefits accordingly
 - Issuing Income Support and services on time and in the correct amount
 - Informing clients of Income Support rules, conditions, expectations, and services
 - Advising a person of their right to appeal a department decision whenever a decision is m
 - Safeguarding and protecting a person's information and ensuring it is collected, used, disc the [*Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy \(FOIP\) Act*](#).
-

Client Responsibilities

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

Income Support clients must:

- Participate, if required, in activities to maintain or re-establish maximum self-reliance and
- Access all resources available outside of the program.
- Substantiate their circumstances, needs and resources, including present and potential in
- Inform the department of any changes that affect eligibility or the amount of benefits.

Clients forfeit the benefit of any income exemptions when they:

- Intentionally mislead the department concerning their [income](#) or
 - Provide false information about the income of themselves or their dependants.
-

Access to Information and Protection of Privacy

Last updated on: Jan 31, 2024

Protection of Personal Information

The [Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy \(FOIP\) Act](#) requires Seniors, Community and Social Services adopted a [Privacy Policy](#) to provide guidance on the Department.

Collection of Personal Information

Staff must only collect personal information directly related to and necessary for the programs and Community and Social Services paper and electronic forms in its information systems. Personal information must not be collected without the appropriate authority, even though the information might be useful.

Unsolicited personal information that is not necessary for program operation is not authorized for collection.

Staff must be able to explain to the client:

- The reason(s) the personal information is needed;
- The purpose the personal information will be used for;
- Client options regarding the provision of the personal information and the consequences of not providing it;
- The name and contact information of a person in Seniors, Community and Social Services.

Use of Personal Information

Personal information may only be used for the purpose for which it was collected; for example, for the [Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\)](#).

[Section 39 of the FOIP Act](#) lists the only circumstances under which Seniors, Community and Social Services may use personal information for a purpose other than that for which it was collected.

Staff Responsibility to Protect Personal Information

Staff must recognize that given the necessity to handle personal information:

- They must be aware of the relevant policies (e.g. Privacy and Security Policies) and procedures.
- Appropriate use of personal information means information must only be accessed in "need to know" circumstances.

Disclosure of Personal Information

FOIP Act

Section 40 of the [FOIP Act](#) lists the **only** circumstances under which Seniors, Community and Social Services may disclose personal information in the course of various administrative processes and in response to requests for access to information.

The authority to disclose personal information is delegated as per the [FOIP Delegation Matrix](#). If a staff member is not listed in the matrix, they must not disclose the information.

individual's written consent. If in doubt about disclosing personal information, staff should consult the Zone Executive Director. Information should be made accessible by the public.

IESA

Workers can also disclose information only as specified in [IESA](#) section 49:

- Where the disclosure is necessary for the administration of the *IESA*, **or**
- To any person employed in the administration of a similar Act in another province or territory
- To any person with the written consent of the Zone Executive Director.

The Minister has the power under [IESA](#) sec 49(2)(c) to disclose information to any person where the Zone Executive Director.

Specific policies for disclosing information under *IESA* and the *FOIP Act* are described below.

Disclosure of Client Information by Oral Consent

Under Seniors, Community and Social Services Oral Consent [Policy](#) and [Procedures](#), oral consent is only valid for 48 hours and all criteria outlined in the Oral Consent [Form](#).

Disclosure of Client Information to a Third Party by Written Consent

Under the [FOIP Act](#), the department may disclose personal information to a third party if the individual provides written consent in the manner outlined in the [FOIP Regulation](#). The consent must specify to whom the personal information is being disclosed and must be signed and dated by the applicant, client or legal guardian. This can be in the form of a [FOIP Information](#) form. To revoke their consent after submitting the letter or the completed form, the individual must provide written notice. An exception to the above is made if a legal guardian or other person with legal authority (e.g., a parent or an individual with a cognitive disability) requests the disclosure of the client's or applicant's personal information. Written authorization must be provided prior to disclosure.

Note

Consent does not mean the Worker must share the information with the third party. If the individual is coerced or misled, or is not aware of the extent of the sensitive nature of some of the information, the Worker should not disclose the information to the third party. Instead, the Worker may disclose the information directly to the client, applicant or legal guardian.

Requests for information related to psychological evaluations, medical reviews, third party information, or if the Worker has concerns about the legality or ethics of a disclosure, they should discuss the request with the Zone Executive Director. Requests should be reviewed by FOIP Operations or Privacy Services (formerly known as the Information and Privacy Services).

Note

The Information and Privacy Office has evolved into two distinct business units: Privacy Services and Information Services.

Disclosure to Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLAS)

Under the [FOIP Act](#), personal information may be disclosed to an MLA who has been requested by the MLA. Under the [Delegation Matrix](#) this is delegated to the **supervisor** or a **higher authority level**. The supervisor must ensure that the disclosure is related to that resolution. The personal information disclosure must be documented in [Compass Comments](#).

Disclosure Related to Law Enforcement

If a Seniors, Community and Social Services Alberta Supports Centre receives a request to disclose [Disclose Personal Information](#) must be completed.

Penalties for Breach of Confidentiality

Seniors, Community and Social Services is committed to the appropriate management of the process, up to and including, termination of employment.

In addition, under [section 92 of the FOIP Act](#), persons who willfully collect, use or disclose personal information not more than \$10,000.

Reports to Child and Family Services

The confidentiality requirements of the *IESA* and the protection requirements under the [FOIP Act](#) are any potential child protection concerns.

Procedures for Disclosure

Under the FOIP Delegation Matrix authority to disclose certain information is delegated beyond personal information, the Alberta Supports Centre will:

1. Complete the **EMP 2941 Request to Disclose Personal Information**.
2. Fax the completed form to the Zone Executive Director for review.

In situations of law enforcement requests to disclose information, the requesting Alberta Supports Centre faxes to the Zone Executive Director for review.

When the EMP 2941 Request to Disclose Personal Information is received, the Zone Executive

1. Review the request in accordance with [section 40 of the FOIP Act](#).

Note

The Zone Executive Director may disclose information about a client only in accordance with

2. Provide verbal consent or refusal for the request.
3. Complete section 4 of EMP 2941 Request to Disclose Personal Information within 10 working days.

Consent to Release

The Alberta Supports Centre will:

1. Enter the decision by the Zone Executive Director in Compass **Comments**.
2. Provide the information to the person requesting the information.

Refusal to Release

The Alberta Supports Centre will:

1. Enter the decision by the Zone Executive Director in Compass **Comments**.
2. Notify the person requesting the information that the information cannot be disclosed and

The Alberta Supports Centre and/or Zone Executive Director's office may consult with FOIP Op

Request for Income Support file

Requests for access to individual documents or a few records from the IS file can be disclosed

Requests for a complete copy of an Income Support file, multiple sections, or large sections of :
be submitted by an applicant, client or authorized representative one of two ways:

1. Complete the online request form found on the [Submit a FOIP request](#) website, or
2. Send a letter to the AISH program or FOIP Operations (address below).

If the Income Support program receives such a request, they must forward it to FOIP Operation

If a client submits a written request into the office, the following must be included with the reque

- The client's and authorized representative's (if applicable) name, address, and a telephon
- Be as specific as possible in describing the records they want to access,
- Include the date range of the records they want to access,
- Copy of their photo ID,
- Be signed and dated.

The Income Support office forwards the written request from the client to FOIP Operations via e

FOIP Operations
4th Floor, Standard Life Centre (SLC)
10405 Jasper Avenue
Edmonton, AB T5J 4R7

Note

FOIP Operations does not accept verbal requests.

If an applicant, client or authorized representative has questions about their access request, the
the number.

Privacy Breach

A privacy breach occurs when there is misuse of an individual's personal information through in disclosure could include an individual receiving another individual's personal information due to contravention of the FOIP Act. Additional information can be found in the [Privacy Breach Proce](#)

Persons who willfully contravene rules governing confidentiality in the FOIP Act may be guilty o including termination of employment, may also apply. Cases involving financial penalties are ra

1. If an Income Support staff member becomes aware of a confidentiality breach, they must available, the Income Support staff member contacts the Privacy Manager as identified in
 2. The Income Support Manager must immediately report the incident to the Privacy Manage Income Support Manager or assigned staff to review and discuss the situation and the sei staff member through any necessary steps (e.g. notifying the Office of the Information and will provide direction and guidance in completing the [Breach Report Form](#).
 3. The Income Support Manager takes immediate steps to recover any personal information
 4. The Income Support Manager immediately reports the incident to the Zone Executive Dire Deputy Minister.
 5. The Income Support Manager or assigned staff member completes all actions recommen
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Indexing of Benefits

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 1\(a.01\) and 5.1; Schedule Alberta Personal Income Tax Act, section 44.2](#)

INTENT

To allow Income Support benefits to be adjusted to reflect the increased cost of living over time

POLICY

Income Support benefit rates are adjusted annually, effective January 1st of each year. Starting established under section 44.2 of the [Alberta Personal Income Tax Act](#).

Annual adjustments are applied to Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) and Expected to Work (E

Core Benefits

- The following core benefits are indexed:
 - Core essential payment including the comforts allowance and
 - Core shelter payment.
 - For client household units living in a Type A continuing care home, the accomr [Care \(Ministerial\) Regulation](#)

Supplementary Benefits

- Supplementary benefits are indexed except in the following circumstances:
 - If they are provided for the actual cost of an item;
 - If they are based on an amount set in an agreement between the Minister and another
 - If they are based on an amount set in legislation separate from Income Support or b

How Benefits are Indexed

Annual benefit rate changes are calculated using the standard escalator amount established in Consumer Price Index (CPI) amount from October through September year-over-year.

See also: [Rounding Benefits](#).

Rounding Benefits

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2024

INTENT

To ensure clients do not receive less than they are eligible to receive, while adhering as closely

POLICY

When calculating a new benefit rate or issuing a benefit, the benefit amounts may contain value Full Employment Policy & Procedures manual.

The IT system used to issue benefits (LISA) does not accept decimal values. Where the actual nearest) dollar value. For example:

- If the actual value of the benefit is \$23.05, the LISA system uses the rounded amount
- If the actual value of the benefit is \$23.90, the LISA system uses the rounded amount

Manual Entry

In some instances, staff are required to manually enter benefit amounts into LISA. There are several pro-rated or if several iterations of a Supplementary Benefit are compounded during one Period

Whenever manual entry of a benefit amount is required, the entry should be as close as possible

- Cost for two [emergency goods/services](#) is \$100.30 and \$50.50. The sum of the two
- 341 kilometres are eligible for a [travel payment](#). The rate per kilometre is less than \$51.15. The worker enters \$52.
- A benefit is pro-rated and the actual eligible amount is \$99.33. The worker enters \$1

Income

This policy does not apply when entering **income** into LISA. Apply the [Rounding Income](#) policy

Assignment of Benefits

The process for Assignment of Benefits involves calculating a Minimum Weekly Allowance and provided/recovered is as close as possible to the actual amount (with cents) without penalizing

Email Communication

Last updated on: Sep 22, 2020

INTENT:

To provide guidelines on how to communicate with clients via email and ensure that communic

POLICY:

Workers can use email communication to correspond with clients. When communicating with cl

Policy Requirement: Policy requirements and criteria for benefits must still be followed regardl

Common Notification: For the purposes of programs and services under Alberta Supports, an should reference the Common Notification. The Common Notification statement provides an ex access. Refer to the [Information Sharing Fact Sheet: Understanding Common Notification for P](#)

FOIP: Workers must review and be familiar with the [Access to Information and Protection of Pri](#)

Government of Alberta Learning Management System: Workers must ensure all required tra

Records Management: Email(s) and attachment(s) that are considered as the official record m [and Transitory Records: A Guide for Government of Alberta Employees guide for additional info](#)

Other Considerations:

- All emails should have subject lines and bodies that are clear, but that do not contain any
- If sharing personal or private information with clients via email, confirm the client's identity (name, etc) and ensure that the correct email address is used prior to emailing
- When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information external to the GoA, us
 - Secure, encrypted website <https://sendfile.alberta.ca>. For more information, access
 - Password protected documents. Where possible, send documents in PDF and locke Send the password separately (not in the same email).

Guides to password protect documents:

- [How to Password Protect Word Documents](#)
- [How to Password Protect PDF Documents](#)
- [How to Password Protect a Zip File](#)

Additional information on digital communications can be found in the two links below:

- [Digital Communication Dos and Don'ts](#)

- [Digital Communication Tip Sheet](#)
-

02 Client Categories/Types

General Policy

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6\(1\)\(a\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1\(2\)\(5\), 4, 8 and 9](#)

INTENT

Client categorization provides a framework for workers to group clients according to common traits. Client sub-type as his/her relationship to the labour market changes.

POLICY

Clients are categorized as either, Expected to Work (ETW) or Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) Category/Type, the individual's client sub-type is established.

Criteria specific to each client sub-type are the basis for developing mutually agreed upon action plans.

Individuals are placed in client sub-types for several reasons:

- Each client sub-type has specific expectations. By meeting these expectations a client is assigned to a sub-type.
- An adult's client sub-type is used to determine the household unit sub-type Income Support Category/Type.
- The use of clients sub-type allows for a standardized system of benefit administration. For clients with different sub-types are not.
- Characterization by sub-type is a means of recognizing commonalities between different groups of clients, the government and the public at large.
- Determining appropriate intervention services in conjunction with other agencies and government sub-types are documented.

Determining Household Unit Sub-Type (HT)

The household unit sub-type is based on the client sub-type assigned to adult members of a household. The client sub-type "Expected to Work" is used to determine the household unit sub-type.

In a one-adult household, an individual's client sub-type (ETW or BFE) and the household unit sub-type are the same.

In a two adult household, where one adult is assigned to an ETW sub-type, the household unit sub-type is ETW.

Note

If one adult in the household is categorized as **BFE client sub-type 43 Severe Handicap**, the household unit sub-type is BFE.

Aside from the exception noted above, **both adults** in a household **must be assigned to a BFI**. A [Household Type Matrix](#) has been developed to determine which client category/type has priority.

Re-categorization

A client must be re-categorized to another client sub-type if his/her circumstances change and a new BFI is assigned.

PROCEDURES

Client Type and Household Unit Sub-Type fields are **mandatory** in **Eligibility Determination (ED)**.

The worker:

1. Determines the client sub-type of each adult in the household.
2. Enters the client sub-type fields in **ED** or **Client File**.

LISA **automatically defaults** to the appropriate household unit sub-type from the Household Type Matrix **File** and **Client Budget**.

LISA uses the household unit sub-types along with household composition, living arrangement, and income to determine the appropriate household unit sub-type for each household.

Client and Household Unit Sub-Types

Income Support (IS) Sub-Types

10 Expected To Work (ETW)

- 11 Self-Employed
- 12 Employed Full-Time
- 13 Employed Part-Time
- 14 Available for Work/Training
- 15 Attending a Program
- 17 Temporarily Unable to Work/Train – Health Problems
- 18 Temporarily Unable to Work/Train – Family Care

40 Barriers to Full Employment (BFE)

- 42 Medical or Multiple Barriers
- 43 Severe Handicap
- 44 Self-Employed
- 45 Employed Full-Time
- 46 Employed Part-Time
- 47 Attending a Program

80 One-Time Issue

- 81 Transient
- 82 Resident

Alberta Adult Health Benefits Sub-Types

70 Alberta Adult Health Benefits (AAHB)

72 AISH Leaver Due to Excess Employment Income73 AISH Leaver Due to Excess CPP-D Inc
74 ETW Leaver Due to Excess Employment Income
75 BFE Leaver Due to Excess Employment Income (Except HT 43)
77 BFE Severe Handicap Leaver Due to Excess Employment or CPP-D Income (HT 43 Only)
78 Health Benefits Card Only – Pregnancy
79 Health Benefits Card Only – High Drug Needs

Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) Sub-Types

90 AISH

91 Straight AISH
92 Modified AISH
93 In Government Group Home

One-Time Issues

Last updated on: Mar 21, 2024

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6\(1\)*](#)
[*Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 100\(1\)*](#)

INTENT

After an [assessment](#) of their employment, training, family, health and financial circumstances clients

- They are currently in receipt of on-going income that is sufficient to meet their basic needs
- Their need is emergent in nature, and it is unlikely that the client will require assistance in
- Their needs will likely be addressed through the issuance of Supplementary Non-Continuing (issued to a One-Time Issue client).

This assessment at the onset will better ensure that clients receive the appropriate type and level

The key distinctions between One-Time Issue and Expected to Work (ETW)/Barriers to Full Employment are currently in receipt of sufficient on-going income to meet their basic needs while recipients in the

NOTE

If it is not practical to complete a full assessment at the time of application for emergency assistance, the client must be receiving the most appropriate supports (financial and otherwise).

Record the reason the full assessment was not completed in Comments.

If the household transitions to ongoing assistance, ensure that an assessment is completed

POLICY

Applicants currently in receipt of sufficient on-going income may receive benefits as a one-time issue.

- A severe emergency exists, and
- No resources are available to meet the emergency need, and
- The worker has applied the program goals and principles, and the applicant meets all rule

A client in sub-type **81 Transient One-Time Issue** or **82 Resident One-Time Issue** is allowed to receive benefits at levels may be allowed at the discretion of the Supervisor when disposal of the asset would create a

Benefits beyond those listed in this section require [Director Approval](#). A [CPAP](#) device requires a

Applicants and Recipients in the One-Time Issue Client Category have a right to [appeal](#) and must

be considered a denial of benefits and as such the client must be advised of their right to appeal.

One-Time issue recipients in client categories **81** and **82** should be reassessed as new applicants following the One-Time Issue.

81 Transient

An applicant who:

- Does not have a fixed address in Alberta, **and**
- Does not intend to establish a permanent residence within Alberta, **and**
- May or may not have sufficient on-going income to meet their basic needs, **but**
- Does not have access to resources to meet their existing emergent need(s).

Eligible transient applicants receive benefits limited to the following:

- [Emergency Allowance](#)
- [Special Transportation and Travel](#)
- [Child Care](#)
- Emergency Health Benefits
 - [Emergency Prescription\(s\)/Drugs](#)
 - [Dental and Denturist Services](#)
 - [Optical Services](#)
 - [Ambulance](#)
 - [Diabetic Supplies](#)
- [Medical and Surgical Supplies](#)

82 Resident

An applicant who:

- Is not a transient, **and**
- Does not have an active Income Support file **and**
- Will not require benefits in the following month.

Note

AISH clients should be referred to the AISH program.

Applicants who are deceased and require an indigent burial are assisted as a resident One-Time

Applicants, who are employed and awaiting first pay, and who, at the time of the application, are of application have sufficient on-going income to meet their basic needs should be assigned to

Note

If an emergency exists such that an individual who is receiving funds from another program is not able to process the emergency request in time to prevent extreme hardship to the household

Eligible applicants receive benefits limited to the following:

- [Emergency Allowance](#)
- [Escaping Abuse Benefit](#)
- [Damage Deposit](#)
- [Non-Emergency Travel and Related Costs](#)
- [Child Care](#)
- [Core Shelter](#)
- [Core Essential](#)
- Emergency Health Benefits
 - [Emergency Prescription\(s\)/Drugs](#)
 - [Dental and Denturist Services](#)
 - [Optical Services](#)
 - [Ambulance](#)
 - [Diabetic Supplies](#)
- [Medical and Surgical Supplies](#)
- [Medical Extraordinary Transportation](#)
- [CPAP Devices](#)
- [Employment and Training Transition Supports](#)

Example

A two-parent family with two dependent children applies for assistance on July 20. One adult is only other income. They have no assets other than household furnishings and personal effects.

The core benefit for this family is less than \$1,500 a month. The family has no continuous suppl

This family unit is not eligible for on-going benefits because monthly income exceeds core need

However, **they are in need** on July 20. The family is out of food, and they have a disconnection of other available resources without success.

They are eligible for an emergency food and utility arrears allowance under client category **82**.

PROCEDURE

See [One-Time Issue Applicants \(Client Types 81 and 82\)](#).

Expected to Work (ETW)

Client Sub-Type 11-18 Overview

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

INTENT

Clients are assigned to the Expected to Work (ETW) client type if they are:

- Employed or employable and able to sustain full-time employment in the competitive labor market
- Able to participate in a short-term educational or training program leading to employment
- Able to be employed but temporarily unavailable for employment because of a health problem, age, or
- Receiving residential addiction treatment for alcohol, drug or gambling addictions.
- Able to be employed but who have family care responsibilities of a temporary nature.

The key distinction between ETW and Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) clients is, the ability to obtain employment are not assigned to the ETW client type.

POLICY

ETW client sub-types must have an [assessment](#) completed. An assessment must be completed

An [Individual Plan](#) must be completed for all clients prior to any financial benefit being issued for their Individual Plan.

If a client does not follow through with their Individual Plan or any other expectations outlined w

Client Sub-Type 11 Self Employed

Last updated on: Aug 27, 2025

Characteristics

Clients who are [self-employed, or a farmer](#), and engaged in developing a viable business. These determine business viability.

Note

Self-employed clients should be provided with the Alberta Business Link Service Centre toll-free

Clients should only be assigned to this ETW sub-type for three months (or 12 months if they are by a CEC including: a review of the client's [assessment](#), their current business viability, their [Inc](#) category. If they wish to pursue self-employment beyond this period, and refuse to actively seek

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, self-employed clients are also required to:

- Keep accurate records of business expenses and income received.
- Maximize earning potential (increase hours, seek additional work contracts).
- Demonstrate progression towards viability.

Substantiation

The client provides proof of earnings.

Client Sub-Type 12 Employed Full-Time

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

Clients working 40 hours per week, or having full-time employment as defined by the employer. meeting expectations to become self-sufficient.

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, clients employed full-time are also required to

- Maintain current employment.
- Actively seek employment opportunities (increased hours, additional work and/or alternative activities).
- Maintain and provide, upon request, an accurate record of attempts to secure alternate employment activities.
- Accept any reasonable job, and not limit himself or herself to a specific type of job or a specific employer.
- Update skills through part-time training if this is needed to progress to a position leading to full-time employment.
- Have an [assessment](#) completed within 6 months of being categorized sub-type 12 to ensure self-sufficiency.

Note

Clients determined, through an [assessment](#) by a CEC, to be not able to become fully self-sufficient.

Substantiation

The client provides proof of earnings.

Client Sub-Type 13 Employed Part-Time

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

Clients working less than 40 hours per week but more than five hours per week, or defined as part-time, are required to receive services to assist them in meeting expectations to become self-sufficient.

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, clients employed part-time are also required to:

- Maintain and maximize employment, and with appropriate employment training and/or support
- Actively seek employment opportunities (increased hours, additional work and/or alternate employment)
- Maintain and provide, upon request, an accurate record of attempts to secure employment
- Accept any reasonable job, and not limit himself or herself to a specific type of job or a specific employer
- Update skills through part-time training if this is needed to progress to a position leading to full-time employment
- Have an [assessment](#) completed within 6 months of being categorized sub-type 13 to ensure appropriate services

Note

[assessment](#)

Substantiation

The client provides proof of earnings.

Client Sub-Type 14 Available for Work/Training

Last updated on: Sep 16, 2024

Characteristics

Clients who are unemployed but available for work/training. Clients must look for work or prepare for services. **Clients in this sub-type are a priority for employment and training services;** therefore, they must be available for work/training.

This sub-type includes clients who may have income from sources other than employment; for example, from family or friends.

- are available for employment and actively seeking employment **and/or**
- work less than five hours a week **and/or**
- may have a range of barriers to employment **and** require one or more of the following interventions:
 - assistance with resume writing, interview and job search techniques
 - short-term courses, pre-employment programs or skill training
 - employment preparation services
 - job maintenance skills
 - early intervention for addictions/substance abuse
 - academic upgrading and/or career planning
 - motivational techniques
 - life management
 - addictions counseling
 - literacy training
 - settlement services (special and specific services required by immigrants)
 - English as a Second Language (ESL) training

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, clients who are available for work/training are expected to:

- actively seek employment and accept any reasonable job and not limit themselves to a specific type of work
- maintain and provide, upon request, an accurate record of attempts to secure employment. The [EMP13552 Job Search Record](#) may be completed to assist clients in recording these activities.
- complete an EI application, if applicable.

Substantiation

When a client is receiving EI benefits, they must provide proof of income. When a client has applied for EI benefits, Workers verify this verbal declaration by using [WebAOBLink](#). Other substantiation required should be provided.

Client Sub-Type 15 Attending a Program

Last updated on: Oct 27, 2023

Client Sub-Type 15 Attending a Program

Characteristics

ETW Clients who are **attending** full-time pre-employment or rehabilitation programs identified in the list below provide general information to prepare for employment not a specific skill set and could include:

- Life management
- Anger management
- Residential addictions treatment
- Job placement
- Job search

These are NOT programs under the *Student Financial Assistance Act (SFAA)*. Clients planning through the *SFAA* or alternate sources.

Note

For more information regarding Income Support eligibility based on the type of program, see [Pe](#)

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, clients who are attending a program are also

- Maintain the same level of commitment and behaviour in their program as an employer would expect.
- Attend the program regularly.
- Inform program officials of the reason for any absences.
- Comply with all program policies and practices for student conduct.
- Attend employment workshops provided by department staff as required.
- Have an [assessment](#) completed.

Substantiation

Worker's knowledge of the client's situation, or a statement from the program provider regarding

Client Sub-Type 17 Temporarily Unavailable for Work

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

A client with disabilities or health problems that are anticipated to prevent employment for up to 6 months must be clearly documented on the [Individual Plan](#), medical note, etc.

Clients in receipt of EI for medical reasons and/or clients in the last trimester of pregnancy are categorized as Sub-Type 17.

Single persons, with no dependent children, who have recently left an abusive relationship and are seeking employment.

Clients must have an [assessment](#) completed within a reasonable period of being categorized as Sub-Type 17, e.g., medical assessment etc.

The minimum expectation is that an Individual Plan be negotiated with clients in this sub-type once they are able to work.

Ideally, the Individual Plan should be negotiated with the client at the time they are assigned to Sub-Type 17. The goal is to provide the client an opportunity, with Department support, to move towards independence if at all possible. The client should be reassessed after six months of the client being placed in this sub-type.

Clients should **not** be in this sub-type longer than six months, unless an unusual set of temporary circumstances is documented.

Expectations

In addition to the expectations for all ETW clients, clients who are temporarily unable to work/travel should be reassessed every six months.

Substantiation

- A note or letter from the client's physician or nurse practitioner confirming a medical situation that prevents employment for up to 6 months.
 - In the case of a person leaving an abusive relationship, the verbal statement of the client or a professional source (physician, nurse practitioner, women's shelter, police, etc.).
 - The worker will request that the client's physician or nurse practitioner complete an [EMP \(Employment Plan\)](#). If the medical professional refuses to provide a note or letter to the client, the client should be reassessed every six months.
-

Client Sub-Type 18 Temporarily Unavailable for Work

Last updated on: Nov 07, 2023

Characteristics

Clients who have family care responsibilities of a temporary nature. This includes clients who:

- Are caring for a dependent child under 12 months old, **or**
- Are caring for a disabled member of the household unit who is on the client's file, **or**
- Have been assessed as having unusual difficulty in coping with the competing demands of family and work
- Are single parents with dependent children, who have recently left an abusive relationship
- Are involved with Children and Youth Services and must comply with that department's case management requirements

Expectations

Clients must have an [assessment](#) completed within a reasonable period of being categorized as a Client Sub-Type 18. This includes a Youth Services case plan, assessments, etc.

Substantiation

- Information containing the child's name and birth date for clients who are caring for a dependent child
 - Medical documentation from the family member's physician or nurse practitioner stating the nature of the condition on the file.
 - Individuals having unusual difficulty coping with the competing demands of family and work responsibilities, with the recommendation of an ERA review to be completed within 90 days of the assessment
 - In the case of a person leaving an abusive relationship, the verbal statement of the client or a written statement from a professional source (physician, nurse practitioner, women's shelter, police).
 - Clients who are unavailable for employment or training as a result of compliance with Children and Youth Services.
-

Barriers to Full Employment (BFE)

Client Sub-Types 42-47 Overview

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

INTENT

Clients who show evidence that they will probably never be able to work full-time continuously in the competitive labour market are categorized as BFE sub-type.

POLICY

The key distinction between [Expected To Work](#) (ETW) and BFE clients is, although some BFE clients may achieve full-time employment in the competitive labour market. Clients in the BFE sub-types receive a higher benefit rate than ETW clients.

If the client's employment in the competitive labour force is intermittent because of their health problem, they are categorized as BFE.

Note: BFE clients who work in sheltered employment are not to be re-categorized to the ETW category.

To be placed in the BFE client category all clients **must**:

- Have an [assessment](#) completed within the timeframe outlined under the specific BFE sub-type.
- Be assessed as having multiple barriers or a persistent mental or physical health problem.
- Have the required supporting documentation/substantiation for that sub-type.

Expectations of all BFE Sub-Type Categories

All clients in the BFE category are expected to:

- Follow recommended medical treatment; **and**
- Maintain contact with their worker and attend appointments as required; **and**
- Develop an [Individual Plan](#) with their worker; **and**

Note: The activities contained in the Individual Plan should be appropriate to the client's circumstances. Consideration is given to what Departmental support(s) are required to assist the client in achieving their goals.

- Inform their worker of changes in circumstances, which may affect their Individual Plan; **and**
- Access and attend all resources identified in their Individual Plan, or through referral by their worker; **and**
- Follow through on Individual Plan expectations.

If a client does not follow through with their Individual Plan or any other expectations outlined w

Client Sub-Type 42 Medical or Multiple Barriers

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Clients who are likely to be permanently unable to take full-time/continuous employment in the future due to a medical or other barrier, are placed in this client sub-type.

Exception

Clients whose medical condition, or course of treatment is expected to prevent employment or training, may be assigned to this client sub-type. An [assessment](#) is completed by a CEC to determine if the condition improves. If there are no barriers to employment other than the temporary medical condition, the client is assigned to another sub-type.

The client is assigned to an appropriate ETW sub-type when the medical condition no longer prevents employment or training.

Characteristics

Clients placed in sub-type **42** are:

- Suffering from persistent mental or physical health problems with expected duration of months or longer.
- Assessed as having multiple barriers to employment.

Assessing for Multiple Barrier Factors

While any one of the multiple barrier factors, listed below, may not in itself create a barrier to employment, a combination of two or more is best suited within the BFE sub-types.

The factors and criteria a Career and Employment Consultant (CEC) considers when completing an assessment are:

- **Medical Impairment** – A persistent mental or physical health problem may create a significant barrier when combined with other factors.
- **Lack of Formal Education** – Grade 8 level or lower may create a barrier in combination with other factors. FASD, etc., should be considered.
- **Social Skills** – A low-functioning client, particularly one who has attended programs such as VET, may not be acceptable in a work environment.
- **Work History** – The client has not sustained steady employment for any number of reasons other than a lack of work history.
- **Age** – A client 60 years and over. Under certain circumstances, younger clients may also be considered.
- **History of Unsuccessful Intervention** – Several interventions have been tried, but the client has not appeared to offer strategies that have not been tried already.
- **Other Social Factors** – Any other relevant social factors such as family situation and/or other barriers.

Substantiation

- An assessment when the multiple barriers was assessed or within a reasonable period of circumstances, assessments, etc.
- In addition, in the case of a person with a persistent mental or physical health problem with
 - [EMP 0207 Medical Information form](#) (internal document); or
 - (DS2444B) [AISH Application - Medical Report](#); or
 - **Note/report from a doctor or nurse practitioner.**

When applying for AISH, BFE clients may be asked to have their physician or specialist complete the report. For BFE clients, Income Support will pay costs associated with completing an AISH medical report in accordance with the AISH Act. For clients who are not BFE, the IS worker can give the [EMP](#)

Note

Expected to Work (ETW) clients should speak to their worker prior to applying for AISH.

Client Sub-Type 43 Severe Handicap

Last updated on: Jul 23, 2025

Characteristics

Client Sub-type **43 Severe Handicap** is applied to an individual who meets the criteria for [severe Regulation](#).

Under the AISH General Regulation, “Severe Handicap” is an impairment of mental and/or physical

- After considering any relevant medical or psychological reports, causes substantial limitation
- Is likely to continue to affect that person permanently because no remedial therapy is available

Income Support workers have discretion to assign an individual, who meets Income Support financial

- The client is designated AISH eligible by an AISH worker/Adjudicator; and it is determined that the AISH program is better able to meet the household’s financial needs; **or**
- The worker deems that the client has a ‘severe handicap’ (consistent with the AISH definition) that they intend to apply for AISH).
- If there is a recommendation for a client to apply for AISH, they should apply for federal Old Age Security Benefit.

1. Client is Eligible for AISH Program Benefits

AISH workers/Adjudicators have sole authority to designate an individual AISH eligible. When an Income Support staff to determine which program best meets the household’s financial need. If the client file is transferred to AISH. If it is determined that the household’s needs are best met by AISH, Consultation between AISH and Income Support staff should reoccur if there are significant changes.

Note:

For clients with an outstanding debt, workers must calculate the benefit level without considering the needs of the household.

2. Client’s Medical Substantiation is Consistent with AISH Medical Criteria and Client has

Income Support workers may assign a client to Sub-type **43**, if convinced that medical documentation provides reasonable evidence of a severe and permanent handicap. The client must also be in the process of applying for the AISH program.

Clients in this circumstance who do not have an AISH medical code, must be assigned AISH medical code

Note:

Clients assigned to Sub-type **43 Severe Handicap** by an Income Support worker are NOT in the AISH process and can only be designated AISH eligible by the AISH program.

Note:

If a client is adjudicated as medically ineligible for AISH by the AISH program, then it is essential that the client is not assigned to Sub-type **43** of ‘severe handicap.’ The client should be assigned to a different client category. At the worker’s discretion.

of their AISH medical eligibility.

For clients who are assigned to Sub-type 43 but who have not yet submitted an application to the program, ensure that the AISH application is being actively pursued. The client should be assigned to a different program. For more information see the [Handicap Benefit](#) policy.

Substantiation

- [EMP0207 Medical Information](#) form, or
- Note/report from a physician or nurse practitioner, or
- [DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report](#), and
- A completed [assessment](#) within a reasonable period of being assigned to Client Sub-type

If uncertain whether a client's medical documentation substantiates an impairment that is considered

- Consult with an Adjudicator; and/or
- Solicit additional medical information and consult with the physician or nurse practitioner v

Clients in Sub-type **43**, who are employed or attending part-time training, are NOT automatically

Clients in Sub-type **43** who maintain full-time employment, over a twelve-month period, at minimum review of their [assessment](#). The client may be reassigned to a client sub-type that more accurately reflects their AISH eligibility (by the AISH program), the CEC is advised to consult with an AISH adjudicator

Guidelines for Issuing [DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report](#) to Income Support Clients

If more comprehensive medical information is required to determine whether a client should be assigned to Sub-type **43**, the CEC is advised to issue the **DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report** to the client for physician's completion.

Prior to issuing the **DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report**, Income Support workers MUST be unnecessary to request additional information.

Providing the **DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report** may be appropriate in situations v

- The Income Support worker, after completing an [assessment](#) and reviewing available medical information, determines that additional medical substantiation is required to support this decision; or
- There is insufficient detail on a client's completed medical note/report or **EMP0207 Medical Information** to determine the severity of the medical condition and its impact on the client's ability to earn
- The client's file contains several short-term medical notes and/or **EMP 0207 Medical Information** over a period of 18 months or longer.

When issuing an **DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report**, Income Support workers MUST ensure that the completed **DS2444B AISH Application - Medical Report** will be used by the Government

This medical report may be shared with:

- AISH and Income Support program staff;
- the AISH Appeal Panel in any appeal regarding the applicant's medical eligibility;
- the Canada Pension Plan Disability program to help determine the applicant's medical eligibility;
- a medical consultant or psychological consultant on contract with Assisted Living and Social Services.

Note:

Section 40 (1) (l) of the [FOIP Act](#) gives the authority to share information for the purpose of

When applying for AISH, BFE clients may be asked to have their physician or specialist complete a medical report. The client may be asked to pay costs associated with completing an AISH Medical Report in accordance with established fees. If the client is unable to pay the specialist's cost for completing the medical, the Income Support worker can give the [EMP1158](#).

Note:

Expected to Work (ETW) clients should speak to their worker prior to applying for AISH.

Process for Transferring AISH Files to the Income Support Program

AISH eligible clients whose financial needs are best met by receiving Income Support benefits, Client Sub-type **43 Severe Handicap**. When transferring an AISH client file to the Income Support program, the AISH worker:

1. contacts the Income Support program to review whether the client would be eligible for Income Support.

If it is assessed that the client will be better off on Income Support, the AISH worker:

1. discusses this with the client,
2. ensures all payments on LISA have been paid and any outstanding overpayments are processed,
3. transfers the client's electronic LISA file and copies the AISH approval and supporting documents.

If eligible for Income Support, the Income Support worker will:

1. update the file to reflect the new client category, effective date, budget, etc.,
2. have the client read and sign an EMP2004 Notice of Eligibility,
3. issue the client's benefits taking into account the amount already issued under AISH.

Note:

The remainder of the AISH client's file is retained by the AISH office on imaging. Normal **SCCP2230-4 File Disposition Report**. Detailed instruction on [File Transfers](#) may be referred to.

Process for Transferring Income Support Files to the AISH Program

Income Support recipients who are assessed as AISH eligible and whose financial needs are b
When transferring an Income Support client file to the AISH program, Income Support staff:

1. ensures that Income Support payments owing to the client are issued and that outstanding
2. informs the AISH worker of details in Compass Comments that may have an impact on th
information for the purpose of determining or verifying an individual's suitability or eligibility
3. initiates electronic file transfer, and
4. forwards AISH eligibility documents: AISH Eligibility Decision, DS2444B AISH Application
program.

Note:

The remainder of the Income Support client's file is retained by the Income Support office
action are listed on the [File Transfers](#)

Client Sub-Type 44 Self-Employed

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

These BFE clients are self-employed and engaged in developing a business. They are **not** required to be employed by a business.

Note

A worker should refer self-employed clients to one of the Alberta offices of [Canada Business Network](#). Clients should be provided with the toll-free number (1-800-272-9675) and the website address, [www.businessnetwork.ca](#).

In addition to the expectations for all BFE clients, self-employed clients are also required to:

- Keep [accurate records of business expenses](#) and [income received](#)
- Maximize earning potential if reasonable (increase hours, seek additional work contracts)

Substantiation

- Proof of earnings
 - An [assessment](#) completed when the multiple barrier was assessed or within a reasonable medical, client circumstances, assessments, etc.
 - In addition, in the case of a person with a persistent mental or physical health problem with:
 - [EMP 0207 Medical Information form](#) (internal document); or
 - [\(DS2444\) AISH Application Part B Medical Report](#); or
 - Note/report from a doctor or nurse practitioner.
-

Client Sub-Type 45 Employed Full-Time

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

These BFE clients (excluding Client Sub-Type 43 Severe Handicap) are working 40 hours per week. If the client's employment in the competitive labour force is intermittent because of their condition, they remain in this BFE sub-type.

If the client has sustained full-time employment in the competitive labour market for more than 12 months, determine if they should be re-categorized as Expected To Work.

In addition to the expectations for all BFE clients, clients employed full-time are also required to

- Maintain current employment if at all possible.
- Maximize employment opportunities if reasonable (increase hours, seek additional or alternative employment).
- Attend employment workshops provided by department staff as required.

Substantiation

- Proof of earnings
 - An [assessment](#) completed when the multiple barrier was assessed or after 6 months of being employed.
 - In addition, in the case of a person with a persistent mental or physical health problem with a barrier to employment:
 - [EMP 0207 Medical Information](#) (internal document); or
 - [\(DS2444\) AISH Application Part B Medical Report](#); or
 - Note/report from a doctor or nurse practitioner.
-

Client Sub-Type 46 Employed Part-Time

Last updated on: Jun 08, 2022

Characteristics

These BFE clients (excluding Client Sub-Type **43 Severe Handicap**) are working less than 40 hours per week.

Clients are not expected to be capable of significantly improving their employment situation, and

They are able to work part-time or temporarily in non-sheltered or sheltered employment but unable to work full-time.

In addition to the expectations for all BFE clients, clients employed part-time are also required to:

- Maintain current employment if at all possible.
- Maximize employment opportunities if able (increased hours, additional work and/or alternate employment).
- Attend employment workshops provided by department staff as required.

Substantiation

- Proof of earnings
 - An [assessment](#) completed when the multiple barrier was assessed or within a reasonable time frame due to medical, client circumstances, assessments, etc.
 - In addition, in the case of a person with a persistent mental or physical health problem with a documented condition:
 - [EMP 0207 Medical Information form](#) (internal document); or
 - [\(DS2444\) AISH Application Part B Medical Report](#); or
 - Note/report from a doctor or nurse practitioner.
-

Client Sub-Type 47 Attending a Program

Last updated on: Oct 27, 2023

Characteristics

BFE clients (excluding Client Sub-Type **43 Severe Handicap**) who are attending full-time pre-e

These programs alone are not expected to lead to employment. They provide general informati

- Training for disabled persons not expected to lead to full-time continuous employment
- Life management
- Anger management
- Residential addictions treatment
- Parenting programs or other interventions required to comply with an Alberta Community

These are NOT programs under the *Student Financial Assistance Act (SFAA)*. Clients planning through the *SFAA* or alternate sources

Note

For more information regarding Income Support eligibility based on the type of program, see [Pe](#)

In addition to the expectations for all BFE clients, clients attending a program are also required

- Maintain the same level of commitment and behaviour in their program, as an employer w
- Attend the program regularly.
- Inform program officials of the reason for any absences.
- Comply with all program policies and practices for student conduct.
- Attend employment workshops provided by department staff as required.

Substantiation

- Statement from the program provider regarding the type and length of the program and pr
- An [assessment](#) completed when the multiple barrier was assessed or within a reasonable medical, client circumstances, assessments, etc.
- In addition, in the case of a person with a persistent mental or physical health problem wit
 - [EMP 0207 Medical Information form](#) (internal document); or
 - [\(DS2444\) AISH Application Part B Medical Report](#); or

- Note/report from a doctor or nurse practitioner.

Alberta Adult Health Benefits (AAHB) Sub-Types

Last updated on: Aug 11, 2011

70 Alberta Adult Health Benefits

[ISTHB Regulation, Part 3, section 87](#) states the criteria for initial eligibility for former Income Support (IS) recipients.
[ISTHB Regulation, Part 3, section 88](#) states the criteria for initial eligibility for households with a member receiving IS.
[ISTHB Regulation, Part 3, section 89](#) states the criteria for initial eligibility for other households.
[ISTHB Regulation, Part 3, section 87](#) states the criterion for annual renewal for former assistance recipients.
[ISTHB Regulation, Part 3, section 89](#) states the criterion for annual renewal for other households.
[Ministerial Order 1/2015](#)

Overview Seniors, Community and Social Services provides the Alberta Adult Health Benefit (AAHB) for persons leaving the Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) programs to eligible persons leaving these programs (CPP-D) program. The AAHB is also available to women during pregnancy and to households with income at or below the qualifying income levels. Eligibility for AAHB is regulated. Only household units with the characteristics and [eligibility](#) conditions described in the [Alberta Adult Health Benefit](#) (AAHB) program section before

Note

For all AAHB sub-types, eligible dependents/children include children under 18 years, as well as

AAHB Sub-Type 72: AISH Leaver Due to Excess Employment/Self-Employment Income

Characteristics

Households previously in receipt of AISH benefits, who obtain independence from the AISH program. Income may be **combined** with any other type of income.

AAHB Sub-Type 73: AISH Leaver Due to Excess CPP-D Income

Characteristics

Households previously in receipt of AISH benefits, who obtain independence from the AISH program. Income may be **combined** with any other type of income.

AAHB Sub-Type 74: ETW Leaver Due to Excess Employment/Self-Employment Income

Characteristics

Households previously in the Expected to Work sub-types who obtain independence from Income Support (IS). Income may be **combined** with any other type of income.

AAHB Sub-Type 75: BFE Leaver Due to Excess Employment/Self Employment Income (e

Characteristics

Households previously in the Barriers to Full Employment sub-types (with the exception of CT 4 self-employment, which may be **combined** with any other type of income.

AAHB Sub-Type 77: BFE Severe Handicap Leaver Due to Excess Employment/Self Employment

Characteristics

Households previously in the Barriers to Full Employment sub-types, with an adult in the sub-type who is not in employment, self-employment or the Canada Pension Plan Disability (CPP-D) program, with

AAHB Sub-Type 78: Health Benefits Card Only - Pregnancy

Characteristics

[Pregnant women](#) and their children, who are not in receipt of Income Support, are eligible for AAHB if their income is equal to or less than the AAHB qualifying income level for their family type.

AAHB Sub-Type 79: Health Benefits Card Only - High Drug Needs

Characteristics

Individuals and families are eligible for AAHB until the annual renewal date, if the combined household [drug supplies](#) required by the household is equal to or less than the AAHB qualifying income level for their family type.

PROCEDURES

The worker documents in Compass notes the circumstances which qualify a client for the assignment.

03 Special Groups

INTENT

Last updated on: Sep 18, 2023

To ensure the Income Support program and benefits are administered fairly and equitably for all eligibility for income support benefits.

Seniors, Community and Social Services Employees

Last updated on: Oct 09, 2024

INTENT

To protect the privacy of an employee and their immediate family members, close friends, or people

POLICY

When employees, their immediate family members and/or persons living with the employees have

Within Calgary and Edmonton city limits:

- Income Support employees, their immediate family members and/or persons living with at Centre other than the centre at which they are employed.
- Under no circumstances may benefits (one time or on-going) be administered through the

Outside Calgary or Edmonton city limits:

- Service Centres can administer benefits to an Income Support employee, his or her immediate applying, at the employee's Service Centre if an alternate Service Centre cannot reasonably
- A Seniors, Community and Social Services employee related to the applicant cannot be in

An employee who has a closed file may request restricted access on CCD by contacting the supervisor

PROCEDURES

1. Applications for assistance must be taken by a [supervisor](#) or higher authority within the Service
 2. Initial benefits must be approved by the Manager and recorded on [EMP 1086 Approval Log](#).
be reviewed by the Manager and recorded on the **EMP 1086 Approval Log**.
 3. Although it is preferred that the supervisor maintain responsibility for administration of on-
 4. The supervisor must establish restricted access to the file on both the LISA system and C
-

Deceased Clients

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

INTENT

To allow the surviving family or next of kin time to get their affairs in order following the death of

POLICY

Surviving Family on Income Support

When an [Income Support client dies](#) and has a surviving family that remains on Income Support, notification of the death, to pay for extra costs incurred by the death.

1. Deceased Head of Household (HH)

If the deceased was the HH, the file is closed at the end of the month in which the death occurred. An extra shelter benefit, in the amount the shelter was reduced, may be given for one full month.

2. Deceased Not HH

If the household unit's liquid assets remain within regulated limits, the worker deletes the client's file. An extra shelter benefit, in the amount the shelter was reduced, may be given for one full month using Need Code 1. If the household unit now has liquid assets over the exemption limits, the client is advised that if the excess of the allowable level, the file is closed at the end of the month in which the death occurred.

No Surviving Family

When an Income Support client dies and there is no surviving family, the next of kin or estate are notified of the death to pay extra costs incurred from the death (e.g., apartment cleaning, utilities).

The maximum Income Support benefits that the Income Support client's estate can receive is the amount of the current month's payment.

PROCEDURES

Immediately upon notification of a client's death, the worker:

- If a payment has **not** been generated (**G**) or printed (**P**), sets the **Cheque Release** flag, **CRC** flag and **Payment Status** flag for the current assistance period.
 - If the payment has already been generated or printed, allows the family or estate to receive the current month's payment.
- Indicates on the comments line of the **CRC Processing** screen **5** that no further benefits are payable.
- Records the date of the client's death and any other relevant information.
- Enters a deceased date on the **Person Profile (SCCS030)** screen of CCD.

Example

If the client died in January and the worker is not notified until after the February payment, the client's Income Support benefits would be withheld.

Financial Administrators, Public Trustee or Third Party

Last updated on: Sep 06, 2024

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 17](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(4\)](#)

INTENT

If a person who is eligible for Income Support is unable to conduct their own financial affairs, then as a landlord), in full or in part, ensures Income Support benefits are expended to meet that person's needs.

POLICY

Workers may consider the appropriateness of the appointment of a financial administrator or refer to a third party on a case-by-case basis when the client:

- lacks the mental capacity to expend income support payments in such a manner as to meet their needs;
- has established a pattern of expending their income in such a manner that their essential needs are not met.

Workers should obtain a client's consent prior to establishing a financial administrator or a payment to a third party.

When the client does not consent to the appointment of a financial administrator, or to third party payments, the Panel for a decision regarding the client's ability to manage their own financial affairs. To communicate this decision, the Panel must indicate that they are doing so because the client does not consent to appointment of a financial administrator.

Third Party Payments

Payments to a third party should be made only for a purpose relevant to the third party (e.g., shelter, food, utility arrears) or may be necessary on an ongoing basis over more than one period.

Benefits not issued for a specific purpose (e.g., handicap benefit or personal needs supplement).

The client or financial administrator signs/attests to form to provide consent prior to redirecting a payment. The form includes the name of the payee, (e.g., landlord) and the specific time period for which the third-party payment must follow procedures as outlined for [third-party cheques](#).

Private Financial Administrator

A private financial administrator is appointed under [IESA Section 17](#) with the consent of clients, and the supervisor.

Income Support workers may request an accounting from the financial administrator when they believe the financial administrator is not acting in the best interests of the client, or fails to provide required information.

Note

These rules apply to financial administrators appointed under the authority of the *IESA* on behalf of the supervisor. The supervisor cannot revoke a court appointed trustee.

Authority

Supervisor

If there is suspicion or evidence that a financial administrator is not expending the Income Support investigation. The Service Centre initiates appropriate action based on the outcome of the investigation.

Private financial administrators are required to report the client's circumstances on a monthly basis.

Public Trustee (Seniors, Community and Social Services)

If the [Public Trustee](#) is already the trustee for the client, then he/she is automatically the financial administrator.

If the person does not already have a Public Trustee, then Seniors, Community and Social Services assist the dependent adult as a private financial administrator.

The Public Trustee derives its authority from the *Public Trustee Act*, or in the case of a mentally incapable person either by order of the Surrogate Court or after a Certificate of Incapacity is issued.

The Public Trustee has the power to maintain and preserve a dependent adult's (individuals 18 and over) interests. This may include the right to:

- lease, sell or transfer property,
- deposit or invest money,
- write or cash cheques or bonds,
- settle debts or court actions,
- carry out contracts, **or**
- carry on business on behalf of the dependent adult.

An **annual report is required** for all clients whose finances are managed by the Public Trustee.

PROCEDURES

Workers must make sure the financial administrator, and client, when possible, understand the [0509 Financial Administrator Appointment](#).

The worker takes the following steps when:

- the Public Trustee has been appointed for an applicant who is applying for Income Support
- an AISH client applies for Income Support benefits, including one-time issues and the Public Trustee is involved
- an Income Support client is approved for AISH benefits and the Public Trustee is involved

The worker:

1. phones the office of the Office of the Public Guardian and Trustee (OPGT) and obtains all necessary information
2. records the following in Compass Comments:
 - date of the call,

- name of the person providing the information, and
- financial details

If the Client is Eligible, the worker

1. has the client (or guardian, if applicable) sign or attest to the [EMP 3428 Income Support A](#)
 2. explains to the signer the information the Public Trustee provides,
 3. crosses out and initials any statement in the Declaration the signer is unable to declare/at
 4. prints Public Trustee on the Trustee's Signature line in the Declaration (whether or not the
 5. issues benefits payable to the Public Trustee, based on the information received verbally
Note: If funds are required immediately for food and shelter, the worker and the Public Tr issues payable to the Public Trustee.
 6. sends a copy of the [EMP 3428 Income Support Application](#) to the office of the Public Trus
 7. records the assigned Service Centres/unit/caseload on the [EMP 3428 Income Support Ar](#)
Public Trustee sends a memo to the worker substantiating the income and assets of the c
Note: The Public Trustee returns CRCs monthly, stamped with the words Public Trustee :
 8. creates a Compass Reminder for one month to make sure the memo is received from the
 9. follows up on the Compass Reminder if required and adjusts the client's budget, if necess
 10. images the memo from the Public Trustee with the [EMP 3428 Income Support Applicator](#)
-

High School Incentive (HSI) Benefit

Last updated on: Apr 30, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 4\(c\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 25](#)

INTENT

To assist low-income families financially with the cost of a new baby in the family, and to encourage and remain with their family for emotional and social support.

To address the inequity that exists if the young parent, attending a program under the *Educational Assistance Act*, is not eligible for financial assistance under the *Student Financial Assistance Act (SFAA)* as opposed to remaining as a dependent child on the Income Support file.

POLICY

The High School Incentive (HSI) Benefit provides a monthly benefit to households with 16- 19-year-olds who reside with their parents and are included as a dependent child on their parent's Income Support file.

If the 18- 19-year-old parent **chooses** to be treated as an independent while living at home with their child, the child is excluded from the Income Support household unit.

To be eligible for this benefit:

- the 16- 19-year-old parent must be attending the regular school system (kindergarten to grade 12)
- the youth and their child(ren) must both be dependent children on the Income Support file
- the 16- 19-year-old parent must be the legal guardian of the child. Families where the grantor is 16- 17 years of age are **not** eligible for this benefit.

Families continue to receive the HSI for the months of July and August if the 16- 19-year-old parent does not attend school in September, no debt is calculated for July and August as the youth had **intended** to attend school and the youth did not attend school.

Substantiation

- Verbal statement or worker knowledge of client situation, **or**
- If there is concern about where the dependent children are attending school, a letter from the school.
- An [**EMP3428C - Declaration of 18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Child**](#) form is complete and the youth is included on the [**EMP3428 Income Support Application**](#). The **EMP3428C Declaration** must be signed by the client (and spouse/partner if applicable) and dependent child's physical signature or the worker must:
 - verbally review and complete the **EMP3428C** form with the client and dependent child.

- receive acknowledgement that the client and dependent child consent, understand and agree with the contents.
- physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client and dependent child.
- enter a Compass Comment attesting that the **EMP3428C** form was read to the client and dependent child, and they agreed with the contents.

Note

The signed form is then imaged to the client's electronic file.

Rates

The HSI is the difference between the total benefits issued for the youth and their child(ren) who would receive (in total) if FLA student were issued for the 16- 19-year-old parent with their child(ren).

The worker manually calculates the HSI benefit using the following formula:

1. Determine what the 16- 19-year-old parent and their child(ren) would be eligible for as an FLA student.
2. Determine what the Household (grandparent(s)) would receive on Income Support as an ISEB Support file (using the appropriate ETW/BFE rates).
3. Determine what the Household would receive on Income Support as an ETW/BFE if the 16- 19-year-old parent were issued for the 16- 19-year-old parent with their child(ren).
4. Calculate the HSI by adding **A** and **B** together, and subtracting **C** from the sum of **A** and **B**.

Example 1 (using 2026 Income Support program benefit rates)

A single parent in the BFE household type, residing in Social Housing with four dependent children include the 16-year-old and her baby.

1. The single parent as a FLA student with one dependent child would be eligible for \$1,774.
2. The BFE grandparent in social housing with two dependent children would be eligible for \$1,263.
3. The BFE grandparent in social housing with four dependent children would be eligible for \$1,628.
4. $HSI = (\$1,774 + \$1,263) - \$1,628 = \$1,409$

Example 2 (using 2026 Income Support program benefit rates)

A couple in the ETW household type, residing in private housing with three dependent children.

1. The single parent as a FLA student with two dependent children would be eligible for \$1,774.
2. The ETW grandparents in private housing with no dependent children would be eligible for \$1,263.

3. The ETW grandparents in private housing with three dependent children would
4. $HSI = (\$1,882 + \$1,288) - \$1,945 = \$1,225$

Need Code

1420 High School Incentive

Income Support Clients as Guardians

Last updated on: Apr 29, 2025

INTENT

To ensure the basic needs of children are met in households where Income Support clients may

To ensure a request for an investigation by a Children and Family Services Authority (CFSA) of suitability of the placement.

POLICY

A child can be added to an active Income Support file when the child's parents are unable or unable to provide Support (CYS) from CFS.

The Income Support client/guardian chooses whether the child is added to the Income Support file. The client/guardian informs the client/guardian of benefit differences between Income Support and CYS from CFS.

The client/guardian is expected to access all resources available to assist in the support of the child.

A [school age child](#) is expected to be in full-time attendance in school.

Consent

Consent for a child to be added to an Income Support client/guardian's file is required from the parent(s).

If the worker believes the child's parent(s) has not provided consent when they otherwise could have, for their child, Income Support benefits are **not** issued until a CFSA investigation has been completed.

Children and Family Services Involvement

If the child has been placed in a protective situation by or has CFS status (Temporary or Permanent), CFS must be involved.

A child may be added to an active Income Support file if:

- A CFS investigation is pending or underway, **or**
- CFS is only providing support services.

Guardianship

Guardians in receipt of Income Support are eligible for benefits for a child in their care if all other conditions are met.

A guardian of a child is **not** required to obtain legal guardianship of the child in their care to be eligible for Income Support.

If the Income Support worker has concerns regarding the appropriateness of a guardian, or the guardian's ability to care for the child, the worker should contact the CFSA.

Substantiation

Income Support clients are required to declare all children for whom they are financially responsible.

[Schedule A – Child Support Services](#) form or on their monthly reporting.

The identity of the child is [substantiated](#) as outlined in policy.

PROCEDURES

Online Income Support Application

The **EMP3428A Schedule A - Child Support Services** referral form has been incorporated with the application determines if an **EMP3428A Schedule A - Child Support Services** form is required. The form does not require client or worker signature as the Freedom of Information and Privacy (FOIP) Statement has been incorporated with the online Income Support Application Declaration and Acknowledgment.

Paper Income Support Application

If the **EMP3428 Income Support Application** and the accompanying **EMP3428A Schedule A**

- reviews the **EMP3428 Income Support Application** and the accompanying **EMP3428A Schedule A – Child Support Services** form may be completed by obtaining the client's (spouse/partner) signature and date:
 - verbally review or complete the **EMP3428A Schedule A – Child Support Services** Declaration with the client,
 - receive acknowledgement that the client consents, understands and agrees to the contents of the form,
 - physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client, and
 - enter a Compass Comment attesting that the form, including the FOIP Statement and Acknowledgment, is true and correct.

Note:

The signed document is then imaged to the client's electronic file.

When reviewing the **EMP3428A Schedule A – Child Support Services** form with the client, the worker should:

- asks the client:
 - if the parent(s) are aware and consent to the child being added to the client/guardian's record,
 - the reason(s) why the child is placed with Income Support client/guardian and cannot be placed with the parent(s),
 - of the anticipated duration of the placement with the client/guardian,
 - of the parent's ability and willingness to pay child support, and
 - about the resources available for the child (e.g. Canada Pension Plan Orphan's Benefit).
- records the information in [Compass Comments](#),
- advises the client/guardian to apply for the CCB on behalf of the child,

- refers any child protection concerns to CFS, and
 - completes referral to [Child Support Services](#) through LISA.
-

Individuals Experiencing Homelessness

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2024

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, Part 2, Division 1, sections 5, 5.1, and 6*](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Part 1, section 2; Part 1, Division 2, s](#)

INTENT

To provide clarity regarding the Income Support benefits that individuals who are experiencing homelessness, Supplementary benefits, and Health benefits, or to meet one-time or on-going needs.

POLICY

This policy applies to applicants and clients who are experiencing homelessness, which include those who do not have a permanent address, or who do not live in a conventional dwelling place (e.g. public spaces).

To be eligible for Income Support benefits, applicants and clients must be present in Alberta. Eligibility for Supplementary benefits is based on homelessness.

Applicants and clients experiencing homelessness are assessed for general and financial eligibility or [Barriers to Full Employment \(BFE\)](#) client category.

If these applicants meet eligibility criteria for ETW or BFE, they are eligible to receive the following benefits:

- [Core Essential](#);
- [Supplementary Benefits \(where applicable\)](#); and
- [Health Benefits](#).

Note: The [Core Shelter benefit](#) is assessed for those with ongoing expenses related to housing. Client circumstances are reviewed to determine if on-going eligibility criteria are met, including those with specific needs. Applicants and clients in this situation may have specific Supplementary benefit needs.

Transitioning To a Residence

If the applicant or client requires assistance to establish a residence, supplementary benefits are provided. This is not an exhaustive list:

- [Utility Connection, Deposit, Reconnection](#)
- [Emergency Allowance](#)

If an applicant or client is in an escaping abuse situation, they may be eligible for benefits specific to escaping abuse.

Related Resources

Identification for the Homeless

If individuals do not have identification, they can apply to the Alberta Health Services (AHS) [AH](#)

To verify identification, follow the [Substantiation and Verification policy](#).

Opening a Bank Account without Identification

Some clients may have difficulty opening a bank account due to lack of identification. Two bank Financial, have agreed to allow clients with limited or no identification, to establish a bank account. [Policy](#).

One Adult Living in Community/Spouse/Partner Living in Facility

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

Introduction

When a household unit makes application for income support benefits and the adult members consist of:

- One adult is living in the community **and**
- The other adult is residing in a facility (long term admission)

The household unit's needs are met by issuing benefits on two separate files, **if** the household unit meets the criteria for both.

Assessment at Intake

The household unit must qualify for income support benefits based on total household unit needs.

The worker **manually** calculates:

- The needs of the adult person (and dependants) living in the community **and**
- The needs of the adult person living in the facility **and**
- The total income of the household unit.

The worker applies all income support legislation and policy concerning income and assets to determine eligibility.

Assessment of Ongoing Client

If the household unit is already receiving income support benefits, the worker:

- Refers the spouse/partner to apply for Income Support.
- Removes this adult from the client's file.
- Makes all appropriate adjustments in Client File function 7 and Client Budget function 9.
- Case conference with the worker taking the application to ensure consistent documentation.
- Records in Compass Comments the name, PID and file number of the adult receiving benefits.

Note

The worker **MUST** update the Client File in a timely manner to prevent a CCD Duplicate Client File.

Case Management

Both files are administered from the Service Centre of the person who is living in the community.

- Facilitate the accurate assessment of the household unit's ongoing eligibility,
- Reduce workload in the Service Centres, and
- Meet audit requirements.

When an application must be completed for the adult being admitted to a facility outside the Ser

- That person cannot attend an office interview **and**
- The distance to the facility does not allow an out-of-office intake to be completed.

The person is referred to the Service Centre which serves the facility. When the application is c resides in the community.

Whenever possible, the same worker should be responsible for the case management of both i

When the facility is not located within the boundaries of the Service Centre managing the files, t

- Notifies the facility of this arrangement.
- Provides the facility with the worker's name.
- Requests all correspondence be forwarded to their Service Centre.

Note

When it may be appropriate for the Service Centres which serves the facility to administer boundaries, the Service Centres managers decide which office retains both files.

Administrative Support (AS) Responsibilities

To enable appropriate tracking of both files, the AS staff indicate on the **EMP 355a File Label** if adult person receiving benefits on a separate file.

Both active files may be filed in the same file folder.

Budget Calculation (Separate Files)

When the household unit has been assessed eligible for income support benefits, the worker:

Advises both adults that:

1. The assets and income for the household unit may be adjusted between files to maintain
2. The household unit must remain eligible for income support benefits in order for each pers
3. Unless the Automated Reporting Card (ARC) is exempted for the individual in a facility – r
4. The household assets may be divided between the two files to maintain the eligibility of ea

- Income will be entered on the budget of the client who is in receipt of the income unless the income is recorded in the “SP column” on the other adult’s file.

Dividing Income Between Two Files

If the household income is insufficient to meet the total household needs but:

- Exceeds the needs of the client living in the community **and**
- Exceeds the needs of the person living in the facility

The income is divided between the two files and is recorded on each file in **Client Budget** function. When dividing partially exempt income, the **income after exemption** is manually calculated and recorded on each file. When dividing non-exempt income, the income is recorded on each file under the income code 0000. When the worker is assigning income to a client who has not earned or received that income during the month, the income is recorded on the client’s file with the income code 0000.

Note

The earnings exemption is applied once only to the income received by the household unit during the month.

Example – ETW

Household Resources		Household Needs
Employment Income	\$1,500	Core Shelter
	Subtotal	
Total Cash Resources	\$1,500	Total Household Needs

- The household is eligible for income support benefits because needs exceed resources and income is recorded on the client’s file.
- If the total income is recorded on either file, LISA advises income exceeds needs.
- Manually** calculate income after exemption (i.e., \$1500 - \$461 earnings exemption = \$1039). Record this amount on the client’s file under the income code 0000. **Other Income.**

Budget:

Income
Budget Deficit:

- Record remaining amount of income after exemption under **Income Code: 4399 Other In**

Budget:
Income
Budget Deficit:

Child Support Services

Because the separation of the adult members of the household unit is due to the health require Services.

The Marital Status data field is coded **9** Spouse/partner has own AISH/income support file. For and the other spouse/partner resides in a facility. Each spouse/partner has a separate file and t

Exception

If there is a responsible person other than the adult members of the household unit, [Child Supp](#)

Partners Other Than Spouses

Last updated on: Sep 06, 2024

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(2\)\(a.2\)](#)

INTENT

To ensure people who have mutual obligations of support fulfill those obligations as a condition

The *Adult Interdependent Relationships Act (AIRA)* defines the kinds of personal relationships that support each other. In addition, people living in relationships of interdependence (formerly common-law partners)

Persons living in these relationships must declare and have the resources of the other person to

Terms Used for the Purposes of the Income Support Program

- 'Co-habiting Partner' or 'Partner' include persons in a legal marriage, common-law relationship or a relationship of interdependence.
- 'Family' includes both spousal relationships and relationships of interdependence.
- 'Household Unit' include both spousal relationships and relationships of interdependence.
- 'Couple' include both spousal relationships and relationships of interdependence.

Three Broad Types of Household Relationships

1. Spouses – Two adults in a legal marriage.
2. Common-law – Two adults in a conjugal or marriage-like relationship, regardless of the length of the relationship:
 1. share one another's lives,
 2. are emotionally committed to one another, and
 3. function as an economic and domestic unit (this **may** include joint ownership of assets, joint vehicle registration, etc.).
3. Other relationships recognized under AIRA:
 1. Any two adults, who declare they are cohabiting partners
 2. Two adults, not related by blood, living in a platonic relationship, regardless of gender
 3. Two adults who have entered into a formal Adult Interdependent Partnership (AIP) agreement

In all categories the adults do not have to be residing together when determining eligibility as a

POLICY

Declared Relationships

Where two adults present themselves or declare themselves to be a common-law couple or a relationship as one of interdependence for purposes of eligibility and benefits determination – p

- two adults, who declare they are cohabiting partners,
- two adults, not related by blood, living in a platonic relationship, regardless of gender, who
- two adults who have entered into a formal AIP agreement as authorized under AIRA. (The

Workers are not expected to investigate the existence of the relationship when:

- two adults are living in a platonic relationship, regardless of gender, or
- two adults have entered into a formal AIP agreement as authorized under AIRA.

Workers are not to assume that two adults are partners simply because they live together, unless

Substantiation

- Self-declaration, **or**
- A signed AIP Agreement

Undeclared Relationships

If the client meets the conditions outlined in the definition above and, in the opinion of the worker, claims that a relationship does not exist, the client is given the opportunity to provide proof that

Proof must be substantiated or clearly documented in [Compass Comments](#) (e.g., the client claim

Two adults living together who have a child of the relationship by birth or adoption are considered it.

Clients suspected of fraud are referred to the Investigation Unit.

PROCEDURES

Change in Relationship Status

When the client reports a change in status, the worker:

1. records the change.
2. reassesses the client's eligibility and benefits.

Note

When [adding the PID of the partner in LISA](#), LISA automatically defaults the gender of the partner if it is the same gender as the HH.

Relationship has been Determined to Exist

Where a couple living common-law or in an AIRA relationship is uncovered by a case audit or a worker:

1. asks the client to verify or deny the department's information,
2. assists the client and their partner as a household unit if they admit to the relationship,
3. asks the client the effective date of the relationship and calculates any potential debt, **or**
4. if they deny being in the relationship:
 1. Closes the file for non-compliance,
 2. Advises them of their right to appeal,
 3. Refers the matter to the Investigation Unit.

No Substantive Evidence a Relationship Exists

If a complaint is received indicating that a client has a partner, but no substantive evidence exists

1. ensures the client signs the [EMP 2544 Denial of Spouse/Partner \(Declaration\)](#),
 2. closes the file for non-compliance and advises them of their right to appeal, if they refuse
-

Persons Involved with Education or Training

Last updated on: Oct 27, 2023

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1\(1\)\(v\), 17 and 19](#)

INTENT

To ensure that clients access the appropriate funding source while attending education and training.

POLICY

Expected to Work (ETW)/Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) Income Support is **not** the ongoing funding source for persons attending an approved program that is identified in their [Individual Plan](#) **may** be eligible.

Persons who plan to enter, or are in between training programs of a full-time education or training program, must be assessed and must meet [eligibility requirements](#) as any other ETW/BFE Income Support applicant.

In the process of [eligibility determination](#) and [Individual Plan](#) development, the following additional criteria must be met:

- Applicants are actively engaged in job search activities and available to accept and maintain employment.
- Applicants have registered with the provider for their next training period and are in the program on the first day of training.

Pre-Employment Programs

Career and Employment Information Services help Albertans to understand the labour market, make career plans and to prepare for, find and maintain work in general.

Clients may benefit from attending a rehabilitative program (i.e. residential addictions treatment program) while attending their [Individual Plan](#). These interventions typically focus on the enhancement of skills to assist the person in finding and maintaining employment.

Clients and applicants may apply and continue to receive Income Support while attending these programs.

Note

Recipients in these types of programs, full-time, are assigned to [Client Sub-Type 15](#) (ETW/BFE).

Exposure Courses

Clients who are job ready can access an [Exposure Course](#) in order to obtain a specific job skill provided this skill acquisition is part of their [Individual Plan](#) and they continue to meet all Income Support requirements.

Dependents in High School

Parents/guardians are eligible to receive ETW/BFE Income Support for a [dependent](#) who is attending high school and continues to be included on the parent's ETW/BFE Income Support file.

- Parents of an [18-19 youth](#) may continue to receive Income Support for the dependent child during school breaks.
- Parents of a 16-19 youth with a dependent are eligible for the [High School Incentive \(HSI\)](#)

Note

Part-Time Training Courses

Clients who attend part-time training can receive ETW/BFE Income Support benefits provided they maintain reasonable employment). The part-time training course(s) should be included in the re

ETW/BFE Income Support does not provide benefits to fund training costs (tuition, books, student materials, Foundational Learning Assistance or Student Aid) for assistance with these costs.

Full-Time Students

Other Full-Time students are not eligible for ETW/BFE Income Support and should access other

Note

These students may be considered for [one-time assistance](#) in emergency situations.

Persons with Immigration Status

Authority and Intent

Last updated on: Dec 19, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 10, 13, 28, 75, 77](#)

INTENT

Foreign Nationals who enter Canada temporarily or permanently are generally expected to accor
require income support in cases where their original source of financial support is no longer ava

General Eligibility

Last updated on: Jan 07, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 10, 13, 28, 75 and](#)

POLICY

Information regarding immigrant status codes can be found on the [Immigration Category on the](#)

The following table is a summary of Income Support eligibility for the more common types of immigration terminology and immigration conditions.

Conditions for Income Support Eligibility

Family Class

Sponsors must sign a Sponsorship Undertaking to be financially responsible for the sponsored

The table below is in place from October 24, 2017 to present day:

Person you sponsor
Spouse, common-law partner or conjugal partner
Dependent child (biological or adopted) or child to be adopted in Canada under 22 years of age
Dependent child 22 of age or older
Parents or grandparent
Other relative

This table below is utilized for undertaking applications received before October 24, 2017

Person you sponsor	Length of time
Spouse, common-law partner or conjugal partner	3 years
Child under 13 years of age	10 years
Child 13- 19 years old	until 19 years of age
Child over 19 years of age	3 years

Parent or grandparent	20 y
Other relative	10 y

The circumstances under which a sponsored immigrant may be eligible for Income Support.

- Sponsor has abandoned the immigrant, and the worker is satisfied the immigrant has max
- Applicant has been neglected or abused by the sponsor, or
- Sponsor has been proven unable to provide financial support.

Staff must inform IRCC by sending the [EMP3828B Notification of Sponsorship Debt](#) when bene

Canadian citizens or permanent residents of Canada may undertake to sponsor a family memb (IRPA). The [period of sponsorship](#) varies depending on the relationship with the sponsor and the continue from the date the person became a permanent resident until the duration listed in the 3

Note

A notation about the duration of sponsorship undertaking should be in the Remarks section (#3) the **IMM 1000 Immigrant Visa or Record of Landing**, the duration will almost always be 10 ye regarding the Immigrant Category; however, there will not be any available information about th

IRCC determines the ability of a [sponsor](#) to provide for the basic needs of a family member bas co-signer (if applicable) are in [default](#) of any previous sponsorship or are in debt to IRCC.

Economic Class

Temporary Resident

Foreign Worker

Not eligible for Income Support.

All temporary workers must meet the general requirements for visitor admission, including obtai cases, at the port or entry.

Foreign (International) Students

Not eligible for Income Support.

Students must meet visitor requirements. Students and their spouses can be granted Work Per

Visitors/tourist

Not eligible for Income Support, including children.

Visitors to Canada have to show financial support for the duration of their stay in Canada. Temp coverage in the event of an emergency.

Temporary Resident Permit Holders (formerly Minister's Permit)

Not eligible for Income Support.

Exception: individuals approved by the Alberta Government, and those individuals who have b

Temporary Resident Permit Holders are eligible to apply for a Work or Study Permit. Persons w
Resident Permit holders who allege that they are destitute or who have medical needs are refer

The only Temporary Resident Permit Holders who may be eligible for Income Support, if they r
Alberta Government, and those who have been recognized as [Victims of Human Trafficking](#) by

Other

Immigrant Children/ Non-Canadian Children

When one parent meets Income Support eligibility criteria, dependent children are eligible for In
Children on visitor or tourist visas are not eligible for Income Support.

Persons in Canada Illegally

Not eligible for Income Support.

Foreign Nationals who overstay their status as temporary residents, work or study with authoriz

NOTE

For information on Refugee and Refugee Claimants, see the [Refugee and Refugee Claimants](#) |

Assessing Eligibility and Verifying Immigration Sta

Last updated on: Jan 07, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 10, 13 and 28](#)

POLICY

Family Class (Sponsored) Immigrants and persons who have Temporary Resident status who a

- must declare their immigration status, and
- are expected to access any and all resources available to them prior to applying.

Applicants who have been a Permanent Resident in Canada less than 10 years, or who are sp (relationship), must have their immigration status and eligibility for financial benefits verified by Ir circumstances where it may be appropriate to request confirmation from IRCC on an individual' but does not have their Canadian Citizenship).

Note

Assisted Living and Social Services (ALSS) has a Memorandum of Understanding authorizing t necessary for the administration of *Income and Employment Supports Act* and the federal *Immi*

Applicants who are eligible and able to work are to be actively seeking employment.

Substantiation

- **Permanent Resident Card** or **IMM 5292 Confirmation of Permanent Residence** or **IMM**
- Completed [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class Immigration Request for Infor](#) years, or who are sponsored immigrants (with sponsorship periods lasting up to 20 years

Procedures For Verifying Immigration Status

The worker sends a status verification request to IRCC who typically responds within two busin request an immediate response.

Status Other Than Family Class (Sponsored)

If the client declares their immigration status as anything other than Family Class (sponsored):

1. The worker completes Section 1 of the [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class Imm](#)
2. IRCC completes Section 2 verifying the applicant's immigration status and returns the forr
3. The worker enters the information from the [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class](#) the client file.

Note

When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information outside of the Government of Canada, the Classification Sensitivity level of the email from Protected A to Protected C. This will encrypt the Outlook.

Family Class (Sponsored)

If the client declares their immigration status is Family Class (sponsored):

The worker completes Section 1 of [**EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class Immigration**](#)

- In the sponsorship section, the worker checks a “Yes” or “No” box to indicate to IRCC whether the sponsor is the default and reminding the sponsor of their obligations under their sponsorship agreement.
- The worker may not wish to send a default warning letter in situations where the applicant

1. The worker emails the **EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class Immigration Request**

2. The IRCC staff returns the completed **EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class**

- _____
- the length of undertaking, and
- whether or not a default warning letter has been sent to the sponsor.

The worker enters the information from the returned [**EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class**](#) document to the client file.

Immigration Status – Family Class (Sponsored)

Last updated on: Jan 07, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 28](#)

POLICY

Applicants to Income Support who have been Permanent Residents in Canada for less than 10 (depending on the relationship), must have their immigration status and eligibility for financial benefits. No person receives social assistance benefits at any point during the validity of the sponsorship unless they are regardless of when this information becomes known.

The [sponsor and co-signer](#), if applicable, have a financial obligation to support the person or persons until they are eligible unless there has been abandonment or abuse.

Applicants are not eligible for Income Support if the sponsor and the sponsored immigrant have previously sponsored an immigrant as allowed under the Income Support, Training and Health Benefit (ISTHB) Act.

Before responsibility and eligibility can be determined, a sponsored immigrant must:

- attend a face-to-face meeting with the applicant and the sponsor, or
- arranging a video or teleconference with the applicant and the sponsor when the sponsor is unable to attend, or
- provide copies of their sponsorship documents.

The sponsor must:

- declare their financial circumstances, **and**
- present documentation to substantiate their financial circumstances.

In instances where the sponsor **cannot** or **will not** substantiate their financial situation, the applicant is not eligible for Income Support.

In exceptional cases the sponsor may **not** be required to attend/participate in the intake interview if:

- the sponsor has abandoned the applicant and the worker is satisfied reasonable efforts have been made to locate the sponsor,
- the applicant has been neglected or abused by the sponsor (e.g., physical, sexual, or emotional abuse), or
- in doubt, evidence from another professional source of the abuse.

Sponsored Immigrant Enters Alberta from Another Province

A sponsored immigrant is not eligible for Income Support if they enter Alberta from another province or territory under circumstances (i.e., they are fleeing a situation of abuse). The applicant is advised to contact the [Transient Worker Program](#) so they may return to their sponsor, if the applicant is **destitute** and:

- the sponsor cannot be reached, **or**
- the sponsor cannot or will not send money to the applicant, **and**
- the applicant's immigration status has been [confirmed](#).

Eligibility

When the applicant's immigration status is confirmed, the worker:

- considers the circumstances which led to the sponsor's inability to support the applicant,
- considers the applicant and sponsor's assets and income according to ISTHB Regulation,
- manually calculates a budget for the sponsor and the members of their household unit (not supplementary benefits,
- deducts all the sponsor's income from their needs (an earnings exemption is not given to
- manually calculates a budget for the applicant based on Core Essential and any required

Core Shelter is considered for the applicant **only** if:

- the applicant is a relative of the sponsor and therefore eligible for \$100 for core shelter, or
- the applicant must live independently because of an abusive situation, or
- the applicant must live independently because of abandonment by the sponsor, or
- the applicant's medical condition requires they reside in a nursing home or designated facility
- the sponsor is a single Income Support recipient and is responsible for two or more sponsors party to the lease or rental agreement, with the sponsor.

If the combined income of the applicant and the sponsor is **not** sufficient to meet the applicant's ISTHB Regulation and Income Support policy.

Note

Financial support from the sponsor is recorded using **Income Code 4399 Other Income**.

If the sponsor and applicant are both on Income Support and have separate files and the sponsor's income is deducted as income from the applicant's budget.

The applicant qualifies only for those health benefits the sponsor is unable to provide (e.g., if the sponsor's benefits are duplicated).

Sponsorship Default

A sponsorship default exists under the following conditions:

- Alberta Supports Service Centre provides a benefit under the *Income and Employment St*
- The benefit is granted to a person who obtained permanent resident status as a member
- The benefit is granted within the sponsorship period (the sponsor's length of undertaking)

Based on federal legislation, Assisted Living and Social Services (ALSS) staff do not have discretion issued to a Family Class sponsored immigrant so that IRCC may determine if the client is in debt.

ALSS may recover the cost of benefits paid on behalf of Family Class sponsored immigrants at the end of the sponsorship period (undertaking).

An overpayment can be calculated at any point after ALSS has determined a sponsorship debt.

IRCC information should already be on file, such as the [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family](#)

- whether a sponsorship undertaking exists,
- the date sponsorship ends, and
- the name and last known address of the sponsor and co-signer (if applicable).

Note

When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information outside of the Government, adjust the Classification Sensitivity level of the email from Protected A to Protected C. This will be adjusted in Outlook.

Procedures for Notifying IRCC of a Sponsorship Debt

The following procedures apply only to **Family Class** sponsorship.

When the conditions of a sponsorship debt exist, the worker:

1. Completes the [EMP3828B Notification of Sponsorship Debt](#).

Note

Workers should use information from the completed [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family](#) to determine the applicant's immigration status.

- The worker indicates by checking "Yes" or "No" in the appropriate box, whether to send a default notification letter.
- The worker may not wish to send a default notification letter in situations where the sponsor is deceased.

2. Emails the [EMP3828B Notification of Sponsorship Debt](#) form to the IRCC to notify them of the debt.

Note

Once notification of sponsorship debt is received, IRCC will send a default notification letter to the sponsor and co-signer, outlining the immediate and potential consequences of default.

3. Enters [Alert Code 27 Sponsored Immigrant](#) on CCD.

Procedures For Repayment of Debts by Defaulting Sponsor

- _____
- If the sponsor was not part of the sponsored immigrant's household unit (spouse/partner),

2. As the overpayment can only be entered by Treasury Board and Finance, the worker must first

- the amount of the overpayment,
- the period of the overpayment,
- the reason for the overpayment, and
- the right to appeal.

Note

The worker's name and phone number are included in the letter in case the defaulting sponsor

3. Once the appeal period has elapsed or the appeal has been concluded by Citizens Appeal Panel that the overpayment is now a debt owing to the government and that full (or partial) payment can

Treasury Board and Finance
Collections Unit
P.O. Box 11417
Edmonton AB T5J 3E4

Note

The Service Centre receiving the payment is responsible to issue a receipt to the third-party

4. The worker sends the information requested on the [EMP3898 Treasury Board and Finance](#) at TBF.Collections@gov.ab.ca.

5. _____

When the debt is paid in full (for active Income Support clients this would only be when the sponsor

- advises IRCC (if requested by the defaulting sponsor) that the debt is paid in full, and
- provides a copy of this confirmation to the defaulting sponsor (if requested by the defaulting sponsor)

Note

Information may be sent to IRCC by marking the email as a Protected Level C Classification under the Access to Information Act policies.

7. The worker can delete **Alert Code 27 Sponsored Immigrant** from CCD.

Immigration Status – Other Than Family Class

Last updated on: Jan 06, 2025

Immigration Status – Other Than Family Class

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 10\(2\)\(c\) and 10\(2\)\(e\)](#)

POLICY

If a person with immigration status other than Family Class status (i.e., Refugees, Temporary R immigration status using the [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class Immigration Reque](#)

Note

When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information outside of the Governr the Classification Sensitivity level of the email from Protected A to Protected C. This will e adjusted in Outlook.

Temporary Resident Permit Holder

Only [Temporary Resident Permit Holders](#) who:

- have been approved for entry into Alberta by the Government of Alberta (GOA), or
- been identified by IRCC as a Victim of Human Trafficking,

may be eligible for Income Support if they meet all other eligibility criteria.

If a Temporary Resident Permit is cancelled, a direction to leave or a removal order may be issi own support.

Ineligible Spouse/Partner

If a spouse/partner of an applicant or recipient does not qualify for Income Support benefits, the belonging to the ineligible person are used to determine ongoing Income Support eligibility for tl

Example

A client gets married and makes a request to add their spouse to their Income Support file a Victim of Human Trafficking, nor does the GOA approve them for entry into Alberta. The file. However, the Income Support program considers the spouse's income and assets wh

IRCC Terminology and Rules

Last updated on: Jan 07, 2026

Immigration Refugee Citizenship Canada (IRCC)

Effective June 28, 2002, IRCC passed the *Immigration and Refugee Protection Act (IRPA)* to re

More information about sponsorship can be found through [Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship](#)

The following definitions (in alphabetical order) apply to terms and rules under *IRPA*.

Canadian Citizen A person who is a citizen of Canada has the right to enter and remain in Canada.

Economic Class

Foreign nationals admitted to Canada under the Economic Class are selected for their skills and

Economic Class is comprised of three main streams:

- **Skilled workers** are assessed according to a point system (e.g. education, official language proficiency, work experience, etc.) and their ability to adapt to the Canadian economy.
- **Business immigrants** are selected to support the development of a strong and prosperous Canadian economy through self-employment. Business immigrants include investors, entrepreneurs, and the self-employed.
- **Provincial Nominees** are assessed by provinces or territories that have entered into an agreement with the federal government. (IRCC is responsible for medical and security checks along with visa issuance).

Family Class (FC Sponsored Immigrant)

A Canadian Citizen or a permanent resident of Canada who is 18 years of age or older may sponsor a family member who consists of a very specific and defined group of relatives. Family members who may be sponsored include a spouse, common-law partner, parent or grandparent, and orphaned brother, sister, niece, nephew, grandson or granddaughter. Family class economic immigrants but are assessed on the basis of their relationship to their sponsor. All applicants must meet the requirements of the Immigration and Refugee Protection Act (IRPA) and the Immigration Regulations.

Undertakings usually begin upon the person's landing in Canada and continue until the duration of the undertaking expires.

- For the period prior to 1997 the length of undertaking varied between 1 – 10 years.
- For the period of April 1997 to June 2002 the length of Undertaking was 10 years for all family class immigrants.
- For the period of June 2002 to December 31, 2013, the length of undertaking was a maximum of 10 years.
- For the period of January 1, 2014 to present, the length of undertaking can vary up to 20 years.

The table below is in place from Oct 24, 2017 to present day:

Person you sponsor
Spouse, common-law partner or conjugal partner
Dependent child(biological or adopted) or child to be adopted in Canada under 22 years of age
Dependent child 22 years of age or older
Parent or grandparent
Other relative

The table below is utilized for undertaking before October 24, 2017:

Person you sponsor	Length of undertaking
Spouse, common-law partner or conjugal partner	3 years
Child under 13 years of age	10 years
Child 13-19 years old	until the child turns 19
Child over 19 years of age	3 years
Parent or grandparent	20 years
Other relative	10 years

Foreign National

An individual who is not a permanent resident or citizen of Canada, including a citizen or nation

Foreign (International) Student

A foreign student is a temporary resident approved by an immigration officer to study in Canada at a university, college or other authorized institution must obtain a Study Permit before entering Canada (except for children of foreign workers or foreign students).

IMM 5292 Confirmation of Permanent Residence

Under IRPA, the **IMM 5292 Confirmation of Permanent Residence** replaced the **IMM 1000 In**

Length of Undertaking

The length of undertaking generally begins on the date the sponsored immigrant is granted Per

Permanent Resident (Landed Immigrant)

A foreign national approved by IRCC to lawfully enter and remain in Canada permanently. Client visa is issued by the immigration officials overseas. The individual is considered a Permanent Resident if foreign nationals from within Canada can apply for permanent resident status. Permanent resident can be a refugee, or under an independent category such as an investor skilled worker or provincial nominee.

for Canadian citizenship.

Government-assisted Refugees, Privately Sponsored Refugees, and Protected Persons Land of Canada.

Permanent Resident Card (PRC)

Since the introduction of IRPA, a PRC is issued to all new permanent residents. Permanent residents have to do so unless they are planning to travel outside of Canada. The card is mandatory for :

If a person is granted Canadian citizenship, the PRC is revoked.

Refugee and Refugee Claimant

A refugee is a person who has been granted protection status in Canada, and a refugee claimant is a person who is seeking protection status. For more information.

Social Insurance Number (SIN) 900-Series

SINs are issued by **Human Resources and Social Development Canada** (not IRCC). SINs that are issued to permanent residents and require a SIN for employment purposes or for other authorized uses (e.g. to file for income tax).

Effective March 30 2003, all new SINs beginning with 9 have an expiry date. SINs starting with 9 are issued to permanent residents and require a SIN for employment purposes or for other authorized uses (e.g. to file for income tax). Current 900-series SINs **without** an expiry date; **expire on April 3, 2004**. If a person receives a new SIN, the card will have an expiry date.

Sponsor/Co-Signer

The Sponsor/Co-Signer:

- Has a financial obligation to support a person they have agreed to sponsor for the period of the sponsorship.
- Is responsible for providing lodging, care and maintenance for the sponsored person and their family members.
- Is responsible for their family member for the full length of the undertaking regardless of a change in residence.

The sponsor and the principal applicant on each sponsorship (if they are a spouse or over 22 years of age) must sign a Sponsorship Undertaking which confirms their mutual obligations and responsibilities.

In those cases where there is a minimum necessary income that must be met, a sponsor's financial obligations are confirmed by the Sponsorship Undertaking and assumes the same obligations as the sponsor for the period of the sponsorship.

Sponsorship Default

A sponsor or co-signer is considered in default of their sponsorship obligations if social assistance is required for the sponsored person during the sponsorship undertaking.

Temporary Resident

A temporary resident is a foreign national who is lawfully in Canada on a temporary basis. Temporary residents are not eligible for permanent residence.

Temporary Foreign Worker

Foreign nationals may work temporarily in Canada under certain conditions. Generally, the IRP is issued to foreign nationals who are working in Canada on a temporary basis. A Work Permit is usually valid only for a specified job, employer and time period. Such workers are not eligible for permanent residence in Canada. Some temporary workers do not require a work permit.

Temporary Resident Permit (TRP)

Formerly called Minister's Permit. A foreign national possessing this special permit, issued by the Minister's discretion to allow otherwise inadmissible or removable persons to enter or remain in Canada. The TRP allows the holder to remain in Canada for the period stated in the permit only. Permits Minister.

Verification of Status (VOS)

In August 2012, IRCC discontinued issuing certified true copies of immigration documents to clients. The VOS is issued by IRCC for requests for verification of status, including Temporary Resident Permit, Amendments to Immigrant Records, Authorization to Return to Canada, Study Permit, and Departure and Departure Order.

Visitor

A person in Canada as a tourist. They may also hold a Visitor Record.

Refugees and Refugee Claimants

Last updated on: Jan 06, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\) sections 6\(2\)\(e\) and 6\(3\)\(f\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 10\(2\)d, 12, 27, 73,](#)

INTENT

To identify Income Support benefit eligibility for persons with refugee or refugee claimant status

POLICY

Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) is responsible for the refugee system in its Regulations. For the purpose of determining Income Support program eligibility, the terms “r Regulations.

Refugees and refugee claimants are required to access all financial and health benefits provide considered for Income Support benefit eligibility.

REFUGEES

A refugee is a person who is granted refugee protection status in Canada (under IRPA):

- As a Convention refugee, or
- As a person in need of protection.

A refugee can be sponsored or non-sponsored.

Refugees (Sponsored)

IRCC coordinates the following federal and private sponsorship programs for refugees:

- The federal Resettlement Assistance Program (RAP) provides monthly financial assistance extend to 36 months in exceptional cases).
- The Private Sponsorship of Refugees Program allows a community organization or group
- Blended Visa Office-Referred Refugees receive joint sponsorship by the federal government

Sponsored refugees are **not eligible** for Income Support benefits while receiving sponsored financial health benefit coverage or ‘top-up’ IFHP benefits.

Provided they meet all eligibility requirements, sponsored refugees may qualify for Income Support

- After their eligibility for the RAP expires, or
- Once their federal or private sponsorship period has ended.

Refugees (Non-Sponsored)

Some refugees are not sponsored, and they **are eligible** for Income Support benefits if they me

REFUGEE CLAIMANTS

A refugee claimant is a person who has made a claim for refugee protection (under IRPA). IRC

A refugee claimant can be **eligible for Income Support financial benefits and** continues to be the Immigration and Refugee Board of Canada (IRB).

As a condition of receiving Income Support benefits, if a refugee claimant is employable, they n IRCC office for more information on obtaining a Work Permit.

Note

Under the IRPA, persons who are seeking to remain in Canada on Humanitarian and Con

Health Benefits for Claimants

A person is not eligible for health benefits if they are receiving federal IFHP coverage. The Inco benefits.

Conclusion of a Claim

Even if an initial claim is not approved, this does **not** mean that the claim has concluded. The “c person status (and can apply for permanent resident status), **or** all avenues of appeal have bee

Refugee claimants can **remain eligible** for Income Support benefits until all mechanisms of ap

- Claimants denied refugee protection by the IRB, who appeal the decision to the IRB Refu the appeal process.
- Persons denied refugee protection on appeal who apply for judicial review before the Fed judicial review process.

Refusal of Refugee Protection and Pre-Removal Risk Assessment (PRRA)

Individuals subject to a removal order may apply to the Minister of Immigration and Refugees (C

- An individual who applies for a PRRA can **remain eligible** for Income Support benefits fo

Individuals denied refugee protection through a PRRA may be eligible to apply for judicial review

- Claimants **continue to be eligible** for Income Support benefits for the duration of the judi

SUMMARY OF INCOME SUPPORT BENEFIT ELIGIBILITY

Category	
Sponsored Refugees	

• Resettlement Assistance Program • Private Sponsorship of Refugees Program • Blended Visa Office-Referred Program
Refugees – Sponsorship Period Has Ended
Refugees – Non-sponsored
Refugee Claimants

INELIGIBLE SPOUSE/PARTNER

If a spouse/partner of an applicant or recipient does not qualify for Income Support benefits, the belonging to the ineligible person are used to determine ongoing Income Support eligibility for the

Example

A client would like to add their spouse to their Income Support file after the spouse's arrival; **not** added to the Income Support file. However, the Income Support program considers the

PROCEDURES FOR VERIFYING STATUS

When a refugee or refugee claimant applies for Income Support benefits, the worker must verify

Note

Clients who are refugee claimants may go through several stages in the federal process. The worker may use the Compass Reminder feature to bring forward the file to verify status.

1. The applicant is asked to provide IRCC documentation, or any equivalent correspondence, to not exhaustive.

- Refugee Protection Claimant Document (IMM 1442)
- Acknowledgement of Claim
- Verification of Status document
- Acknowledgement of Conditions Form (IMM 1262)
- Confirmation of Referral
- Entry for Further Examination or Admissibility Hearing Form.

2. The worker must verify the applicant's status with IRCC. The Memorandum of Understanding between governments. Program staff can disclose information only if disclosure is necessary for

- The worker requests verification from IRCC via the [EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family](#) within two business days.
- The worker completes the top part of the form and emails the form to the IRCC.

Note

When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information outside of the Go adjust the Classification Sensitivity level of the email from Protected A to Protected (sensitivity level is adjusted in Outlook.

- IRCC completes the bottom portion of the form, verifying the applicant's status (or that the
- IRCC will also confirm whether the applicant:
 - is receiving financial support from the federal RAP, or
 - is currently maintained under a federal or private sponsorship agreement (and durat

Once IRCC confirms the applicant's status:

- The worker enters the information from the **EMP13574 Family Class/Non-Family Class** the client file, and
- The worker determines the applicant's eligibility for Income Support benefits.

The worker creates a Reminder in Compass to follow-up on the refugee claimant's status in the

- Claimant is waiting for a decision on their claim from the IRB (the worker records the date
 - Claimant is appealing an IRB decision to the Refugee Appeal Division, or
 - Claimant is in process of a judicial review through federal court, based on a negative IRB
 - Client has been issued a removal order and is involved in the PRRA or judicial review pro
-

Victims of Human Trafficking

Last updated on: Jan 06, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Part 2, Division 1](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 10\(2\)\(e\)](#)

INTENT

To ensure Foreign Nationals deemed Victims of Human Trafficking receive financial support wh

POLICY

Foreign Nationals with a Temporary Resident Permit (TRP) issued under the *Immigration and F*
[Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada](#) (IRCC) are eligible to receive Income Support u

Seniors, Community and Social Services must have confirmation that the person has a TRP an
benefits. Benefits can only be issued for the time period the TRP is valid.

Foreign Nationals with a TRP and who are recognized as a Victim of Human Trafficking are elig
benefits under the Interim Federal Health Program.

PROCEDURE

1. The worker must [verify](#) the person's immigration status by emailing the [EMP13574 F](#)

Note

When identifying and sending confidential or sensitive information outside of the Go
adjust the Classification Sensitivity level of the email from Protected A to Protected (
sensitivity level is adjusted in Outlook.

3. If eligible, the worker issues the appropriate Income Support benefits and a **Com**

When the Head of Household is a victim of human trafficking and their health care benefits are

- The **Medical Coverage (Med Cov)** is 'Y'. The **Med Cov** is coded individually for each me
 - The **AHCIP Status** data field is coded '1', and
 - The **Med Code** is '6'.
-

16 and 17 Year Olds Not on Parent's File

Last updated on: Oct 27, 2023

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6\(2\)\(b\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(2\)\(a\)](#)

INTENT

Child and Family Services is best equipped to meet the needs of children, including 16- and 17-year-olds. This policy outlines the limited situations where a 16- or 17-year-old might be assisted.

POLICY

Eligibility As Spouse or Cohabiting Partner

16- or 17-year-olds are eligible to receive Income Support benefits as a spouse or cohabiting partner on the file.

16- and 17-year-olds are eligible if:

- The HH is 18-years of age or over, **and**
- They are in a legal marriage or are living in a cohabiting relationship approved by their parents
- The parents are unable or unwilling to support them; **and**
- The household unit is eligible for assistance.

Any household unit with a 16- or 17-year-old spouse/partner attending a full-time program under the [Foundational Learning Assistance](#) program. All other 16- or 17-year-olds, including those separated from their parents, are eligible for assistance and follow up if their parents are unable or unwilling to support them.

Financial Contribution From Parents

If the 16- or 17-year-old is not legally married, the worker contacts the parents of the 16- or 17-year-old couple. The worker documents the results of their discussion with the parents in [Compass Connect](#).

Appeals

If Child and Family Services determine that a 16- or 17-year-old is not in need of protection and support, the worker may appeal the decision to the Child, Youth and Family Services Appeal Panel.

The Income and Employment Supports Appeal Panel has no authority to rule on the eligibility of 16- or 17-year-olds.

Benefits

16- or 17-year-olds who are a spouse or a cohabiting partner are considered to be an adult when Income Support (Core Shelter and Core Essential) are issued based on a household unit of two adults receiving benefits.

Earnings Exemption and Assets

A 16- or 17-year-old who is a spouse or a cohabiting partner with an adult 18 years of age or older

- Is eligible for an earnings exemption as an adult member of the household unit as per [IST](#)
- Has assets included as part of the total assets of the household unit in determining eligibility

Expectations for 16- or 17-Year Olds

16- and 17-year-old spouses or partners have an assessment completed at intake and a mutual goal to acquire the skills they need to become self-sufficient and independent.

The **preferred** situation for 16- and 17-year-olds who are spouses or partners is full-time attendance in school or training and applying for assistance under the [Foundational Learning Assistance](#) program and is not eligible for

If a 16- or 17-year-old spouse/partner is not in school because they have a mental or physical impairment that is **not** affected.

PROCEDURES

If the worker becomes aware the 16- or 17-year-old is not in school and is capable of attending

- The worker **encourages** the youth to return to school and assists them with internal and external barriers to meet this goal.
The HH should already have an Individual Plan and be working towards the employment goal.
 - If the youth chooses not to return to school, the youth is expected to be actively seeking employment.
 - If the worker is satisfied that the youth is actively seeking employment, the worker continues to provide support.
 - If the youth obtains employment, the worker applies the adult earnings exemption as per [IST](#).
 - If the worker is not satisfied that the youth is planning to return to school or is actively seeking employment, the worker consults with [IESA Section 15\(1\)](#) and [Eligibility Impacts](#) policy.
-

18- and 19-Year-Old Dependants

Last updated on: Apr 30, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(2\)\(b\)](#)

INTENT

The Alberta government believes in supporting and encouraging youth to maximize their potential as dependent children on a household's file provides stability to the household to help ensure the

POLICY

The definition of dependent child under the Income Support program includes a person:

- who is living with and dependent for support on an adult member of the household unit, and
- who is under the age of 18 or, if attending an education program under the *Education Act*

18- and 19-year-old dependent children of Income Support applicants or recipients:

- who attend school or plan to return to the regular school system after a scheduled school break or turn 20 years old,
- can attend school full-time or part-time as long as they are progressing in completing the level of education required to graduate),
- can participate in an academic upgrading program at an Alberta high school or online through a post-secondary program full-time or part-time to upgrade or to take a course(s) required to enter a post-secondary program,
- **do not** apply for Foundational Learning Assistance under the *Student Financial Assistance Act*,
- are referred to [Child Support Services](#), if one of their parents is not part of the household or

Income and Assets of Dependent Children

Employment income of dependent children, including 18- and 19-year-olds, who are attending school or

Assets of all dependent children are exempt.

18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Children Who Leave School

If the 18–19-year-old leaves school, they are no longer eligible to remain as a dependent child on the household's file following the student leaving school. 18- and 19-year-olds who leave school should access other support themselves, they may apply for Income Support. They must meet program eligibility criteria.

Periods of Non-Attendance

18- and 19-year-old students should be actively seeking employment during school breaks. This

employment in the future.

18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Children Who Are Upgrading

18- and 19-year-old students who have completed high school but are upgrading or taking a co-op course on the Income Support file. In these circumstances, the student is required to be enrolled in a program of study offered by an Alberta school authority.

Note

- Some Alberta high schools/school authorities may not provide academic upgrading for dependent children who turn 19 on or after September 1st, Income Support program staff should be consulted.
- 18- and 19-year-old students who are upgrading at a post-secondary institution do not qualify for the program.

18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Children of Income Support Leavers Eligible for Alberta /

18- and 19-year-old dependent children living at home and attending high school may receive the program regardless of the AAHB Client Type.

The [AEHB3654 Declaration of 18 and 19 Year Old Dependant](#) form must be completed.

Benefits

18- and 19-year-olds are counted as dependent children when determining the amount of [Core](#)

The household receives additional benefits for 18- and 19-year-old dependent children, as follows:

- Child Supplement Allowance of \$238 per month is automatically added to the budget for 18- and 19-year-olds.
- Health Benefits Coverage (same as any other dependent child), **and**
- [Continuous Supplementary Benefits](#) and Non-Continuous Supplementary Benefits based on household income.
- School Expense Allowance of \$208 per year.

Substantiation

Applicants verbally confirm their 18–19-year dependent child is attending the regular high school.

- [EMP3428 Income Support Application](#), **and**
- [EMP3428C Declaration of 18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Child](#)

Recipients verbally confirm their 18–19-year dependent child is attending the regular high school.

- **Automated Reporting for Clients (ARC)**, **and**
- **EMP3428C - Declaration of 18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Child.**

Applicants

1. informs the applicant (spouse/partner if applicable) the 18–19-year-old dependent child is they are residing in the household unit and actively attending and progressing in the regular 18-year-old plans to attend regular school in September, the 18-year-old dependent child
2. reinforces the availability of educational supports within the school system to help the dependent child
3. advises the applicant they must advise their worker as soon as possible if the dependent child is deleted from their file at the beginning of the following month,
4. ensures the **EMP3428C** is completed and included with the **EMP3428 Income Support Application** and the physical signatures or the worker may:
 - verbally review and complete the **EMP3428C** form with the client and dependent,
 - receive acknowledgement that the client and dependent child consent, understand and agree with the content,
 - physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client and dependent child,
 - enter a Compass Comment attesting that the **EMP3428C** form was read to the client and the client agreed with the content.

- ## Note

Recipients

17-Year-Old Dependent Children Turning 18

LISA generates a monthly report **MRR21 Dependent Child Approaching 18th Birthday Withi**

1. removes the deletion date by selecting the dependent child with “**R**” to restore the dependent
2. continues to issue benefits to the 18- and 19-year-old, as long as they are attending the re

If the worker becomes aware that the dependent child no longer resides with them or is no long

month's benefits.

19-Year-Old Dependents Turning 20

LISA generates a report **Dependent Child Approaching 20th Birthday Within 4 Months** by u

Note

Most students would have completed their regular high school education prior to turning 20 and

The worker sends out [EMP3478 Dependent Child Turning 20](#) letter to both client and dependor following their 20th birthday. These individuals are expected to access family, friends, and/or se

04 Limited/Ineligible Groups

INTENT and POLICY

Last updated on: Feb 06, 2014

INTENT

This section outlines the circumstances under which a person may be completely ineligible or p

POLICY

Some persons (applicant, recipient or members of the household unit) are ineligible or have lim jurisdiction is required, expected or able to provide for their basic needs (refer to [Income Suppo](#)

Limited eligibility occurs when:

- Another program/service is expected to provide assistance
 - Another person is expected to provide assistance
 - Income Support benefits are limited by the Income Support, Training and Health Benefits
 - The applicants or recipients who are expected to work have placed themselves in a positi
-

Children Involved with/or Supported by Children at Risk Children with Disabilities (FSCD) and/or Alberta Aids to Daily Living

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2018

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, Tables 1, 2 and 3](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(2\)\(b\); Schedule 2, section 1](#)

INTENT

To ensure Income Support benefits are not duplicated while a child is in the care and/or responsible for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) and/or receiving services provided by Alberta Aids to Daily Living.

Note

FSCD provides individualized supports and services that are related to the child's disability.

[Basic medical equipment and supplies](#) for children under 18 years may be available through [AA](#) for eligible clients.

POLICY

Child(ren) Living Out of the Home

When CFS determines a client's child should live outside the home or a child who is provided services, education, training or residential services, the following policy applies:

Core Essential Benefit

The Core Essential benefit is reduced for the period the child is out of the home. If the child is returned home, the Core Essential benefit is not recovered as the client **was** entitled to that amount at the beginning of the period. The client receives pro-rated Core Essential benefits for the days the child is in the home.

If/when the child is returned full-time after the first day of the benefit period, the [Core Essential Benefit](#) is reinstated. If the child was removed by CFS, the client must apply for reinstatement of the Canada Child Benefit (Temporary Replacement Benefit).

Core Shelter Benefit

If a child is:

- Absent for three months or less, the Core Shelter benefit is not reduced; if more than three months, the benefit is reduced.
- Removed from the home by CFS, the child is deleted from the IS file at the time the Core Shelter benefit is reduced.
- Out of the home because of an agreement under FSCD, the child remains on the budget for more than three months.
- Returning home after having been outside of the home for more than three months, the benefit is reduced to allow the family size and to allow the parent(s) to prepare for their return.

Note: In situations where the Core Shelter benefit has been reduced because the child was

child's shelter portion is not issued, the worker should enter a Compass Reminder on a m

Health Benefits Coverage

If the child is:

- Removed from the home by CFS, health benefits coverage for the child is deleted on the home. Income Support covers health benefits for the month in which the child is removed; recommence [health benefits coverage](#) the day the child is returned (full time).
- Out of the home because of an agreement under FSCD health benefits, coverage for the

Any support services addressed in the CFS case plan is CFS's responsibility.

Child(ren) Living in the Home

Children who are:

- Adopted through either the adoption or private guardianship process and receiving a daily
- A foster child/a child in Kinship Care
- A child receiving income support from the Child and Youth Support Program through a Cr

are **not** eligible to receive Income Support benefits as a dependant of a household unit and sho

Foster Children/Children in Kinship Care

CFS meets the financial needs of foster children and children in Kinship Care. These children th purposes of determining Income Support benefits, as foster parents and Kinship Caregivers re for the needs of the child.

Note

Kinship Care is a family home that is approved to care for a child in need because of a far friend or cultural community). It is similar to foster care in the types of supports that are pr found on the [CFS website](#).

Supports for Permanency Program

Families who adopt or who assume private guardianship of children who were in permanent car consists of a flat daily maintenance rate based on the age of the child to help the parents/privat

In addition to the daily maintenance rate, services under the Supports for Permanency Agreem

- The cost of respite for the parents/private guardians for up to 567 hours annually.
- In the case of a child who is of First Nation status, the cost of transportation of the child to
- Help to address the child's emotional or behavioural problems, the cost of up to 10 couns
- Additional Needs Funds of up to \$70 per week to purchase services to address the child's

A list of these additional benefits are available by contacting the nearest CFSA.

Income Support workers must:

- Verify with adoptive parents/private guardians whether the child is eligible for supports un
- Provide no benefits (Core, Supplementary or Health) for these children.

Child and Youth Support Program

If an [adult of a household unit](#) is a guardian of a child who is receiving benefits from the Child a unit and is not eligible for Income Support. They should **not** be added to the household's file.

Fine Option Program (FOP)

Last updated on: Dec 04, 2007

INTENT

Benefits are not provided to pay for babysitting, travel, or any other expense incurred while working.

POLICY

Income Support benefits are granted only if FOP participation does not interfere with the obligation to accept and maintain employment by signing the **Individual Plan**. Normally clients are able to receive benefits while working.

Note

Income Support does not pay court-ordered fines.

First Nations People with Registered Status under

Last updated on: Nov 06, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 2, 6 and 15\(1\)\(a\)\(b\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 14](#)

INTENT

To ensure the terms and conditions of the [Administrative Reform Agreement](#) are met with respect to the reserve.

When a First Nation person is residing on reserve or ordinarily residing on reserve the Income Support lies with the federal government.

Definitions

Registered Status under the *Indian Act*

The [Indian Act](#) sets out the requirements for determining who is an Indian for the purposes of the Act if their band has its own membership code and the membership code defines and stipulates how to determine status.

Non-Registered First Nations Person

A First Nation person may not be registered as an Indian under the *Indian Act* because their band is not a band under the provisions of the *Indian Act*. Over the years, however, the rules have changed. An individual may be registered under C-31 an Act to Amend the *Indian Act*, some First Nations people who had lost their status previously.

Registered First Nations Person

A Registered Indian under the Indian Act who belongs to a First Nation that has signed a treaty with the Crown.

Providing Income Support to First Nations People Living Off-Reserve

According to the Administrative Reform Agreement, the province has agreed to fund and deliver Income Support to First Nations people living off-reserve in the Treaty 7 and 8 areas. The province also funds and delivers Income Support to First Nations people in the Treaty 6 area. The federal government continues to provide social assistance to persons on reserve.

POLICY

Registered First Nations people residing off-reserve and deemed to be in need, are eligible for Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, and Alberta Supports Income Support regardless of where they live since this is the responsibility of the federal government, through the Administrative Reform Agreement.

Assessment

Registered First Nations People

The worker:

- Asks all applicants if they have Registered Status under the *Indian Act*.
- Confirms with the applicant they are not ordinarily a resident on a reserve by asking if they have a permanent address.

- Determines the status of each member of the household unit.

When a client indicates they have Registered Status under the Indian Act and do not ordinarily referred to as 'status card') number for the HH (head of household) and/or spouse/cohabiting partner.

If the card is unavailable other official documentation is acceptable.

Note

The CIS card number is a maximum of ten digits:

- The Band Number is the first three digits.
- The Family Number is the next five digits. If the Family Number is less than five digits, it is padded with zeros.
- The Position Number is the last two digits.

Since June 3, 2003 any:

- Registered child will have their own position number as 01 and
- Child turning 18 is required to apply for their own number.

First Nations People without Registered Status under the *Indian Act*

If the client states they:

- Have some First Nations heritage **and**
- Are uncertain if they are eligible for status registration **and**
- Wish to pursue their status eligibility, they are referred to:

Head of Indian Registration and Band Lists Indigenous Services Canada (ISC)
Room 162, Canada Place
9700 Jasper Avenue
Edmonton AB T5J 4G2

Persons who indicate they are eligible to be registered as a First Nations person under the *Indian Act* but are **not** required to do so.

PROCEDURES

When a Non-Registered First Nations person indicates they are applying for registration, the worker:

1. Informs the client they must provide a copy of their CIS once it is received; or document that they have applied for a CIS.
2. Enters a Compass Reminder to allow for appropriate follow-up,

3. Enters Compass Comments regarding the outcome of the client's contact with AANDC.

If the client obtains a CIS, the worker records the number in LISA and records this information in

Obtaining a Band Number

If the client provides a CIS card with the band name, position number and family number, the worker records this number in LISA and documents the source of the band number in Compass Comments.

Incomplete Registration Number

When the client does not know their complete registration number, the worker:

- Asks the client to contact their band or their family to obtain the registration number or
- Refers the client to AANDC to apply for their CIS card.

If the client is still unable to obtain their complete registration number, benefits are issued provisionally.

The worker:

- Enters the information that is available into LISA,
- Sets the **Cheque Release Flag** for the next benefit period to 'N', and
- Records on the comments line of the CRC Processing screen that further benefits are held in abeyance.

When the CIS card is received, the worker:

- Reviews the registration number entered previously, or
- Enters the new registration number.

Note

Although a client may not know their complete registration number, it is expected they know their band number. The band number must be entered into LISA. The other data fields are left blank until the complete registration number is known.

No Certification of Registered Status under the *Indian Act* or the CIS Number is not Known

In situations where the client knows their registration number but does not have their CIS card,

1. Enters the complete registration number into LISA,
2. Leaves the **Cheque Release Flag** for the next period of assistance at 'N',
3. Indicates on the comments line of the **CRC Processing** screen that no further benefits are payable until the CIS card is received.

4. Records in Compass Comments the method used to obtain the registration number.

Other Client File Codes

Registered First Nations people do **not** receive health benefits. When the Head of Household (records the following codes in LISA:

1. The **Medical Coverage (Med Cov)** is 'N'. The **Med Cov** is coded individually for each member. Members who are coded 'Y' to receive health benefits.
2. The **AHCIP Status** data field is coded '2'.
3. The **Med Code '7'** only when **all** members of the household unit are Registered First Nations.
4. The **Ordinarily on Reserve** data field is coded 'N' or left blank.

Providing Income Support to First Nations People Living On Reserve

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Section 6\(2\)\(e\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulations, Section 14](#)

POLICY

First Nations people living on reserve, non-First Nations people living on reserve and persons in certain situations. In accordance with an agreement with the federal government, these groups receive

People who are **not** eligible include:

- People residing in the following communities (associated First Nations Bands in brackets)
 - Cadotte Lake (Woodland Cree First Nation)
 - Fort Chipewyan (Chipewyan Prairie First Nation, Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation)
 - Fort McKay (Fort McKay First Nation)
 - Garden River (Little Red River Cree Nation)
 - Little Buffalo (Lubicon Lake) and
 - Any other Bands that are established under the *Indian Act*.
- People who are away from a reserve to obtain services in a care facility
- People who are away from a reserve to access a social service not available on the reserve
- People who are away from a reserve to access addictions treatment programs
- People who are away from a reserve to access full-time post-secondary education or a full

The Income Support [Emergency Allowance](#) is only issued to Registered First Nations people, n
the following conditions:

- The emergency situation poses a serious health and safety risk for the applicant **and**
 - The circumstances warranting the person applying for provincial emergency Income Supp
-

Health and Treatment Facilities

Last updated on: Mar 04, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(a\), Schedule, sections 1\(f\) and \(h\), 6 and 8](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 4, 8 and 9 and Schedule 4,](#)

INTENT

Income Support applicants, recipients or members of their household unit who are admitted to a health facility, or care center (Claresholm), or residential addiction treatment facility should not need to worry about costs while receiving treatment.

POLICY

Benefit Determination

The type of benefit provided is determined by the type of admission, as determined by the doctor, whether temporary or permanent.

A person may be admitted to a health facility as a permanent patient or their status may change to temporary.

The worker determines the client type and eligibility for specific benefits based on whether it is a temporary or permanent admission.

In accordance with the [Supplementary Benefits](#) policy, the circumstances of clients who enter the facility to receive treatment, to determine existing supplementary benefits and to identify any new supplementary benefits that they may be eligible for.

Types of Facilities

Acute Care/Active Treatment Hospitals

Income Support applicants or recipients who are admitted to an acute care hospital, and intend to stay for a minimum of 30 days, are eligible for the **duration of their hospitalization**.

Occasionally patients in acute care hospitals are approved by the Assessment/Placement Committee for a temporary admission. In these situations, the policy for continuing care applies. A 30-day notice of their change in status. For clients in these situations, the policy for continuing care applies.

Continuing Care Homes

Temporary Admissions

Income Support applicants or recipients who are temporarily admitted to a continuing care home for a period of less than one month in the facility.

If the client remains in the continuing care home beyond one month, and intends to return to the community, the client is responsible for the accommodation charge at the Shared Room rate.

If there are other members of the household unit living in the community, they receive their portion of the accommodation charge.

Permanent Admissions

Income Support applicants or recipients permanently admitted to a continuing care home are eligible for the **duration of their admission**. However, where the client has not been able to give one month's notice to the landlord, the client is responsible for the accommodation charge.

If a client who is permanently admitted to a continuing care home has a spouse/cohabiting partner, the client is responsible for the accommodation charge.

issued on two separate files.

Provincial Mental Health Hospitals (Alberta Hospital Edmonton or Ponoka) and Claresholm

Temporary Admission

Income Support applicants or recipients who are temporarily admitted to a mental health hospital for one month of hospitalization.

If the client remains in the mental health hospital beyond one month, and intends on returning to the community, Core Shelter can be provided for clients admitted to these facilities.

The Comforts Allowance is not paid by the Income Support program for clients admitted to Alberta Hospital Edmonton or Ponoka; however, the program is providing this allowance to their patients.

If there are other members of the household unit living in the community, they receive their portion of the allowance.

Permanent Admission

Alberta Health determines when admission to a mental health hospital is permanent.

Income Support clients permanently admitted to a provincial mental health hospital are not eligible for Core Shelter. If a client has not been able to give one month's notice to the landlord, Core Shelter can be provided for one month.

If a client who is permanently admitted to a Provincial Mental Health Hospital has a spouse/cohabitant, they may be eligible for Income Support benefits, they may be issued benefits on their own file.

Residential Addiction Treatment Facilities

Licensing Requirements

All service providers who operate residential addiction treatment facilities must be licensed under the [Licensing of Residential Services Act](#). If a worker identifies that a service provider is operating without a license, they should report it to the [Licensing of Residential Services Act](#). [Questions](#).

Residential addiction treatment facilities may be publicly or privately funded. These facilities must be licensed under the [Licensing of Residential Services Act](#).

Publicly Funded Facilities (including Recovery Communities)

These facilities are licensed and funded by the Government of Alberta. Clients generally incur no costs for their basic needs as not all of these costs may be covered by the facility.

- Clients are eligible for Core Essential, supplementary and health benefits, based on their income.
- Clients are not eligible for Core Shelter beyond the month of admission, as they are not in the community.

However, if the client or their family is maintaining a residence in the community, they are eligible for Core Shelter. Core Shelter can be provided for one additional month.

Privately Funded Facilities

These are facilities that are licensed, but not funded by the Government of Alberta. Clients will incur costs for their basic needs as not all of these costs may be covered by the facility.

- Clients are eligible for Core Essential, Core Shelter, supplementary and health benefits, b

If a client is receiving Core Essential and Core Shelter while in one of these facilities and they, c
landlord, they do not receive duplicate Core benefits (i.e., two Core Essential and/or two Core S

Reassessment of Client Categorization

Workers may need to reassess a client's category/type and Individual Plan, including the feasib
need to be reassessed more than once if the type/intensity of the treatment changes over time ;

Liquid Asset Limits

The worker advises applicants or clients in these facilities of their allowable liquid asset limit and
worker also advises that once their liquid assets are below this limit, they may reapply for Incom
Adult Health Benefit program if they have medical expenses.

Persons Involved in Justice System

Last updated on: Oct 03, 2023

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 2 and 6](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 15](#)

INTENT

To describe the policies and practices in place for persons involved in various stages of the just

POLICY

Persons who are incarcerated or who are unable to work as a condition of their sentence or rele

Groups of ineligible persons may include:

- Persons who are unable to work due to the specific condition(s) of their sentence or relea
- Persons held in custody in a provincial or federal correctional center.
- Persons **required** by Correctional Service Canada (CSC) to reside in a half-way house or
- Persons on day parole from a federal correctional centre or Community Residential Centri

Release from a Correctional Facility

There are several conditions under which a person can be released from a federal or provincial

Type of Release	Circumsta
Statutory Release of Parole	Release fr
Temporary Absence (Provincial)	Temporary
Probation	Non-custo
Provincial Parole	Release fr

Eligibility for Income Support is based, in part, upon the conditions of release.

Provided they meet all other eligibility conditions, the following persons **may** be eligible for Inco

- Persons on temporary absence;
- Persons released on full-parole from the provincial system (note: provincial parole has no
- Persons residing in a half-way house or Community Residential Centre who are **not** requi

- Persons released to live in the community-at-large without a specific residency requirement

Substantiation

To determine eligibility, the following is required:

- Verbal statement from the recipient or applicant on the conditions of their release; and
- If there are conditions to their release that would impact eligibility for Income Support, official Documentation includes Parole Order, Permits, Release Certificate, or Probation Order.

Persons involved in the justice system must verbally declare the conditions of their release. Address their Income Support eligibility. Documentation includes Parole Order, Permits, Release Certificate

Note

Not all individuals involved with the justice system who are released with conditions will have concerns that information is being withheld, staff may connect with the individual's probation substantiation requirements.

PROCEDURES

Matching LISA and Alberta Justice Inmate Records

Alberta Justice provides Seniors, Community and Social Services with monthly computer data on Income Support clients. Clients incarcerated in provincial correctional centres and who are currently in custody. **Community and Social Services Match between LISA and Alberta Justice.**

When using the SEIP 3580-1 report, the worker:

1. Reviews the "SEIP 3580-1 AFSS Match Between LISA and Alberta Justice Inmate Records" report, comparing the records of clients in provincial correctional centres with those of active Income Support clients. The printout includes the following information:
 1. Admit Date: The most recent date that a person was admitted to the correctional centre, or the date they were then re-admitted before expiry of their sentence.
 2. Aggregate Sentence: The total number of days to be held in sentence custody. It could be 0 days.

Note
Aggregate Sentences of 0 days means the client is in custody but no sentence has been imposed.

 3. ORCA Number: A unique identifier that Alberta Justice assigns to each offender.
 4. Correctional Centre: Where the client is being held. The initials are explained in the report.
 5. Self-Reporting Flag: On admission to a correctional centre, a person is asked whether they are currently receiving Income Support.
2. Review the file and determine whether the information is already known.
3. If there is no record of that client information already on file, contact the client and determine if they are currently receiving Income Support. If there is no contact from the client or if the client responds but the information provided is not accurate, the client was in custody by completing the following steps:

1. Select "Report an IT issue" tab
2. Under "Category of Issue" choose "Application/ software"
3. Under "Short Description" input "INCR information request"
4. Under "Long Term Description" input "client name, ORCA #, Date of Birth, Last adm"
5. Under "How does your issue affect your ability to work" choose "I am able to perform"
6. Under "How many people are impacted" choose "Just myself"
7. Click "Submit"

4. Once the incarceration period has been determined, assess the client's eligibility and take
 - A system closure
 - Referral to the Fraud Investigation Unit
 - Creation of a debt in the Recoveries System.
 - Adjustment of the household unit's benefit level

Note

No repayment or prorating of benefits is calculated for the first month of incarceration

Note

Child care or homemaking is not provided for the children of a person who has been refer the person to Children's Services.

Offenders Unlawfully at Large from a Correctional Facility

When a worker becomes aware that an applicant or recipient is unlawfully-at-large from a provi to deny Income Support eligibility or benefits. In these situations, the following must occur:

1. Workers must inform the supervisor or manager of their findings.
2. The Alberta Supports Center staff must request a release of information from the Regiona
3. After obtaining the Regional Director's approval, the Alberta Support Centre staff must inf
4. When the individual has left the Alberta Supports Centre, the worker enters alert **03 Eligib**
5. When benefits are believed to have been obtained fraudulently, the worker refers the clie

Warrants

If the worker becomes aware of outstanding warrant for an income support client, the worker sh requiring that the client resolve their outstanding legal issues. If these issues go unresolved, the

Workers should use their discretion in determining whether to request a release of information a

public.

If the worker determines that a release of information **should** be requested, the worker must inf

Imminent Threat to Health or Safety

If the worker suspects there is an imminent threat to the health and safety of staff or the public,

Persons Not in Alberta

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2011

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 2, 6 and 15\(1\)\(a\)\(b\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 11](#)

INTENT

Income Support benefits are intended for people in Alberta.

POLICY

Persons are eligible for Income Support only while they are in Alberta with the following exceptions:

- A client who is out of the province for legitimate reasons (e.g., out of province job search or Health) may be eligible for Core Shelter **only**, for a maximum of **one** month, to maintain their

The Health Benefits Card is not valid for coverage outside Alberta.

Substantiation

- An [Individual Plan](#) in which the worker has approved job search outside of Alberta.
 - A medical letter (from their physician or nurse practitioner) substantiating the need to seek
-

Self-Employed Persons and Farmers

Last updated on: Apr 24, 2012

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 2, 6 and 15\(1\)\(a\)\(b\)*](#)

INTENT

Self-employment may be a viable means to become independent of Income Support, however,

POLICY

Defining Self-Employment

- A client who claims (in any context) to be self-employed is considered to be self-employed
- A self-employed person is not allowed to declare they are no longer self-employed unless
- A client substantiates a change in employment by providing documents such as a job contract or new pay stubs.
- Casual employment (e.g., day labour, grass cutting, snow-shoveling) is **not** self-employment

Asset and income restrictions on self-employed persons and farmers apply as outlined in the [A:](#)

Note

Clients determined to be self-employed must meet all program expectations for [self-employment](#)

Expectations for Self-Employed Clients

Clients are expected to:

- Keep an accurate record of income received,
- Maximize earning potential,
- Demonstrate progression towards business viability, **and**
- Attend worker appointments as required.

A worker should refer self-employed clients to one of the [Starting a business | Alberta.ca](#) for information

with the toll free number (1-800-272-9675) [Alberta.ca](#).

Image: Unknown

If a client requires Income Support beyond three months (or 12 months if they are a farmer) a re

current business viability, their Individual Plan and the possibility of re-categorizing the individual as self-employed beyond this period, and refuse to actively seek full-time competitive employment.

Self-Employed Client Groups

Farmers

Farmers may receive a maximum of one year's asset exemption, to give their business a chance. If a viability assessment indicates that the farm operation is viable.

Farmers, otherwise eligible for the Income Support program, are referred to the district agricultural agent.

Following one month of assistance, Income Support is only granted when:

- A thorough assessment of the farm operation has been made, **and**
- The assessment shows that the farm has the potential of being a viable operation, **and**
- All appropriate resources have been used such as farm or business loans and the service of a farm manager.

If the viability assessment indicates the farm would never be viable, then the client is assigned to a new business. If reassigned, their business assets can be exempted for up to six months at a time, twice, to give them a chance to succeed.

The worker reviews the financial situation of farmers through their monthly reporting to determine if the business is viable. All actual revenue and all allowable expenses incurred during the calendar year are reported.

Note

For assistance with farm income calculation, the worker can consult regional agricultural agents.

Expected to Work (ETW)

ETW self-employed clients, including seasonal businesses, are allowed **three months only** to manage their business.

ETW self-employed people in **seasonal businesses** are expected to manage their affairs so that their business can sustain the family throughout the year, it may not be viable.

ETW **family day-home providers and child care providers** are considered to be self-employed.

Barriers to Full Employment (BFE)

There is no time limit on a BFE client's ability to make the company a viable business.

BFE clients who operate a home-based business will continue to have business assets exempt from the asset exemption.

Shelters for those Fleeing Abusive Relationships

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

Shelters for those Fleeing Abusive Relationships

INTENT

Shelters provide a safe place for those fleeing abusive relationships and support residents by providing transportation. The goods and services provided may vary across shelters.

POLICY

Income Support Benefits for Clients Residing in a Shelter for Persons Escaping Abuse

Income Support benefits as outlined below, may be issued to clients residing in a shelter for persons escaping abuse.

Core Benefits

- [Core Essential](#) - Clients in shelters for persons escaping abuse receive the Core Essential benefits.

Health Benefits

- [Prescription drugs](#)
- [Prescription Nutritional Products](#) for adults and children not including regular infant formula
- [Emergency dental](#)
- [Optical](#)

Note

Residents who otherwise have health coverage for needed [health benefits](#) (e.g., from an employer or government) are not eligible for health benefits from IS.

Supplementary Benefits

- [Emergency Allowance](#) such as emergency child care and/or
- [Emergency transportation](#) not provided by shelters.
- [Escaping Abuse Benefit](#) may be accessed while in the shelter if required for storage of furniture.

Income Support Benefits for Clients Leaving a Shelter for Persons Escaping Abuse

Relocation Costs

Persons leaving abuse, regardless of their relationship to the abuser, may be eligible for a [reloc](#)

Damage Deposits

Persons leaving abuse, regardless of their relationship to the abuser, may be eligible for a [dam](#).

Escaping Abuse Benefit

Persons leaving abuse are eligible for the \$1,177 [Escaping Abuse Benefit](#) to establish a new ho

Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation – Leaving Abusive Situation

Persons leaving abuse are eligible for the [Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation – L](#)

Note

Persons fleeing abusive situations who are unable to access shelters, or when leaving a shelter actual cost of a reasonably priced hotel, motel, or other shelter in accordance with [emergency e](#)

Strikes

Last updated on: Dec 04, 2007

INTENT

To prevent Income Support being used to financially subsidize persons involved in labour conflict or is helping prolong the labour conflict.

POLICY

Persons on Strike

As a general rule, persons on strike are not eligible for Income Support with the following exceptions:

1. For recipients who are receiving a supplement to earnings, the original amount of the supplement is provided.
2. Applicants who are unable to provide for their dependant(s) are issued the food portion of Children's Services involvement. Applicants substantiate this need by making a verbal statement of income (e.g., strike pay) proof of the amount must be provided.

Food is provided on a week-by-week basis only.

Persons Locked Out

Persons locked out by the employer are treated the same as persons on strike.

Persons Refusing to Cross Another Group's Picket Lines

Persons refusing to cross another group's picket lines are treated the same as persons on strike.

Persons Unemployed as a Result of Strike Action by another Group

Persons affected by the strike action of another group may apply for benefits. The requirement to accept employment by signing a **Individual Plan**.

05 Core Shelter

General Policy

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(a\); Schedule, sections 4\(b\), 8 and Tables 2](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1\(2\)\(a.1\), 1\(2\)\(c\), 1\(2\)\(d\), 2\(](#)

INTENT

To provide for the costs of rent, mortgage, utilities (except for electricity in social housing) heating and damage deposit.

POLICY

Core Shelter is determined by household composition and living arrangement.

Clients residing in private housing or social housing are eligible for Core Shelter at the rate specified in the [Monthly Core Shelter Payment Table Social Housing](#).

Core Shelter rates are legislated and cannot be exceeded by Seniors, Community and Social Services. Core Shelter unless a specific provision has been made elsewhere in the ISTHB Regulation. For

Clients residing in a shelter (for example, a homeless shelter) are not eligible for Core Shelter but may still be eligible for Core Essential. See [Individuals Experiencing Homelessness | Income](#)

Core Shelter for applicants can be issued for the entire month if the applicant has unpaid shelter

Substantiation

For all benefits issued in this section, substantiation is as reported and signed by the client on the Client's (ARC).

Verbal notification from the client may be accepted as confirmation of an address change depending on eligibility for or the amount of the Core Shelter benefit.

See [Core Shelter Rate Adjustment](#) policy for information about adjusting Core Shelter benefits.

Recording Shelter Benefits

LISA makes automatic adjustments if rates change or there is a household unit size change and

To ensure the proper amount of benefit is issued, shelter information entered in LISA must accurately

Living Arrangement Codes

Private housing:

Living Arrangement 1

These Core Shelter rates vary by household composition.

Social housing:

Living Arrangement 6

These Core Shelter rates vary by household composition.

Clients who live with family:

Living Arrangement 2

Clients who do not have accommodation costs:

Living Arrangement 7

Are not eligible to receive Core Shelter.

Parenting Agreement/Order

See [Core Shelter Rate Adjustment](#) policy

One-Time Issue

_____ actual amount _____

Reducing Shelter Rates

One month's notice is provided to clients to allow time to find alternative accommodations when

If Rent or Shelter is Paid by Another Party

[See Income - Third Party Payments](#)

Applicants or recipients residing in living arrangements other than private housing or social hou

Variations to Maximum Core Shelter

- **Approved Homes**

An approved home is a home where residential support services are provided for adults w
the case of an approved home, the Core Shelter covers rent, heating fuel, utilities and foo
request a copy of the agreement between the service provider and the Minister of Health.

Need Code 1112 Mental Health Approved Home

Living Arrangement 4 Approved Home/Group Home

Rate \$590.00 per month per adult

- **Active Treatment Hospital**

See [Core Essential](#) policy regarding the Comforts Allowance.

See [Limited/Ineligible Groups-Health and Treatment Facilities](#) policy for information regar
Hospitals and Residential Addiction Treatment Facilities for eligibility for Core Shelter ben

- **Group Homes**

A group home is a home where residential support services are provided to adults with ph
Government of Alberta. This includes group homes operated under contract by non-profit
covers rent, heating fuel, utilities and food. If it is not clear whether the facility is a group h
provider and the Government of Alberta. The group home should be able to provide this ir

Need Code 1111 Government Funded Group

Living Arrangement 4 Approved Home/Group Home

Rate \$502.00 per month per adult

- **Living with Family**

A set Core Shelter amount is provided when the household unit resides with a parent, step-parent, or other relative of the household unit. The relationship can be established through marriage or a relationship as outlined in the [Private Housing](#) policy is provided to each eligible applicant or recipient.

Need Code 1134 Shelter Living with Family

Living Arrangement 2 Living with Family

Rate \$121.00 per household unit

- **Type A Continuing Care Home**

A type A Continuing care home is a home under the [Continuing Care Act](#).

The maximum shelter allowance for an applicant or recipient residing in a type A continuing care home is the **shared room rate**. When a physician or nurse practitioner confirms the need in writing for a private room, the **shared room rate**.

Lists of approved hospitals and continuing care homes in Alberta are identified and can be found at [Alberta Health Services](#).

Clients who were approved for a medically necessary private room before January 1, 2008, are exempt from the accommodation charge until they no longer require a private room.

The Accommodation Charge is not paid to Provincial Mental Health Hospitals (Alberta Health Services), the Centre for Mental Health and Addictions Hospitals.

Need Code 1105 Accommodation Charge

Living Arrangement 5 Designated Facility

Rate The accommodation charge is established by Alberta Health and can be found at [Alberta Health Services](#).

PROCEDURES

Standard Core Shelter:

1. Ensure the **Client File** reflects accurate shelter information and any information impacting the shelter amount.
2. Enter the mailing address of the accommodation and the residence address (if different than the mailing address).
3. Enter the appropriate **Living Arrangement** field displayed in **Client Budget** and ensure the **Need Code** is entered.
4. Update the **Client Budget** to reflect the actual shelter costs and then press **PF10** to default to the **Client Budget**.
5. Update Compass to reflect accurate shelter information.

1. The worker must manually enter the Need Code identified in this section.
2. LISA will default to the Core Shelter amount for **Living with Family** when the worker presses **Budget** for all household types except **One-Time Issues** when the **Living Arrangement** is set to **2**.

Private Housing

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 8 and Table 2](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 2\(1\), 2\(2\) and 2\(4\)](#)

INTENT

To describe the Core Shelter benefits available to individuals in a variety of private housing situ

POLICY

Core Shelter is provided to clients residing in private housing. Private housing includes homeov

- clients or applicants who are renting a self-contained suite from relatives; or
- clients or applicants who have a tenancy agreement with a landlord (including when Living

Note

The landlord cannot be a relative (as defined in the Living with Family section of the [Core](#)

Core Shelter is determined by household composition and living arrangement. See also the [Co](#) arrangements.

Core Shelter for private housing covers the following items:

- Payments for rent or payments under a mortgage or agreement for sale
- Utilities (except telephone)
- Heating fuel
- Damage deposit
- Lot rental for a mobile home
- Municipal taxes, house or tenant insurance, and, if applicable, condominium fees
- Homeowner's maintenance

Maximum Monthly Core Shelter Payment Table-Private Housing

Household Composition
Single adult

Single adult, 1 child
Single adult, 2 children
Single adult, 3 children
Single adult, 4 children
Single adult, 5 children
Single adult, 6 children
Each additional child
Couple, no children
Couple, 1 child
Couple, 2 children
Couple, 3 children
Couple, 4 children
Couple, 5 children
Couple, 6 children
Each additional child
Exception
1. If the Director is satisfied that a child will become a member of the household unit, the Director

Need Code 1130 Core Shelter
Living Arrangement 1 Private Housing

See [Core Shelter Rate Adjustment policy](#) for information about adjusting Core Shelter benefits :

PROCEDURES

1. LISA will default the Core Shelter when the worker presses the **Enter** key in **Preliminary** except **One-Time Issues** when the **Living Arrangement** is **'1' Private Housing**.
2. To ensure LISA defaults the right Core Shelter amount from The Maximum Core Shelter F

Budget is correct and that household composition and client type is correct in **Client File**.

Social Housing

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 8 and Table 3](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 2\(1\), 2\(2\) and 2\(4\)](#)

INTENT

To describe the core shelter benefits available to individuals living in social housing.

POLICY

Core Shelter is provided to clients residing in social housing. Social housing is a housing unit of
Core shelter is determined by household composition and living arrangement.

Core Shelter for Social Housing covers the following items:

- Rent
- Heating fuel and utilities other than electricity
- Damage deposit

Social Housing shelter rates are regulated and **cannot** be exceeded by Seniors, Community an

Clients in Social Housing are allowed an amount for **electricity** over and above the Maximum C
established regional electricity rate. In all cases, the total costs of Social Housing rent and utiliti

Instead of paying the utility companies directly some social housing authorities give income sup
if received, are exempt as income.

See [Core Essential Rate Adjustment](#) policy for information about adjusting Core Essential bene

Maximum Monthly Core Shelter Payment Table-Social Housing

Household Composition
Single adult
Single adult, 1 child
Single adult, 2 children
Single adult, 3 children

Single adult, 4 children
Single adult, 5 children
Single adult, 6 children
Couple, no children
Couple, 1 child
Couple, 2 children
Couple, 3 children
Couple, 4 children
Couple, 5 children
Couple, 6 children
Exception: 1. A household unit living in social housing with more than 6 children does not receive an additio 2. If a household unit is living in social housing, the amount set out in this Table must be increase housing. 3. If the Director is satisfied that a child will become a member of the household unit, the Directo

Need Code 1115 Social Housing Rent
Need Code 1201 Utilities – Social Housing
Living Arrangement 6 Social Housing

PROCEDURES

1. LISA will default the Core Shelter when the worker presses the **Enter** key in **Preliminary** except **One-Time Issues** when the **Living Arrangement** is '**6**' **Social Housing**.
2. To ensure LISA defaults the right Core Shelter amount from the Maximum Core Shelter P **Budget** is correct and that household composition is correct in **Client File**.

Note

Workers can change Living Arrangement in Client Budget.

Core Shelter Rate Adjustment

Last updated on: Feb 27, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(a\); Schedule, sections 4\(b\), 8 and Tables 2](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 2\(1\), 2\(2\) and 2\(4\)](#)

INTENT

Clients not eligible for the standard Core Shelter as per the standard Core Shelter Private and S the amount specified as outlined in this section.

POLICY

In certain situations the full amount of the standard Private or Social Housing Core Shelter bene household circumstances or need, or a change in situation/living arrangement during the month

Where an applicant or recipient is not eligible for Core Shelter for a full month, they receive a pr

The following situations may require the Core Shelter benefit to be pro-rated.

- **Parenting Agreement/Order**

If a client living in private housing has a formal or informal Parenting Agreement/Order (th child is included in the household unit to determine the Core Shelter private housing bene

If both parents are Income Support recipients, the full Core Shelter private housing rate is Agreement/Order exists, **only** one parent is entitled to the child's portion of the Core Shel

If a parent living in Social Housing has joint custody of a dependent child, the child is inclu

- **Children Supported by other Government Programs**

For information about how to issue Core Shelter benefits for children who are supported b please see [Children Involved with /or Supported by Children and Family Services \(CFS\), I \(AADL\)](#) policy.

- **Decrease in Family Size**

If the worker knows in advance a household member is leaving the family, that individual i Shelter is issued under **Need Code 1109 Additional Shelter** for one benefit period.

When the core shelter will be reduced, the worker provides the household with one month reduced.

When an unforeseeable decrease in the size of the household unit occurs because one m benefit periods.

- **Increase in Household Size**

Core Shelter for a household unit living in **private housing** may be increased to reflect th

return of that child who has been in the care of Child and Family Services **or** living elsewhere

Clients can verify the addition of the child to the household unit with one of the following documents:

- Note from a doctor or nurse practitioner confirming the due date of the child
- The Alberta Health Care Card, the baby's hospital bracelet, or birth certificate
- Adoption papers
- Documentation from Child and Family Services
- Other suitable indication of a child's expected arrival/return

Need Code 1135 Shelter for Expected or Returning Child(ren)

- **Backdating File**

Core Shelter can be backdated for applicants to the date they first requested Income Support.

- **Change in Living Arrangement**

A change in a living arrangement during the month may require a review of the Core Shelter cases:

1. If a new type of Core Shelter is required part way through the month, the new Core Shelter is applied for the entire month. For example, if a client was living with family and moved into private residence part way through the month, the new Core Shelter is applied for the entire month.
2. Notwithstanding adjustment 1, the total amount of Core Shelter (standard and/or varied) is the standard Core Shelter amount that the client is eligible to receive in that month. For example, if a client was living with family part way through the month, moved into Social Housing, there would be no additional Core Shelter.

PROCEDURES

When issuing shelter for expected or returning children:

1. The worker enters a Compass Reminder to ensure the budget is updated appropriately.
 2. The worker deletes **Need Code 1135 Shelter for Expected or Returning Child(ren)** from the client's file.
-

06 Core Essential

Core Essential

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(a\); Schedule, sections 4\(a\), 6 and Table 1](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 2\(1\), 2\(2\) and 2\(3\)](#)
[Ministerial Order No 2018-19, Appendix A: Core Essential Payment Rates](#)

INTENT

The intent of the Core Essential benefit is to provide for monthly needs (listed below). Amounts

POLICY

Core Essential covers the following items:

- Food (except for a household unit living in an approved home, a group home, a hospital, c
- Clothing, including diapers
- Household needs
- Personal needs
- Use of a telephone
- Laundry
- Basic transportation, including vehicle registration

The standard Core Essential is provided to all clients who reside in private housing, social hous the [Individuals Experiencing Homelessness policy](#) for further information.

No additional allowance may be issued for an item covered by Core Essential, unless a specific [Benefits](#) policy.

See [Core Essential Rate Adjustment](#) policy for information about adjusting Core Essential bene

Maximum (Standard) Monthly Core Essential Payment Table

Household Composition	Amount for expected to unit
Single adult	\$479

Single adult, 1 child	\$708
Single adult, 2 children	\$824
Single adult, 3 children	\$939
Single adult, 4 children	\$1,054
Single adult, 5 children	\$1,168
Single adult, 6 children	\$1,284
Each additional child	\$117
Couple, no children	\$773
Couple, 1 child	\$1,003
Couple, 2 children	\$1,117
Couple, 3 children	\$1,233
Couple, 4 children	\$1,347
Couple, 5 children	\$1,463
Couple, 6 children	\$1,577
Each additional child	\$117

Need Code 1430 Core Essential

Need Code 1839 Core Essential/One-Time Issue

Variations to Maximum Core Essential

When the household is not eligible for the standard Core Essential amount, a variation rate can

See [Core Essential Rate Adjustment](#) policy for information about adjusting Core Essential bene

- **Type A Continuing Care Homes and Active Treatment Hospitals**

The Core Essential amount prescribed in the above Core Essential Payment Table is not majority of their needs met by the facility and receive basic needs in the form of a **Comfo** rate.

Rate

\$373.00

Clients **temporarily** admitted to Acute Care/Active Treatment hospitals or residential addi (Core Essential and Core Shelter) as outlined in the [Limited/Ineligible Groups - Health an](#)

- **Group Homes and Approved Homes**

The Core Essential amount prescribed in the above Core Essential Payment Table is not provided is based on the person's client type.

Rate

\$336.00 per month per adult in the ETW client type

\$476.00 per month per adult in the BFE client type

- **Food Only**

The Core Essential amount prescribed in the above Core Essential Payment Table is not amount is for food only, a “food only” amount may be provided. It can be provided either for

Rate

\$171.00 for an adult in a one adult household unit

\$164.00 for each adult in a two adult household unit

\$99.00 for each dependent child in the household unit

This may apply for [One-Time Issues](#), particularly client type **81 Transient**.

One-Time Issues

When [Emergency Allowance](#) benefits are not appropriate to meet the need, clients in client type Payment Table for the actual need for that one month.

Parenting Agreement/Order

See [Core Essential Rate Adjustment](#).

Foster or Adopted Children

See [Children Involved with/or Supported by Children and Family Services \(CFS\), Family Support](#)

See [Core Essential Rate Adjustment](#) policy for information about adjusting Core Essential bene

PROCEDURES

Standard Core Essential

Budget Status 1

On LISA the **Budget Status** must be ‘1’ when the Core Essential is pro-rated.

LISA will default to the standard Core Essential rate when the worker uses the **PF10** key in **Client**

Arrangements:

1 Private Housing,

2 Living with Family,

6 Social Housing, or

7 No Shelter

Only these Living Arrangements are Eligible for Standard Core Essential. To ensure LISA displayed in **Client Budget** are correct and that **Budget Status ‘1’** is entered. Workers can cha In a household unit with 18 and 19 year old dependants, the LISA system will automatically issu

Variations to Maximum (Standard) Core Essential

Budget Status 2

For Type A Continuing Care Homes and Active Treatment and Hospitals

In **Client File**, the worker enters:

Living Arrangement '**5**'

The appropriate **Designated Facility**

In **Client Budget**, the worker enters:

Need Code

1405 Comforts/Residence/Core Essential

Budget Status

2 Other than Maximum Core Essential

For Group Homes and Approved Homes

In **Client File**, the worker enters:

Living Arrangement '**4**'

The appropriate **Designated Facility** which is 33333

In **Client Budget**, the worker enters:

Living Arrangement

4 Approved Home/Group Home

Budget Status

1 Maximum Core Essential

Presses the **PF10** key to default the client's budget

Need Code

1430 Core Essential

HT has no bearing on the Core Essential amount provided to clients in designated facilities or a their **Living Arrangement**.

Core Essential Rate Adjustment

Last updated on: Aug 13, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 6 and Table 1](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 2\(1\), 2\(2\) and 2\(3\)](#)
[Ministerial Order No 2018-19, Appendix A: Core Essential Payment Rates](#)

INTENT

Clients not eligible for the standard Core Essential as per the standard Core Essential Payment

POLICY

In certain situations the full amount of the standard Core Essential benefit is not issued. Instead need, or a change in situation/living arrangement during the month.

Where an applicant or recipient is not eligible for Core Essential for a full month, they receive a

The following situations may require the Core Essential benefit to be pro-rated.

Parenting Agreement/Order

If a client has a formal or informal Parenting Agreement/Order, the child is included in the household to the client for the actual days the child is in the home.

Example: Single Expected to Work applicant/client with one dependent who's parenting agreement 30-day month.

Calculation:

Step #1

Core Essential single adult one child household rate minus the Core Essential single adult household

Step #2

Using the difference of the Core Essential rates from Step 1 divide by 30 days (number of days

Step #3

Using the total from Step 2 multiply by 11 days (number of days the child is in the home), equal

Children Supported by other Government Programs

For information about how to issue Core Essential benefits for children who are supported by CFS see [Children Involved with /or Supported by Children and Family Services \(CFS\), Family Support](#)

Backdating File

Core Essential can be backdated for applicants to the date they first requested Income Support

Change in Living Arrangement

A change in a living arrangement during the month may require a review of the Core Essential benefit

1. If a new type of Core Essential is required part way through the month, the new Core Essential is receiving the [Comforts Allowance](#), and moved into private residence part way through the month.
2. Notwithstanding adjustment 1, the total amount of Core Essential (standard and/or varied), standard [Core Essential table](#). For example, if a client received the maximum standard Core Essential at a [Group Home](#), there would be no additional Core Essential provided for that month.

Food Only

Where the Core Essential payment is for food only, a food amount may be provided, either for the month or for a part of the month.

See [Core Essential](#) policy for Food Only rates.

07 Supplementary Benefits

Authority - Intent - Policy

Last updated on: May 06, 2022

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, sections 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1\(2\)\(g\) and 2\(5\); Schedule 4](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)
[Ministerial Order 2022-007, Prenatal Needs Payment](#)

INTENT

To describe the eligibility criteria for supplementary Income Support benefits.

POLICY

Income Support provides supplemental benefits to assist clients with specific one-time or ongoing

To be eligible to receive a supplementary benefit, the following criteria must **always** be met:

- The client demonstrates a need for the benefit;
- The same or similar benefit is not available from any other program or source;
- The client meets the criteria and provides necessary substantiation, as indicated in the sp
- A reasonable, lower cost alternative is not available.

Supplementary benefits may be issued to a third party, in accordance with the [third-party chequ](#)

Reimbursement for Expenses Not Authorized in Advance

A supplementary benefit is **not** provided to reimburse a person for an expense that was not aut

- the expense was incurred in an emergency situation, **or**
- the expense is identified in a review or audit and failure to provide the benefit causes undi

For practical reasons, any allowance issued as reimbursement must be issued within a six-mon
than a period of six consecutive months.

Delegated Authority for Issuing Supplementary Income Support Benefits

See the Delegated [Authority for Issuing Supplementary Benefits](#) policy.

Repayment of Supplementary Benefits

Depending on the benefit, supplementary benefits may be issued subject to repayment by the r

See the [Repayment Agreements](#) policy and the benefit pages below for more information.

Supplementary Benefit Procedures

Workers should review the [Supplementary Benefit procedures](#) policy when reviewing a request

Supplementary Income Support Benefits

Depending on the supplementary benefit, the client may be required to re-establish eligibility ongoing, so eligibility is re-established at regular (non-monthly) time intervals.

See the benefit pages below for more information.

[Emergency Allowance](#)

[Emergency Prescription\(s\)/Drugs](#)

[Escaping Abuse Benefit \(Household Start-Up\)](#)

[Damage Deposit \(Escaping Abuse\)](#)

[Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation – Leaving Abusive Situation](#)

[Employment Training and Transition Supports](#)

[Children's School Expenses](#)

[Natal and Adoptive Needs Payment](#)

[Child Care Deposit and Registration Fee](#)

[Community Living Start-Up Allowance](#)

[Relocation Allowance](#)

[Utility Connection, Deposit, Reconnection](#)

[Special Transportation and Travel Payment](#)

[Medical Extraordinary Transportation](#)

[Director Approval](#)

[Funeral Benefits](#)

Re-Check Eligibility at Regular Intervals, as Described in the Applicable Policy

[Additional Shelter](#)

[Isolated Community Allowance](#)

[Transportation to Day or Employment Programs](#)

[Child Care](#)

[Child Supplement Allowance](#)

[Special Diets](#)

[Home Parenteral Therapy Program and Home Enteral Therapy Program](#)

[Medical and Surgical Supplies](#)

[Continuous Positive Airway Pressure \(CPAP\) Devices](#)

[Hearing Aid Benefits](#)

[Handicap Benefit](#)

[Earnings Replacement Allowance](#)

[Personal Needs Allowance](#)

[Prenatal Needs Payment](#)

Additional Shelter

Last updated on: Jan 28, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 8](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide additional assistance to support households with specific shelter requirements.

POLICY

The additional shelter allowance is available to assist households who are unable to sustain the other accommodations due to one of the situations outlined below.

Households living in social housing or accessing supportive housing programs are not eligible for

The allowance is available to a household unit as long as all the conditions are met and other re

When determining initial eligibility for Additional Shelter requests, the following criteria must be

1. The household must be in one of the following situations:
 - New recipients of the Income Support program or previous recipients who have had
 - Households receiving ongoing Income Support must have experienced a change in accommodation (such as an increase in rent or reduction in income); **and**
2. The household must also meet the requirements for one of the following situations:
 - **Large Family**
 - Where the household unit has six or more persons and suitable accommodati
 - **Adapted Accommodation**
 - Where a person in the household unit is disabled, the accommodation has been reviewed and the allowance is insufficient, to be reviewed annually.
 - **Endangered Health**
 - Where the health of a member of the household unit would be endangered by
 - As per Ministerial Order 2018-19, the allowance is provided for a three-month period to exist.

Note

For Endangered Health, a written medical opinion is not required to be provide

reconfirm eligibility for the additional shelter allowance. See Review of Continu

An additional shelter allowance may be provided under only one situation at any given time: lar the situation that has the most significant impact on the household's need for an additional shel

Households who have been receiving an additional shelter allowance must be given one month arrangements. In these cases, the worker must provide the client with verbal notification of the (for the decision and providing appeal information, in accordance with the [Denying or Terminatir](#)

Periodic reviews of continued eligibility are conducted to ensure the household continues to me endangered by a move.

Note

The allowance is available to a household unit living with a relative if all the eligibility

Substantiation

Initial Eligibility for the Additional Shelter Allowance

When determining initial eligibility for the additional shelter allowance, substantiation is required allowance, and that the household unit falls into one of the regulated household situations.

1. The worker requests substantiation to help determine if the household meets the change i
The change in circumstances must contribute to the household's inability to afford their cu
 - A new recipient of Income Support or recently reopened file (within two months);
 - A change in household circumstance or composition;
 - An increase in rent; or
 - The loss of employment or other incomes.
2. In addition to substantiation for the change in circumstances, substantiation is required for
 1. **For Large Families**
 - The worker's knowledge of the household unit's size, and
 - Verification that a suitable accommodation cannot be obtained for the core she
 2. **For an Adapted Accommodation**
 - Documentation confirming that the accommodation has been adapted for a ho
 - Verification that a suitable adapted accommodation cannot be obtained for the accommodations.

3. For Endangered Health

- A written opinion from a physician, psychologist or nurse practitioner stating:
 - The health of a member of the household unit would be endangered by a move;
 - How their health would be endangered or what aspects of the move would be a concern;
 - The anticipated length of time that the individual's health would be endangered;
 - Based on the aspects of the move that would endanger the health of the individual, the worker should request updated substantiation before issuing the additional shelter allowance.

Note

Typically, if a household unit was receiving an additional shelter allowance and

If a household unit was receiving an additional shelter allowance, moved and subsequently required substantiation should be requested for their new accommodation.

The worker requests the following:

- Clarification of the reason for the move and relevant changes to the situation of the recipient;
- Any change in circumstance since the move; and
- How the client's health has changed since the move, the size of the household unit, or the household unit.

Review of Continued Eligibility for the Additional Shelter Allowance

Change in circumstances is not considered when determining continued eligibility for an additional shelter allowance.

When reviewing a file to confirm continued eligibility, the worker should request updated substantiation if one of the following situations:

1. For Large Families

- If there have been no changes to the household composition, additional substantiation is not required.
- Verification that the household has not been able to obtain a suitable accommodation.

2. For Adapted Accommodation

- If the address of the household unit has not changed, additional substantiation of the need for adapted accommodation is not required.
- Verification that the household has not been able to obtain a suitable adapted accommodation.

accommodations.

3. For Endangered Health

- If health would be endangered by a move, a new written opinion is required from the
 - That the health of a member of the household unit would be endangered by a
 - How their health would be endangered or what aspects of the move would enc
 - The anticipated length of time that the individual's health would be endangered
- A new written opinion is not required as part of the three-month review if the opinion
 - For example, if the written opinion on file states that the client's health will be e and six-month reviews.
 - A new written opinion is required at least once per 12 months. This means if th

Rate

Actual up to \$354.00 per month

Need Code

1109 Additional Shelter

Child Care

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 16](#)

[Ministerial Order 2016-21: Delegation of Minister's Authority to Directors/Staff](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide reasonable child care for employment, training and health purposes.

POLICY

Ensuring the safety and well-being of children is more important than minimizing income support or child care costs. The intent is to encourage client independence even if the cost of child care is more than parent staying at home.

A child care allowance may be provided in situations where all adult members of the household

- Full or part-time employment.
- Participating in an active job search or attending an employment preparation program in a
- Attending a full or part-time education or training program in accordance with an **Individual**
- Attending an approved treatment program.

A child care allowance may also be provided when:

- A written opinion is received from a physician or nurse practitioner that the physical health
- A written opinion is received from a physician, nurse practitioner or a psychologist that the include the duration for which child care should be provided.
- There is an emergency situation as outlined in [Emergency Allowance](#), and there are no other

Child care is limited to the hours actually required and may include travel time to and from appropriate

Child care coverage is limited to children 12 years of age and younger. However, child care can be provided if it is necessary to ensure the safety and well-being of the child.

Child care is **discontinued** if the **Individual Plan** is not followed.

Child care is provided for job-seeking only after other resources (e.g., family and friends) have been exhausted. The individual may be eligible for subsidy under the Child Care Subsidy Program.

The allowance covers the actual cost of child care, less the amount of any subsidy or any money

- Providers can include non-custodial grandparents who do not live in the child's home.
- Parents, step-parents, or other persons who live in the same residence as the child do not

Substantiation

Clients substantiate their **initial** need for child care by providing a receipt or written statement from

- The provider's signature **and**
- The monthly child care fee charged by a licensed or approved program to the parent **or**
- The rate charged by a private babysitter.

Note

The [EMP 14864 Babysitting Statement](#) may be used to substantiate babysitting costs.

The worker enters the information provided in Compass comments.

Clients provide verbal statement of the child's relationship to the child care provider where the parent

Clients document subsequent changes in their childcare needs through their monthly reporting.

- A worker has reason to believe the client is not accurately reporting their child care needs
- The hours a client has worked in a benefit period do not match with the hours claimed for
- **Private Babysitting**
Maximum rates for private babysitting **including babysitting by family members not me**

Rate

Actual babysitting rates will be paid **up to** a maximum of **\$9.00** per hour for the first child

Exceptions

A worker may approve higher rates if there are special circumstances. These could include

- Client works shift-work.
- Multi-needs child (child who needs additional care due to special needs such as autism). Clients should explore other options such as Family Supports for Child with Disabilities available or appropriate, before requesting babysitting expenses.
- Client resides in a high cost of living centre such as Fort McMurray or High Level. Residents
- The client requires and has substantiated the need for 24-hour child care.

Private babysitting rates are established under the authority of the Minister, delegated to F

- **Grandparents**

The babysitting rate for grandparents not residing in the home is **\$179.00** per child per mo

- **Kin-Care and Extended Hours Child Care**

Clients accessing a subsidy for private child care such as the Kin-Care and Extended Hou
Subsidy received up to the specified babysitting rates.

Note

Unlicensed or unapproved family day homes are provided private babysitting rates.

- **Lunch Programs**

Fees for a supervised school lunch program may be paid in lieu of babysitting when a clie
the **Individual Plan**.

- **Licensed and Approved Child Care Programs**

If appropriate, the client must provide verification that they have applied for a subsidy und

Rate

In the case of licensed day cares, out-of-school care, group family child care or preschool
[Registration Fees](#) are provided. The parent portion is the difference between the fee char

Need Codes

1702 Babysitting by Family (including grandparent not in same home)

1703 Babysitting (for all other child care)

1708 Day Care (if the child is attending a child care program, including an out-of-school care pr

1840 Emergency Child care (if the child care is being provided in conjunction with the Emergen

Child Care Deposit and Registration Fee

Last updated on: Feb 03, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 16](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To assist with the costs associated with having children registered in a licensed or approved child care program.

POLICY

A refundable child care deposit and/or a refundable/nonrefundable registration fee is provided to eligible parents.

- It is required by the licensed or approved child care program from all parents, **and**
- Child care is part of the client's service plan with the department, **and**
- There are no other resources available.

The first child care refundable deposit and/or refundable/non-refundable registration fee is not repaid by the client. Children are subject to repayment.

Deposits and registration fees are not issued for private babysitting.

A refunded deposit and/or registration fee is not treated as income.

Substantiation

A written statement from the licensed or approved child care provider stating the amount of the fee.

Rate

Actual cost up to one month's child care fees (this is the unsubsidized amount that the client must repay).

Need Code

1831 Day Care Deposit

1867 Day Care Registration

PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts this benefit to the **Scratch Pad**.

If a deposit and/or registration fee was previously issued, the worker:

1. Has the client sign an [EMP 0976B Repayment Agreement](#). Enters the debt into the Record of Repayment.
2. Issues the benefit.

Refer to [Supplementary Benefits - Child Care Policy](#) for additional information.

Children's School Expenses

Last updated on: Apr 30, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 19](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To assist parents in covering additional costs associated with having children in school.

POLICY

A benefit for fees and costs associated with school attendance may be provided for a child in a school in Alberta, or home schooled.

The worker issues school expenses in accordance with the child's grade.

- When a child is in a lower grade than the age indicates, no repayment is required if the ar
- When a child is in a higher grade than the age indicates, the worker issues the higher am

What it Covers

All school-related expenses such as:

- school fees
- locker fees
- school supplies (pencils, books and paper)
- field trips
- gym shoes
- sports supplies
- all other expenses required by the school for school attendance

Substantiation

- Client's verbal statement.
- Substantiation of school attendance is required for four-year-old dependent children.
- [EMP3428C Declaration of 18- and 19- Year-Old Dependent Child](#) form. This form is co

[Income Support Application](#) form. The **EMP3428C** form may be completed by obtaining worker may:

- verbally review and complete the **EMP428C** form with the client and dependent child
- receive acknowledgement that the client and dependent child consent, understand a
- physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client and depend
- enter a Compass Comment attesting that the **EMP3428C** form was read to the client and the information.

Note

The signed form is then imaged to the client's electronic file.

- Workers may request substantiation such as a letter from the child's school only if there is

Rate

- **\$63.00** per year per child aged 4 or 5 or in kindergarten
- _____
- _____

Need Code

1802 Children's School Expenses

PROCEDURES

LISA runs a program annually before July rollover to automatically add the children's school exp

The children's school expenses allowance for applicants, 4-year-olds, 18- and 19-year-olds, and LISA.

Child Supplement Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10*](#)
[*Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 5*](#)
[*MO 2018-20 Income Support Child Supplement Allowance Rates with Indexing*](#)

INTENT

To ensure each Income Support household unit with children receives up to the threshold amount of the [Child Benefit](#).

BACKGROUND

The Canada Child Benefit (CCB) is a **tax-free** monthly payment to assist families with the cost of raising children. The [Child Supplement Allowance](#) may be included as part of the CCB monthly payment.

Canada Child Benefits are paid over a 12-month period from July of one year to June of the next year.

The Income Support program can provide a Child Supplement Allowance (CSA) benefit to some households. The amount of the CSA benefit is based on the amount the household receives through the federal CCB.

To be eligible for the CCB, a household must file income taxes every year. If household information changes, the Income Support program adjusts the CSA amount if this occurs.

Each June, Income Support sends letters to applicable household units advising that they will receive the CSA benefit for the next 12 months. Further issuance of this benefit requires reassessment.

POLICY

The Child Supplement Allowance is issued during the period between August of one year and July of the next year.

- Who do not qualify for the Canada Child Benefit, or
- Who qualify for a monthly Canada Child Benefit payment, but the Canada Child Benefit payment is less than the threshold amount set by the Income Support program.

Note

Some households with dependent children will not receive the Income Support Child Supplement Allowance if the Canada Child Benefit exceeds the threshold amount set by the Income Support program.

The Income Support threshold amount is described below under **Rate**.

Duration of Eligibility

An Income Support household unit is eligible to receive the Child Supplement Allowance until:

- They qualify for monthly Canada Child benefits up to or beyond the Child Supplement Allowance threshold amount.

- They reach the maximum duration (noted below) for receiving the Child Supplement Allowance
- They no longer qualify for Income Support benefits and their program file closes; or
- They reach the following July benefit period.

Scenario
A household has an overpayment with the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA)
A household has not filed their income tax and benefit return for the previous year
A newborn child is added to the family unit
A child is added to the family unit (e.g., child returns from foster care, etc.)
Persons in a marital separation/relationship breakup must wait 90 days to inform the CRA
Refugee Claimants must meet an 18-month residency requirement
Families whose prior year's income prevents them from receiving the CSA threshold amount per child

Note

In all scenarios listed above, the Child Supplement Allowance is issued without repayment.

Substantiation

The following is required to determine a household unit's eligibility (if any):

- A copy of the applicant's Canada Revenue Agency CCB Notice, verifying the household's
- A print-out from the applicant's personal, on-line account with the Canada Revenue Agency
- Substantiation from the Canada Child Benefit Help Desk via the completed Canada [Child](#)

Common Service Delivery staff, who operate the Canada Child Benefit Help Desk have access to:

- Eligibility for the Canada Child Benefit;
- Why an Income Support household does not qualify for the Canada Child Benefit or why it
- The monthly Canada Child Benefit amount per dependent child that an Income Support household
-

If clarification is required, Help Desk staff can be reached at 780-644-5136.

In

Note

If there is a change in family composition such as an addition of a dependent child to the household

Rate

Actual amount, up to a maximum of **\$238.00** per dependent child per month

Determining the amount of a Child Supplement Allowance

The monthly Child Supplement Allowance amount is the difference between the Income Support threshold amount that the household unit is receiving (per month per dependent child).

For each dependent child:

Child Supplement Allowance = Income Support threshold amount – Canada Child Benefit amount

Need Code

1738 Child Supplement Allowance

PROCEDURES

Career and Employment Consultants and/or Supports and Financial Services Coordinators determine eligibility (if any)

1. Determine the amount of Canada Child Benefit the household is receiving.

If the applicant or recipient does not provide substantiation from the Canada Revenue Agency, contact the Canada Child Benefit Help Desk who can verify Canada Child Benefit eligibility for an individual.

The worker will receive a return email verification and reference number, then within 48 hours the Income Support applicant or recipient is eligible to receive.

Note

Compass Comments should be made for each step of this verification process.

2. Calculate the Child Supplement Allowance amount that the household is eligible to receive. The Child Supplement Allowance threshold amount per dependent child as per policy.
3. Issue the Child Supplement Allowance under Need Code 1738 for the months the household is eligible.

Note

This is a continuous benefit that can be added or adjusted at any time. It is removed from the household when the [maximum duration](#) is reached. If a household is only eligible for the allowance for 1 month, it will be issued accordingly.

4. Record the following in Compass:

- How the Canada Child Benefit amount received by the household was substantiated
- The monthly dollar value for Canada Child Benefits received by the household unit;

- The amount and duration of eligibility for the Child Supplement Allowance.
-

Community Living Start-Up Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 14\(a\)](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

This benefit provides assistance for specific individuals to establish a residence in the community.

POLICY

An allowance to cover the cost of establishing a principal residence in the community may be provided to a person who:

- Has been residing in an institution as a result of a disability or mental illness and is permanently assigned to a place that provides intensive care to severely disabled persons such as the Michener Institute of Mental Health Research and
- Is assigned to the Barriers to Full Employment sub-type.

Persons being released from correctional institutions or facilities are not eligible for this benefit.

This is a once in a lifetime benefit for which there is no minimum period of institutionalization required.

Need for this benefit can be substantiated by the verbal statement of client, the worker's knowledge, or other appropriate evidence.

Use of this benefit must be a last resort and only considered after all other resources have been exhausted. Personal appliances and household items are covered under this benefit.

Individualized Funding Programs like Supported Independent Living are also available through the Community Living Start-Up Allowance.

Rate

Maximum of **\$1,177.00 once** in a lifetime.

Need Code

1835 Community Living Start-Up Allowance

AUTHORITY

CEC or SFSC for persons leaving medical institutions
Supervisor for persons leaving correctional institutions

PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts it to the **Scratch Pad**. The worker will:

1. Review the client's circumstances.

2. Record the reason the benefit was issued in Compass Comments.

Continuous Positive Airway Pressure (CPAP) Device

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 27](#)
[Ministerial Order 2016-21 Delegation of Minister's Authority to Directors/Staff](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

The Income Support program provides coverage for Continuous Positive Airway Pressure (CPAP) devices that are medically essential. The Income Support program does not provide funding for CPAP devices that are not medically essential.

The Income Support program does not provide funding to rent a CPAP device.

POLICY

The Income Support program may provide:

- Up to **\$1,999.00** for a fixed pressure CPAP device, or
- Up to **\$2,351.00** for an auto-pressure CPAP device.

The above prices include a CPAP device with a three year warranty, heated humidifier, hose, and mask.

Replacement CPAP devices may be considered if the warranty has expired and the client confirms the cost of CPAP device rentals or repairs.

Notes

A Level 1 Sleep Study is conducted in a sleep lab or clinic. The client requires a referral from a physician to a sleep lab or clinic or contact the clinics directly.

- Edmonton
Sleep Disorders Lab
Edmonton General Continuing Care Clinic
11111 Jasper Avenue, NW
Edmonton, AB T5K 0L4
780-342-8310
- Calgary
Foothills Medical Centre Sleep Centre
1403 29 Street, NW
Calgary, AB T2N 2T9

403-944-2404

Image: Unknown

- Lethbridge
Lethbridge Sleep Clinic
542 7 Street, S
Lethbridge, AB T1J 2H1
403-388-6034

A Level 3 Sleep Study is a portable sleep study conducted in a person's home. The equipment is provided by a private vendor with instructions on how to use it. The Income Support program does not pay for the equipment.

Clients who must travel to access a Level 1 or Level 3 Sleep Study may be eligible for funding.

First CPAP Device

Clients requesting a CPAP device for the first time must have a confirmed diagnosis of moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea. This is a two-step process where clients must demonstrate their diagnosis before proceeding to a CPAP device.

First CPAP Device – Step 1 Substantiation

The Income Support Worker must not request substantiation documents from Step 2 until the Respiratory Therapist's medical consultant's advice could put the client's life in jeopardy.

For their first CPAP device, the client must provide:

1. **Pulmonary Function Test (PFT)** is needed to check for severe lung disease and must include:

- The PFT must have been completed within the past two years.
- The BMI from a Level 3 Sleep Study is not a substitute for a PFT.

2. Current **medication list** obtained from the pharmacy (no more than six months old), and

3. Full **Level 1** or **Level 3 Sleep Study** including the interpretation by a specialist sleep physician. Studies older than 5 years will not be accepted.

- A Level 3 Sleep Study is not appropriate for everyone. Clients with the following health conditions are not eligible:
 - A **BMI above 38**,
 - A **history of cardiac issues**, or
 - Taking **narcotic, psychoactive** or other **medications that affect sleep**.
- In addition, a Level 1 Sleep Study will be required when the Respiratory/Sleep Medication may be unsafe.

First CPAP Device – Step 2 Substantiation

After reviewing the documents from Step 1, the medical consultant will ask the Income Support until the medical consultant confirms that it is safe to proceed. To do so could put the client's life

Note

A Level 1 Sleep Study is completed in a medically supervised lab and may include a CPA practice. Most safety concerns are related to Level 3 Sleep Studies and trials because the

For their first CPAP device, the client must provide:

a. CPAP trial and a Level 3 Sleep Study, including the interpretation by a specialist

- The CPAP trial must be at least 14 days long.
- The Level 3 Sleep Study is conducted on the last day of the trial while the client is breathing heart rate while the client is being treated with a CPAP device.
- Tests older than 12 months will not be accepted.

b. CPAP trial completed in a sleep lab as part of a Level 1 Sleep Study.

- This test can be arranged by a physician, public sleep clinic or by a private vendor.
- Tests older than 12 months will not be accepted.

1. A doctor's prescription for a fixed pressure or auto-pressure CPAP device.

- The prescription must clearly indicate "fixed" or "auto-pressure" CPAP device, and

2. A **vendor quote detailing the total cost of the CPAP device specified in the prescription.**

- The quote must include a CPAP device with a three year warranty, heated humidifier

Replacement CPAP Device

In most cases, requests for replacement CPAP devices are completed in one step. As the client concerns associated with unsupervised CPAP device use.

For replacement CPAP devices, the client must provide:

1. The results of a recent sleep study (a or b):

a. A CPAP trial and a Level 3 Sleep Study, including the interpretation by a specialist

- The CPAP trial must be at least seven days long.
- The Level 3 Sleep Study must be conducted while the client is being treated w show oxygen saturations and heart rate while the client is being treated with a
- Tests older than 12 months will not be accepted.

b. **CPAP trial** completed in a sleep lab as part of a Level 1 Sleep Study.

- These tests can be arranged by a physician, public sleep clinic or private CPA

2. **Pulmonary Function Test (PFT)** is needed to check for severe lung disease and must inclu

- The PFT must have been completed within the past two years.
- The BMI from a Level 3 Sleep Study is not a substitute for a PFT.

3. Current **medication list** obtained from the pharmacy (no more than six months old),

4. A **doctor's prescription** for a fixed pressure or auto-pressure CPAP device.

- The prescription must clearly indicate “fixed” or “auto-pressure” CPAP device,

5. A **vendor quote** detailing the total cost of the CPAP device specified in the prescription.

- The quote must include a CPAP device with a three year warranty, heated hur

6. Clients who did not receive their first CPAP device from the Income Support or AISH program interpretation by a specialist sleep physician and all graphs, charts, and summaries that made t

- This test would have been conducted just before the client received their first C

- If this information is not available, then a letter from the client's physician indicating

When necessary, the Respiratory/Sleep Medicine Consultant will ask for additional information. Once CPAP therapy continues to be safe and effective.

PROCEDURE

First CPAP Device

1. The Income Support Worker sends [EMP13554 CPAP Device First Request Letter](#) to the client. This letter is only sent if the client has not already provided all of the required substantiating information.
2. The Income Support Worker submits all required documents from Step 1 to [SCSS.CPAP\(](#)

DO/Unit/Caseload
File Number
Client Name
Worker Name
Worker Phone #
New CPAP
Place an X beside all that apply
Level 3 Sleep Study (Home Sleep study) – Diagnosis portion
Level 1 Polysomnogram (PSG) / Overnight in sleep laboratory

Medication List
Vendor Quote

3. The medical consultant reviews the documents from Step 1 and provides an expert medical recommendation. The medical consultant will:
 1. Recommend the Income Support Worker request documents from Step 2,
 2. Request additional or missing information,
 3. Advise that CPAP is unsafe, or
 4. Advise that CPAP is safe and all documents have been provided. This may happen at the same time.
4. Based on the medical consultant's recommendation, the Income Support Worker makes a decision.
5. If the medical consultant advises the Income Support Worker to proceed to Step 2 or request additional documents, the Income Support Worker will:
 1. Contact the client or vendor to request the information by sending the **EMP13554** Client Information Request form. The client is required to provide during Step 2.
 2. Once received, the Income Support Worker sends the requested information to [SCS](#) using the Income Support Worker's contact information.
6. After all Step 1 and Step 2 documents have been reviewed, the medical consultants will provide a recommendation. The medical consultant will review the recommendation and makes a decision.
 1. If the decision is to **deny** the request, the Income Support Worker must contact the client and advise them of the decision and direct them back to their physician.
 2. If the decision is to **approve** the request, the Income Support Worker must notify the client and vendor of the decision.
 1. The Income Support Worker informs the client and vendor that the approved a humidifier, hose, mask with headgear, chin strap (if needed), and 12 filters.
 2. The Income Support Worker issues payment for a CPAP device directly to the client.
 3. The Income Support Worker issues the benefit using LISA need code 1912 Medical Equipment.

Replacement CPAP Device

1. The Income Support Worker sends [EMP13555 CPAP Device Replacement Request Letter](#). The letter is only sent if the client has not already provided all of the required substantiation documents.
2. The Income Support Worker submits all required documents to SCSS.CPAP@gov.ab.ca.

DO/Unit/Caseload
File #
Client Name
Worker Name
Worker Phone #
Replacement CPAP
Previous CPAP provided by Income Support or AISH programs? (Yes or No)
· If No, original Level 1 or Level 3 sleep study or doctor's letter attached
<i>Place an X beside all that apply</i>
Level 3 Sleep Study (Home Sleep study) – Diagnosis portion
Level 1 Polysomnogram (PSG) / Overnight in sleep laboratory
Medication List
Vendor Quote

-
3. The medical consultant reviews the documents and provides an expert medical opinion or consultant will:
 1. Request additional or missing information,
 2. Advise that CPAP is unsafe, or
 3. Advise that CPAP is safe and no further information is required.
 4. Based on the medical consultant's recommendation, the Income Support Worker makes a decision:
 1. If additional information is requested, the Income Support Worker forwards the information to the medical consultant, the client's file number, and Income Support Worker's contact information.
 5. After all necessary documents have been reviewed, the medical consultants will provide a recommendation and makes a decision.
 1. If the decision is to **deny** the request, the Income Support Worker must contact the client and advise them of the decision and refer them back to their physician.
 2. If the decision is to **approve** the request, the Income Support Worker must notify the client and the vendor:
 1. The Income Support Worker informs the client and vendor that the approved a humidifier, hose, mask with headgear, chin strap (if needed), and 12 filters.
 2. The Income Support Worker issues payment for a CPAP device directly to the vendor.
 3. The Income Support Worker issues the benefit using LISA need code 1912 Medical Equipment.
-

Damage Deposit

Last updated on: Dec 03, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 14\(b\)](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide benefits for persons leaving an abusive situation

POLICY

The worker has the authority to issue the actual cost of a damage deposit, up to the maximum (

- A household is establishing a new residence in order to escape an abusive situation, regardless of whether the household is currently receiving a benefit.
- Requires a damage deposit to obtain rental accommodation.

Note

- The client does not have to have just left the abuser to receive the benefit. For example, a client may be eligible for the benefit while they are still securing their own accommodation.
- A damage deposit may be issued as a one-time issue for those who clearly do not qualify for ongoing benefits. The client must first be given to eligibility for ongoing benefits.

Substantiation

Evidence of abuse may include:

- Verbal statement of client or worker's knowledge of client's situation and if in doubt, a written statement from the worker.
- Evidence from a reliable source (e.g. physician, nurse practitioner, police or women's shelter).

The amount of the damage deposit may be substantiated by **one** of the following documents:

- Lease agreement
- Letter from landlord, caretaker, owner, management company

Rate

Actual amount of the damage deposit must not exceed the applicable **Core Shelter Benefits** at the time of the deposit.

Forfeited Damage Deposit

Damage deposits may be recovered regardless of the amount of subsequent damage deposits, the following:

- The damage deposit was not used for the purpose intended.
- The client decided not to move into accommodation.
- The damage deposit was obtained fraudulently.

Refunded Damage Deposit

A refunded damage deposit is **not** treated as income [ISTHB Regulation, Schedule 2, Section 1](#)

PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts this benefit to the **Scratch Pad**.

Need Code

1801 Damage Deposit

Delegated Authority for Issuing Supplementary Income Support

Authority and Intent

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\); Schedule, sections 1\(i\) and 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 1\(2\)\(g\) and 2\(5\); Schedule 4](#)
[Ministerial Order 2016-21 Delegation of Minister's Authority to Directors/Staff](#)
[Ministerial Order 2022-007, Prenatal Needs Payment](#)

INTENT

To describe the delegated authority to issue supplementary income support benefits.

POLICY

The authority to issue supplementary income support benefits has been delegated as follows:

Emergency Supplementary Benefits	Legislation
Emergency Accommodation	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Emergency Child Care	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 16
Emergency Damage Deposit	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Emergency Food	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Emergency Rental Arrears	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Other Emergency Goods and Services	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Emergency Repairs to Principal Residence or to Major Appliance	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Emergency Replacement Clothing	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section

Emergency Transportation	6
Emergency Utility Arrears	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 26
Escaping Abuse Household Start-Up	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 14(b)
Escaping Abuse Damage Deposit	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 14(b)
Escaping Abuse Relocation Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 13(b)
Escaping Abuse Telephone and Transportation	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 20
Escaping Abuse Travel to Family Violence Shelter	ISTHB Regulation Schedule 4, section 6

Supplementary Benefits	Legislation
Employment Training and Transition Supports	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Transportation to Day or Employment Programs	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Children's School Expenses	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Natal and Adoptive Needs Payment	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Child Care Deposit and Registration fee	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Community Living Start-Up Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Relocation Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Utility Connection, Deposit, Reconnection	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Special Transportation and Travel Payment	ISTHB Regulation Scl
Medical Extraordinary Transportation	ISTHB Regulation Scl

Director Approval	ISTHB Regulation Scheme MO No. 2016-21
Funeral Benefits	ISTHB Regulation Scheme

Ongoing Supplementary Benefits	Legislation
Additional Shelter	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Isolated Community Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Child Care	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Child Supplement Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Special Diets	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Medical and Surgical Supplies	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Continuous Positive Airway Pressure (CPAP) Devices	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Handicap Benefit	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Earnings Replacement Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Personal Needs Allowance	ISTHB Regulation Scheme
Prenatal Needs Payment	ISTHB Regulation Scheme

*Minister delegation, not subject to appeal.

Director Approval

Last updated on: Oct 09, 2024

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 1\(2\)\(g\) and Schedule 4, section 1](#)

INTENT

To be able to provide a benefit that is not addressed or fully addressed in the regulation or policy or a member of the household unit.

POLICY

Conditions for Director Approval

- The need is not fully addressed in Regulations **and**
- The need is not fully covered by policy **and**
- The need is considered essential to the health, well-being or the move towards independence
- All non-departmental appeal avenues have been exhausted **and**
- There are no other resources **and**
- The least cost alternative is used.

Note

This section does not apply to the authority of the Executive Director of Alberta Supports Program [Diets](#) (ISTHB Schedule 4, Section 21). To determine whether a benefit is a Health Benefit, or w

These benefits are provided under the authority of the Minister and Appeal Panels have no authority

Information on health related benefits and services can be found at [Tools and Resources – Health and Complementary Health Therapies](#).

Authority

Manager or Regional Director

If the Manager is not available, approval must be received from the Regional Director or another

Rate

Least cost alternative, no upper limits

Substantiation

Workers may ask for substantiation, from a reliable source, outlining:

- Specific need and reason **and**
- Duration of the need.

Need Code

1798 Other Continuous Needs, Director Approval

1898 Other Non-Continuous Needs, Director Approval

PROCEDURES

1. When a client requests a benefit which may be provided under this policy, the worker recommends:
 - Requested Benefit (including how the request conforms to conditions outlined in policy)
 - Rationale for Request (including what other options client has pursued)
 - Amount of Benefit

2. The Director Approval Request is forwarded to the Manager or Regional Director for review.

Note

Offices may require the worker to consult with the Supervisor before the request is forwarded.

The Regional Income Support Specialist may be consulted when required.

3. The Manager or Regional Director reviews the Director Approval Request. Their decision is recorded in the Compass Comments.
-

Earnings Replacement Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 4](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

Provides a supplement to benefit rates for Expected to Work household units who, due to short supplement their income support benefits with employment earnings.

POLICY

The following household unit types receive the earnings replacement allowance:

- [17 Temporarily Unable to Work/Train: Health Problems](#) and
- [18 Temporarily Unable to Work/Train: Family Care Responsibilities](#)

Rate

\$102.00 per household unit per month

Need Code

1731 Earnings Replacement Allowance

PROCEDURE

LISA automatically adds the Earnings Replacement Allowance to the budget of household unit : **Budget** in **Eligibility Determination** or the **PF10** key in **Client Budget**.

Emergency Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, Section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, Section 26](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide assistance to clients in an emergency situation who do not have resources to meet t

POLICY

An emergency allowance may be provided for food, accommodation, replacement clothes, unp: emergency nature may be provided when:

- the situation is beyond the control of the household unit, **and**
- an applicant or a recipient or a member of the household unit is in a situation that present:
- the person cannot wait until the next payment date, access other available resources, or r

In all cases, the worker must review [Compass Comments](#) and LISA Scratch Pad to ensure that

Note

In addition to the emergency benefits listed, clients in an emergency situation may be issu are otherwise eligible for these benefits.

Substantiation

- Verbal statement of the client, **or**
- Workers' knowledge or observation, **or**
- Evidence from a reliable source that the item is essential (e.g., Trailer Park Management home has unsafe wiring, etc.).
- In the case of the Emergency Eviction Benefit, a statement of arrears or notice of eviction
- In the case of the Emergency Damage Deposit, a lease agreement or notice of rental deta
- In the case of unpaid utility bills, a utility bill or statement.

Note

In the case of an essential appliance or home repairs, a written estimate is required.

- Workers may ask for further [substantiation and verification](#) in situations where:

- eligibility cannot be determined without further documentation (e.g., medical need), or
- the worker has reason to believe the client is withholding information or providing incorrect information.

Emergency Allowance Rates

- **Rate for Replacement Clothes**

- **\$253.00** per Adult
- **\$190.00** per Child

Need Code

1842 Emergency Clothing

- **Rate for Food**

1. When the members(s) of the household unit are required to travel outside the community:
 - **\$15.00** per day per adult
 - **\$10.00** per day per child

Need Code

1850 Emergency Food Travel (e.g., outside the home community)

2. Where the member(s) of the household unit are **within** the community they reside:
 - **\$29.00** per month per adult
 - **\$19.00** per month per child

Need Code

1841 Emergency Food-Non-Travel (e.g., in home community)

3. If this amount is not sufficient, the food rate portion of the [Core Essential](#) may be used.

- **Rate for Accommodation**

Actual cost of reasonable hotel, motel or other accommodation as approved by the worker, less any Core Shelter allowance issued within the same benefit period.

Authority

Worker – up to one month (two weeks at a time)

Supervisor – any additional time

Need Code

1843 Emergency Shelter

- **Repairs to Major Appliance**

Actual cost of **essential** repairs to the home or major appliances owned by the applicant or recipient

Need Code

1845 Emergency Repairs to household appliances

- **Repairs to Home**

Actual cost of **essential** repairs to the home owned by the applicant or recipient **subject to**

Need Code

1846 Emergency Home Repairs

- **Rate for Damage Deposit**

The actual cost of the damage deposit to establish a residence to prevent homelessness,

- **\$1,177.00** for families with children, or
 - **\$414.00** for singles and childless couples
- Households would only be able to access this benefit **once in a three-year period.**

Note

For singles and childless couples, up to the maximum amount for families with children in the household (by birth or adoption or when a child is returning to the household after being removed) is issued when the child is within three months of becoming a member of the household.

Need Code

1851 Emergency Damage Deposit

- **Rate for Eviction Due to Outstanding Rental Arrears**

The actual cost of outstanding rental arrears to prevent homelessness, up to:

- **Same as rate above for Damage Deposit** for families with children, or
- **Same as rate above for Damage Deposit** for singles and childless couples

Applicants or recipients residing with a family member are not eligible for this benefit.
The first arrears payment is **not** recovered, but subsequent arrears payments are **subject to**

Need Code

1852 Emergency Eviction

- **Rate for Unpaid Utility Bills**

The actual cost of utility arrears required to access services or to prevent a disconnection
[Information.](#)

Note

To meet emergency eligibility criteria for Utility Arrears the worker should ensure options to determine if there are Regulated Retailers in the requested area, the worker may use the option that has not been considered the worker should advise the applicant/client to contact the utility company.

The first arrears payment for each utility is **not** recovered but subsequent arrears payments are. When [utility connection, reconnection, or deposit](#) fees are issued along with an emergency benefit code.

Need Code

1807 Utility Arrears

1817 Utility Connection

1820 Utility Deposit

1829 Utility Reconnection

It is important that all utility payments are updated in LISA Scratch Pad as well as in [Compass](#). The worker must update the name of the utility company and the type of utility payment. For example, if the utility is for electricity, the type of utility payment should be "Electricity".

- **Other Emergency Goods and Services**

Actual cost up to a maximum of **\$1,177.00** for other emergency benefits in addition to utility arrears.

A person is eligible for this allowance **only once** for each set of circumstances. Each set of circumstances is defined by the type of emergency benefit issued.

The client may be required to repay, under ISHTB Regulation, Section 99, any amount issued for this allowance.

Authority

Manager

Need Code

1847 Other Emergency Issue

PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts benefits that have restrictions by amount or frequency of issuance to the Scratch Pad.

After the payment is generated, workers must record in the Scratch Pad description field the type of emergency benefit issued.

The following emergency benefits may be subject to repayment:

1845 - Emergency Repairs to Household Appliances

1846 - Emergency Home Repairs

1852 - Emergency Eviction

1807 - Utility Arrears

1820 - Utility Deposit

1829 - Utility Reconnection

1847 - Other Emergency Issue

When issuing an emergency benefit, the worker records the following in Compass Comments:

1. the type of benefit issued. If it is a utility related benefit, which utility (e.g., electricity, natural gas, water, etc.)
2. the amount of the benefit issued.

3. the date the benefit is issued.
 4. the conditions that support the issuing of the benefit.
 5. the substantiation or verification provided by the client and
 6. if subject to repayment, enter the date the [EMP0976B - Repayment Agreement](#) was signed
-

Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs

Last updated on: Sep 06, 2024

INTENT

To provide a process for one-time issuance of emergency prescription(s)/drugs that will address:

POLICY

Applications for prescription drugs can be made using the [EMP 3428 Income Support Application](#)

Although both the **EMP 3428 Income Support Application** and the **EMP 3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** detail:

Requests for emergency prescription drugs may be sent after-hours to the Income Support Cor work hours, requests can be made by phone or walk-in at an Alberta Supports Centre.

Documents pertaining to the issuance of emergency drugs should be filed in accordance with R

PROCESS

1. When the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** is faxed from the:
 1. Seniors, Community and Social Services staff reviews the form to ensure required information and other needs such as ongoing Health Benefits, Income Support, Child Support Services, etc.
 2. If there are other needs, the applicant is referred to an Alberta Supports Centre. In the meantime, the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** may be authorized.
 3. If the applicant is unable to sign [or attest to](#) the **EMP 3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs**, a reason must be provided to the referring agency. If the Seniors Community and Social Services staff determine that the applicant is unable to sign, the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** may be authorized.
2. When an applicant presents emergency prescription(s)/drug needs at an Alberta Supports Centre:
 1. Seniors, Community and Social Services staff interviews the applicant to ensure the applicant understands the process, the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs**, etc.
 2. If the application is made over the phone and there are other needs, the applicant is referred to an Alberta Supports Centre. In the meantime, the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** may be authorized.
 3. Depending on the assessed needs, the applicant will complete either the **EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription(s)/Drugs** for ongoing benefits.
 4. Seniors, Community and Social Services staff will either ensure the applicant reads and understands the declaration and consent to the application and ensure the applicant understands the urgency of the matter.
3. If applicable, the applicant completes the spouse/partner section of the application and signs the application.
4. Third parties cannot apply on the client's behalf but can assist with the client's application.

Note

If the person returns a subsequent time, they should be referred for a more in-depth assessment; they should be assessed for ongoing benefits under the [Alberta Adult Health Benefit - Initial Assessment](#).

If the applicant has children and is low-income but does not qualify for ongoing AAHB or Initial Assessment (ACHB).

PROCEDURES

When it is determined the need is for an emergency prescription(s)/drugs, and the applicant is not an immigrant in a non-eligible group), the worker:

1. advises the applicant that if the prescription drug is listed on the [Interactive Drug Benefit List](#), the applicant can request a review by the [Health Benefits Exception Committee \(HBEC\)](#). In e
2. advises the applicant that Seniors, Community and Social Services will contact the pharmacist with the individual's personal information so their identity can be verified by the pharmacist and the
3. verifies or creates a PID and file number in CCD,
4. requests the electronic file by using **Function 20 Request for File Download** or **Function 21 Request for File Upload**

Note

The stage at which the electronic file is created may depend on each worksite.

1. certain information, such as the client's address, Employment Insurance (EI) status, and highest level of completed education, is **not** required in the determination of eligibility for emergency prescription drugs.
 1. When the applicant's address information is not known, the worker may enter "no" in the address field.
 2. When the application's EI status is not known, the worker may enter "no" in the EI status field.
 3. When the applicant's highest level of completed education is not known, the worker may enter "no" in the education field.
 5. obtains a drug authorization number – **EMP1976 Drug Authorization**,
 6. contacts the pharmacy to authorize the issuance of the prescription/drug and advises them of the client's drug list, the Alberta Adult Health Benefit List, or drugs approved by the HBEC,
 7. faxes a copy of the **EMP1976 Drug Authorization** to the pharmacy.
 8. Ensures the client(s) information is entered in LISA within one working day. This ensures the client is not rejected,
 9. ensures a copy of the **EMP 1976 Drug Authorization** and the **EMP 3854 Application for Initial Assessment** is sent to the pharmacy.
 10. Enters [Comments](#) in Compass.
-

Employment Training and Transition Supports

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 15](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

A benefit available to clients to assist with employment and training opportunities.

POLICY

This benefit is provided to cover expenses associated with seeking, accepting and/or maintaining a program, to participate in a training program, or to participate in an academic upgrading program, including applications, deposits, testing fees before the start of classes, tools, phone and service fees, for a recipient who:

- Is actively seeking employment according to their **Individual Plan**, or
- Is working or starting confirmed employment (including at a sheltered workshop), or
- Is starting or participating in an employment preparation program (including employment counseling), or
- Is starting or participating in a training or academic upgrading program in accordance with

Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) clients attending a day or employment program who require [Program](#) policy.

Substantiation

The worker's knowledge of the client's situation, and if the need is identified as part of the client's

If in doubt, additional documentation may be requested, such as:

- A written job confirmation (or documented contact) from the client's employer or training program
- Invoices or written estimates for specific needs or costs.

Rate

Up to **\$590.00** for each adult in the household per calendar year (January 1 to December 31)

Need Code

1827 Employment Training and Transition Supports – Head of Household

1857 Employment Training and Transition Supports – Partner

PROCEDURE

LISA automatically posts any portion of this benefit issued to the **Scratch Pad**.

Escaping Abuse Benefit (Household Start-Up)

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 14\(b\)](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

Seniors, Community and Social Services provides supports to ensure the ongoing safety of victim household in the community and remain independent from their abuser.

POLICY

An allowance to cover the cost of establishing a residence in the community is provided to an individual who is living:

- With their spouse or partner,
- With someone other than their spouse or partner (e.g., roommate), **or**
- Alone.

The client does not have to have recently left the abuser to receive this benefit, as long as the residence is free of abuse.

If a client has been issued this benefit once, and requests it again, the worker should have a discussion with the client.

Note

The Escaping Abuse Benefit may be issued as a one-time issue. When determining a [One-time](#)

The Escaping Abuse Benefit is one of a number of benefits available for Albertan's fleeing abuse.

Rate

\$1,177.00

Substantiation

Clients substantiate their need for this benefit by:

- Verbal statement of the client or worker's knowledge of the abuse **and only if in doubt**
- Evidence from another professional source (e.g. physician, nurse practitioner, police, worker)

Certificate Confirming Grounds to Terminate Tenancy

This certificate will allow the client to break their lease without financial penalty. The worker must ensure the client understands the process.

To obtain a Certificate Confirming Grounds to Terminate Tenancy the client will need a court order. Alternatively, they can obtain a statement from a person in a professional capacity such as outlined in the *Residential Tenancies Act*.

For more information on how to obtain this certificate, any Albertan can be referred to www.safealberta.ca toll free at 310-0000 followed by the number.

PROCEDURE

LISA automatically posts this benefit to the **Scratch Pad**.

The worker reviews the client's circumstances and records the reasons the benefit was issued in

Need Code

1849 Escaping Abuse Benefit

Funeral Benefits

Funeral Benefits for Income Support Households

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\) and the Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 25](#)
[General Regulation \(*Funeral Services Act*\), section 36\(2\)](#)
[Cemeteries Act, section 12](#)
[General Regulation \(*Cemeteries Act*\), sections 12 and 13](#)
[Fatality Inquiries Regulation, Schedule, section 3\(1\)](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-027 - Funeral Benefits](#)

INTENT

To describe what funeral benefits may be provided to eligible household units, the eligibility criteria

POLICY

In order to receive a funeral benefit, the eligibility criteria outlined in the [Supplementary Benefits](#)

Funeral benefits are available for eligible deceased members of an Income Support household

Funeral benefits may be provided for burial or cremation and a funeral in Alberta, including:

- Funeral expenses for burial or cremation;
- A funeral ceremony;
- Embalming, when necessary;
- An additional transportation rate when transportation is required outside the funeral service area;
- A cemetery plot or other resting place.

Or, funeral benefits may be provided for expenses related to transporting the deceased individual

Other Low Income Albertans

For a deceased individual who was a low income Albertan, but not actively receiving Income Support

- [Funeral Benefits for Low Income Albertans](#)

Funeral Benefit Categories

Funeral Expenses for Burial or Cremation

The following are examples of potential funeral expenses for burial or cremation in Alberta, but

- Removal of the deceased individual from the place of death;
- Completion of documents for cremation or burial;
- Providing shelter for the deceased individual until disposition;
- Basic preparation of the deceased individual for identification;
- Professional services;
- Cremation fees;
- A casket and/or an urn;
- Transportation within the funeral service provider's municipality;
- Administrative costs; and
- Alberta Funeral Services Regulatory Board fee

Note: If the expenses for burial or cremation are below the maximum amount provided, of additional funds for a ceremony, a headstone).

Funeral Ceremony

Funds may be provided for families and loved ones of the deceased individual to host a basic, c

The following are examples of potential ceremony expenses, but it is not a complete list:

- Facility rental (e.g., community hall, religious facility, funeral home chapel, cemetery or cre
- Honorarium for a religious, cultural or spiritual leader;
- Printing an order of service;
- Funeral staff;
- Equipment;
- Refreshments;
- Flowers;
- Preparation of public notices; and
- Vehicle to transport the deceased individual to a ceremony or graveside.

Note: The funds provided for a ceremony can only be used for ceremony expenses. If the funds cannot be used for other funeral expenses (e.g., a more expensive casket).

Embalming

Funds may be provided for embalming when deemed necessary by an embalmer who is licensed.

Note: The funds provided for embalming can only be used for embalming expenses. If the funds cannot be used for other funeral expenses (e.g., additional funds for a ceremony, a headstone).

Additional Transportation within Alberta

Funds may be provided, per trip, for transportation and attendant services:

- After 20 kilometres, when travelling outside of the funeral service provider's municipality, a fee of \$1.00 per kilometre.
- When it is required to transport a deceased individual to a funeral service provider, a ceremony fee of \$100.00.

This rate is based on the additional kilometer section of the [Fatality Inquiries Regulation, section 10](#).

Cemetery Fees

Funds may be provided for the following cemetery expenses:

- A single cemetery plot;
- Cemetery perpetual fees;
- A grave liner, when required by a cemetery;

Note: grave liners may be provided by a funeral service provider or a cemetery. This cost is not included in the fee schedule.

- Grave opening and closing fees; and
- Winter fees, if applicable.

Note: In accordance with the [Cemeteries Act, section 12](#), cemetery burial plots are paid a maximum rate of \$1,000.00. Alternatively, funds up to a maximum rate, may be provided to place the deceased individual in a mausoleum crypt.

Transportation of the Deceased Individual to another Province or Territory, within Canada, for Entombment

Transportation expenses may include, but are not limited to:

- Preparing the deceased individual prior to shipping;

- Hermetically sealed casket or other approved container; and
- Transportation by road and/or by airfreight to another province/territory for burial or crema

Definitions for the Relationships to the Deceased Individual

Depending on the relationship to the deceased, an individual may be expected to contribute financially to another province.

Responsible Survivor

A responsible survivor is expected to financially contribute toward the cost of funeral services.

A responsible survivor is defined as:

- the spouse or other cohabiting partner of the deceased individual (providing that the deceased
 - a cohabiting partner includes persons in a legal marriage, common-law relationship or more information.
- the legal parents of a deceased child who was living with and dependent for support from program under the [Education Act](#); or
- the legal sponsor of a sponsored immigrant.

The financial resources of a responsible survivor would have been considered during the eligibility determination.

Non-Responsible Survivor

A non-responsible survivor is not required to contribute financially toward funeral expenses.

A non-responsible survivor is any family member, friend, or organization, who is not considered an individual.

Depending on who is available to make the arrangements for the deceased individual, the applicable

Eligibility

Additional resources may become available to the estate or a responsible survivor upon the death of

Canada Pension Plan – Death Benefit

The Canada Pension Plan (CPP) death benefit is a one-time payment from the federal government to a contributor.

The CPP death benefit is considered non-exempt income by the Income Support program.

To be eligible to receive funeral benefits, the applicant for funeral benefits must agree to assign

If the CPP death benefit is assigned to ALSS and the value of the funeral benefit issued was less than the funeral payment provided, you may request the difference by completing an application through [Employment and Social Development Canada](#).

If the applicant applied for the CPP death benefit prior to submitting the application for funeral benefit payment provided.

If, after the funeral payment was reduced by the CPP death benefit, the applicant is informed that the funeral payment was not substantiated to the Health and Funeral Benefits Unit (HFBU) and the remaining value of the funeral benefit is less than the funeral payment provided.

Other Available Programs

Income Support does not provide funeral benefits if burial or cremation and funeral expenses are not covered by other programs, but are not limited to:

- Workers Compensation Board benefits, if the deceased individual died due to a work-related injury or illness;
- Victims of Crime Assistance Program, if the deceased individual is eligible under the [Victims of Crime Act](#);
- Motor vehicle accident victim benefits for funeral expenses, if the deceased individual is eligible under the [Motor Vehicle Accident Insurance Act](#);
- The [Last Post Fund](#), if the deceased individual was a Canadian Forces veteran;
- A First Nation band that has a program or policy to pay for the burial or cremation and funeral expenses;
- Any other program where the deceased individual meets program eligibility criteria to receive benefits.

Income Supports also does not provide funeral benefits in the following circumstances:

- If there is a prepaid funeral where arrangements have been made and paid for prior to the death;
- If there is a life insurance policy, or policies, where the value of the benefit is equal to or greater than the funeral expenses:
 - If the beneficiary of the life insurance policy is someone other than the estate of the deceased individual.

Note: Contributions to the funeral provided by non-responsible survivors including family members, friends, religious groups, and crowd sourcing accounts, are not considered when determining eligibility for funeral benefits.

Client Passes Away Outside of Alberta

If a member of a household unit was temporarily outside of Alberta (e.g., on a job search or visiting family), funeral benefits may be payable if the following criteria are met.

If the deceased individual will be interred or permanently laid to rest in Alberta, the funeral benefits may be payable.

If the deceased individual will be buried in a Canadian province or territory other than Alberta, a funeral benefit may be payable if the place of death is in another province or territory other than Alberta.

Application Process for Funeral Benefits

The applicant should be the person who is responsible for making arrangements based on their [Regulation to the Funeral Services Act](#). This list is in order of priority, with the highest listed person being responsible for making arrangements. If the highest listed person is not available, or is unwilling to make arrangements, the right passes to the next person on the list.

An applicant may or may not be a responsible survivor, depending on the relationship to the deceased individual.

All funeral benefits applications are processed by the HFBU. The application for funeral benefits is available on the website.

The application guide linked on the website provides guidance to the family and friends of the deceased individual.

The available individual or organization who is making arrangements, in accordance with section 2(1) of the Funeral Services Act, is responsible for submitting the application for funeral benefits.

Preapproval of funeral benefits, where the applicant is informed of the deceased individual meeting the criteria for funeral benefits and the individual making the arrangements on behalf of the deceased individual is fully aware of whether or not they are eligible for funeral benefits.

In order to receive preapproval, the applicant should submit the application, along with the Official Funeral Home Invoice, so that staff can determine if the eligibility criteria have been met and notify the applicant of the results.

Note: If approved, an email with a letter will be sent to the applicant indicating the type of deduction will occur if the CPP death benefit has already been applied for.

Reimbursement Requests

Reimbursements will be considered if the invoice was paid in full, for up to 6 months after the expense was incurred, and there was an emergency situation. Emergencies are considered on a case-by-case basis based on the circumstances.

The invoice is considered paid if it was paid in full or if an amount equal to or exceeding the total amount of the invoice has been received.

Consent to Disclose Personal Information

The application form includes a consent section to allow the applicant to name people and organizations that may be contacted regarding the status of the funeral benefits application, via a telephone inquiry.

The consent is valid for the period of time that the funeral benefits application is being processed. The consent can be revoked, at any time, in writing.

Directing Payment

Typically, benefits will be issued directly to the service provider(s) as a third party payment.

If the applicant is the spouse/partner of the deceased individual or the parent of a deceased dependent child, and the deceased individual was in a dependent position, the applicant will be responsible for arranging payment to service providers.

Cemetery fees are generally paid directly to the cemetery as the entity providing the service and does not have the ability to collect these fees and relies on the funeral service provider to collect payment.

RATE

When the deceased individual is being buried or cremated in Alberta, the rates for funeral goods and services are set by the government.

- For funeral expenses for burial or cremation, the actual cost up to \$4,601;
- For a funeral ceremony, the actual cost up to \$1,041;
- For embalming, the actual cost up to \$781;
- For additional transportation and attendant services, the actual cost up to \$1.13 per kilometre if the funeral service provider is located;
- When an exception request is approved for safe sheltering (storage) after 10 days, the actual cost up to \$1,041;
- Actual cemetery costs for:
 - A single cemetery plot, plus cemetery perpetual fees, a grave liner, when required by the cemetery;
 - For an alternate resting place, including a single columbarium niche or mausoleum crypt.

Note: In accordance with the [Cemeteries Act, section 12](#), cemetery burial plots are paid at the actual cost. When the deceased individual is being transported outside of Alberta to another province or territory, the actual cost of transportation is included.

- Actual cost of preparing the deceased individual for transport prior to shipping, including embalming or other preservation methods;
- Actual reasonable cost of transportation by road and/or by airfreight. Least cost alternative mode of transport.

Exception Requests

[Ministerial Order 2023-027](#) outlines the maximum rates that have been set by the Minister for funeral expenses. In exceptional and necessary circumstances where the maximum benefit rates are insufficient, an exception request may be made for substantiation.

The applicant must complete the [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form. For more information, contact the appropriate delegated authority. Examples of exceptions may include:

- Additional costs due to health and/or safety reasons such as bioseals;
- Safe sheltering (storage) of a deceased individual for more than 10 days. An exception for safe sheltering (storage) of a deceased individual; or
- Alternate resting places above the rate limit.

The following criteria are considered for these requests:

- The burial or cremation and funeral expenses cannot be met by the maximum rate due to

- The expenses are considered necessary and essential for cremation or burial and funeral
- There are no other means to pay; and
- The least cost alternative is considered.

A decision for a benefit in excess of the rates is not appealable.

DELEGATED AUTHORITY

HFB Assessor – eligibility for a funeral benefit, including reimbursement for expenses not authorized by the HFB Director or Manager, Common Service Delivery (CSD) – for funeral expenses exceeding the maximum rates.

SUBSTANTIATION

Required documentation

- Proof of identification of the applicant
- Official Death Certificate or Funeral Director's Statement of Death.
- Quotes or unpaid invoices for:
 - Funeral and burial or cremation expenses, including a breakdown of the funds for a funeral home.
 - Quotes or unpaid invoices for transportation expenses to another province or territory.

Documentation depending on situation

- Completed "[Request for Estimate – CPP Death Benefit](#)" form, unless the CPP Death Benefit is being requested.
- Proof of denial from a program if the deceased individual may have been eligible for funding from that program.
- Documents showing the deceased had a prepaid funeral.
- The value of a life insurance policy for the deceased individual if the estate or a responsible person is requesting a benefit in excess of the maximum rates.
- 30-day bank statement for the Responsible Survivor(s) as proof of the source of income, if requested.

Required documentation if requesting an exceptional amount

- A completed [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form.
- Finalized quotes/invoices and other relevant documents showing all the funeral costs, as well as the source of funds to pay for the funeral.

PROCEDURE

Income Support Worker:

1. When advised of the death of a client, spouse/partner or dependent child, reviews the [De](#)
2. If a next of kin making funeral arrangements has not yet applied for funeral benefits, provi
ALSS [website](#).
3. When necessary, assists the applicant by answering questions about the application proc

HFB Assessor:

Eligibility Review

1. Notifies the Income Support office that an Income Support client, spouse/partner or deper
2. Reviews the application and substantiation documents to determine if the applicant is elig
 1. Has the applicant's identity been verified?
 2. Is the applicant the most appropriate person to be making funeral arrangements?
 3. Has the Official Death Certificate or Funeral Director's Statement of Death been pro
 4. Are there other programs available to cover the cost of the funeral?
 5. Did the deceased individual have a prepaid funeral?
 6. Did the deceased individual have life insurance policies where the value of the bene
 7. Does the application form have a valid signature?
Note: a handwritten signature is required.
3. If the request is for a reimbursement for burial or cremation and funeral or transportation e
 1. Ensures that the service occurred within the past six months, and
 2. Reviews the paid invoice(s) and the emergency circumstances, as provided by the a
4. Reviews the final quotes or unpaid invoices.
 1. Confirms that the applicant is the person named on the invoice. This ensures the ap
 2. Reviews the invoice for each funeral benefit category to ensure the items are appro
 1. Funeral expenses for burial or cremation;

2. Funeral ceremony;
 3. Embalming;
 4. Additional transportation within Alberta:
 5. Validates, per trip, the transportation was necessary, the rate requested is at c charged);
 6. Cemetery or alternate resting places fees; or
 7. Transportation to another province or territory within Canada
3. If the invoice is for an amount in excess of the maximum rates and the applicant sub the CSD Director or Manager for consideration.
5. If a decision cannot be made due to missing information:
 1. Records the missing information in Comments;
 2. Sends an Information Missing Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant det;
 3. Provides a due date of seven days for the missing information to be submitted.
 6. Once additional information is provided, return to Step 2.
 7. If additional information is not provided within the timeline provided, proceed to Step 9 to c
 8. Determines if the applicant is eligible for a funeral benefit:
 1. If the applicant is eligible for the full funeral benefit amount without a partial payment:
 1. Records the following in Comments:
 - The type of benefit approved;
 - The conditions that support issuing the benefit;
 - The substantiation or verification provided;
 - The amount of the benefit issued;
 - How the payments were directed if there is more than one service provid
 - The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for.
 2. Sends the Approval Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant who is r
 3. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and cemetery (if applicable).

2. If the applicant is eligible for a funeral benefit with a partial payment due to the deduction:
 1. Contacts the applicant to explain the deduction amount and the reason for the deduction.
 2. Confirms how the partial payment should be directed, if more than one service provider is involved.
 3. Records the following in Comments:
 - The type of benefit approved;
 - The amount of the deduction based on the Canada Pension Plan death benefit;
 - The conditions that support issuing the benefit;
 - The substantiation or verification provided;
 - The amount of the benefit issued;
 - How the payments were directed if there is more than one service provider;
 - The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for.
 4. Sends the Approval Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant who is responsible for the funeral.
 5. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and cemetery (if applicable).
Note: if the applicant is the spouse/partner or parent of the deceased individual.
Note: if a reimbursement request is approved, the applicant may receive the payment by cheque.

9. If not eligible for the funeral benefit:
 1. Records the decision in Comments, including the reason(s) for the denial.
 2. Sends out a Denial Letter, by email and then by mail, to advise the applicant of the decision, the reasons for the denial, and information on how to appeal the decision.

Note: if a cheque was issued to the applicant and the applicant advises they have not received the cheque, refer to the Unclaimed Printed Cheques policy.

Exception Requests

1. If the applicant has completed the [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form, the request will be considered for an exceptional amount.
2. If approved for an exceptional amount:
 1. Records the following in Comments:
 1. The amount of the benefit issued;

2. The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for; and
3. The rationale provided by the decision maker. Does the application form

2. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and the cemetery (if applicat

3. If not approved for an exceptions amount:
 1. Records the rationale in comments

Note: if a reimbursement request is approved, the applicant may receive the payment dire

CSD Director or Manager:

1. When requested by the applicant, reviews requests for exceptions above the funeral bene
2. Communicates their decision to the HFBU Assessor:
 1. If approved, the CSD Director or Manager sends an approval letter to the applicant,
 1. Advising them of the decision;
 2. Providing confirmation of the amount of additional funds approved;
 3. Advising them of the right to provide additional information if they do not agree
 4. Explaining the decision is exempt from appeal to an Appeal Panel.
 2. If not approved, the CSD Director or Manager notifies the Assessor of the decision a
 1. Advising them of the decision;
 2. Providing the reason(s) for the denial of the additional funds requested;
 3. Advising them of the right to provide additional information if they do not agree
 4. Explaining that the decision is exempt from appeal to an Appeal Panel.

Central Payment and Data Entry (CPDE) Administrative Clerk:

1. Generate payment based on the Need Codes provided by the HFB Assessor
 1. 1970 – Funerals – Basic Service

2. 1971 – Funerals – Transportation
 3. 1975 – Funerals – Cemetery Plots
 4. 1976 – Funerals – Cremation
-

Funeral Benefits for Low Income Albertans

Funeral Benefits for Low Income Albertans General

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\) and the Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 25](#)
[General Regulation \(Funeral Services Act\), sections 20 and 36\(2\)](#)
[Cemeteries Act, section 12](#)
[General Regulation \(Cemeteries Act\), sections 12 and 13](#)
[Fatality Inquiries Regulation, Schedule, section 3\(1\)](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-027 - Funeral Benefits](#)

INTENT

To describe what funeral benefits may be provided to eligible low-income Albertans, the eligibility decisions.

This policy is intended for deceased individuals who were not a member of an Income Support

POLICY

Funeral benefits are available on behalf of deceased low-income Albertans who meet the criteria

Funeral benefits may be provided for burial or cremation and a funeral in Alberta, including:

- Funeral expenses for burial or cremation;
- A funeral ceremony;
- Embalming, when necessary;
- An additional transportation rate when transportation is required outside the funeral service area;
- A cemetery plot or other resting place.

Or, funeral benefits may be provided for expenses related to transporting the deceased individual

Funeral Benefit Categories

Funeral Expenses for Burial or Cremation

The following are examples of potential funeral expenses for burial or cremation in Alberta, but

- Removal of the deceased individual from the place of death;
- Completion of documents for cremation or burial;
- Providing shelter for the deceased individual until disposition;

- Basic preparation of the deceased individual for identification;
 - Professional services;
 - Cremation fees;
 - A casket and/or an urn;
 - Transportation within the funeral service provider's municipality;
 - Administrative costs; and
 - Alberta Funeral Services Regulatory Board fee.
-

Funeral Ceremony

Funds may be provided for families and loved ones of the deceased individual to host a basic, c

The following are examples of ceremony expenses, but it is not a complete list:

- Facility rental (e.g., community hall, religious facility, funeral home chapel, cemetery or cre
- Honorarium for a religious, cultural or spiritual leader;
- Printing an order of service;
- Funeral staff;
- Equipment;
- Refreshments;
- Flowers;
- Preparation of public notices; and
- Vehicle to transport the deceased individual to a ceremony or graveside.

Note: The funds provided for a ceremony can only be used for ceremony expenses. If the cannot be used for other funeral expenses (e.g., a more expensive casket).

Embalming

Funds may be provided for embalming when deemed necessary by an embalmer who is licenc

Additional Transportation within Alberta

Funds may be provided, per trip, for transportation and attendant services:

- After 20 kilometers, when travelling outside of the funeral service provider's municipality, a
- When it is required to transport a deceased individual to a funeral service provider, a cere

This rate is based on the additional kilometer section of the [Fatality Inquiries Regulation, section](#)
Cemetery Fees

Funds may be provided for the following cemetery expenses:

- A single cemetery plot;
- Cemetery perpetual fees;
- A grave liner, when required by a cemetery;

Note: grave liners may be provided by a funeral service provider or a cemetery. This cost

- Grave opening and closing fees; and
- Winter fees, if applicable.

Note: In accordance with the [Cemeteries Act, section 12](#), cemetery burial plots are paid a

Alternatively, funds up to a maximum rate, may be provided to place the deceased individual in mausoleum crypt.

Transportation of the Deceased Individual to another Province or Territory, within Canada, for E

Transportation expenses may include, but are not limited to:

- Preparing the deceased individual for transport, prior to shipping;
- Hermetically sealed casket or other approved container; and
- Transportation by road and/or by airfreight to another province/territory for burial or crema

Definitions for the Relationships to the Deceased Individual

Depending on the relationship to the deceased, an individual may be expected to contribute financially to another province or territory.

Responsible Survivor

A responsible survivor is expected to financially contribute toward the cost of funeral services.

A responsible survivor is defined as:

- The spouse or other cohabiting partner of the deceased individual (providing that the decea

- A cohabiting partner includes persons in a legal marriage, common-law relationship more information.
- The legal parents of a deceased child who was living with and dependent for support from program under the [Education Act](#); or
- The legal sponsor of a sponsored immigrant.

There may be more than one responsible survivor, depending on the deceased individual's situation.

Non-Responsible Survivor

A non-responsible survivor is not required to contribute financially toward funeral expenses.

A non-responsible survivor is any family member, friend, or organization, who is not considered a responsible survivor of a deceased individual.

Depending on who is available to make the arrangements for the deceased individual, the applicable rules may vary.

ELIGIBILITY

To be eligible for funeral benefits, both general and financial eligibility criteria must be met.

General eligibility criteria are related to the deceased individual's residency and status in Canada.

Financial eligibility criteria are related to potential programs that cover funeral expenses, and the individual's income.

General Eligibility

To be eligible for funeral benefits, the deceased individual must be a resident of Alberta and have been a resident of Alberta for at least 183 days in the 12 months before death.

- Canadian citizen,
- Permanent resident,
- Temporary resident permit holder who has been approved for entry into Canada by the Government of Canada,
- Refugee or refugee claimant not receiving financial assistance from the Government of Canada,
- A victim of human trafficking as determined by the Department of Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada.

Albertan Passes Away Outside of Alberta

If the deceased individual was a resident of Alberta and was temporarily outside of Alberta (less than 183 days) at the time of death, the individual is still eligible for funeral benefits if the eligibility criteria are met.

If the deceased individual will be interred or permanently laid to rest in Alberta, the funeral benefits are payable.

If the deceased individual will be buried or cremated in a Canadian province or territory other than Alberta, the body must be transported from the place of death to another province or territory other than Alberta.

Financial Eligibility

To be eligible for funeral benefits, there must be no other program that provides for a similar benefit to the survivor, must also meet the applicable eligibility criteria.

Note: If the deceased individual is a sponsored immigrant, the income and assets of the sponsor must be reported. The sponsor must complete the process outlined in the [Immigration Status – Family Class \(Sponsored\)](#) policy.

If the sponsor has abandoned the deceased individual, their income and assets are not used to determine eligibility. The sponsor must report the situation to the federal government.

Income and assets are considered when determining eligibility for funeral benefits.

Note: If there are multiple responsible survivors, the exemptions detailed below apply for each survivor.

Note: If the responsible survivor is the spouse/partner of the deceased individual, the common-law spouse/partner is also considered a responsible survivor.

Other Available Programs or Sources

Income Support does not provide funeral benefits if burial or cremation and funeral expenses are covered by another program, but are not limited to:

- Workers Compensation Board benefits, if the deceased individual died due to a work-related injury or illness;
- Victims of Crime Assistance Program, if the deceased individual is eligible under the [Victims of Crime Assistance Program](#);
- Motor vehicle accident victim benefits for funeral expenses, if the deceased individual is eligible under the [Motor Vehicle Accident Victim Benefits](#);
- The [Last Post Fund](#), if the deceased individual was a Canadian Forces veteran;
- A First Nation Band that has a program to pay for the burial or cremation and funeral expenses;
- Any other program where the deceased individual meets program eligibility criteria to receive benefits.

Income Support also does not provide a funeral benefit when there is a prepaid funeral where a contract has been entered into.

Note: Contributions to the funeral provided by non-responsible survivors including family members, friends, and crowd sourcing accounts, are not considered when determining eligibility for funeral benefits.

Income

Income is money that becomes available to a household during a monthly benefit period, including:

- Employment income;
- Old Age Security, Canada Pension Plan or other pension income; and

- A life insurance payout.

See the [Exempt Income for Responsible Survivors and the Estate of the Deceased](#) policy for in

Any non-exempt income of the estate, and any responsible survivor, will be deducted from the :

Estate of the Deceased Individual		Resp						
In situations where the deceased individual was the single parent of a dependent child(ren) under the age of 18, or under the age of 20, and enrolled in an education program under the Education Act , the following exemption will be applied:		The f remai						
<table><tr><th>Number of Children</th><th>Income Exemption Amounts</th></tr><tr><td>1 Child</td><td>\$863</td></tr><tr><td>Each Additional Child</td><td>\$577</td></tr></table>		Number of Children	Income Exemption Amounts	1 Child	\$863	Each Additional Child	\$577	Ho Sin Cou For
Number of Children	Income Exemption Amounts							
1 Child	\$863							
Each Additional Child	\$577							
If the deceased individual had multiple dependent children, \$577 is added to the initial \$863 exemption, for each additional child.		If the single						

The Canada Pension Plan (CPP) death benefit is a one-time payment from the federal governn contributor.

The CPP death benefit is considered non-exempt income by the Income Support program.

To be eligible to receive funeral benefits, the applicant for funeral benefits must agree to assign

If the CPP death benefit is assigned to ALSS and the value of the funeral benefit issued was les may request the difference by completing an application through [Employment and Social Devel](#)

If the applicant applied for the CPP death benefit prior to submitting the application for funeral b payment provided.

If, after the funeral payment was reduced by the CPP death benefit, the applicant is informed th substantiation to the Health and Funeral Benefits Unit (HFBU) and the remaining value of the fu

Life Insurance

Life insurance is considered non-exempt income when the benefit will go to the estate of the deceased as non-exempt income for the deceased individual or responsible survivor(s).

If the beneficiary of the policy was someone other than the estate or a responsible survivor, the

Assets

Assets are valuable items, including, but not limited to:

- Liquid assets;
- Real estate;
- Vehicles; and
- Other property.

Liquid assets are cash on hand or cash held in a financial institution or by a third party that must

Full and partial exemptions are provided for certain assets and liquid assets:

Estate of the Deceased individual		Resp						
Liquid Assets Generally, any liquid assets held by the estate of the deceased individual will be deducted from the amount of the funeral benefit. Only in the following situation will an exemption be applied: • where the deceased individual was the single parent of a dependent child(ren), under the age of 18, or under the age of 20, and enrolled in an education program under the Education Act:		Liquid The f Any r						
<table><tr><th>Number of Children</th><th>Liquid Asset Exemption Amounts</th></tr><tr><td>1 Child</td><td>\$2,876</td></tr><tr><td>Every Additional Child</td><td>\$1,726</td></tr></table>		Number of Children	Liquid Asset Exemption Amounts	1 Child	\$2,876	Every Additional Child	\$1,726	How Sing Cou For
Number of Children	Liquid Asset Exemption Amounts							
1 Child	\$2,876							
Every Additional Child	\$1,726							

If the deceased individual had multiple dependent children, \$1,726 is added to the initial \$2,876 exemption, for each additional child.	If the single
Other Assets	Other
Certain other assets are exempt and are outlined in the Exempt Assets for Responsible Survivors and the Estate of the Deceased policy.	Certain the E
If the estate has any non-exempt asset (other than liquid assets), they are not eligible for funeral benefits. See above for the treatment of non-exempt liquid assets.	If the treatr

APPLICATION PROCESS FOR FUNERAL BENEFITS

The applicant should be the person who is responsible for making arrangements based on their Regulation to the *Funeral Services Act*. This list is in order of priority, with the highest listed person making arrangements is not available, or is unwilling to make arrangements, the right passes to the next person on the list.

An applicant may or may not be a responsible survivor, depending on the relationship to the deceased individual.

All funeral benefits applications are processed by the HFBU. The application for funeral benefits is available on the website.

The application guide linked on the website provides guidance to the family and friends of the deceased individual.

The available individual or organization who is making arrangements, in accordance with section 2(1) of the *Funeral Services Act*, is responsible for submitting the application for funeral benefits.

Preapproval of funeral benefits, where the applicant is informed of the deceased individual's wishes and the applicant is fully aware of the consequences of making arrangements on behalf of the deceased individual is fully aware of whether the deceased individual's wishes are being followed.

To receive preapproval, the applicant should submit the application, along with the Official Death Certificate, to the HFBU. Staff can determine if the eligibility criteria have been met and notify the applicant of the approval.

Note: If approved, an email with a letter will be sent to the applicant indicating the per trip expenses and any deductions of non-exempt income or liquid assets, if any.

Reimbursement Requests

Reimbursements will be considered if the invoice was paid in full, for up to 6 months after the expense was incurred, and there was an emergency situation. Emergencies are considered on a case-by-case basis based on the circumstances.

The invoice is considered paid if it was paid in full or if an amount equal to or exceeding the total amount of the invoice was received.

Consent to Disclose Personal Information

The application form includes a consent section to allow the applicant to name people and organs and the status of the funeral benefits application, via a telephone inquiry.

The consent is valid for the period of time that the funeral benefits application is being processed and is withdrawn. The consent can be revoked, at any time, in writing.

Directing Payment

Typically, benefits will be issued directly to the service provider(s) as a third party payment.

If the applicant is the spouse/partner of the deceased individual or the parent of a deceased dependent situation, the applicant will be responsible for arranging payment to service providers.

Cemetery fees are generally paid directly to the cemetery as the entity providing the service and does not have the ability to collect these fees and relies on the funeral service provider to collect payment.

Special Groups

See the [Special Groups](#) policy for information on unique situations including:

- First Nations Persons
- Estates with No Administrator;
- Public Trustee Clients
- Disposition of Deceased Individual's Remains;
- Unidentified Deceased Persons; and
- Children in Care under the [Child, Youth and Family Enhancements Act](#)

RATE

When the deceased individual is being buried or cremated in Alberta, the rates for funeral goods

- For funeral expenses for burial or cremation, the actual cost up to \$4,601;
- For a funeral ceremony, the actual cost up to \$1,041;
- For embalming, the actual cost up to \$781;
- For additional transportation and attendant services, the actual cost up to \$1.13 per kilometre if the funeral service provider is located;
- When an exception request is approved for safe sheltering (storage) after 10 days, the actual cost;
- Actual cemetery costs for:
 - A single cemetery plot, plus cemetery perpetual fees, a grave liner, when required by the cemetery

- For an alternate resting place, including a single columbarium niche or mausoleum (

Note: In accordance with the *Cemeteries Act*, section 12, cemetery burial plots are paid a
When the deceased individual is being transported outside of Alberta to another province or ter

- Actual cost of preparing the deceased individual for transport remains prior to shipping, in container; and
- Actual reasonable cost of transportation by road and/or by airfreight. Least cost alternative

Note: Any non-exempt income or liquid assets will be deducted from the funeral benefit a

Exception Requests

[Ministerial Order 2023-027](#) outlines the maximum rates that have been set by the Minister for fu
In exceptional and necessary circumstances where the maximum benefit rates are insufficient, substantiation.

The applicant must complete the [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form. F appropriate delegated authority. Examples of exceptions may include:

- Additional costs due to health and/or safety reasons, such as bioseals;
- Safe sheltering (storage) of a deceased individual for more than 10 days. An exception for deceased individual; or
- Alternate resting places above the rate limit.

The following criteria are considered for these requests:

- The burial or cremation and funeral expenses cannot be met by the maximum rate due to
- The expenses are considered necessary and essential for cremation or burial and funeral
- There are no other means to pay; and
- The least cost alternative is considered.

A decision for a benefit in excess of the rates is not appealable.

DELEGATED AUTHORITY

HFB Assessor – eligibility for a funeral benefit, including reimbursement for expenses not autho
Director or Manager, Common Service Delivery (CSD) – for funeral expenses exceeding the m:

SUBSTANTIATION

Required documentation

- Proof of identification of the applicant.
- Proof of identification and address of the deceased individual.
- Official Death Certificate or Funeral Director's Statement of Death.
- Proof of the deceased individual's citizenship or status in Canada.
- 30-day bank statement for the deceased individual as proof of the income source, the amount of income, and the date of death.
- Quotes or unpaid invoices for:
 - Funeral and burial or cremation expenses, including a breakdown of the funds for a funeral home, a cemetery, and a funeral director.
 - Finalized quotes or unpaid invoices for transportation expenses to another province.

Documentation depending on situation:

- Proof of denial from a program if the deceased individual may have been eligible for funding.
- Completed [Request for Estimate – CPP Death Benefit](#) form, unless the CPP death benefit is not applicable.
- Proof of the value of a life insurance policy for the deceased individual if the estate or a responsible person is requesting a refund of the premium.
- Documents showing the deceased had a prepaid funeral.
- Any other verification of income and assets of the deceased individual.
- 30-day bank statement for the responsible survivor(s) as proof of the source of income, the amount of income, and the date of death.

Required documentation if requesting an exceptional amount

- A completed [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form.
- Quotes/invoices and other relevant documents showing all the funeral costs, as well as any other expenses related to the funeral.

PROCEDURE

HFB Administrative Clerk:

1. Check CCD and generate a PID, as necessary.

HFB Assessor:

Eligibility Review

1. Searches in Compass to determine if the deceased individual is in the system and, if not,
2. Reviews the application form and substantiation documents to determine if the applicant is:
 1. Has the applicant's identity been verified?
 2. Is the applicant the most appropriate person to be making funeral arrangements?
 3. Has the Official Death Certificate or Funeral Director's Statement of Death been provided?
 4. Has the deceased individual's identity, residency in Alberta, and status in Canada been verified?
 5. Are there other programs available to cover the cost of the funeral?
 6. Did the deceased individual have a prepaid funeral or life insurance?
 7. Does the deceased individual have any estate income, liquid assets or assets available?
 8. If there is a responsible survivor(s), do they have income, liquid assets, or assets available?
 9. Does the application form have a valid signature?

Note: a handwritten signature is required.

3. If the request is for a reimbursement for burial or cremation and funeral or transportation expenses:
 1. Ensures that the service occurred within the past six months, and
 2. Reviews the paid invoice(s) and the emergency circumstances, as provided by the applicant.
4. Reviews the quotes or unpaid invoices.
 1. Confirms that the applicant is the person named on the invoice. This ensures the applicant is the person responsible for the funeral expenses.
 2. Reviews the invoice for each funeral benefit category to ensure the items are appropriate:
 1. Funeral expenses for burial or cremation;
 2. Funeral ceremony;
 3. Embalming;
 4. Additional transportation within Alberta:
 - Validates, per trip, the transportation was necessary, the rate charged is appropriate (if not, the rate charged is not reimbursed); and

5. Cemetery or alternate resting place fees; or
 6. Transportation to another province or territory within Canada.
3. If the invoice is for an amount in excess of the maximum rates and the applicant submits the CSD Director or Manager for consideration.
5. If a decision cannot be made due to missing information:
1. Records the missing information in Comments;
 2. Sends an Information Missing Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant detailing the missing information;
 3. Provides a due date of seven days for the missing information to be submitted.
6. Once additional information is provided, return to Step 2.
7. If additional information is not provided within the timeline provided, proceed to Step 9 to complete the process.
8. Determines if the applicant is eligible for a funeral benefit:
1. If the applicant is eligible for the full funeral benefit amount, without a partial payment:
 1. Records the following in Comments:
 - The type of benefit approved;
 - The conditions that support issuing the benefit;
 - The substantiation or verification provided;
 - The amount of the benefit issued;
 - How the payments were directed if there is more than one service provider;
 - The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for.
 2. Sends the Approval Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant who is responsible for the funeral service.
 3. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and cemetery (if applicable).
 2. If the applicant is eligible for a funeral benefit with a partial payment:
 1. Contacts the applicant to explain the deduction amount and the reason for the deduction.
 2. Confirms how the partial payment should be directed, if more than one service provider is involved.
 3. Records the following in Comments:
 - The type of benefit approved;
 - The amount of deductions based on the Canada Pension Plan death benefit and/or the individual's estate and/or responsible survivor;

- The conditions that support issuing the benefit;
 - The substantiation or verification provided;
 - The amount of the benefit issued;
 - How the payments were directed if there is more than one service provided;
 - The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for.
4. Sends the Approval Letter, by email and then by mail, to the applicant who is responsible for the funeral service.
 - The letter states the deduction amount.
 5. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and cemetery (if applicable).

Note: if the applicant is the spouse/partner or parent of the deceased individual, they may receive the benefit directly.

Note: if a reimbursement request is approved, the applicant may receive the payment directly.

9. If not eligible,
 1. Records the decision in Comments, including the reason(s) for the denial.
 2. Sends out a Denial Letter, by email and then by mail, to advise the applicant of the decision, the reasons for the decision, and information on how to appeal the decision.

Note: if a cheque was issued to the applicant and the applicant advises they have not received it, the applicant must follow the [Printed Cheques](#) policy.

Exception Requests

1. If the applicant has completed the [Funeral Benefits – Request for an Exceptional Amount](#) form, the decision maker must consider the request.
2. If approved for an exceptional amount:
 1. Records the following in Comments:
 1. The amount of the benefit issued;
 2. The period of assistance (POA) the benefit is issued for; and
 3. The rationale provided by the decision maker.
 2. Arranges payment to the funeral service provider and the cemetery (if applicable).

Note: if the applicant is the spouse/partner or parent of the deceased individual, the
Note: if a reimbursement request is approved, the applicant may receive the payme

3. If not approved for an exceptional amount:
 1. Records the rationale in comments.

CSD Director or Manager:

1. When requested by the applicant, reviews requests for exceptions above the funeral bene
2. Communicates their decision to the HFBU Assessor:
 1. If approved, the CSD Director or Manager sends an approval letter to the applicant,
 1. Advising them of the decision;
 2. Providing confirmation of the amount of additional funds approved;
 3. Advising them of the right to provide additional information if they do not agree
 4. Explaining the decision is exempt from appeal to an Appeal Panel.
 2. If not approved, the CSD Director or Manager notifies the Assessor of the decision a
 1. Advising them of the decision;
 2. Providing the reason(s) for the denial of the additional funds requested;
 3. Advising of the right to provide additional information if they do not agree with t
 4. Explaining that the decision is exempt from appeal to an Appeal Panel.

Central Payment and Data Entry (CPDE) Administrative Clerk:

1. Generate payment based on the Need Codes provided by the HFB Assessor
 1. 1970 – Funerals – Basic Service
 2. 1971 – Funerals – Transportation
 3. 1975 – Funerals – Cemetery Plot
 4. 1976 – Funerals – Cremation

Funeral Benefits for Low Income Albertans Special

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2022

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\) and the Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 25](#)
[Funeral Services Act General Regulation, section 36\(2\)](#)
[Cemeteries Act General Regulation, section 12 and section 13](#)

INTENT

To describe unique situations that may occur related to providing funeral benefits for low-income

POLICY

First Nations Persons

If the deceased was residing off reserve, they may be eligible for funeral benefits if all other eligible for Income Support benefits. If the deceased was ordinarily residing on reserve, refer to [Nations People with Registered Status Under the Indian Act and Off-Reserve Nations People](#)

Estate with No Administrator

[The Public Trustee](#) must be notified if the deceased has an estate with no administrator. When administer the estate. The Public Trustee will take appropriate action, which may include a request for no contact is made with the Public Trustee.

Public Trustee Clients

The Public Trustee has an agreement with the funeral homes for funeral services. When the Public Trustee will confirm the amount available in the estate and ask the Health and Funeral Benefit Unit

The amount of the estate is not used as a deduction to offset the total funeral costs. Community the cost of the estate funds from the Public Trustee. Service Alberta must be advised by the Community collection can occur.

Requests for Disposal of Human Remains

Under section 36(2), of the [Funeral Services General Regulation](#), the Minister of Community and Social Services remains when there is no other person or government body with higher priority who is able or willing

Unidentified Deceased Persons

When a deceased individual cannot be identified, basic funeral services are provided in the name of the deceased and the HFB Unit arranges payment for the funeral. A **burial only** is provided. A cremation must be arranged

Children in Care under the *Child, Youth and Family Enhancement Act*

The Child and Family Services Delivery Division of Community and Social Services is responsible for the Director, under the [Child, Youth and Family Enhancement Act](#).

Exempt Income for Responsible Survivors and the

Last updated on: Mar 24, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\) and the Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 25](#)

INTENT

To describe the income that is exempt for determining eligibility for funeral benefits for low income

POLICY

The income of the deceased individual and any responsible survivor(s) is used to determine eligibility

Income is money that is available to household members during the period of assistance that funeral

- Employment and self-employment income;
- Room and board and rental income from a principal residence; and
- Any other source of money available to the household unit that is not exempted under Schedule

When determining eligibility and the benefit amount, the following resources are not considered

- Money received from Income Support;
- Certain types of refunds (e.g., income tax refunds, damage deposit refunds, utility refunds
- Gifts in kind (goods and services received);
- Third party payment income (direct payment made by a third party on the individual's behalf
- Loans and loan payments;
- Contributions to the funeral provided by non-responsible survivors including family members and crowd sourcing accounts.

Fully Exempt Income

The following sources of income are exempt and do not impact eligibility or benefit amount:

Tax Benefits/ Rebates

- Alberta Child and Family Benefits (ACFB) payments received from the Government of Alberta
- A Canada Child Benefit (CCB) under the Income Tax Act (Canada)

- A Goods and Services Tax credit (GST) received from the Government of Canada
- Money received from a management body under the [Alberta Housing Act](#) for the payment
- Money received under a program of the Government of Canada or Alberta for home repair
- A payment, refund or credit directly or indirectly from the Government of Canada or Alberta
- The Canada Workers Benefit received from the Government of Canada

Compensation for Deposits or Rent Supplements

- A refunded damage deposit under a tenancy agreement or a refunded deposit paid in respect of a tenancy agreement
- A moving allowance provided by a landlord on termination of a tenancy agreement
- Rent Assistance Benefit from the Rent Supplement Program
- Canada Housing Benefit (one-time top-up for renters)
- Canada Housing Benefit for Survivors of Gender-Based Violence

Compensation for Care of Others

- A payment received by a member of the household unit pursuant to an order for the support of a child
- Payments of arrears of child support that are not owing to the government
- A payment made under a Government of Alberta program to reimburse living expenses of a caregiver

Employment/Training Resources

- A grant or loan to start a business, from a federal or provincial government department or agency
- A loan from a financial institution, excluding a government loan for post-secondary studies
- A payment made by the Government of Canada or Alberta for part-time training costs as follows:
 - Part-time Canada Student Loan (Government of Canada)
 - Canada Student Grant for Part-time Studies (Government of Canada)
 - Canada Student Grant for Persons with Permanent Disabilities (Government of Canada)
 - Canada Student Grant for Services and Equipment for Persons with Permanent Disabilities (Government of Canada)
 - Skills Investment Bursary (Government of Alberta)
- A payment made by the Government of Canada or Alberta for Disability Related Employment

Community and Social Services funded full or part-time training programs and / or to obtain

'Harm Done' Payments

- A payment received under Schedule A or B to the 1986-1990 Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement
 - A payment under section 4.02 of the Agreement for loss of income, or
 - A payment under section 6.01 of the Agreement for loss of support resulting from the death of a family member
- A payment received for the pre-1986 and post 1990 Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement
- Compensation for a member of the household unit having been infected with the HIV virus
- A benefit paid under the [Victims of Crime Act](#) except for any portion paid for lost income or loss of support
- A Common Experience Payment (CEP) and Independent Assessment Process Payments
- Clegg Class Action Settlement payments (2017)
- Compensation payments made under the Final Settlement Agreement between Ross, Ro and Bisexual and Transgender (LGBT) federal public servants (2020)
- Compensation payments made under the Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement (2020)
- Compensation payments made under the Federal Indian Day Schools (McLean) Settlement Agreement
- Japanese Canadian Redress Agreement
- Extraordinary Assistance Plan
- Huronia Regional Centre Class Action Settlement
- A Child Welfare Class Action Settlement payment from the Government of Alberta
- Compensation payments made under the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) - Department of Veterans Affairs Class Action Settlement
- Compensation payments to individuals impacted by the September 2023 E. coli outbreak
- Compensation payments made to a class member under the Manitoba Developmental Centre Class Action Settlement
- The First Nation Drinking Water Advisory Class Actions Settlement Agreement (2021)
- Compensation payments from the Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement
- Compensation payments under the First Nations Child and Family Services, Jordan's Principle Class Action Settlement

Specific Claims Agreements

- A payment received from Tsuut'ina First Nation as a result of the Final Calgary Ring-Road

- Payments made to a First Nation under an agreement with the Government of Canada for
 - Duncan First Nation Land Settlement Claim
 - O'Chiese First Nations Land Settlement Claim
 - Bigstone Cree Nation and Peerless Trout First Nation Treaty 8 Land Settlement
 - Mikisew Cree First Nation Settlement Agreement
 - Castle Mountain Land and Timber Claim Settlement (2016)
 - Mosquito Grizzly Bear's Head First Nation Settlement (2021)
- Government of Alberta Siksika Land Settlement Claim regarding Bassano Dam

Per Capita Distribution Payments

- A payment of a non-recurring nature received from a First Nation that is paid equally to each member of the First Nation
 - Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements;
 - The Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - The Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty 8 Lands and Benefits Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - The Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - The Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - The Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - Peepeekisis First Nation Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2021);
 - Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement (July 2022 PCD payment);
 - The Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement (2024); and
 - The Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation Treaty 8 Annuities Settlement Agreement (2024)

Disaster Relief/ Recovery Payments

- A Slave Lake Wildfire Relief Payment or a payment under the Emergency Accommodation Program
- Compensation pursuant to a Disaster Recovery Program for the June 2013 floods
- Payments issued by a charitable organization for the June 2013 floods
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta for damage or loss caused by a disaster
- Payments issued by a charitable organization for a disaster determined by the Government of Alberta

Compensation and Other Income

- Withdrawals from a Registered Disability Savings Plan (RDSP)
- Money received as compensation for loss or damage to property of a member of the household used for some other purpose, within a reasonable time
- Money received from the Government of Alberta to assist a person with a disability in purchasing a vehicle
- Roth/Fifield Class Action Settlement Agreement from the Government of Alberta
- Proceeds from Calgary Dollars or Cochrane Dollars
- Payment for participation in the University of Calgary Research Project: “Empowering food security program”
- Canada Emergency Student Benefit payments received from the Government of Canada
- One-time payment to persons with disabilities in response to COVID-19 received from the Government of Alberta
- Veterans Affairs Canada Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the Government of Canada
- Veterans Affairs Canada Additional Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the Government of Canada
- Canada Recovery Benefit (CRB) payments intended as income for the eligibility periods based on the household. This includes the:
 - Canada Recovery Benefit;
 - Canada Recovery Sickness Benefit; and
 - Canada Recovery Caregiving Benefit
- Payments from the Heroes Fund received from the Government of Alberta
- COVID Self-Isolation payments issued by the Government of Alberta, after the person completed COVID-19 testing and received services from the Government of Alberta
- Working Parents Benefit payments received from the Government of Alberta
- Critical Worker Benefit payments received from the Government of Canada and the Government of Alberta
- Memorial Grant Program payments received from the Government of Canada
- COVID-19 Vaccine Incentive payments received from the Government of Alberta
- Affordability payments received from the Government of Alberta
- Canada Dental Benefit
- Compassionate payments from the Government of Alberta to individuals impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic

Exempt Assets for Responsible Survivors and the

Last updated on: Mar 24, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 5\(1\)\(b\) and the Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 25](#)

INTENT

To describe the assets that are exempt for determining eligibility for funeral benefits for low-income

POLICY

For Responsible Survivors and Estate of the Deceased:

In addition to the liquid asset exemptions set out in the [Funeral Benefits for Low Income Alberta](#)

- A home of any value in which the individual lived (or lives), including the home quarter section;
- Clothing, personal jewelry, children's toys, and other common household goods;
- Household furnishings and appliances;
- Business assets required for the operation's viability and farm machinery required for the operation;
- Vehicles where the total combined equity of the vehicles is less than \$10,000;
- Any vehicle specially adapted to accommodate a disability of an individual in the household;
- Money in trust for a child.

For Responsible Survivors

The following are also exempt assets for Responsible Survivors:

- Locked-In Retirement Accounts;
- Registered Education Savings Plan;
- Registered Savings Plan up to \$5,000 per adult member of the household;
- Registered Disability Savings Plan;
- Life insurance policy with a cash surrender value of less than \$1,500; and
- Prepaid Funeral.

The following payments and any asset bought with money from the payment are also exempt for

- Japanese Canadian Redress Agreement
- Extraordinary Assistance Plan
- Compensation for HIV infection through the blood supply
- Financial benefits under the *Victims of Crime Act*, other than funeral benefits issued under
- Common Experience Payments (CEPs) and Independent Assessment Process Payments
- Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement
- Roth/Fifield Class Action Settlement Agreement from the Government of Alberta
- A Slave Lake Wildfire Relief Payment or a payment under the Emergency Accommodation Emergency Management Agency in May 2011.
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta pursuant to a Disaster Recovery Pro
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta for damage or loss caused by a disaster
- Payments issued by a charitable organization for a disaster as determined by the Government
- Alberta Child Welfare Class Action Settlement from the Government of Alberta
- Clegg Class Action Settlement (2017)
- A non-recurring per capita distribution or compensation payment received from the First Nations
 - Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements;
 - The Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
 - The Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty Lands and Benefits Claim Settlement Agreement
 - The Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2012)
 - The Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreement;
 - The Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific Claim Settlement Agreement
 - Mosquito Grizzly Bear's Head Lean Man Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2020)
 - The Peepeekisis First Nation Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2021);
 - The Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement (2022);
 - Note:** this exemption is for the per capita distribution payment provided in July 2022
 - The First Nation Drinking Water Advisory Class Actions Settlement Agreement (2021)
 - The Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement (2024); and
 - The Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation Treaty 8 Annuities Settlement Agreement (2024)

- Veterans Affairs Canada Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the C
 - Compensation payments made under the Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement (2020).
 - Compensation payments made under the Final Settlement Agreement between Ross, Ro Bisexual and Transgender (LGBT) federal public servants (2020).
 - Compensation payments made under the Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the Que disabled Veterans (2020).
 - Compensation payments made under the Federal Indian Day Schools (McLean) Settlement
 - Payments issued by the Government of Alberta from the Heroes Fund.
 - COVID Self-Isolation payments issued by the Government of Alberta, after the person cor Services.
 - Working Parents Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta (2021).
 - Critical Workers Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta and the Govern
 - Memorial Grant Program payments from the Government of Canada.
 - Affordability payments received from the Government of Alberta.
 - COVID-19 Vaccine Incentive payments received from the Government of Alberta.
 - Compensation payments made under the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) – Department o
 - Canada Housing Benefit.
 - Canada Dental Benefit.
 - Compassionate payments from the Government of Alberta to individuals impacted by the
 - Compensation payments made to a class member under the Manitoba Developmental Ce
 - Compensation payments from the Government of Canada made to an Individual Class M (2021).
 - Compensation payments under the First Nations Child and Family Services, Jordan's Pri
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Handicap Benefit

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 2](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To describe the handicap benefit that may be available to eligible household units to help offset

POLICY

A Handicap Benefit is issued to adult applicants or recipients, who meet the financial eligibility to

- Are approved for **Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped** (AISH) benefits but that
- The worker determines the client has a “severe handicap” as defined in the AISH General AISH medical report and the client has an active AISH application or intends to apply for A
- They are not eligible to receive an Old Age Security benefit.

Note

The definition of “severe handicap” under the AISH General Regulation is: an impairment of mental or physical ability, as determined by medical or psychological reports, causes substantial limitation in the person's ability to earn a livelihood. If therapy is available that would materially improve the person's ability to earn a livelihood.”

These clients are assigned to the [Barriers to Full Employment \(BFE\) Client sub-type 43 Severe](#) **606060**.

For clients approved for AISH, the Income Support worker **must** consult with the AISH worker to

For clients applying for AISH, the Income Support worker **must** consult with AISH to ensure the

For clients applying for AISH, the Income Support worker should review the client file after a pending application is still pending, the file should be reviewed after each subsequent 3 months until the

For clients who intend to apply for AISH, the Income Support worker should review the client file based on the client's individual circumstances (typically after 1 month, no longer than 3 months) or client category if the client is not taking reasonable steps to apply to the AISH program.

See Client Sub-Type 43 Severe Handicap for more information on assigning a client to sub-type

Substantiation

- Confirmation that the client has been approved for AISH or is currently applying for AISH.

- For clients previously approved for AISH, confirmation from the AISH worker that the client better met by the Income Support program than the AISH program.
- The worker is satisfied that the client intends to apply for AISH benefits and is taking steps:

Note

Transfer procedures between Income Support and AISH can be found in Client Sub-type .

Rate

\$208.00 per month for each eligible adult

Need Code

1501 Handicap Benefit

PROCEDURES

LISA defaults the Handicap Benefit when the worker uses the **PF10** key in **Client Budget** for ar

Hearing Aid Benefits – Refer Clients to the Alberta

Last updated on: Dec 03, 2020

Effective July 1, 2010, responsibility for the provision of hearing aids has been transferred to the
requiring hearing aids to AADL.

Home Parenteral Therapy and Enteral Nutrition Proc

Last updated on: Dec 03, 2020

Home Parenteral Therapy Program

The Home Parenteral Therapy (HPT) program is a collaborative hospital and home care program for patients with chronic or terminal illnesses. A parenteral drug is administered intravenously or by injection through a central line.

The purpose of this program is to decrease the health costs related to lengthy hospital stays, and to provide home administration. The program is administered by the Regional Health Authorities.

Clients who are in hospital, and in need of parenteral drug or hydration therapy and who meet the criteria for home care (i.e., unable to transport medicine from designated pharmacy) may be identified by HPT for this program. Clients must be eligible for home care services.

There is a maximum limit of \$5,000 for drugs and supplies to be shared between the HPT program and the client's personal funds. The HPT program is responsible for identifying when the combined \$5,000 limit for drugs and supplies has been reached.

PROCEDURE

- The HPT program notifies the worker if the client has been accepted for this program and established in their homes, the HPT program notifies workers of supplies, as they are needed.
- Payment for supplies under the HPT program will be the same as for other medical and surgical supplies.
- Alberta Blue Cross will monitor and cover all the drug costs.
- HPT funds cover up to 75% of the cost of supplies, and Income Support covers the balance.

Note

Where HPT programs cover a smaller proportion of the cost of supplies (e.g., Lethbridge), clients may be billed for the balance that other Albertans on the program would be billed (to the \$5,000 per year maximum).

Home Enteral Nutrition Program

The Home Enteral Nutrition Program provides the supplies required, but not the formula for tube feeding. The program charges all patients at cost for the formula.

PROCEDURE

Invoices for the programs are sent to Regional Financial Services, which verifies the client had been approved by the Assistant Deputy Minister of Employment and Financial Supports who authorizes the invoice.

Isolated Community Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 9](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To cover the higher living costs associated with residing in a permanent community that does not

POLICY

An applicant or a recipient and their dependants who reside in a permanent community that does not have a person. An example of a remote community is Fort Chipewyan.

Rate

\$48.00 per month per person residing in the isolated community

Need Code

1724 Isolated Community Allowance

Medical and Surgical Supplies

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 27](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide coverage for essential medical and surgical supplies required for health and well-being.

POLICY

Income Support provides essential medical and surgical supplies when a physician indicates that

- It is not available or **normally covered** through any other resource such as [Alberta](#) clinic, therapist, community resource or agency **and**
- No lower-cost alternative can be accessed. Fixed rates have not been established for batteries. At least two written quotes should be obtained for any items costing \$1,000

Substantiation

Documentation from a physician indicating the item is essential for the medical management of the individual must be pre-approved by the worker. Reimbursements should not be made unless the item was

Requests for Continuous Positive Airway Pressure ([CPAP](#)) Machines require more extensive

Rate

Items covered by Income Support under Medical and Surgical Supplies must:

- Be a consumable (one-time use or disposable) product or supply with a total value covered (e.g., insulin, syringes, bandages, skin testing materials, bandages) **or**
- Be a durable item (have a useful life of more than three months) and its cost must not exceed

Wheelchair/Scooter Repairs and Batteries

Income Support covers the actual costs for repairs and batteries for privately owned wheelchair

- Manual wheelchair repairs: **\$519.00** per year
- Power wheelchair repairs: **\$692.00** per year

- Scooter repairs: **\$692.00** per year
- Batteries for power wheelchairs and scooters: **\$692.00**

Clients must use other resources whenever possible. For example, **short-term medical needs** Cross, Easter Seal) that loan medical supplies, such as crutches, canes, walkers, wheelchairs, within their community.

Alberta Aids to Daily Living (AADL) may cover benefits for Albertans who have a **long-term dis** AADL benefits can be found in the [AADL Program Manual](#).

The client is responsible for contacting an AADL authorizer or their Regional Health Auth assess the client's needs and eligibility for AADL medical equipment and/or supplies, an the [health benefits card](#) to the vendor as proof of exemption from the AADL 25% co-pay.

AADL provides coverage only for items listed in their program manual. AADL does not have an replace lost or stolen equipment, or equipment damaged due to misuse.

AADL does have an appeal process to review requests outside their quantity and frequency lim Frequency Review Committee denies a request, consultation should occur with AADL to explor providing the requested item.

For more information on coverage criteria please contact AADL at 780□427□0731 in Edmonton

Appeals

Medical and surgical supplies are provided under the authority of the Minister [Income Support,](#) authority to rule with respect to them.

However, if the item requested does not meet all the policy or coverage criteria, **and** denial of th sought.

PROCEDURES

When a worker receives a request for coverage of medical and surgical supplies, the worker:

1. Reviews the medical documentation submitted to confirm medical need.
2. Consults the AADL program or any other relevant programs e.g. the Residential Acc do not cover the item requested.
3. Reviews the [Scratch Pad](#) to ensure the client has not reached their monthly maxim and if eligible,
4. Notifies the vendor to proceed.

The vendor then sends an invoice that includes the client's name, file number, and itemized list issued.

Benefits approved for coverage under medical surgical supplies are provided either by cheque or by **0018HW Purchase Authorization and Invoice** (handwritten voucher) to the vendor and are covered.

Need Code

1721 Continuous Medical Needs

1912 Medical/Surgical Supplies

Medical Extraordinary Transportation

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 6](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To provide transportation benefits to access ongoing medical treatment covered by Alberta Health Services.

POLICY

The extraordinary transportation benefit may be provided if a member of the household unit has a medical need (doctors, radiologists, lab technicians, physiotherapists, etc.). The person must use the most appropriate transportation available.

Substantiation

The verbal statement of the client or the workers knowledge of the situation.

The client could be requested to further substantiate their need for medical transportation by providing information on the medical need, the frequency of treatment and the duration of treatment.

Rate

- For public transportation, a benefit equal to the actual cost of a bus pass, **or**
- If the person cannot use public transportation, a benefit equal to **\$0.17** per kilometer for a private vehicle.
- If the person cannot use public transportation and does not have access to a private vehicle, a benefit equal to the actual cost of a taxi.

Need Code

1705 Medical Extraordinary Transportation

Natal and Adoptive Needs Payment

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 17](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To assist with the additional costs associated with having a newborn baby.

POLICY

The full natal allowance is provided (for infant clothing, toiletries, crib, mattress, bedding, high chair) when the following conditions are met.

- The applicant, recipient or a dependant within the household is pregnant and is within 1 month of the due date.
- A child has been adopted or born into a household and the child is not more than twelve months old.

Households where a dependant has a child are also eligible if they meet the above conditions.

Substantiation

Verbal statement or Worker's knowledge of client's situation, and if in doubt:

- A letter from their physician or nurse practitioner indicating their due date, **or**
- An official document containing the child's name and birthdate such as a birth certificate, I

Rate

\$296.00 per child

Need Code

1819 Natal Allowance

PROCEDURE

LISA automatically posts this benefit to the **Scratch Pad**.

The worker records the name of the dependant for which the benefit was issued.

Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation –

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 20](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

Seniors, Community and Social Services provides supports to ensure the ongoing safety of victims. **Situation** is provided to help them cover the costs of telephone and transportation in order to a

POLICY

A monthly allowance to cover the costs of telephone and transportation is provided to an applicant. The individual does not have to have moved in order to obtain this benefit.

The Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation – Leaving Abusive Situation allows a victim to ensure their safety such as to call for emergency support and/or to arrange and attend appointments such as medical appointments. Extensions are provided as required.

Substantiation

Clients substantiate their need for this benefit by:

- Verbal statement of the client or worker's knowledge of the abuse **and**
- **Only if in doubt**, evidence from a professional source (e.g. physician, nurse practitioner,

Rate

Telephone Rate

- **\$37.00** per month

Transportation Rate

- **\$73.00** per month

PROCEDURE

The worker reviews the client circumstances and issues the benefit.

Need Code

1732 Personal Benefit – Telephone and Transportation – Leaving Abusive Situation

Note

The telephone rate and the transportation rate are issued together under the same need c

Personal Needs Allowance

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 3](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To meet needs associated with long term dependency of clients who have Barriers to Full Employment to the workforce and reside in an Expected to Work (ETW) household.

POLICY

This benefit is issued to an adult applicant or adult recipient categorized with a BFE client sub-type.

This benefit is **not** issued to:

- Clients with an ETW client sub-type;
- Clients in a BFE household;
- Clients residing in a type A continuing care home or active treatment hospital and receiving services;
- Clients who are in receipt of a comforts/resident core essential allowance (Need Code 14).

Rate

\$93.00 per month per adult with a BFE Client Sub-type in an ETW household.

Need Code

1422 Personal Needs Supplement

PROCEDURES

LISA defaults the Personal Needs Supplement when the worker uses the **PF10** key in **Client B**

Prenatal Needs Payment

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 16.1](#)
[Ministerial Order 2022-007, Prenatal Needs Payment](#)

INTENT

To assist with covering additional expenses during pregnancy.

POLICY

Eligibility

To receive the Prenatal Needs Payment, the eligibility criteria outlined in the [Supplementary Be](#)

The Prenatal Needs Payment may be provided to assist with prenatal expenses for a member c

The Prenatal Needs Payment is payable each month:

- Starting the first day of the month that the person reaches 14 weeks of pregnancy; and
- Continuing until the last day of the month in which the person's expected date of delivery c

Substantiation

A letter from a physician or nurse practitioner is required:

- Confirming that the person is pregnant, and
- Indicating the person's expected date of delivery.

Rate

\$117.00 per month

The maximum benefit rate payable is \$117 per month, per pregnancy. The payment is not incre

Need Code

1740 Prenatal Needs

Authority Level

Career and Employment Consultant, Supports and Financial Services Coordinator or equivalen

PROCEDURE

Determining When a Person Reaches their 14th Week of Pregnancy

According to Alberta Health Services guidelines, most babies are born between 37 weeks and 4

To determine when a person reaches (or has reached) their 14th week of pregnancy and qualify

- Uses the date provided in the physician's letter, if it indicates when the person will reach the
- Calculates the date the person will be 14 weeks pregnant by counting back 24 weeks from

Example

- If the person's expected date of delivery is October 14, they will be 14 weeks pregnant
- In this case, the person would be eligible for the Prenatal Needs Payment for each month

If unsure, the Worker may also contact the person who is pregnant and have them confirm the date

Issuing the Prenatal Needs Payment

Once the Worker establishes the period of assistance the person's 14th week of pregnancy falls

- Issues the Prenatal Needs Payment using LISA **Need Code 1740** for the month the person's expected date of delivery occurs.
 - Records in Compass Comments:
 - The name and expected date of delivery of the household member who is pregnant.
 - The first month the benefit was issued.
 - The last month the benefit is to be issued.
 - Enters a Reminder in Compass to remove the Prenatal Needs Payment from the budget,
-

Procedures for Issuing Supplementary Income Support

Last updated on: May 06, 2022

INTENT

To describe the procedures for issuing supplementary income support benefits.

POLICY

The majority of supplementary income support benefits follow a standard procedure.

PROCEDURES

STANDARD SUPPLEMENTARY BENEFIT PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts benefits that have restrictions by amount or frequency of issuance to the client's record.

When issuing a supplementary income support benefit:

1. The worker reviews the client's request and circumstances and determines if they are eligible for the benefit.
2. If approved, the worker records the following in [Compass Comments](#):
 1. The type of benefit issued.
 2. The amount of the benefit issued.
 3. The POA the benefit is issued.
 4. The conditions that support the issuing of the benefit.
 5. The substantiation or verification provided by the client.
 6. If subject to repayment, enter the date the [EMP 0976B - Repayment Agreement](#) was signed:
 1. That the client was advised of the requirement to repay and their right to appeal the decision.
 2. That the client was notified that if they do not sign the repayment agreement a repayment plan will be set up.
 3. That the program has the right to re-evaluate the approval if the requirement to repay is not met.
3. If denied, the worker notifies the client
 1. If the worker notifies the client verbally, they must inform the client:
 1. That the request was denied,
 2. The reason for the denial; and
 3. Their right to appeal the decision within 30 days of the notification.

2. The worker records the following in Compass Comments:

3. The date the client was advised the request was denied/the letter was issued.
4. The reason the client was deemed ineligible for the requested benefit.
5. That the client was advised of their right to appeal the denial within 30 days and how

Some benefits also have specific or additional procedures and are listed below. These in EXCEPTIONS

FUNERAL BENEFITS

See the [Funeral Benefits](#) policy for procedures.

CHILD SUPPLEMENT ALLOWANCE

See the [Child Supplement Allowance](#) for procedures.

CHILDREN'S SCHOOL EXPENSES

See the [Children's School Expenses](#) policy for procedures.

MEDICAL AND SURGICAL SUPPLIES

See the [Medical and Surgical Supplies](#) policy for procedures.

CONTINUOUS POSITIVE AIRWAY PRESSURE DEVICE

See the [Continuous Positive Airway Pressure \(CPAP\) Devices](#) policy for procedures.

HOME PARENTERAL THERAPY PROGRAM AND HOME ENTERAL THERAPY PROGRAM

See the [Home Parenteral Therapy Program and Home Enteral Therapy Program](#) policy for procedures.

RELOCATION ALLOWANCE

Moving Out of Alberta – [Relocation Allowance](#)

The worker enters a [CCD Alert](#) using **Alert Code 25 Relocation** and an explanation.

If the client reapplies for benefits within 12 months of the move and is eligible, the worker:

1. Informs the client of the debt owing for the repayment of their moving costs.
2. Enters the debt in the Recoveries System.
3. Informs the client of the monthly deduction from their benefits.

HANDICAP BENEFIT

[Handicap Benefit](#)

LISA defaults the Handicap Benefit when the worker uses the **PF10** key in **Client Budget** for an

PERSONAL NEEDS ALLOWANCE

[Personal Needs Allowance](#)

LISA defaults the Personal Needs Supplement when the worker uses the **PF10 key** in **Client B**

EARNINGS REPLACEMENT ALLOWANCE

[Earnings Replacement Allowance](#)

LISA automatically adds the Earnings Replacement Allowance to the budget of household unit : **Budget** in **Eligibility Determination** or the **PF10** key in **Client Budget**.

PRENATAL NEEDS PAYMENT

See the [Prenatal Needs Payment](#) policy for procedures.

DIRECTOR'S APPROVAL

See the [Directors Approval](#) policy for procedures.

Relocation Allowance

Last updated on: Dec 03, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 13](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To assist with the costs associated with a residential move in specific circumstances when the I

POLICY

A benefit may be provided to an applicant or recipient for actual moving costs of the household for each circumstance are described separately further below):

- Where a residential move is essential to accept confirmed employment, **or**
- To relocate for financial or social support, **or**
- To escape a situation of abuse, regardless of the abused household member's relationshi

Substantiation

- The standard substantiation for costs is a written estimate from the vendor. Additional esti
- Additional substantiation for each type of move is indicated below.

Costs Covered

- Reasonable hotel or motel and meals if essential to the move and the well-being of the fai
- Gas; insurance; rental truck or trailer deposits; bus fare.
- Professional moving company only if self-move is not reasonable.
- Packing only if a person is unable to pack due to medical reasons.

Moving to Confirmed Employment

When an adult member of the household unit is accepting confirmed employment within Alberta

Substantiation

A written job confirmation from the employer, or the worker may contact the employer dire

Need Code

1804 Moving for Employment

Moving Out of Alberta – Relocation

When a household unit is moving to another province or territory for financial or social support (

- Young applicants and recipients (age 18-25), who have parents or guardians who may be for their move.
- A person being assisted with a move, where the cost of the move is more than the value c within 12 months of receiving this benefit, he or she will be required to repay all the movin [Repayment Agreement](#) prior to receiving the benefit.

Substantiation

- **Returning to Province of origin:** Verbal statement of client is sufficient; however, v
- **Moving to Another Province:** Documentation such as a letter from family and/or fri support to the client. Or, workers may verify the above by contacting the family and/

Need Code

1833 Relocation Allowance

Moving to Escape Abuse

When it is essential for the safety of any member of the household unit to move within Alberta c

Substantiation

- Verbal statement of client or worker's knowledge of situation, **and** if in doubt
- Evidence from a reliable source (i.e., women's shelter or police) that the family's saf

Need Code

1865 Moving to Escape Family Violence

PROCEDURES

Moving Out of Alberta – Relocation

LISA automatically posts the allowance to the **Scratch Pad**.

The worker enters a [CCD Alert](#) using **Alert Code 25 Relocation** and an explanation.

If the client reapplies for benefits within 12 months of the move and is eligible, the worker:

1. Informs the client of the debt owing for the repayment of their moving costs.
2. Enters the debt in the Recoveries System.

3. Informs the client of the monthly deduction from their benefits.

Special Diets

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 21](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To describe the special diet benefits that may be provided to eligible household units to assist v

POLICY

Individuals who require a special diet for health reasons are provided an allowance to cover the special diet.

The rates in the table below have been set by the Minister. Rates for special diets are not subje Minister.

For more information on nutritional requirements of these diets, see [Special Diets Helpful Inform](#)

Special Diets
Low Sodium
Low Cholesterol or Low Fat - Low cholesterol or low fat have similar nutritional requirements. - Either low cholesterol or low fat is issued, not both.
High Fibre
High Calcium
High Protein
Lactose Free Either lactose free or milk free would be issued, not both.

Low or High Potassium

Baby's needs – Pregnancy

- All women who are pregnant or become pregnant must be issued these special diet funds.
 - A woman pregnant with twins is issued two times the pregnancy special diet rate.
-

Baby's needs – Breast feeding mother (of baby up to 12 months old)

- Funds must be issued for breastfeeding and/or infant formula.
 - A breastfeeding mother of twins may be issued two times the breastfeeding special diet.
 - In cases where the baby is being breast fed **and** on infant formula, both special diets should be
-

Baby's needs – Infant formula

It is recommended that, whenever possible, infant formula is issued as a Health Benefit. Alternatively special diet.

- Funds must be issued for infant formula and/or for breastfeeding (Baby's needs – Breastfeeding)
- Workers should review the continued need for the infant formula benefit when the child is app

Infant formula as a Health Benefit:

- Several formulas are included on the [Interactive Drug Benefit List](#) and are covered benefits on prescription by an authorized prescriber.
- **Requests for any other infant formula may be authorized by HBEC**
- Clients eligible for health benefits may access these infant formulas with the Health Benefits C

Infant formula as a Special Diet:

- When infant formula is funded as a special diet, the worker may issue the difference between the formula, up to \$238.00/month.
- Director Approval is required if the cost is over \$238.00/month
- **An estimate of the monthly cost from a health care professional (nurse, dietician, nurse p**

As First Nations clients are not eligible for Health Benefits Cards, they may receive special diet funds

High Calorie (over 2,500 calories)

- If Boost, Ensure or similar high calorie supplements are prescribed, then do not issue funds for

HIV/AIDS or Hepatitis C • These are different medical conditions but have the same nutritional requirements. • Even if a person has both conditions, only one is issued, not both.
Diabetic or Heart Healthy • Diabetic and heart healthy are different medical conditions but have the same nutritional requirements. Only one diet is issued, not both. • This diet also contains the nutritional elements covered in low cholesterol, low fat, and low sodium. These elements should not be duplicated either.
Milk Free • Either milk free or lactose free would be issued, not both.
Celiac/Gluten Free
Renal Failure/Insufficiency • Contains the nutritional elements covered in high calorie, high protein, low sodium, low potassium, and heart healthy. Those diet amounts are not to be duplicated.

If a client requests a special diet not on the list, the worker may issue **\$26.00** pending approval. If both diets are issued, the rates for both diets are issued, except in the circumstances noted above.

Note

If the dietary need for the identified medical condition is addressed by a listed special diet, no additional diet is considered.

Nutritional Products and Supplements

The special diet allowance is intended for the purchase of food items. Many nutritional products are listed on the [Interactive Drug Benefit List](#) and can be provided through the Health Benefits Card.

First Nations Clients Accessing Nutritional Supplements

The Government of Canada's Non-Insured Health Benefits (NIHB) program provides health benefits to eligible First Nations clients. First Nations clients are eligible to receive Health Benefits through Income Support.

The NIHB program does not provide coverage for nutritional supplements.

A benefit may be provided at the actual cost of the nutritional supplement so that these clients receive a health care professional that they:

- require nutritional supplements,
- the number of nutritional supplements required per day, and
- the duration that the supplements will be required.

Substantiation

For Baby's Needs - Pregnancy

- Confirmation from a health care professional or a verbal or written statement from the client

For Baby's Needs – Breast-Feeding:

- Verbal or written confirmation from the client that she is breast-feeding and for how long.

For Baby's Formula – Infant Formula

- Letter from a physician, dietician, or nurse confirming the need and the duration the special diet is required.
- Estimate of the cost.

All other special diets:

- A letter from a physician, dietician or registered nurse explaining the medical condition, the duration, and the cost.
- The worker may request additional documentation if the worker deems it necessary.
- If documentation exists on file to show a recipient has a specific health condition listed in the plan document.
- If it is clearly understood from the available documentation that a condition is permanent, the worker may request additional documentation.
- Some special diets have additional substantiation requirements. These include:
 - **Lactose Free** – Test results confirming lactose intolerance are required.
 - **Milk Free** – Test results confirming casein allergy are required.
 - **Celiac or Gluten Free** – Test results confirming Gluten intolerance are required.

Note

Test result requirements for these special diets may be met by a medical interpretation of

PROCEDURES

Need Code

1701 Special Diet

If a client has requested a special diet but has not provided the required substantiation document, the worker must send a [DS13096 Special Diet](#) letter to the client to identify the substantiation documents required to assist with the request.

When the need for a special diet has been established, the worker:

- Issues the table rate for one or more diets.
- Records in **Compass Comments** the:
 - type of special diet (e.g. low cholesterol),
 - related medical condition (e.g. heart condition), and
 - length of time the special diet is likely to be required.
- Establishes the time period for confirmation of continuing need if the medical condition is likely to be ongoing.

Workers do not issue funds as a Special Diet for nutritional products or vitamins. When a client requests funds for nutritional products or vitamins, the worker must follow the [Prescription/Non-Prescription Drugs and Nutritional Products](#) policy.

Note

Requests for nutritional supplements made by First Nations clients covered by NIHB follow the [First Nations Nutrition Policy](#).

Special Transportation and Travel Payment

Last updated on: Dec 03, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 2\(3\)\(e\) and Schedule 4, section 4](#)
[Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates](#)

INTENT

To assist with unusual travel-related expenses incurred when clients are required to travel in special circumstances.

POLICY

A benefit may be provided to cover the costs of return transportation, accommodation, and/or food and lodging for the following reasons:

- To reach a place of safety
- To receive treatment for a health-related matter (e.g., addictions, medical, etc.),
- To comply with Child Support Services (CSS) requirements, **or**
- To make a mandatory appearance in a criminal court proceeding within Alberta.

This benefit is issued **only** to the person(s) who is/are required to travel. If another member of the household is required to travel, a separate benefit for the accompanying person can also be issued.

NOTE

[Core Essential](#) is intended to be used for the cost of basic transportation, such as regular bus or train fares. Payment should only be issued for eligible unusual travel-related expenses, where basic transportation is not available.

Substantiation

To substantiate the need for the Special Transportation and Travel Payment:

- **Reaching a Place of Safety:**
 - The client's verbal statement; or
 - Workers knowledge of the need for safety (e.g., fleeing abuse); or
 - If there is any significant doubt, evidence from another professional source (e.g., police officer, social worker, etc.); or
- **Receiving Treatment for a health related matter:**
 - For frequent treatment, a letter from a physician, nurse practitioner, the treatment facility (e.g., hospital, clinic, etc.) or a community health worker (e.g., community health worker, etc.) outlining the frequency of treatment; or

- For one-off situations where it is impractical to obtain documentation, a client's verbal statement.
- **Complying with CSS:**
 - If the worker has knowledge of the client's situation, the client's verbal statement; or
 - Confirmation from CSS; or
 - A copy of a court document.
- **Appearing in Criminal Court:**
 - If the worker has knowledge of the client's situation, the client's verbal statement; or
 - The worker's knowledge of the need to appear in court; or
 - A copy of the court document.

To substantiate the cost:

- Client's verbal statement. Quotes may be requested at the worker's discretion.

Special Transportation and Travel Payment Rates

- **Rate for Transportation**
- The most economic and reasonable means of travel:
 - Actual cost of public transportation, **or**
 - Private vehicle – same as the per kilometer rate for [Transportation to Day or Employment](#)
 - Actual cost of a taxi

Need Code

1828 Non-Emergency Travel

1844 Emergency Transportation (when travel is provided in conjunction with the [Emergency](#))

1848 Emergency Shelter Safety (when travel is provided in conjunction with the Emergency Shelter Safety)

- **Rate for Accommodation**
Actual cost of reasonable hotel, motel or other accommodation for each member of the family.

Need Code

1863 Non-Emergency Accommodation

- **Rate for Food**

When the member or members of the household unit are required to travel outside the co

- Adult: Same as the daily food rate in the [Emergency Allowance](#) policy
- Child: Same as the daily food rate in the [Emergency Allowance](#) policy

Need Code

1864 Non-Emergency Food

1850 Emergency Food Travel (when food is provided in conjunction with the Emerg

- **Rate for Child Care**

Actual cost of reasonable childcare (babysitting, licensed or approved child care) as appr

Need Code

1866 Other Non-Continuous Needs (Non-Emergency-Child Care)

1840 Emergency Child Care (when child care is being provided in conjunction with the Er

- **Child Care**

See the [Child Care](#) policy if child care is required in conjunction with the special transport:

Transportation to Day or Employment Programs

Last updated on: Jan 01, 2026

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10*](#)
[*Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 4, section 15\(2\)*](#)
[*Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates*](#)

INTENT

To provide transportation benefits to enable Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) clients to attend

POLICY

This benefit is provided to cover expenses associated with transportation to attend a day or em

- Is assigned to the BFE sub-type, **and**
- Travels by the most economical means of transportation.

Where the individual cannot reasonably be expected to use public transportation (taxi, bus) to t
appropriate transportation means.

Rate

- An allowance equal to the actual cost of public transportation (bus pass, taxi) **or**
- When public transportation cannot be used, an allowance equal to **\$0.17 per kilometer**.

Note

This amount is in addition to rates issued under [Employment Training and Transition Sup](#)

Substantiation

Clients substantiate their need for transportation to a Day or Employment program by providing
program, how often they are to attend, and the length of the program.

Need Code

1723 Transportation – Day or Employment Program

PROCEDURES

The worker:

- Confirms with the SPD worker that transportation is not included as part of the agency cor
- Documents this confirmation in [Compass Comments](#)

Utility Connection, Deposit, Reconnection

Last updated on: Aug 26, 2024

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, section 10*](#)
[*Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 99\(d\)\(i\); Schedule 2, section*](#)
[*Ministerial Order 2018-19, Appendix D: Schedule 4 - Supplementary Income Support Rates*](#)

INTENT

This benefit is intended to provide assistance with the connection, reconnection or deposit of sp

POLICY

An allowance to obtain water, power and heat service may be provided under conditions identifi
deposit or arrears.

Ongoing utility charges are paid for as part of the Core Shelter allowance.

Substantiation for benefits in this section is a utility bill or statement.

Utility arrears may be provided per [Emergency Allowance](#) policy and may include amounts for u

Utility Connection

An allowance is issued to an applicant or recipient if connection charges are required to secure
separately. Each type of utility (water, heat, power) is tracked and issued separately in both [Co](#)
payment is generated by LISA. Once the payment is generated, the worker must edit the paym

Need Code

1817 Utility Connection

Rate

Actual cost

Utility Deposits

An allowance is issued to an applicant or recipient if a deposit is required to secure water, powe

The first deposit for each utility issued is not recovered but subsequent deposits are subject to r
[0976B Repayment Agreement](#). If the client refuses to sign the repayment agreement the bene

A forfeited utility deposit is not recovered. Refunded utility deposits are not treated as income. I
[Income](#) policy

Need Code

1820 Utility Deposit

Rate

Actual cost

Utility Reconnection

An allowance is issued to an applicant or recipient for utility reconnection when the utility has been tracked and issued separately in both [Compass Comments](#) and LISA Scratch Pad. LISA Scratch Pad generated, the worker must edit the payment in LISA Scratch pad to show the utility company name.

All reconnections for utilities are subject to recovery. The worker notifies the client they must agree to sign the repayment agreement the benefit is not issued.

Need Code

1829 Utility Reconnection

Rate

Actual cost

PROCEDURES

LISA automatically posts the benefit to the Scratch Pad. When a client requests a utility connection,

1. check the Scratch pad to determine if a connection, deposit or reconnection for that participant has been made.
 2. have the client sign the **EMP 0976B Repayment Agreement** if a connection or deposit has been made.
 3. issue the connection, deposit or reconnection fee,
 4. enter the debt into the Recoveries System if required and,
 5. edit the payment in LISA,
 6. record in Scratch pad to show the utility company and utility type for each connection, deposit or reconnection.
-

08 Income

General Policy

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\), section 5\(2\)\(b\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 1\(3\)\(b\)\(i\) and 23; S](#)

INTENT

To define how income is treated when determining program eligibility and the monthly benefit amount.

Income

The income of household members is used to determine program eligibility and the amount of money that is available to household members during a benefit period of assistance and includes:

- [Employment and self-employment income](#);
- Room and board and rental income from a principal residence; and
- Any other source of money available to the household unit that is not exempted under Section 5(2)(b)(i) of the [Cash Gifts](#).)

Notes:

- Some income received is not available to the household. See the [Available Income](#) policy.
- Some resources are not considered income. See the [Resources Not Considered Income](#) policy.
- Money an applicant or recipient saves following a benefit period of assistance, including the [Asset Exemptions](#) policy.

Calculating the Monthly Benefit Amount

The household's monthly benefit amount is calculated by determining the household's total assessed benefit eligibility. All calculations are rounded in accordance with the [Rounding Income](#) policy.

$$\text{Benefit Amount} = \text{Total Assessed Benefit Eligibility} - \text{Total Non-Exempt Income}$$

The components of this calculation are described below.

Total Assessed Benefit Eligibility:

The household's total assessed benefit eligibility is the sum of all core income support (Core ES)

household members are eligible for.

Total Non-Exempt Income:

There are two steps to determine Non-Exempt Income:

1. Determine the Net Amount
2. Subtract the exemptions

These steps are described below.

1. Determine the Net Amount:

The Net Amount is determined for each income type available to a household.

To determine the Net Amount, for each income type, subtract allowable deductions from t

Note: The “gross income” amount is the total amount for an income type prior to any dedu

Net Amount = Gross Amount – Allowable Income Deductions

2. Subtract the Exemptions:

Income exemptions are applied to the net amount of each income type. See the [Income E](#)

Non-Exempt Income = Net Amount – Income Exemptions

To determine the Total Non-Exempt Income, add up the non-exempt income for each income ty

Total Non-Exempt Income = Sum of non-exempt income of each income type

Notes:

- The household is not eligible if the total non-exempt income amount is equal to or ex
- There are some differences in the benefit calculation when determining initial eligibil details.
- If an applicant or recipient does not access income they are entitled to receive, bene received during a benefit period of assistance. See the [Eligibility Impacts](#) policy for fi
- Substantiation requirements for different kinds of income are available in the [Substa](#)

Available Income

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23\(2\)](#)

POLICY

“Income” is money that is available to a household unit during a benefit period of assistance. Money received.

Note:

For payments that have not been received, but are subject to repayment, see the [Overpayment](#)

There may be circumstances where money an applicant or recipient receives is not considered in the determination of eligibility and benefits as long as the applicant or recipient can provide appropriate

Example 1:

A recipient receives money from his/her roommate that is intended to pay the monthly rent. The money is used to pay the landlord his/her share of the rent.

If the recipient can substantiate that the funds belong to the roommate and are destined for the payment of the rent, the funds are not considered income for the determination of eligibility and benefits.

Example 2:

A recipient receives funds from a GoFundMe account. The fund was set-up by a colleague to help the recipient

Even though these funds have a specific intended purpose, they do belong to the recipient and are included in the determination of eligibility and benefits.

Example 3:

A recipient pays out-of-pocket for supplies for a fundraising event for a not-for-profit organization. The reimbursed amount shows up on the recipient's bank statement.

If the recipient can substantiate that the funds in the bank account were a reimbursement for out-of-pocket expenses, the funds are not considered income for the determination of eligibility and benefits.

Example 4:

A recipient raises funds for a charitable cause (e.g., collects funds as part of a walk for cancer research). The purpose of collecting these funds is to provide them to the person or organization the funds are intended to benefit.

If the recipient can substantiate the intended purpose of these funds, the amount is not considered income. If fundraising is complete, the recipient should provide substantiation that the funds were provided to the charitable cause.

Rounding Income

Last updated on: Jul 09, 2019

In **all** cases, both net income and the income exemption are rounded as follows:

When the net income or income exemption has a cents value less than 50 cents, the amount is

When the net income or income exemption has a cents value of 50 cents or more, the amount i

Example

A recipient reports net employment income of \$601.12. The worker rounds the income do

Rounding Benefits

This policy does not apply when entering benefits into LISA. Apply the [Rounding Benefits](#) policy

Resources Not Considered Income

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 23\(3\)\(e\) and Schedule 1](#)

INTENT

To identify resources that are not usually considered “income” in the determination of program eligibility.

POLICY

When determining program eligibility and the monthly benefit amount, the following resources are not considered income:

- Money received from Income Support;
- Certain types of refunds (e.g., income tax refunds, damage deposit refunds, utility rebates);
- [Gifts in kind](#);
- [Third party payment income](#);
- [Loans](#); and
- [Loan payments](#).

Note:

In some circumstances, substantiation may be required to validate that a payment is not income.

Gifts in Kind

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2011

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23\(3\)\(e\)](#)

POLICY

Goods and services received by an applicant or recipient under circumstances other than those estate or other assets are **not** income. However, the recipient is required to report an increase in need to be reported.

Exception

A "Gift in Kind" received by an applicant or recipient is considered income if the "Gift in Kind" is in addition to the arrangement for child and/or adult support, then the gift is not considered income.

Third Party Payments

Last updated on: Jun 15, 2009

A direct payment made by a third party on an applicant or recipient's behalf is usually **not** consi

Example 1

A recipient's family member pays all or part of the recipient's rent directly to the landlord. **not** issued.

Example 2

A family member gives money to the recipient to pay rent. The money is income and **must**

Exception

Payments made to an applicant's or recipient's agent (e.g., lawyer) are considered income. Pay

Example 1

A recipient owns a house, but does not live in it. The recipient rents the house to another | lawyer, who in turn makes the mortgage payments. The **full** amount of the rent is income

Example 2

A recipient owns a house, but does not live in it. The recipient rents the house to another | mortgage company. The rent is **not** income. However this house would be an asset.

Payments made to an agency, business or person (e.g. landlord) on an applicants or recipients made to the person directly.

Loans

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2011

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 2, section 1\(1\)\(o\)](#)

POLICY

Money loaned to a recipient by a financial institution, under a written repayment agreement, is r
to the liquid asset limits.

Exception

Loans arranged through Students Finance (SF) **are** income. These loans are meant to pr

Money loaned to an **applicant** or recipient by any source other than a financial institution is con

Loan Payments

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

Loan payments made on a recipient's behalf are **not** income.

Example 1

A friend makes loan payments on a recipient's car directly to the lender. The money is **not** the client's debt, the client must report an increase in vehicle equity (asset). The increase equ

Example 2

A separated or divorced spouse continues to make mortgage payments on the matrimonial home. The spouse must report increase in assets because exemption of the home depends on value, not equity.

Allowable Income Deductions

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23\(4\).](#)

INTENT

To allow for certain deductions when determining a household's income.

POLICY

All sources of income available to household members are considered when determining eligibility types.

“Allowable income deductions” are amounts that are **not** included when determining the income available to a household to determine the associated net income amount.

Note

Allowable income deductions are not the same as [Income Exemptions](#). Income exemption or income type are needed before program eligibility and monthly benefits can be determined.

Allowable income deductions are outlined in the following policies:

- [Employment and Self-Employment Income](#) policy;
- [Room and Board / Rental Income Deductions](#) policy; and the
- [Income Deducted at Source to Repay Other Programs](#) policy.

In addition to the circumstances addressed in the policies above, some other income types receive “mandatory deduction” is a deduction that is required and that a person cannot opt out of. These situations are:

If the recipient can substantiate that a portion of an income type is subject to a mandatory deduction, it must be included for the purpose of establishing eligibility and benefits.

Notes

In cases of garnishments from employment income and income deducted at source to repay a debt, see the [Employment and Self-Employment Income](#) and [Income Deducted at Source to Repay Debt](#) policies.

Employment and Self-Employment Income

Last updated on: Jan 26, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 23\(3\)\(a\) and \(b\), \(4](#)

POLICY

Employment Income

Employment income includes money earned by an applicant or recipient from a range of source. Income from the following sources are also considered employment income:

- [Vacation Pay](#);
- [Earnings in Kind](#); and
- [Skill Fees](#).

Employment Income Deductions

Certain amounts are deducted from the gross employment income of clients to determine net earnings. The following are allowable income deductions from employment income:

Government of Canada Deductions:

- Income tax;
- Canada Pension Plan contributions; and
- Employment Insurance premiums.

Deductions as a Condition of Employment:

- Any deductions required by an employer as a condition of employment, such as contributions to a pension plan.

Note:

If a client claims deductions are a condition of employment, the worker **must** see a list of deductions and must pay the deductions.

Garnishments from Employment Income:

When a creditor garnishees a debtor's employment income, part of the income is withheld at source. This is not an allowable income deduction when calculating a client's employment income.

The worker informs the applicant or recipient that all future payments on the garnishee order will apply to the court to vary the garnishee order (i.e., reduce the amount withheld).

Note:

The [Income Deducted at Source to Repay Other Programs](#) policy addresses garnishment

Employment Income Exemptions

The income exemptions for employment income are as follows:

Adult Members

- When earned by an adult member of a household unit with only one adult, the first \$
- When earned by an adult member with a cohabiting partner, the first \$115 plus 25%

Dependent Child

- When earned by a dependent child who is **not** attending school, the first \$350 plus 2
- When earned by a dependent child while attending school, 100% is exempt.
- All employment income of dependent children who are in school or in the summer m

Note:

If a client fails to report employment income and there is intent to mislead the department income, but reports it the following month, the earned income exemption is applied.

Self-Employment Income

Self-Employment income includes money earned by a client from a range of sources such as a self-employment income. In some cases, self-employment income may come from a home-bas

Self-Employment Income Deductions

Certain amounts are deducted from the gross self-employment income of applicants and recipients (for further details.) The following are allowable income deductions from self-employment income:

- Government of Canada self-employment deductions for income tax, Canada Pension
- All deductions required by law, including business taxes and business license fees;
- Reasonable cost of materials, supplies, goods and services that are **essential** to the
 - Interest (but not principal) payments on a loan made for the purpose of the bus
 - Advertising costs, accounting and legal fees, bank service charges;

- Insurance, license, rental, repair and operating expenses of motor vehicles and
- Delivery, express and freight charges including postage;
- Veterinary services related to the business or farming operation;
- Materials and supplies used in warranty work; and
- Business-related facility costs:
 - lease payments;
 - mortgage interest but not principal payments;
 - property taxes;
 - fire insurance;
 - liability insurance;
 - telephone;
 - utilities; and
 - reasonable maintenance and repairs.

- In-home child care provider costs that are a condition of the contract with the client.
- Notes**

- No facility costs are allowed for home-based businesses unless the client provides a telephone line for the business). Shelter costs (rent, mortgage, utilities, etc.) are paid whether or not they operated a business from their home.
- Clients who provide child care in their own homes can claim the cost of food as a business-related expense, only if providing food and other items are a condition of the contract for themselves or their families. Examples of required items to run a business include:

The business person or farmer reports net self-employment income and changes in assets through the [EMP 5515 Net Self-Employment Income](#) form. The worker may ask the

Self-Employment Income Exemptions

All net **self-employment income** is deducted dollar for dollar from program benefits and is coded

Home Based Business – Barriers to Full Employment (BFE)

- Where the BFE adult member of a household unit with only one adult is operating a business, the unit is exempt.

- Where a BFE adult member is operating a home based business and has a cohabiti

Home Based Business – Child Care Services – Expected to Work (ETW)

- Where the adult member of a household unit with only one adult provides child care
- Where the adult member with a cohabiting partner provides child care in their home,

Dependent Child – BFE and ETW

- The first \$350 plus 25% of the remainder of the net monthly income for a dependent
- 100% of net self-employment income earned by a dependent child **while attending**

For those who are eligible to receive the self-employment income exemptions, the self-employe
Dependent Child(ren).

Note:

If a client fails to report self-employment income and there is intent to mislead the departm
income, but reports it the following month, the earned income exemption is applied.

Entering Employment and Self-Employment Income

- The worker enters the client's income that is not 100% exempt as reported on the C earnings exemptions for adult members.
 - **Dependent Child Not Attending School**
If the dependent child is not attending school, the worker manually calculates the ea
 - See [LISA Codes](#) to enter partially exempt income and deductions
-

Room and Board / Rental Income Deductions

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 23\(4\)\(d\), \(e\) and 23\(4\)\(f\)](#)

POLICY

Room and Board Income

The gross income amount received by an applicant or recipient from a room and board arrangement is:

Note:

A recipient who lives with relatives who are also receiving Income Support benefits is not a "tenant". Do not deduct this money from the "landlord's" benefits.

The gross income amount received by an applicant or recipient from a rental arrangement in the community is:

Gross rental income from a property that is not the applicant or recipient's principal residence is:

Notes:

- Staff must determine that a rental situation exists before applying the above policy. If a recipient provides a lump-sum payment to the landlord. In these cases, the money collected is not income for a purpose other than paying the rent. See the [Available Income](#) policy for more information.
 - If a recipient fails to report all or part of their room and board and/or rental income and where a recipient receives late income, but reports it the following month, the income is not deductible.
-

Income Deducted at Source to Repay Other Progra

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23](#)

POLICY

Section 23(4)(b)(ii) of the ISTHB Regulation **only** applies to garnishee orders on employment in (e.g., buying back a portion of their pension, overpayments, etc.) from a source like:

- Employment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation
- Canada Pension Plan
- Quebec Pension Plan

For **one month only**, the amount the client actually receives from an income source is counted

Rationale

The one-month grace period allows the client time to negotiate with the creditor. The client may deduction lowered.

In the second and all subsequent months, the worker counts the amount of income before auto

Income Exemptions (Full, Partial and Non-Exempt)

Last updated on: Jul 23, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 1\(1\)\(j\), 23\(3\)\(e\) and Ministerial Order 2020-016 Canada Emergency Response Benefit](#)
[MO 2021-005 – Canada Recovery Benefits](#)
[MO 2021-019 - ISTHB Exemption – CRB Payments Extension](#)

INTENT

Certain types of income are fully or partially exempt to ensure that:

- Clients have incentives to earn money from employment
- Clients get the benefit of specific federal and provincial financial supports available to them
- Clients may have some resources they can use to purchase items that are not available to them
- Dependent children are encouraged to accumulate savings for their future.

POLICY

Under Income Support, income may be considered fully exempt, partially exempt or non-exempt. The following income types are considered fully exempt:

- [Fully Exempt Income](#)
 - **Canada Recovery Benefits (CRB)** - September 27, 2020 to June 30, 2021:
 - The three types of CRB payments intended as income for the eligibility period of an individual who was an existing member of an Income Support household
 - Households receiving CRB payments that apply to these periods will not be considered as income

Note

The temporary exemption on CRB income does not apply to Income Support. The Canada Recovery Benefit, Canada Recovery Sickness Benefit and Canada Recovery Tax Credit are not considered as income.

The following income types are considered partially exempt:

- [Employment and Self-Employment Income](#)

- **Canada Emergency Response Benefit (CERB)** payments are combined with partial exemption as [Employment and Self-Employment Income](#). For new appl
- [Awards, Prizes and Cash Gifts](#).

All other income is considered non-exempt income.

Canada Disability Benefit (CDB) payments are non-exempt income.

Canada Worker Lockdown Benefit (CWLB) payments are treated in the same manner as EI I

- [Allowable Income Deductions](#) may apply to partially exempt and non-exempt income
 - Some [resources are not considered income](#).
-

Fully Exempt Income

Last updated on: Mar 26, 2026

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 1\(1\)\(j\), 23\(3\)\(e\) and](#)
[MO 2018-19 Appendix C: Schedule 2 - Exempt Financial Resources](#)
[MO 2016-18 Exemption of Alberta Child Welfare Class Action Settlement](#)
[MO 2016-01 Exemption of Alberta Child Benefit](#)
[MO 2016-15 Exempt Retroactive Guaranteed Income Supplement Payments](#)
[MO 2016-24 Castle Mountain Land and Timber Claim Settlement](#)
[MO 2016-17 Exemption of Disaster Relief Payments](#)
[MO 2017-03 Clegg Class Action Settlement](#)
[MO 2017-13 Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements](#)
[MO 2017-17 Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2018-15 Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty 8 Lands and Benefits Claim Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2019-02 Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2019-07 Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2019-09 Canada Workers Benefit](#)
[MO 2019-10 – Pain and Suffering Compensation](#)
[MO 2019-12 – Additional Pain and Suffering Compensation](#)
[MO 2020-003 – Final Settlement Agreement \(Ross, Roy and Satalic and Her Majesty the Queen\)](#)
[MO 2020-005 – Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the Queen Class Action Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2020-007 – Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2020-009 - Alberta Child and Family Benefit](#)
[MO 2020-013 – Federal Indian Day Schools \(McLean\) Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2020-023 - Canada Emergency Student Benefit](#)
[MO 2020-024 - Empowering food insecure Albertans to manage their diabetes through a subsidy](#)
[MO 2020-025 - Federal One-Time Payment to Persons with Disabilities in response to COVID-19](#)
[MO 2021-005 – Canada Recovery Benefits](#)
[MO 2021-003 - Heroes Fund](#)
[MO 2021-008 - Covid Self-Isolation Payment](#)
[MO 2021-010 - Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific Claim Settlement](#)
[MO 2021-012 - Working Parents Benefit](#)
[MO 2021-014 - Critical Worker Benefit](#)
[MO 2021-016 – Memorial Grant Program Payments](#)
[MO-2021-019 ISTHB Exemption – CRB Payments Extension](#)
[MO 2021-025 - Mosquito Grizzly Bear Head Lean Man First Nation](#)
[MO 2021-027 - Peepeekisis First Nation](#)
[MO 2021-030 - Vaccine Incentive Debit Cards](#)
[MO 2022-010 – Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2023-004 - Canada Dental Benefit and Canada Housing Benefit Payments](#)
[MO 2023-07 – Canadian Armed Forces/Department of National Defense/Canadian Forces Class Action Settlement](#)
[MO 2023-024 - Compassionate payments to individuals impacted by the September 2023 E. coli outbreak](#)
[MO 2023-025 – Manitoba Developmental Centre \(Weremy v Manitoba\) Class Action Settlement](#)
[MO 2024-015 – First Nation Drinking Water Advisory Class Actions Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO 2025-015 - Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement](#)
[MO 2025-017 - Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement](#)
[MO-2025-027- Parent Payment Program Exemption](#)

INTENT

To define resources that are fully exempt as income in the determination of program eligibility a

POLICY

Schedule 2 of the Income Support, Training and Health Benefits (ISTHB) Regulation, along with eligibility and the monthly benefit amount a household unit is eligible to receive.

Note

Income exemptions are different from [Resources Not Considered Income](#) and [Allowable I](#)

The following sections outline payments that are fully exempt income.

'Harm Done' Payments

'Harm Done' payments can relate to a wide range of 'harms' such as physical, cultural, or historical harm done to a person or community as a result of a settlement agreement involving the Government of Canada or a Territory of Canada.

The following 'harm done' payments are fully exempt:

Payment
A payment received under Schedule A or B to the 1986-1990 Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement other than: • A payment under section 4.02 of the Agreement for loss of income, or • A payment under section 6.01 of the Agreement for loss of support resulting from the death of the infected person.
A payment received for the pre-1986 and post 1990 Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement
Compensation for a member of the household unit having been infected with the HIV virus through the blood supply
A benefit paid under the Victims of Crime Act except for any portion paid for lost income
A Common Experience Payment (CEP) and Independent Assessment Process Payments (IAP) under the Residential Schools Settlement Agreement
Clegg Class Action Settlement payments (2017)
Compensation payments made under the Final Settlement Agreement between Ross, Roy and Satalic and Her Majesty the Queen for policies and actions taken against Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual and Transgender (LGBTQ2S+) individuals

federal public servants (2020)
Compensation payments made under the Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the Queen Class Action Settlement Agreement for policies that resulted in reduced pension benefits of disabled Veterans (2020)
Compensation payments made under the Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement (2020)
Compensation payments made under the Federal Indian Day Schools (McLean) Settlement Agreement
Japanese Canadian Redress Agreement
Extraordinary Assistance Plan
Huron Regional Centre Class Action Settlement
A Child Welfare Class Action Settlement payment from the Government of Alberta
Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) - Department of National Defense (DND) Sexual Misconduct Class Action Settlement.
Compensation payments made to a class member under the Manitoba Developmental Centre Settlement Agreement (Weremy v Manitoba) (2023)
Compensation payments from the Government of Canada made to an Individual Class Member under the Nation Drinking Water Advisory Class Actions Settlement Agreement (2021)
Compensation payments from the Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement (2023)
Compensation payments under the First Nations Child and Family Services, Jordan's Principle and Treaty Settlement Agreement (2025)

Specific Claims Agreements

Specific Claims Agreements are a type of harm done payment. These claims are filed by the First Nations.

The following specific claim agreements are fully exempt:

Payment	Notes
A payment received from Tsuut'ina First Nation as a result of the Final Calgary Ring-Road Agreement dated November 27, 2013	Agreement is between Tsuut'ina First Nation
Payments made to a First Nation under an agreement with the Government of Canada for a specific land claim (surrender): Duncan First Nation Land Settlement Claim	

• O'Chiese First Nations Land Settlement Claim • Bigstone Cree Nation and Peerless Trout First Nation Treat 8 Land Settlement • Mikisew Cree First Nation Settlement Agreement • Castle Mountain Land and Timber Claim Settlement (2016) • Mosquito Grizzly Bear's Head Lean Man First Nation Settlement (2021)	
Government of Alberta Siksika Land Settlement Claim regarding Bassano Dam	

Per Capita Distribution Payments

A payment of a non-recurring nature received from a First Nation that is paid equally to each member

Payment	Notes
A payment of a non-recurring nature received from a First Nation that is paid equally to each member on the First Nations Band List	Examples of non-recurring payments • Agricultural Benefits • The Piikani Nation • The Lubicon Lake • The Blood Tribe M • The Missanabie Cr • The Enoch Cree N • Peepeekisis First N • Siksika Nation Glo • Robinson Huron T1 • Athabasca Chipew

Disaster Relief/Recovery Payments

Disaster relief/recovery payments are made to individuals who have been impacted by disaster: to repair damaged property, or to replace lost/destroyed property.
The following disaster/recovery payments are fully exempt:

Payment
A Slave Lake Wildfire Relief Payment or a payment under the Emergency Accommodation Program to mandatory evacuation order
Compensation pursuant to a Disaster Recovery Program for the June 2013 floods
Payments issued by a charitable organization for the June 2013 floods
Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta for damage or loss caused by a disaster
Payments issued by a charitable organization for a disaster determined by the Government of Alberta

Tax Benefits/Rebates

Certain tax benefits/rebates provided to low income Albertans by the federal or provincial government. The following payments received for tax benefits/rebates are fully exempt:

Payment
Alberta Child and Family Benefits (ACFB) payments received from the Government of Alberta
A Canada Child Benefit (CCB) under the Income Tax Act (Canada)
A Goods and Services Tax credit (GST) received from the Government of Canada
Money received from a management body under the Alberta Housing Act for the payment of utilities or electricity
Money received under a program of the Government of Canada or Alberta for home repairs or renovations
A payment, refund or credit directly or indirectly from the Government of Canada or Alberta that is designed to reduce the energy costs of consumers from high energy costs
The Canada Workers Benefit received from the Government of Canada

Compensation for deposits or rent supplements

The following table lists fully exempt income for payments received for damage deposits, moving expenses, and compensation for deposits or rent supplements.

Payment	Notes
A refunded damage deposit under a tenancy agreement or a refunded deposit paid in respect of a utility or telephone	
A moving allowance provided by a landlord on termination of a tenancy agreement	
Rent Assistance Benefit from the Rent Supplement Program	Formerl
Canada Housing Benefit	One-tim
Canada Housing Benefit for Survivors of Gender-Based Violence (CHB GBV)	The CH provinci

Compensation for the Care of Others

The following table lists fully exempt income for payments received for the care of others.

Payment	Notes
A payment received by a member of the household unit pursuant to an order for the support of a child who is not a member of the household unit	This exemption who is not a de client.
Payments of arrears of child support that are not owing to the government.	Arrears are onl See the Child s
A payment made under a Government of Alberta program to reimburse living expenses of a person who is living with the member not normally part of the household unit.	This exemption • Foster pa • Supporte • Host fan • Guardian

Employment/Training Resources

The following table lists fully exempt income for payments received for employment/training res

Payment
A grant or loan to start a business, from a federal or provincial government department or agency or fro

A loan from a financial institution, excluding a government loan for post-secondary studies
A payment made by the Government of Canada or Alberta for part-time training costs as follows: • Part-time Canada Student Loan (Government of Canada) • Canada Student Grant for Part-time Studies (Government of Canada) • Canada Student Grant for Persons with Permanent Disabilities (Government of Canada) • Canada Student Grant for Services and Equipment for Persons with Permanent Disabilities (Government of Canada) • Skills Investment Bursary (Government of Alberta)
A payment made by the Government of Canada or Alberta for Disability Related Employment Support: with disabilities to access Community and Social Services funded full or part-time training programs are

Compensation and Other Income:

The following table lists fully exempt income for payments received for compensation and other

Payment
Withdrawals from a Registered Disability Savings Plan (RDSP)
Money received as compensation for loss or damage to property of a member of the household, repair or replace the property within a reasonable time or is used for some other purpose, with
Money received from the Government of Alberta to assist a person with a disability in purchasing the person to live in the community.
Roth/Fifield Class Action Settlement Agreement from the Government of Alberta

A retroactive Guaranteed Income Supplement payment
Proceeds from Calgary Dollars or Cochrane Dollars
Payment for participation in the University of Calgary Research Project: “Empowering food insecure people with diabetes through a subsidized healthy food prescription program”
Canada Emergency Student Benefit payments received from the Government of Canada while attending post-secondary education
One-time payment to persons with disabilities in response to COVID-19 received from the Government of Canada
Veterans Affairs Canada Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the Government of Canada
Veterans Affairs Canada Additional Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the Government of Canada
Canada Recovery Benefit (CRB) payments intended as income for the eligibility periods beginning on March 15, 2020 and ending on June 30, 2021 when received by an existing member of an Income Support household. 7
• Canada Recovery Benefit; • Canada Recovery Sickness Benefit; and • Canada Recovery Caregiving Benefit
Payments from the Heroes Fund received from the Government of Alberta
COVID Self-Isolation payments issued by the Government of Alberta, after the person completes their self-isolation/quarantine period in hotel, as required by Alberta Health Services.
Working Parents Benefit payments received from the Government of Alberta
Critical Worker Benefit payments received from the Government of Canada and the Government of Alberta
Memorial Grant Program payments received from the Government of Canada
COVID-19 Vaccine Incentive payments received from the Government of Alberta
Canada Dental Benefit

Affordability payments received from the Government of Alberta

Compassionate payments from the Government of Alberta to individuals impacted by the St. Elizabeth's Hospital closure and the St. Elizabeth's Hospital Calgary childcare facilities

Parent Payment Program benefits to help ease the extra costs families may face while children are in childcare starting in October 2025

Vacation Pay

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

Some employers add the legally required vacation pay to the worker's wages. Others give the employee a separate vacation pay cheque. Employees who are not eligible for the earnings exemption.

Canada Emergency Response Benefit Income

Last updated on: Jan 26, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 23\(3\)\(e\), 23\(6\) and Ministerial Order 2020-016 – Canada Emergency Response Benefit](#)

INTENT

To define how to treat Canada Emergency Response Benefit (CERB) payments when determinin

POLICY

Canada Emergency Response Benefit (CERB) Payments

In 2020, The Government of Canada provided CERB to eligible Canadians who stopped workin

Combine CERB payments with the household's employment and self-employment income, if ar
Refer to the [Employment and Self-Employment Income](#) policy to see the partial exemptions.

For new applicants, see the [Income at Intake](#) policy.

Note: For payments received retroactively, subject to repayment, see the [Overpayments](#) :

Entering CERB Payments

Enter CERB payments into LISA using the same codes as employment income:

- 4101 Employment Earning Head of Household
- 4102 Employment Earnings for Partner
- 4103 Employment Earning Child(ren)

Workers must enter a Compass Comment including the following information:

- Statement that the client received a CERB payment;
 - The amount of the CERB; and
 - The period of assistance for which the CERB was paid.
-

Earnings in Kind

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

Earnings in kind – that is, goods and services received in payment for employment are considered

Example

A single parent with two children manages an apartment building. The rent on her suite is \$400 a month and includes utilities. This means, she is earning \$400 a month **in kind**. The worker instructs the client to report these earnings in kind under **Income Code 4101** and reflects the client's actual shelter in LISA :

A **self-employed** person who is paid in kind does not get the earnings exemption. However, this is still considered income.

Skill Fees

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23\(3\)\(a\); Schedule 2](#)

POLICY

Skill fees are employment income. Skill fees are payments made to foster parents to compensate

Skill fees include:

- Money paid to foster parents under the *Child, Youth and Family Enhancement Act* and pro
- Money paid to host families caring for disabled adults.

The foster parent must provide the payment approval form (supplied by the Child and Family Services) of an ordinary or extraordinary nature. All maintenance costs are 100% exempt.

Skill fees for host families are calculated by the region.

Note

Payments under the Post-Adoption Support and Child Financial Support (CFS) programs Schedule 2, Section 1(1)(i).

Awards, Prizes and Cash Gifts

Last updated on: Feb 14, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, Schedule 2, sections 1\(1\)\(p\), 1\(1\)\(q\)
MO 2018-19 - Income Support Rates with Indexing](#)

POLICY

When determining program eligibility and the monthly benefit amount, the following resources apply:

Awards and Prizes

An award or prize received by a member of the household unit for outstanding academic or community achievement.

Note

Where the amount of the award or prize is more than \$3,500 and is determined to cover more than the prize or award was given.

Cash Gifts

Cash gifts of a non-recurring nature from any source to a maximum of \$900 per calendar year (per household) are calculated as a cumulative amount based on the number of members in the household.

Note

In some circumstances, substantiation may be required to validate the nature of the resource.

PROCEDURE

Documenting Cash Gifts

When the client has reported the **first** cash gift received by a member of the household in the calendar year, the worker will document the YTD total by:

- creating a High Priority Compass Comment titled “**YTD Cash Gifts (year).**” For example:
- indicating in the body of the Compass Comment the recipient of the cash gift (if indicated)
- including a YTD total for each member of the household in the Compass Comment.

For example:

Client reported \$100 cash gift for spouse (date)

YTD Total HH \$0

YTD Total SP \$100

For **subsequent** reports of cash gifts within the calendar year, the worker will:

- reply to the “**YTD Cash Gifts (year)**” Compass Comment, and
- add the recipient of the cash gift (if indicated), the date the cash gift was reported, the amount
For example:
Client reported \$100 cash gift for child (date)
YTD HH Total \$0
YTD SP Total \$100
YTD child Total \$100

When a **new calendar year** High Priority “**YTD Cash Gifts (year)**” Compass Comment is added:

- add a **new** High Priority Compass Comment, and
- update the previous year’s Compass Comment from High Priority to a Regular Priority Comment

Holding Benefits

The worker will put benefits on hold if:

- a family member is not specified, and the household total has been exceeded (e.g., two household members)

Benefits are **not** held if the recipient of the cash gift has not been specified but the YTD cash gift amount is within the household limit.

Note

When benefits are held, clients are advised to contact their worker or Contact Centre to discuss the cash gift. The worker should ensure the client has received the cash gift in the ‘message’ section of their report.

On-Going Assistance

Last updated on: Jan 17, 2020

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 22\(2\), 23\(1\), 23\(2\)](#)

POLICY

The worker determines if the applicant is eligible for ongoing Income Support assistance by using the family's total monthly income using the net monthly employment income of the adults in the family, less family necessities and compares this sum against the total monthly income. If the family's total monthly income is less than the total monthly income, the family is eligible for **on-going** assistance. The worker may want to consider the possibility of a [One-Time Issue](#).

Income spent before an application is taken is not used to determine eligibility or in the calculation of the liquid **asset** and is subject to asset exemption limits.

After the [EMP 3428 Income Support Application](#) is signed, income earned during the same month is used to determine eligibility.

When adding a spouse/partner to an active file, any income of the spouse/partner that was spent on the household is considered as a **recipient** for the purpose of the treatment of employment income.

When adding a spouse/partner to an active file, the [EMP 2004 Notice of Eligibility](#) is used. After the same month is reported and used to determine the next month's benefits.

The worker may take an application from an applicant who is **not** in need at the time of application for assistance until the first of the month, but makes application five days before month-end. After the application is taken and the first benefit cheque issued is not used to determine the income asset level for the client sub type.

Income and the First Benefit Period

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2011

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 23\(2\)](#)

POLICY

Income can only be used once to calculate benefits. Income received during the first period of a

Income at Intake

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

At intake, the worker asks for information about income to find out whether the applicant may be

Note

An earnings exemption is not applied to on-going income when determining initial eligibility to receive an exemption as stated.

Child and Adult Support Income

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2019

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\), sections 6\(2\)\(d\), 29 and 31](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 23\(3\)\(e\); Schedule 2](#)

POLICY

Income Support clients must be willing to comply with the Child Support Services (CSS) program household unit. If payments to the applicant or recipient are late or unreliable, or if the applicant given to the government while Income Support benefits are paid. *IESA*, Part 5

The worker asks the parent whether they are receiving child or adult support payments directly, deducted dollar for dollar from their income support benefits. The worker **refers** the applicant or Worker decides whether the support is reasonable and takes appropriate action if it is not.

If the applicant or recipient is unreasonably uncooperative, the CSS Worker may recommend the section 6(2)(d).

For the purpose of the Income Support and CSS programs, child and adult support income is defined (Program or the courts) and the reason it is received (for the care of a child or adult) rather than

Child and adult support income can be paid pursuant to a [legally enforceable agreement or order](#)

Example 1

The Income Support applicant/recipient has an arrangement with the other parent to receive is also paying the Income Support client's rent directly to the landlord. The \$500 payment is **not** intended to replace the \$500 child support payment and is paid to a third party. The income.

Example 2

The Income Support applicant/recipient has an arrangement for child support in the amount \$100 per month is paid directly to the client
\$400 per month is paid directly to the client's landlord
In this circumstance, the total \$500 is considered child support based on the arrangement

Child and Adult Support Arrears on Legally Enforceable Court Orders and Agreements

Child and adult support arrears are past support payments owed to an Income Support client that payments may or may not be owing to the Alberta government.

Amounts Owed to the Crown (Alberta Government)

Payments on support arrears received by a client for a period when the person was receiving a rather than through the Maintenance Enforcement Program (MEP).

If the client declares it through their monthly reporting, it is treated as non-exempt income.

If the payment is discovered after the fact, it is treated as an overpayment. The amount of the over

costs) and the amount of arrears paid for each month the client received income support.

Amounts Not Owing to the Crown (Alberta Government)

Payments on support arrears received by clients for a period when the person was not on assis identified by MEP. MEP has confirmed these payments are not owing to the Alberta governmer

The rationale for this policy is to allow clients who have suffered financial stress due to accrued

Income Support Recipients from Other Provinces a

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

If an applicant has received Income Support in another province for a benefit period, then Alber

In most instances, applicants who have already received their monthly entitlement from another

There are circumstances where duplicate Income Support from another province is not consider
is open.

Circumstances include when a client:

- Has left an abusive situation.
- Has moved to accept employment.
- Has a serious illness and moved to receive support.
- Is stranded and requires emergency benefits and/or return transportation to their province

Where client circumstances do not fit the above situations, and the client presents as destitute,
the Supervisor. Such approval must be entered on EMP 1086 Approval Log.

If Income Support is issued, and it is later discovered through interprovincial information sharing
province, a repayment is usually calculated. Since client benefits vary from province to province

Interprovincial Information Sharing

When agreements have been reached between provinces to share information, reports identifyi
monthly basis:

- **SEIP 3610 Alberta Community and Social Services – Alberta and (Name of Province**
clients matched by Social Insurance Number
- **SEIP 3620 Alberta Community and Social Services – Alberta and (Name of Province**
Duplicate Periods of Assistance For the Month of (M/Y) – the report lists clients without
alias, birthdate and sex
- Ontario produces their own report and forwards it to Community and Social Services. The

The reports are listed by service centre, unit and caseload and provide the worker with persona
reports are received, the worker:

1. Reviews the information contained in the report
2. Contacts the client to discuss the circumstances concerning the duplicate benefits. If the p
SIN, the worker verifies that the SIN has been properly entered into LISA by reviewing the

worker notifies the other province (the phone number is identified on the report), as the SI revises the necessary information on LISA.

Note

Alberta and the provinces of BC, Saskatchewan, Manitoba, Ontario and Newfoundland have been pursuing repayments or fraud investigations. If the client's file is currently active in both provinces, action is being taken. Subsequent agreements with other provinces are pending.

3. Applies existing policy to determine whether the circumstances of the client warrant further action.

Note

If further information is required, the worker contacts the worker in the other province.

4. Enters the debt in the Recoveries System, or
 5. Refers the matter to Fraud Investigations if the information received indicates the client is (e.g., presenting false identification).
-

Substantiation and Verification

Last updated on: Jul 09, 2019

INTENT

Applicants declare the type and amount of income received by all members of the household until they have provided is true and complete.

Applicants are informed at intake of the requirement to access all income they are eligible to receive. Benefit or quarterly GST Credits through the annual filing of income tax. When income tax is filed, applicants must submit their NOA annually to confirm this has been done.

Recipients report the type and amount of income received by all members of the household until reporting, recipients declare the information they have provided is true and complete. In addition to the above, clients provide the standard documents required by policy, and any additional documents as requested.

Recipients who are exempt from monthly reporting provide changes in their income to their workers.

Workers advise clients they are required to disclose all household income including income not reported on the NOA.

POLICY

All Income Support clients are required to submit an annual NOA in order to maintain program eligibility.

Note: It can take up to three months to receive a NOA, depending on how the client filed their taxes.

All Income Support clients are required to provide substantiation when requested.

Income Support clients using the ARC are not required to submit verification of any income they receive until a verification review. When requested by the worker, Income Support clients will provide all relevant documentation.

Verifying Income

The NOA from the CRA contains income information for the previous year. This information is used by the worker to verify income amounts, or to confirm no income was received.

The information from the NOA is used by the worker to verify income amounts, or to confirm no income was received.

When reviewing the NOA, the worker notes any discrepancies on file. The NOA information compared with what is reported on ARC. In these cases a further review may be necessary. For example, the NOA may not reflect the current financial situation or may require additional documentation.

The NOA may not reflect the current financial situation or may require additional documentation.

Employment Income

Clients must substantiate employment income when requested by a worker. Employment income substantiation includes a direct deposit statement which contains:

- Name of employer
- Pay period
- Date pay was received

- Gross pay
- Description and amount of mandatory and statutory deductions
- Net pay

The worker records the information in [Compass Comments](#) and returns the documents to the c

Note

For tips and other casual employment which there is no paystub or record, clients make a

Other Income

When requested, clients who have other income, which varies from month to month, may be re information in Compass **Comments** and returns the documents to the client.

Clients who have other income, which remains constant, are required to provide the initial docu be reported during each monthly reporting.

When the other income has no supporting documentation then the client's verbal statement or /

- Source and type of income
- Pay period
- Date income was received
- Gross income
- Description and amount of deductions, if applicable
- Net income
- Family member it applies to

The following are various types of income and examples of acceptable substantiation. This is n internal sources for verifying income.

Income	Substantiation
Self Employment,Farm, Business	Latest income tax assessm Audited financial statemer Accounting books Receipts for income and e Written statement from cu Business Contract EMP 5515 Statement of N
Employment Insurance	Direct Deposit StatementE

	Statement from EI *EI Post-audit Data Match (Infopac Report SEIP2330 *EI On-line inquiry system
Government Pensions	Latest income tax assessm Cheque stub Direct deposit statement Bank statement
Private Pensions, Insurance and Retirement Savings	Statement from source Cheque stub Latest income tax assessm Policies, Agreements Direct deposit statement Bank statement
Workers' Compensation	Direct Deposit Statement Cheque stub Written statement from W
Training Allowance	Direct Deposit Statement Cheque stub Written statement from soi
Scholarships, Bursaries, Grants, SF	Direct Deposit Statement Written statement from pa; Bank statement *SF data match
Court/Voluntary Maintenance and Alimony	Decree Nisi Separation Agreement Court Order Written statement from pa; Written statement from cli *Confirmation from Child
Windfall Gains	Written statement from pa; Written statement from cli
Rental and Room and Board	Latest income tax assessm Rent book Rent receipts Lease or rental agreement Written statement from ter
Dividends, Interest, Royalties, Investments	Written statement from pa; Cheque stubs Direct Deposit statement Deeds. agreements. warrar

	Bank statement Latest income tax assessm
Canada Child Benefit	Canada Child Benefit Noti Canada Child Benefit Veri
Other e.g. Money in Trust for Children, Gifts	Written statement from soi Written statement from cli

PROCEDURES

Workers verify a client's income by:

- ensuring the documentation received is sufficient to determine eligibility and level of bene
 - considering information obtained from data matching or other sources; **and**
 - documenting all relevant observations and information in [Compass Comments](#).
-

09 Assets

General Policy

Last updated on: Oct 30, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6\(2\)\(c\)](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 20, 21 and 28](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 100](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, Schedule 1](#)

INTENT

Certain assets are exempt to ensure:

- Applicants/Recipients who are eligible for on-going benefits are not placed in total poverty
- People have some resources they can use to purchase items that are not available through
- People are encouraged to save for their and their children's futures and manage their funds

Definitions

Liquid Assets

"Liquid asset" means cash on hand or cash in a financial institution or held by a third party that includes such as stocks, term deposits, guaranteed investment certificates (GICs), bonds and other securities.

Workers must determine whether:

- The asset is a **form** of money rather than an item of merchandise, **and**
- The applicant or recipient can access it **immediately**.

Readily Convertible

Readily convertible means that within the next two banking days:

- A local business is open and willing to cash the applicant's cheque, **or**
- A bank, Treasury Branch or Credit Union is open and the applicant has the required identification
- The applicant has an automated teller card and access to the account through an available
- In the case of a savings bond, an individual or business is willing to redeem it for its full cash value
- By some other means, the applicant or recipient can access the value of the asset without

Temporary Exemption

Some financial assets cannot be readily converted to cash and can be temporarily exempted.

Further information regarding exempting assets temporarily can be found in [Asset Exemptions](#).

POLICY

Applicants and recipients must declare all assets.

Note:

Applicants and recipients are required to provide documentation (i.e., bank statements) for assets and banking information.

Recipients must declare all changes in their assets.

If an applicant or recipient declares excess liquid assets, they are **not** eligible to receive IS. (The

Compensation and Extraordinary Assistance Payments

Certain payments are exempt over and above an applicant's or recipient's cash and liquid assets. Non-liquid assets purchased with an exempt payment may also be exempt. Further details can

IS benefits and income, saved from one month to the next, become part of liquid assets and may

Savings of a dependent child are not taken into consideration when determining the household

An applicant [cannot dispose of assets](#) for other than fair market value in order to qualify for IS.

A recipient must report the sale of an asset. Recipients have one month after the sale of the asset. Assets sold are considered liquid assets. Any asset is subject to limits allowable by exemption.

Assets for One-Time Issue Clients

Applicants with sufficient on-going income may receive benefits only as a [One-Time Issue](#) if an

An applicant in client type **81** or **82** is allowed the same liquid and other asset exemptions as an

If non-exempt liquid assets are not adequate to meet the emergency need, the worker issues the

Substantiation

- Applicants are required to declare their assets and the assets of their spouse/partner on the
- Recipients are required to declare changes in their assets and the assets of their spouse/partner
- Recipients who are exempt from monthly reporting, inform their worker of changes in their assets. They are also required to report changes in their circumstances on their [EMP 0110 Annual Report](#)
- Clients are required to provide any additional substantiation the worker determines necessary for client's assets.

PROCEDURES

Recording One-Time Issue in LISA

If the client has excess liquid assets, the worker:

1. Records the maximum exempt liquid assets in the **Liquid Asset** field in **Eligibility Determination**
2. Uses the remainder of liquid assets to reduce the amount of the emergency need on the k

Verification

The worker verifies assets by:

1. Obtaining the standard substantiation and any additional documentation determined necessary
 2. Reviewing the substantiation to ensure it contains all the information necessary to determine
 3. Documenting all relevant information in [Compass Comments](#).
-

Asset Exemptions

Last updated on: Mar 25, 2026

On this page:

[Authority](#)

[Intent](#)

[Liquid Asset Exemptions for Applicants and Recipients](#)

[Liquid Asset Test Calculation](#)

[Federal Child Benefit](#)

[Income Tax Refunds](#)

[Exempt Assets](#)

[Vehicles](#)

[Asset Bought with Exempt Income](#)

[Short-Term Exemption](#)

[LISA Asset Fields](#)

[Procedures](#)

AUTHORITY

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, sections 1\(1\)\(i\), 1\(1\)\(p\), 20 :](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, Schedule 1, section 1](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-19 Appendix B: Schedule 1 – Exempt Assets](#)

[Ministerial Order 2016-15 Exempt Retroactive Guaranteed Income Supplement Payments](#)

[Ministerial Order 2016-17 Damage or Loss Caused by a Disaster](#)

[Ministerial Order 2016-18 Alberta Child Welfare Class Action Settlement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2017-03 Clegg Class Action Settlement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2017-13 Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements](#)

[Ministerial Order 2017-17 Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-09 Liquid Asset Test Federal Child Benefit Amounts](#)

[Ministerial Order 2018-15 Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty 8 Lands and Benefits Claim Sett](#)

[Ministerial Order 2019-02 Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Ag](#)

[MO 2019-07 Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2019-10 – Pain and Suffering Compensation](#)

[Ministerial Order 2020-003 – Final Settlement Agreement \(Ross, Roy and Satalic and Her Maje](#)

[Ministerial Order 2020-005 – Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the Queen Class Action Se](#)

[Ministerial Order 2020-007 – Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2020-013 – Federal Indian Day Schools \(McLean\) Settlement Agreement](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-003 – Heroes Fund](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-008 – Covid Self-Isolation Payment](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-010 – Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-012 – Working Parents Benefit](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-014 - Critical Worker Benefit](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-016 – Memorial Grant Program Payments](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-025 - Mosquito Grizzly Bear Head Lean Man First Nation](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-027 - Peepeekisis First Nation](#)

[Ministerial Order 2021-030 - Vaccine Incentive Debit Cards](#)

[Ministerial Order 2022-010 – Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-004 - Canada Dental Benefit and Canada Housing Benefit Payments](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-07 - Canadian Armed Forces \(CAF\) - Department of National Defense \(I](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-024 – Compassionate payments to individuals impacted by the Septemb](#)
[Ministerial Order 2023-025 – Manitoba Developmental Centre \(Weremy v Manitoba\) Class Acti](#)
[Ministerial Order 2024-015 – First Nation Drinking Water Advisory Class Actions Settlement Ag](#)
[Ministerial Order 2025-015 – Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement Agre](#)
[Ministerial Order 2025-017 – Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement](#)
[Ministerial Order 2025-027- Parent Payment Program Exemption](#)
[Ministerial Order 2025-033 - Compensation Payments from the Athabasca Chipewyan First Na](#)
[Ministerial Order 2026-004 – First Nations Child and Family Services, Jordan's Principle and Tr](#)

INTENT

Certain assets are exempt to ensure:

- Applicants/Recipients who are eligible for on-going benefits are not placed in total poverty
- People have some resources they can use to purchase items that are not available throug
- People are encouraged to save for their future and that of their children and manage their

POLICY

An applicant or recipient that has a non-exempt asset is not eligible for income support.

Liquid Asset Exemptions for Applicants and Recipients

Liquid asset exemptions are in addition to:

- Japanese Canadian Redress Agreement payments
- Extraordinary Assistance Plan payments
- Provincial payments to persons (or their families) who have contracted HIV through the bl
- Payments received under Schedule A or B of the 1986-1990 Hepatitis C Settlement Agree or section 6.01 of that Agreement (for loss of support resulting from the death of the infect
- Financial benefits paid pursuant to section 13, 15, 19(2) of the *Alberta Victims of Crime A*
- Common Experience Payments (CEPs) and Independent Assessment Process Payments
- Roth/Fifield Class Action Settlement Agreement from the Government of Alberta

- A Slave Lake Wildfire Relief Payment or a payment under the Emergency Accommodation Emergency Management Agency in May 2011.
- Government payments as designated by the Minister
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta for damage or loss caused by a disaster
- Payments issued by a charitable organization for a disaster as determined by the Government
- Alberta Child Welfare Class Action Settlement from the Government of Alberta.
- A non-recurring per capita distribution payment or compensation received from the First Nations

- Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements;
- The Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
- The Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty 8 Lands and Benefits Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
- The Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
- The Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreement (2017);
- The Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
- Mosquito Grizzly Bear's Head Lean Man Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2017);
- The Peepeekisis First Nation Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2021);
- The Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement (2022);
- Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement (2024); and
- The Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation Treaty 8 Annuities Settlement Agreement (2024)

Note

Interest income, generated from investing these per capita distribution payments is included in the account for a dependent child and that is accessed when the child reaches the age of majority.

- Veterans Affairs Canada Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from the C

Note

Veterans Affairs Canada Additional Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received

- Compensation payments made under the Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement (2020).
- Compensation payments made under the Final Settlement Agreement between Ross, Ronald and Bisexual and Transgender (LGBT) federal public servants (2020).
- Compensation payments made under the Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the Queen (2020).

- Compensation payments made under the Federal Indian Day Schools (McLean) Settlement
- Payments issued by the Government of Alberta from the Heroes Fund.
- COVID Self-Isolation payments issued by the Government of Alberta, after the person completed COVID-19 Self-Isolation Services.
- Working Parents Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta (2021).
- Critical Workers Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta and the Government of Canada.
- Memorial Grant Program payments from the Government of Canada.
- COVID-19 Vaccine Incentive payments received from the Government of Alberta.
- Compensation payments made under the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) - Department of Veterans Affairs.
- Canada Housing Benefit.
- Canada Dental Benefit.
- Affordability payments received from the Government of Alberta.
- Compassionate payments from the Government of Alberta to individuals impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Compensation payments made to a class member under the Manitoba Developmental Centre Class Action Settlement Agreement (2023).
- Compensation payments made to an Individual Class Member under the First Nation Drinking Water Class Action Settlement Agreement (2023).
- Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement Agreement (2023).
- Parent Payment Program Benefits to help ease the extra costs families may face while caring for a child.
- Compensation payments made to an Individual Class Member under the First Nations Child Development Fund Class Action Settlement Agreement (2023).

Exclusion of Core Benefits for the Purpose of Liquid Asset Test Calculation

The value of the combined liquid assets of the adult members of the household unit **cannot exceed** \$100,000 under s. 21(1).

Core benefits for **liquid** asset purposes **only are** defined as:

- [Core Essential](#), **plus**
- [Core Shelter](#), **plus**
- The following (if applicable):
 - the [Federal Child Benefit](#),
 - the [High School Incentive Benefit](#),
 - the [Handicap Benefit](#),

- the [Personal Needs Supplement](#), and
- the [Earnings Replacement Allowance](#).

The Core Essential and Core Shelter are determined using the applicable rates based upon the For applicants residing in [social housing](#) use the appropriate maximum private Core Shelter rate Table for the purpose of determining Core Benefits.

The **Federal Child Benefit** amounts are determined by the Minister under [Ministerial Order 201](#)

- \$192 per month for the first dependent child;
- \$170 per month for the second dependent child; and
- \$162 per month for each remaining dependent child.

The Federal Child Benefit is not an Income Support benefit issued by the province of Alberta. T Liquid Asset Test. The following table is a summary of the monthly **Federal Child Benefit** amo Income Support household unit.

Number of Children
1
2
3
4
5
6
Each additional child

Workers must manually calculate Core Benefits if the client is eligible for the High School Incen

Income Tax Refunds

Income Tax refunds are part of liquid assets and may affect eligibility.

For applicants, the remaining portion of the combined tax refunds of the head of the household

For recipients, the tax refunds of the head of household and spouse/partner are considered to be a liquid asset. This allows clients to have resources to purchase items not available.

The onus to report Income Tax refunds rests with the client. Each year, clients will receive a direction to report any refunds to their worker.

Substantiation

Unless otherwise stated the client's verbal or written statement and signature on the **EMP 3428** substantiate assets.

If the client has liquid assets, the worker considers the amount of the assets in determining whether the client is eligible for Income Tax credits.

- Current bank statement or passbook.
- Statement or letter from a financial institution confirming the number, value and maturity of the asset.
- Statement from a financial institution to confirm the value of a GIC or term deposit.

Exempt Assets

Apply the exemptions below to determine whether an **applicant or recipient** is eligible for Income Tax credits.

Home

A home of any value in which the individual lives, including the home quarter section for farmers.

Clothing

Clothing, personal jewelry, children's toys, and common household goods are exempt with no restriction on value.

Household Furnishings and Appliances

Household furnishings and appliances of reasonable value are exempt. Household furnishings and appliances must be used by the applicant or recipient.

Business Tools and Equipment

Business tools including essential equipment and supplies for farmers needed for employment are exempt.

Business and Farm Assets

Business

Assets required for the operation's viability are exempt if the applicant or recipient cannot get a loan to start or maintain the business. If a business operation is **not** viable, the recipient's client category will determine the expectation to substantiate assets.

Farm

Farm machinery and other assets required for the operation's viability are exempt if the applicant or recipient cannot get a loan to start or maintain the operation. If a farm operation is not viable, the recipient's client category will determine the expectation to substantiate assets.

Substantiation

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Assets Held by Trustee in Bankruptcy

Any asset held by a trustee in bankruptcy for any member of the household unit under the Bankruptcy Act.

Substantiation

Written documentation for the worker from an official source (such as a trustee, lawyer, or accountant) indicating that the asset is held by a trustee in bankruptcy.

Locked-In Retirement Accounts (LIRA)

A LIRA is a registered account that holds pension money that has been transferred from a pension plan to a LIRA.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source (i.e., financial institution) indicating that the account is a LIRA.

Registered Education Savings Plan (RESP)

All RESPs in any amount are exempt.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source (such as a financial institution) confirming that the account is a RESP.

Registered Retirement Savings Plan (RRSP)

An RRSP up to the value of \$5,000 per adult member of the household unit is exempt. The RRSP value is included in the liquid asset test calculation in the determination of benefits (ISTHB Section 21(1) three months total core benefits).

Example 1: Applicant has \$5,700 in an RRSP, the first \$5,000 are exempt and \$700 would be included in the Liquid Asset test.

Example 2: Applicant has \$3,500 in an RRSP and the spouse/partner has 2,500 in an RRSP. The total RRSP value is \$6,000. The first \$5,000 are exempt and \$1,000 would be included in the Liquid Asset test.

Example 3: Applicant has \$4,500 in a RRSP and the spouse/partner has \$5,000 in an RRSP. The total RRSP value is \$9,500. The first \$5,000 are exempt and \$4,500 would be included in the Liquid Asset test.

Example 4: Applicant has \$4,000 in an RRSP and spouse/partner has \$9,600 in an RRSP. The total RRSP value is \$13,600. The first \$5,000 are exempt and \$8,600 would be included in the Liquid Asset test.

NOTE:

Workers must document in Compass the total amount of RRSP and state amount of exempt RRSP.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source (such as a financial institution) stating the value of the RRSP.

Registered Disability Savings Plan (RDSP)

All RDSPs in any amount are exempt.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source (such as a financial institution) confirming that the account is a RDSP.

Life Insurance Policy

A life insurance policy with a cash surrender value of \$1,500 or less for the **household unit** is exempt.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source, such as a life insurance company stating the cash surrender value of the policy.

Prepaid Funeral Costs

All prepaid funeral costs for any member of the household unit are exempt.

Money In Trust for a Child

Money received on a child's behalf, other than funds intended for a child's maintenance, and plus interest that accrues to and forms part of the trust is **exempt**:

- For an applicant, if placed in trust before applying, or within 60 days after applying, for income
- For a recipient, if placed in trust within 60 days of being received.
- For both, the money is exempt only if it cannot be withdrawn for the child's benefit.

If the parent, guardian or child can get money from the trust account, the money in that fund is **not** exempt.

Note

The principal amount of a per capita distribution (PCD) payment, resulting from an Agricultural Income Tax Credit (AITC) payment, is exempt.

Money for maintenance may be exempt as [income](#) but is **not** exempt as an asset even if placed in trust.

CPP Orphans Benefit is **not** exempt income. It cannot be made exempt as an asset under this section.

Money left to a child in a will is **not** exempt income, but may qualify for exemption under this section in certain circumstances.

Substantiation

Written documentation from an official source such as a lawyer, public trustee, financial institution or other official source is required to substantiate the exemption.

- The money is not accessible
- The source of the money to determine whether it was intended for the education or maintenance of the child
- The date the money was placed in trust
- The date the child can access the money

Children's Assets

Money saved by a dependent child and/or assets accumulated by a dependent child are exempt. The asset(s) must be in the child's name. This provides an incentive for children to accumulate savings.

Money saved by an adult member of the household unit for a dependant that is accessible by the dependant may turn them into another asset exempted by policy (i.e., if the money is in a joint account).

Other Assets

Any other asset, excluding a liquid asset, **may** be exempted as per ISTHB Regulation, Schedule 1, if the asset is used to secure a loan.

Substantiation

The client's verbal or written statement and their signature on the **EMP 3428 Income Sup**

- Other documentation may be required depending on the exempted asset.

Vehicles

Any number of Vehicles in which the total equity is \$10,000 or less ie exempt.

Note

Equity means the value of the vehicle(s), after subtracting money owed on the vehicle(s) f

Although clients are required to "[access all resources available outside of the program](#)" there m

Workers may exceed the \$10,000 vehicle asset limit when a member of the household unit req

1. To access confirmed employment or training;
2. As part of their **Individual Plan**;
3. To access health services or to meet family care responsibilities.

Note

When an amount greater than \$10,000 is entered, the LISA system will display the messa
from proceeding.

See [Short-Term Exemption](#).

Workers must enter Compass Comments explaining why the vehicle asset limit has been exce

In addition to other motor vehicles, any vehicle specially adapted to accommodate a disability o
and equity.

Substantiation

- Workers may request to view a Vehicle Registration Certificate, an appraisal from a
equity in the vehicle.
- The Canadian Red Book is helpful to determine market value of a vehicle.

Asset Bought With Exempt Income

An asset is exempt if bought with money received from the following:

- Japanese Canadian Redress Agreement

- Extraordinary Assistance Plan
- Compensation for HIV infection through the blood supply
- Financial benefits under the *Victims of Crime Act*
- Common Experience Payments (CEPs) and Independent Assessment Process Pay
- Hepatitis C Settlement Agreement

Note

An asset bought with ongoing payments received under Section 4.02 (payment for the Settlement Agreement) is **not** exempt.

- Roth/Fifield Class Action Settlement Agreement from the Government of Alberta
- A Slave Lake Wildfire Relief Payment or a payment under the Emergency Accommodation Emergency Management Agency in May 2011.
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta pursuant to a Disaster Recovery
- Compensation issued by the Government of Alberta for damage or loss caused by a
- Payments issued by a charitable organization for a disaster as determined by the G
- A retroactive Guaranteed Income Supplement Payment
- Alberta Child Welfare Class Action Settlement from the Government of Alberta.
- Clegg Class Action Settlement (2017); and
- A non-recurring per capita distribution or compensation payment received from the f
 - Agricultural Benefits Settlement Agreements;
 - The Piikani Nation Grazing Leases Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (201
 - The Lubicon Lake Band No. 453 Treaty Lands and Benefits Claim Settlement .
 - The Blood Tribe Mismanagement of Assets Specific Claim Settlement Agreem
 - The Missanabie Cree First Nation Treaty Land Entitlement Settlement Agreem
 - The Enoch Cree Nation Yekau Lake Practice Bombing Range Specific Claim &
 - Mosquito Grizzly Bear's Head Lean Man Specific Claim Settlement Agreemen
 - The Peepeekisis First Nation Specific Claim Settlement Agreement (2021);
 - The Siksika Nation Global Settlement Agreement (2022);
- Note:** This exemption is for the per capita distribution payment provided in July
- Robinson Huron Treaty Settlement Agreement (2024); and
- The Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation Treaty 8 Annuities Settlement Agreem

Interest income, generated from investing these per capita distribution paymer

- Veterans Affairs Canada Pain and Suffering Compensation payments received from **Note**
Veterans Affairs Canada Additional Pain and Suffering Compensation payments rec
- Compensation payments made under the Sixties Scoop Settlement Agreement (202
- Compensation payments made under the Final Settlement Agreement between Ros
Bisexual and Transgender (LGBT) federal public servants (2020).
- Compensation payments made under the Raymond Michael Toth v. Her Majesty the
benefits of disabled Veterans (2020).
- Compensation payments made under the Federal Indian Day Schools (McLean)Set
- Payments issued by the Government of Alberta from the Heroes Fund.
- COVID Self-Isolation payments issued by the Government of Alberta, after the pers
Services.
- Working Parents Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta (2021).
- Critical Workers Benefit payments provided by the Government of Alberta and the G
- Memorial Grant Program payments from the Government of Canada.
- COVID-19 Vaccine Incentive payments received from the Government of Alberta.
- Compassionate payments from the Government of Alberta to individuals impacted b
- Compensation payments made under the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) - Departm
- Affordability payments received from the Government of Alberta.
- Compensation payments made to a class member under the Manitoba Developmen
- Compensation payments made to an Individual Class Member under the First Nation
- Federal Administrative Segregation Class Action Settlement Agreement (2023).
- Parent Payment Program Benefits to help ease the extra costs families may face w

An asset is exempt if bought with money received from a Government of Canada or Governme
Alberta Resource Rebate, CEPs and IAPs under the Indian Residential Schools Settlement Agr

Substantiation

The client's verbal or written statement:

- Describing the asset, **and**

- Indicating the value of the asset, **and**
- Identifying the exempt income with which the asset was purchased.

Short-Term Exemption

This section allows time for a client to dispose of an asset which is not appropriate for exemption (such as fine art, recreational vehicles, or expensive entertainment systems).

Any asset required to be disposed of for fair value within a time specified is a short-term exemption granted, **only** if extreme hardship would result from not giving income support benefits.

This exemption must **not** be used to exempt excess liquid assets. It is used to exempt assets and exempt assets not specified in policy or regulation.

Extensions are permitted **only** if the recipient proves continuing effort to deal with the asset. The selling assets for a nominal amount (e.g. \$1) on a private agreement that will be returned later.

Two specific exemptions under this section are real estate the applicant or recipient does **not** own

Real Estate

Solely owned real estate the applicant or recipient does **not** occupy as the principal residence property must be used to secure a loan.

Jointly owned real estate, which the applicant or recipient does **not** occupy as the principal residence (home) is exempt for not more than six months at a time.

Substantiation

If a client owns real estate, the standard requirement for substantiation for a worker to view

- A document indicating the current market value such as a written appraisal, current
- Written documentation from a financial institution indicating a loan cannot be obtained
- Real estate listing or newspaper ad indicating the real estate is for sale at a reasonable
- In the case of jointly owned real estate, a copy of the mortgage or land title to identify
- If a co-owner(s) of jointly owned real estate is unwilling to sell, the client provides evidence
- If the real estate is rented out, a copy of the lease agreement, official receipts or income

Marketable Commodities

Marketable commodities produced or purchased in mass quantity and intended for sale or resale allow a viable farm to operate through a brief period of difficulty.

The owner is expected to sell at current market prices if the sale does not endanger the on-going commodity may result in a lower profit than might have been received later. However, resource-marketable commodities merely because of price fluctuations.

Substantiation

The worker may request additional substantiation such as a current income tax assessment

LISA Asset Fields

LISA has the following asset fields in **Eligibility Determination** and **Client File** that **must** be completed

- Liquid Assets
- RRSP
- Life Insurance
- Vehicle(s)

These fields have edits with maximum amounts prescribed by ISTHB Regulation.

PROCEDURES

Applicants

When determining eligibility for Income Support based on assets, the worker:

1. Determines the kind and value of all assets belonging to adult members in the household
2. Completes the appropriate asset fields in **Eligibility Determination**.
 1. If eligible for the benefit, enter the applicant's actual liquid asset in the Liquid Assets field. Provide any message if the client is eligible.
 2. If the message "Liquid Assets Total Exceeds Limit" appears, the worker must manually enter the amount.
 3. Determine the appropriate HSI.
Note
Multiply the HSI amount by three for an ETW or BFE household type (HT).
 4. Add this number to the Liquid Asset Maximum displayed on the **Asset** screen in **Eligibility Determination**.
 5. If eligible, enter assets totaling \$1.00 in Liquid Assets field on the **Asset** screen in **Eligibility Determination** completed along with the total assets.
3. Enters temporarily exempt assets in the **Temporarily Exempt** asset field.

4. Does **not** enter assets that are 100% exempt in **ED**.
5. Rejects ineligible applicants and advises them of their right to appeal.
6. Records the applicant's assets and/or the reason for rejection based on assets in **Compa**

Recipients

When becoming aware of a change in the client's assets directly from the client or through a rel

1. Contacts the client to confirm the current total of their assets, particularly liquid assets.
2. Updates the appropriate asset fields in **Client File**.
 - If eligible for the HSI benefit, enter the recipient's actual liquid asset in the Liquid As: will not provide any message if the client is eligible.
 - If the message "Cash Total Exceeds Limit" appears, the worker must manually recal
 - Remove the amount entered in the Liquid Assets field and proceed to the Budget Up
 - Enter only the needs identified as Core Benefits for the purpose of determining liquic the Total Needs field is the new liquid asset maximum for the client.

Note
Multiply the HSI by three for an ETW or BFE HT.

 - If eligible, return to the **Additional Client File Information** screen in **Client File** and
 - Record in Compass Comments that a manual calculation was completed along with
3. Advises the client if they become ineligible due to excess assets that their file will close fo
4. Advises ineligible clients that they have the right to appeal and can reapply for income su
5. Records the new circumstances regarding assets in Compass.
6. Continues to provide income support to clients whose eligibility is not impacted by the ass
7. Reviews the file for potential debts and/or referral for **Fraud Investigation** when appropri

LISA

1. Compares the amount of the assets entered in **ED** and **Client File** with the maximums all

Note

Populates asset information in **Client File** from information entered in **Eligibility Determination** Essential, Core Shelter, Handicap Benefit, Personal Needs Supplement and Earnings Replacer

1. Displays an **Assets Exceed Maximum** message if any asset renders an applicant or recipient **Eligible**.

Workers must reduce the liquid asset below the liquid asset maximum in order to continue

10 Assignment of Benefits

Intent

Last updated on: Sep 09, 2020

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 16](#)

INTENT

Employment Insurance claimants who do not have alternate resources to meet their basic need
The Assignment of Benefits (AOB) process allows Seniors, Community and Social Services to i
A person “assigns” a portion of their EI benefit to Seniors, Community and Social Services to re
The purpose of the AOB process is to minimize dual EI and income support payments being pa

[For additional information on Assignment of Benefits see the Assignment of Benefits Fact Shee](#)

[Staff Access form](#)

Definitions

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2024

The abbreviations/definitions shown in this policy are used in the Employment Insurance (EI) Act.

- [WebAoBLink Manual](#),
- [WebAoBLink Web Form Guide](#), and
- [Tip Sheet of Completion of INS3113 Assignment of Benefits](#)
- [___](#)

Assignment of Benefits (AoB)

AoB is the process to direct a portion of an EI claimant's benefits to the Province when both EI and Income Tax credits are available.

AoB Balance

The AoB Balance is a dual payment amount that cannot be recovered immediately from EI.

An AoB balance occurs when either or both of these conditions are met:

- When the AoB request for the same time period is received after EI benefits have already been paid.
- If the dual payment is greater than the amount recovered.

AoB balances are calculated and monitored by the Insurance Payment Operational Centre (IPC).

AoB Period

The AoB period is the period beginning with the first week of benefit assignment and ending with the last week of benefit assignment. Terms **Start Week** and **Last Week** are used on the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form to indicate the period.

It is essential that the dates on the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form are correct.

- The date of the Start Week and Effective Date must always match the first Sunday of the month.
- The client's Signature Date and Date Payment client's signature **cannot** be after the completed manual **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form on or before the date the payment is issued.
- The Date Payment Issued is the date the Income Support benefit is released.

AOB – Assignment of Benefits

The process to direct a portion of an EI claimant's benefits to the Province when both EI and Income Tax credits are available.

AOB Balance

A dual payment amount that cannot be recovered immediately.

An AOB balance occurs:

- When the AOB request for the same time period is received after EI benefits have already
- If the dual payment is greater than the amount recovered.

AOB balances are calculated and monitored by the Insurance Payment Operational Centre (IPOC)

AOB Period

The period beginning with the first week of assignment and ending with the last week of the assignment. **Start Week** and **Last Week** are used on the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form to identify the AOB period.

It is essential that the dates on the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form are correct.

- The date of the Start Week and Effective Date must always match the first Sunday after the assignment.
- The client's Signature Date and Date Payment Issued can match but the client's signature must be on the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form on or before the date the Income Support payment is made.
- The Date Payment Issued is the date the Income Support benefit is released.

AOB Recovery

The AOB Recovery is the amount of EI benefits reimbursed to the Province as a result of an AOB request.

AOB Request

An AOB request is made by a worker to assign EI benefits for specific weeks as stated on an INS 3113 form.

Dual Payment Amount

The dual payment amount is the amount duplicated by Income Support and EI deemed to have Income Support **Weekly Amount**. This is the amount, which can be recovered. Dual payments do not affect a person's future EI benefits.

Example 1
EI weekly
Income Support Weekly Amount
Dual payment

Example 2

EI weekly benefit
Income Support Weekly Amount
Dual payment

Insurance Payment Operational Centre - IPOC

EI claimants' reports are processed, and EI payments are issued at IPOC. The AoB request is a

Minimum (Weekly) Living Allowance (MLA)

The Minimum Living Allowance (MLA) is calculated and determined by the Income Support program to meet their financial needs when they are no longer receiving Income Support. This amount is used by the program. Any EI funds over the MLA are directed to repay the duplicated Income Support funds that were

- Minimizes hardship for a client by ensuring a minimum amount of EI benefits remain to meet their needs.
- Eliminates the client needing to return for additional Income Support benefits.
- Allows for some recovery of the dual payments that the client has received.
- Extends the recovery of the duplicated/dual payment over a reasonable period of time.

Any EI benefit over the MLA is applied to the dual payment amount. Any further EI remaining after the MLA is determined by:

The MLA is determined by:

1. Adding Need Codes 11XX to **17XX** (excluding medical or contract payments). Note: The MLA **must** be calculated by using a **full month's** benefits.
2. Adding an additional 25% to the Need Code Total from step 1 (for unforeseen expenses and other needs).
3. Dividing the total by the number of Sunday's in the **full month**; usually 4 or 5 for a full month.

Example 1
Need Codes 11XX to 17XX for February
Add 25%
Divide by 4
MLA

Example 2
Need Codes 11XX to 17XX for February
Add 25%
Divide by 5
MLA

The EI system does not respond to cents so for the clients benefit, the worker needs to **round up** to the next whole dollar.

The MLA must be included on each **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form submitted to IPOC.

Reason Codes

Codes that appear on the **SM 3041 Assignment of Benefit** report which advises the office why

Code Description

- 01 No record of claim
- 02 Earnings declared
- 03 Benefit period not established (BPNE)
- 04 Prior to the benefit period commencement (BPC)
- 05 Beyond 8-week limitation
- 06 Disqualified
- 07 Disentitled
- 08 EI week not processed
- 09 Waiting period (WP)
- 10 Found work (FW)
- 11 Transferred out of region
- 12 BF until first AOB cleared

Recovery Limitation

Each Assignment of Benefit has a 52-week recovery limitation. The recovery limitation is calculated as follows:

Total Amount Paid

The "total amount paid" refers to the actual amount of Income Support paid to the client for the month of the MLA and excludes:

- Any benefits that will be paid back to the department through an **EMP 0976B Repayment**
 - 1807 - Utility Arrears
 - 1817 - Utility Connection
 - 1820 - Utility Deposit
 - 1829 - Utility Reconnection
 - 1831 - Day Care Deposit (when issued by repayment)
 - 1845 - Emergency Repairs to Household Appliance
 - 1846 - Emergency Household Repairs
 - 1847 - Other Emergency Issue
 - 1852 - Emergency Eviction
 - 1867 - Day Care Registration (when issued by repayment)
- Medical or contract payments
- All benefits related to Escaping Abuse including:
 - 1732 - Personal Benefit - Telephone and Transportation - Leaving Abusive Situation
 - 1801 - Damage Deposit
 - 1849 - Escaping Abuse Benefit
 - 1848 - Emergency Shelter - Abuse Situation
 - 1844 - Emergency Transportation
 - 1865 - Relocation Allowance

WebAOBLink

The WebAOBLink provides internet website access to EI client data and allows staff to complete applications online.

Workers can make a request to the designated WebAOBLink staff in their office to print a WebAOBLink User Guide.

Weekly Amount

The **Total Amount Paid** is broken down into weekly increments used on the **INS 3113 Assignment**

The AoB request must be in weekly increments as Subsection 34(2) of the [Employment Insurance Act](#) assignment can be deducted from a claimant's EI benefit.

The Income Support **Weekly Amount** is calculated by dividing the **Total Amount Paid** by the number of weeks.

The EI system does not respond to non-whole dollar amounts. Workers will need to do the following:

- **Round down** the amount for all but the last week.
- To find the last week value
 - Add up the rounded weeks,
 - Subtract the total of the rounded Income Support weekly rates from the total Income Support amount.
- This will then give you the Income Support weekly rate for the final week.

- **Calculation Tip**

The Weekly Amounts (when added together) must be equal to the Total Amount Paid.

Example for calculating weeks

If the applicant applies for Income Support on the 12th of July 2006 and you are backdated for 5 weeks, the Total Amount Paid by 5 (number of Sundays in the benefit period from July 1-July 31 2006). If the file wasn't backdated and all benefits were prorated from July 12th the Total Amount Paid (from July 12, 2006) to get the weekly amount.

Example calculation with rounding:

Step 1: Determine the Weekly amount for all but the last week

(total amount paid) ÷ (no of Sundays in the month) = weekly amount

\$669 ÷ 5 = \$133.80

Step 2: If a decimal amount, round down to the nearest whole dollar.

\$133.80 -> \$133.00

Step 3: Determine the last weekly amount.

(total amount paid) - [(no of Sundays in the month - 1) x (weekly amount for all but the last week)]

\$669.00 - (4 x \$133.00) = \$137.00

General Policy

Last updated on: Dec 07, 2022

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 14, 15, 16 and 35](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, section 99](#)
[Recovery Regulation](#)

POLICY

An applicant/client, who is waiting for their Employment Insurance (EI) claim to be processed m

The Assignment of Benefits (AoB) process allows the Province to recover Income Support prov [Benefit](#) form, the person agrees to assign a portion of their EI payments to the Province. The as period that they were eligible to receive EI.

AOB Request Required

Signing an **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form is **mandatory** when an EI claimant applies f

This form **must** be completed if the person's weekly EI benefit is higher than their weekly Minim

Note

The weekly MLA is equal to the Income Support weekly rate the person is eligible to receive, pl calculations used in this section.

Before Income Support benefits can be issued, applicants/clients in the following situations mus

- The person has a pending EI claim;
- The person is in process of applying for EI benefits;
- The person is appealing an EI claim decision; or,
- The Income Support worker advises the person that they are required to apply for EI bene
 - Their weekly EI payment amount is not yet determined (not known); or
 - The person's pending EI payments are verified as being greater than their Income S their EI).

An applicant/client who refuses to sign the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form is not eligible t client categories.

AOB Request Not Required

The **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form is not required, when:

- The person qualifies for ongoing Income Support benefits in addition to their EI (i.e., mont

- The person has applied for one month of emergency assistance under the [One-Time Issu](#)

Completing the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit Form

Program staff must verify the person's EI claim status prior to completing the [INS 3113 Assignn](#) refer to the resources below.

- [WebAoBLink Manual](#)
- [WebAoBLink Web Form Guide](#)

Instructions on completing the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit manual form are available in the Prior to asking an applicant/client to sign the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form, staff must c

- The person understands that deductions will be made to their future EI benefits to repay a
- By signing the form, the person consents to deductions from their EI (for amounts in exce:
- The person is aware that they can forego applying for Income Support and choose to wait

The [AoB Fact Sheet](#) is also available to support this process

Before the applicant/client signs the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form, staff must also ensu

- The calculations and dates on the form are accurate;
- The form has been fully completed; and
- The person signs the form **on or before the date** that Income Support benefits are issued

Under no circumstances should program staff ask an individual to sign a blank or incomplete **IN**

Recovery Options

Program staff must consult with the applicant/client to determine which method for recovering d

1. Minimum Living Allowance (MLA)

Recover only the portion of EI benefits that exceed the calculated MLA. This ensures that Income Support program. The EI program continues to assign benefits to the Province un

1. All Income Support benefits have been recovered,
2. The EI claim is exhausted, or
3. The 52-week recovery limitation is reached.

2. **Recovery at 100%**

Staff must obtain the person's consent to assign 100% of their EI payments to the Provincial payments.

1. To implement a 100% assignment rate, program staff would leave the MLA section 'A

A 100% assignment of EI should **not** be considered, if doing so, would cause the person to

PROCEDURES

When completing the procedures below, refer to information in the following resources:

- [WebAoBLink User Guides](#)
- [WebAoBLink: INS3113 Web Form](#)
- [AoB Fact Sheet](#)
- [AoB Definitions policy](#)

Applicant/Client Does NOT Proceed with Income Support Application or Request for Ongoing

If the applicant/client does not proceed with the Income Support application or request further information

- The INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form is not completed/submitted.
- The worker enters a "reject status" in the LISA eligibility determination screen (for applicant)
- The worker records the applicant/client decision in Mobius Notes.

Applicant/Client Proceeds with IS Application or Request for Ongoing Benefits

Before completing an INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form, the worker confirms that the person

The worker:

1. Advises the client that deductions will continue from their EI until all Income Support benefits
2. Ensures the applicant/client signs the completed INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form;
3. Issues Income Support benefits;
4. Provides the client with a copy of the INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form and retains a copy
5. Forwards the signed copy of the form to the IPOC:
Insurance Payment Operational Centre (IPOC)
Service Canada, W-T
400, 555 Hasting Street West
Vancouver, BC V6B 1M1

ATTENTION: Assignment of Benefits

The worker:

6. Leaves the cheque release flag at "N" for the following month's benefits; and
7. Adds Mobius Notes indicating the period that the AoB was completed.

Note

If the IPOC receives the **INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit** form later than eight weeks from the date of the claim, the worker must process an [overpayment](#) in these situations.

After the first month of Income Support benefits:

- If the client does not require further assistance, the worker may allow the LISA system to close the file.
OR
- If the client requires further Income Support, the person must return to the office to complete the subsequent AoB form.
 - Follow the steps in the Subsequent AoB Request section (below); and
 - Follow Steps 1-7 (above) to process the subsequent AoB form.

Note

Individuals who require Income Support for subsequent months, must agree to report their income to the program.

Head of Household and Partner are Awaiting EI Benefits

When the head of household and their partner are both waiting for EI benefits, one of the following options must be chosen:

1. Completes an AoB request for each person, dividing the MLA rate and Total Amount Paid equally between the two files.
2. Completes an AoB request for one person's file, using a 100% recovery rate.

If option two causes the household to remain on Income Support for an additional month; implement the following steps:

Subsequent Assignment of Benefits (AoB) Requests

If the client requires Income Support for another month and has not received EI yet, a subsequent Assignment of Benefit form. For subsequent AoB requests, the worker completes the same process as the first AoB request.

- Completes a WebAoBLink inquiry,
- Reviews the client's EI status, and
- Determines if the federal EI program has processed/cleared the previous AoB request.

Note

If there is a change in the MLA amount from the previous month, the worker must "hold" the file until the next month's benefits are processed.

The worker also completes the following procedures:

- For a manual INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form, the worker checks “**Subsequent Re**”
- If using the web-based form, the worker checks “new” and uses **RED** ink to write “**Subse**”
- The worker re-enters the MLA amount on the subsequent form (even if it has not changed)
- The worker ensures the effective date is the same date as the start week on the initial AoB form until the initial AoB request is recovered.)

Irregularities in the Assignment of Benefit (AoB) Process

Amending Cancelling or Writing-Off an AoB

Prior to submitting an amendment to cancel or write-off an AoB, the worker must confirm the EI write-offs can only be actioned on a go forward basis.

Amending an AoB

Amending an INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit form is appropriate when specific changes are re

To amend an AoB request, the worker:

- Writes “**AMENDMENT**” on the top of the form, using **RED** ink, and
- Crosses out the original information neatly, and adds the correct information beside it.

An applicant/client signature is not required on an amendment, as they have signed the original

Cancelling an AoB

An AoB request can only be cancelled if it has **not been** processed by the IPOC. The worker m

- Prints the AoB form,
- Puts a line diagonally across the form, and
- Writes, “**CANCELLED**” across the diagonal line in **RED** ink.

Example

If a client adds a spouse to the Income Support file, and their EI income is insufficient to meet th

Writing-Off an AoB Balance

The worker requests that an AoB balance be written-off when the person pays off the amount o an AoB balance.

To write-off an AoB balance, the worker:

1. Checks the box marked **Write-Off AoB Balance** at the top of the form;
2. Fills in the case number, agency code, claimant's SIN and name, authority signature and
3. Indicates the dates and amount of the AoB that is being written-off.
 Note
 Use the HTML print screen function in WebAoBLink, when printing an Amendment/Cance
4. Once the Amendment/Cancellation or Write-Off is complete, the worker mails the update t
5. The worker places a copy of the updated form on section 1 of the client file.
6. The worker updates Mobius Notes explaining the rationale for the changes.

Cash Payments

If a client issues a cash payment at an Income Support office, for all or part of the AoB balance,

1. Follows procedures for writing-off an AoB balance.
2. Records the cash payment on the FINSA0367A Cash Blotter, as payment for an AoB.
3. Issues a receipt to the client for the payment received.
4. Forwards the cash payment to Financial Operations.

Once received, Financial Operations notifies IPOC of the cash payment.

Providing a Refund to a Client

At times, workers may create an AoB request in error and/or submit an AoB when it is not requi

In this case, the following steps are required.

1. The worker confirms the AoB deductions to-date, by viewing WebAoBLink. (If no assignm
Note
 The WebAoBLink system only shows 8-weeks of payment processing information. Staff m
 of AoB deductions.
2. For closed files, the worker forwards the refund request to the Expenditure Officer for revi
 operator for payment.
3. For active files, the worker provides a refund to the client using:
Need Code
 1887 [Underpayment](#)

IPOC Overpayment Created by an Amended EI Decision

If IPOC determines a person is not eligible to receive EI during weeks where an assignment pa
 amount owing from the EI claimant.

- Clients who have questions about these types of overpayments should be referred to Emj

Bankrupt Clients

If after receiving an AoB request, IPOC becomes aware that the person has declared bankrupt, an assignment remains in effect.

11 Child Support Services

Referrals

Last updated on: Jul 27, 2012

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, section 6\(2\)\(d\)](#), requires compliance with Child Support [Income and Employment Supports Act, Part 5](#) and the [Child and Adult Supports Services Regu](#) support payments to the Crown.

INTENT

The purpose of CSS is to ensure that child support agreements are negotiated or orders are ob

The CSS program is guided by the following principles:

- Children have the right to be supported by their parents.
- Parents are responsible for providing support for dependent children to the best of their al

A substantial cost savings in the amount of Income Support benefits paid to individuals occurs \

The Maintenance Enforcement Program (MEP) is administered by the Department of Justice. T agreements and orders and registers these with MEP. MEP collects support payments on agre

POLICY

Income Support staff refer to CSS when:

- A dependent child is supported by Income Support benefits (including those over 17 years and
- At least one of the child's parents is not included as part of the household unit on the inco
- There is an existing adult support order for an adult of the household unit.

All Status First Nations people residing off reserve who receive Income Support benefits under

PROCEDURES

New Files

Referral Procedures

The Income Support worker determines CSS referrals by verifying the names of the biological c the budget, the Income Support worker refers the client to CSS, by completing the [CSS Referr](#)

When the client indicates there is a possibility of more than one responsible person for one dependent for one of the responsible persons, and records the details about the other responsible person(s).

The Income Support worker must ensure that all appropriate dependants are associated to the file. The Income Support worker must associate the dependants with the applicable responsible person.

Reopened Files

If **CCD Alert 28 Non-Compliant Child Support Services** exists on the file and/or Compass Case Manager worker determines if any benefits should be issued before the client meets with the Child Support Services, the Income Support worker deletes the alert and places a comment on the file.

Within 3 Months

When a file is reopened within 3 months, (information is still on LISA) the worker:

- Reviews the information on the **Dependant Information Update** screen and ensures the information is correct.
- Selects all dependants with a 'Y' **CSS Referral Flag** and ensures they have been associated to the file.
- For dependants who:
 - Have previously been coded CSS Referral Flag 'Y' and
 - will remain on the file and
 - have at least one parent not included on the file,
 - leave the **CSS Referral Flag** coded as 'Y'. This will correctly re-refer the dependant to the appropriate parent.
- For dependants who:
 - Have previously been coded CSS Referral Flag 'Y', and
 - Are being deleted from the file,
 - Change the referral flag to **CSS Referral Flag 'N'**, enter the appropriate **CSS Closure Reason**.

Note

If the **CSS Closure Reason 4** is used, the Income Support worker **must** document the reason for closure.

More Than 3 Months

The **CSS Referral** information is deleted when the LISA file is purged. When a file is downloaded from LISA, the Income Support worker enters the **CSS Referral** information in **Client File** as outlined for new files.

Verification of Support Payments

The Income Support worker reviews the status of each child who has a responsible parent identified on the file. The Income Support worker verifies the status of each dependent child.

When applicants are in receipt of support, the amount of the payment is entered on the budget, from the applicant's income support benefits.

The worker records whether or not the applicant is registered with MEP into Compass **Commei**

When payments are being made by the responsible parent(s) to MEP, the Income Support work support received by the applicant from MEP is deducted dollar for dollar on the budget, using **In**

Referrals to CSS

The Income Support worker refers the applicant to CSS:

- When the dependent child has a responsible parent, including a deceased parent. (The C dependent child.), **and**
- Whether [support payments](#) are being received or not, **or**
- When a person who is required to pay support offers or agrees to pay the rent or mortgag

Note

The CSW decides whether the support received by the applicant is reasonable and initiate

The worker:

- Advises applicants that information regarding CSS is included in the Income Support bo
- If the applicant has submitted copies of support agreements, court orders or divorce docu
- If the applicant has indicated the responsible person is voluntarily paying support, but is w

Referral Procedures for Supports and Financial Services Coordinator (SFSC)

Review of Active Files and Preventing Incomplete CSS Referrals

When the SFSC makes changes to the household unit situation in **Client File** function **7**, they n **Update** and **Responsible Person Information** screens. Updating this information ensures refe requiring support action no longer exist.

The SFSC must review and update the **CSS Referral** screens when the following occurs:

- A dependant is added on a single parent or blended household unit file.
- A spouse is deleted and there are one or more dependants.
- A spouse is added and there are one or more dependants.
- Some change is made in Client File function **7** and a dependant on a single parent file wa
- The monthly FMR01 Incomplete CSS Referral Report shows dependants on single paren

The SFSC:

- Ensures the CSS Referral Flags are [entered correctly](#) for each dependant on the **Depend**
- When changing a CSS Referral Flag from a 'Y' to an 'N', enters a **CSS Closure Reason** :
- Selects all dependants with a 'Y' **CSS Referral Flag** on the **Dependant Information Upd** the **Responsible Person Information** screen.

The SFSC communicates the following information to the CSW by recording comments into Co
Notes:

- The client requests a referral because they have new information about the responsible p
- A couple has a child in common but a common-law relationship is not acknowledged by th

The following changes on LISA automatically produce electronic messages on active TOMIS fil

- A file changes from one program to another e.g., Income Support to AISH or AAHB
- A dependant is deleted from the file
- The SFSC changes the CSS Referral Flag from 'Y' to 'N' with a **Closure Reason 2 "Resp**
- The Income Support/AISH/AAHB file is closed
- An unreferral dependant is added to the Income Support/AISH/AAHB file
- The Income Support/AISH/AAHB DO changes
- A spouse, who is a CSS Applicant, is deleted from the Income Support/AISH/AAHB file
- The Income Support/AISH/AAHB file number changes for the CSS Applicant
- The client's name is changed in any way
- The birth date of a dependant referred to TOMIS is changed

The following information from Pay History automatically produces electronic messages on acti

- The Income Support benefit is less than the amount of child support directed to the Crow
- The amount in **Income Code 4001 Child/Adult Support** differs from the amount of supp

Reopened Files

When a file is reopened for a single parent or blended household unit, the SFSC:

- Determines if any benefits should be issued before the client meets with the CSW, if [CCD](#) with the CSW, the SFSC deletes the alert.
- Reviews the information on the Dependant Information Update screen and ensures the C:
- Selects all dependants with a 'Y' **CSS Referral Flag** and ensures they have been associa
- When changing a CSS Referral **Flag** from a 'Y' to an 'N', enters a **CSS Closure Reason**, the **CSS Referral Flag** to 'N' and enter **CSS Closure Reason 4** when deleting dependant previously.)

Referrals With No Dependants

The Income Support worker views the divorce or separation agreement or order to verify if the a
In situations where an applicant has been awarded adult support, the Income Support worker re
[2922 Referral to Child Support Services](#).

The client is advised to report on the CRC any adult support payments received either directly f
A referral is not made to CSS if there is no agreement or order for adult support.

Both Parents Not Part of Household Unit

In situations where a dependant is being supported by income support benefits in a household i

The worker records CSS referral information in the **CSS Referral** screens in **Client File** function

For example, an individual applies for Income Support benefits with three dependants. The wor
Referral screens are completed by recording the information applicable to these dependants. T
on the income support budget.

The Income Support worker determines the third dependant is the applicant's niece. The **CSS F**
responsible parents are the biological or adoptive parents of this dependant. The Income Supp
Information screen and enters the name and relevant information concerning the other respon

The SFSC:

- Answers the question "**Are/Were the parents legally married to each other?**" appropria
- Selects "Head of Household" as the **CSS Applicant** (the person who is receiving the inco

Note

Do **not** use "**Other Dependant Child**" as the selection for the **CSS Applicant** in this situa

- Selects the third dependant to associate them with the Responsible Person, and presses

Correction of Wrong CSS Applicant Referral

The supervisor or designated staff member uses [Correction of CSS Referral function 15](#) wher

- The dependant in a three generation household unit who is the parent, is deleted from the
- The worker or SFSC enters the wrong selection of CSS Applicant on the **Responsible Pe**

Off-Reserve Status First Nations People

When Income Support benefits have been applied for, or are issued on LISA, the Income Support other income support clients.

When Income Support benefits are not issued on LISA, the Regional Director's office and the C

Case Management

Last updated on: Sep 30, 2016

INTENT

Consultation with Child Support Workers (CSW) is encouraged to promote:

- Case Management
- Communication
- Program information sharing
- Cost savings to the Income Support Program (e.g., appropriate referrals)

POLICY

Child Support Services (CSS) File Closure

CSS requires support action to be concluded within one year from the date of referral to that program. The Support and Financial Services Coordinator (SFSC) on **Compass Comments**.

There are a number of reasons for a CSS file closure. The CSS closure reasons that may impact client eligibility are:

- Agreement/Order – MEP – Crown/Special Handle
- Agreement/Order – Crown Interest – Applicant
- Agreement/Order – No Crown Interest – Applicant
- Applicant/Respondent Reconciled
- Dependant(s) Left Applicants Care
- Non-Compliant

The CSS Closure reasons that do not impact client eligibility are:

- Respondent Deceased
- Respondent Does Not Live In a Reciprocal Jurisdiction
- Divorced, Support Reserved
- Unable to Identify Person Responsible
- History of Threats/Violence
- Whereabouts Unknown Locate Unsuccessful

- Respondent Excluded by DNA Testing
- Person Responsible Has No Ability To Pay
- Applicant Decision to End Services
- Wrong CSS Applicant Referral on LISA
- Assistance File Closed
- Other- See Comments

Note

If assistance has ended and there is potential for obtaining support, action may be continued by the Crown, [/ESA Part 5, section 29\(9\)](#).

When an order or agreement is registered with the Maintenance Enforcement Program (MEP), is active. The **exception** occurs when:

- The support payments exceed the Income Support benefit amount. MEP then disburses the difference.
- When the responsible parent pays according to the order or agreement and MEP forwards the payments received through the monthly reporting.

Arrears collected by MEP are disbursed depending upon the time period during which the arrears accrued. If the arrears accrued during the time the client's Income Support file is open, the arrears are disbursed to the Crown. If the arrears accrued during the time the client's Income Support file is closed, the arrears are disbursed to the client.

PROCEDURES

Child Support Worker

The CSW advises the SFSC of relevant ongoing CSS activities in **Compass Comments** on the SFSC. The CSW may phone or email the SFSC.

Note

Relevant ongoing CSS activities that may impact income support eligibility are direct support request follow-up activities by the SFSC.

SFSC

The SFSC responds in a timely manner to requests from the CSW for follow-up phoning or emailing.

The SFSC adjusts **Client Budget** function 9 prior to the next cut-off date after being advised by the CSW of payments.

In situations where the client does not cooperate with the CSW, the CSW recommends to the SFSC that the SFSC may negotiate release of the benefit with the Supervisor. The SFSC advises the CSW of the outcome.

When the SFSC withholds further benefits, the SFSC:

- Sets the Cheque Release Flag in **CRC Processing** function **5** to **N** for the following month
 - May use the Automated Reporting Card system to hold financial benefits
 - Advises the client to contact the CSW
 - Advises the client that their benefits are on hold pending their cooperation with the CSW
 - Releases the following month's benefits when advised by the CSW that the client has con
 - Denies or suspends benefits under IESA Section 6(2)(d), when a client is unwilling to coop
-

12 Appeal and Decision Review

Overview and Authority

Last updated on: Jan 18, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections: 35, 36.1, 37, and 43-48](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections: 73-74, 92-94 and 97](#)
[Disability-Related Employment Supports Regulation, sections 6 and 7](#)
[Ministerial Order 2017-12 Disability-Related Employment Supports Review Committee](#)

INTENT

To introduce Appeals and authority of the Appeal Panel within the Income Support Program.

POLICY

If requested, a Citizen's Appeal Panel conducts an appeal of certain decisions made by Income

Authority of the Citizen's Appeal Panel

Matters that are subject to appeal to an Income and Employment Supports Appeal Panel include

- Eligibility or continuing eligibility, for the amount or value of assistance under [Part 2 of the](#)
- Any other matter provided for in the [Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHE](#)

Some decisions of the Director are **not** subject to appeal to the appeal panel. IESA section 44 &

Powers given to the Minister under IESA and associated Regulations are **not** within the jurisdiction

While Senior, Community and Social Services staff cannot deny an individual the right to request an appeal, the appeal panel is limited to certain decisions of the Director.

A Citizen's Appeal Panel has authority to:

- Hear evidence from parties to an appeal; and
- Confirm, reverse or vary a decision under appeal.

Structure of the Citizen's Appeal Panel

Citizen's Appeal Panels:

- Are under the auspices of the Appeals Secretariat;

- Are made up of citizens at large;
- Are appointed by the Minister of Community and Social Services;
- Are located in various sites across Alberta; and
- Are independent quasi-judicial bodies.

Mechanism for Review and/or Appeal of Decision

The following table outlines decisions affecting an individual's eligibility and benefits, which are jurisdiction, the table provides the alternate review medium for that decision (if applicable).

Type of Decision
Whether an individual has met residency and citizenship requirements as a condition of eligibility under the Income Support program (residency and citizenship requirements themselves, are not subject to appeal)
The amount or value of Income Support and benefits payable based on information provided in the Income Support Application form
Other eligibility criteria for Income Support benefits
Suspension of IS benefits due to failure to cooperate with Child Support Services (CSS) Case Management
Eligibility for CSS based on decisions under Part 5 of IESA (including case management decisions)
Financial eligibility for AAHB or Alberta Child Health Benefits (ACHB)
Other eligibility decisions for AAHB or ACHB
Health benefits coverage and requests for coverage outside of professional service agreements and Disability Benefit Lists (DBL)
DRES decisions involving provision of employment and training benefits except for those made under Sections 4 and 5 of the Employment and Training Benefits for Persons with Disabilities Regulation
Case management decisions that do not impact the amount or value of Income Support and benefits that a client is eligible to receive
Assessment of an overpayment under IESA, section 35 , and decision of the Director (or delegate) that the assessed overpayment must be repaid.
Determination that a Repayment Agreement is not required under IESA, section 16

Amount repayable under *IESA*, [section 16](#) (i.e., Repayment Agreement)

Determination of the repayment rate

Decisions that relate to appointing a financial administrator or issuing third-party payments - when no consent is given by the client

Notice of Decision

Last updated on: Nov 21, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 43-48](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 73-74, 93-94 and 96-97](#)

INTENT

To describe how Income Support notifies an individual of a decision made.

POLICY

Assisted Living and Social Services (ALSS) must inform an applicant or recipient (individual) who must:

- Provide relevant details of the decision and rationale, explaining why the decision was made;
- (If applicable) send [File Closure Letter](#) when requested;
- (If applicable) advise the individual of their right to appeal the decision to the appeal panel;
- (If applicable) explain the appeal process to the individual;
- (If applicable) inform the individual that they must initiate the appeal process by submitting a written appeal within 30 days of the date of the decision and
- Document all eligibility decisions in [Compass Comments](#).

Notification:

An ALSS staff member (the worker) makes a decision regarding eligibility for assistance under the Income Support Application. After determining eligibility for assistance, the worker is required to:

- The details of a decision (with supporting rationale) that affect eligibility for assistance;
- The individual's right to appeal this decision (as applicable); and
- The process and the 30-day time limit to appeal the decision to the appeal panel.

An individual receives notification when a worker notifies them:

- Verbally, on the date that the conversation with the worker takes place; or,

- In writing, on the date that the notice is presented to the individual by the worker; or,
- As outlined in [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#).

If the worker verbally notifies the individual, the worker must enter in [Compass Comments](#):

- The date the conversation took place,
- The decision that the individual was informed of, and
- (if applicable) Verification that the worker notified the individual of their right to appeal.

If the worker provides the decision in writing, the [EMP14927 Income Support Application Decision](#)

- The decision and rationale supporting why the decision was made, and
- The right to appeal the decision (in writing) within 30-days of first receiving notification.

NOTE: See [Overview and Authority](#) section to identify which decisions are subject to appeal.

The Appeal Process

Last updated on: Mar 31, 2025

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Supports Act, sections 43-48*](#)
[*Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 73-74 , 93-94 and 96-97*](#)

INTENT

To describe the appeal process and provide details and procedures for situations that may occur.

POLICY

Individuals who disagree with a decision can initiate an appeal within 30 days.

See [Overview and Authority](#) section to identify which decisions are subject to appeal.

Initiating the Appeal Process

To initiate the [appeal process](#), an individual must submit a completed **Notice of Appeal** form, (if an Appeal is submitted to an Alberta Supports Centre it should be forwarded to the Appeals Secretariat).

Workers and Supervisors should try to resolve the individual's concerns (if possible) prior to initiating an appeal.

If a **Notice of Appeal** form is required, the Worker or Supervisor should provide it to the individual or submit it to the [Alberta Supports – How to Appeal Webpage](#) and/or by contacting the office of the Appeals Secretariat.

When submitting a Notice of Appeal, the individual identifies:

- the decision they are appealing, and
- the reason for appeal.

The individual must submit the written Notice of Appeal to the Appeals Secretariat within 30 days.

When the Alberta Supports Centre receives an appeal form, the Worker:

- notifies the Appeal Secretariat by sending an email to SCSS.Appeals@gov.ab.ca with the
- documents in a Compass [Comment](#) that the Notice of Appeal was received and forwarded.

When the Appeals Secretariat receives the appeal form, they:

- register and upload the form in the System for Appeals Management (SAM), and
- send the appeal form to the appropriate Alberta Supports Centre.

Extension to 30-Day Time Limit to Submit an Appeal

The Appeals Secretariat has the delegated authority to grant an extension beyond the 30-day time limit.

In circumstances where an individual files a Notice of Appeal after the 30-day time limit has expired, the individual must complete this form. This form outlines how to request an extension to the 30-day time limit to appeal a decision.

An individual can submit a request for an extension in writing. The request must indicate:

- the date that notice of the decision was received, and
- the reason(s) why the Notice of Appeal could not be filed within the 30-day time limit.

Appeal extension requests must be forwarded to: SCSS.Appeals@gov.ab.ca

The Appeals Secretariat may contact the Alberta Supports Centre to verify the nature of the decision.

The Appeals Secretariat may grant an extension if they are satisfied that there are apparent grounds for an extension.

The Appeals Secretariat advises the individual and the Department if an extension is granted. If an appeal hearing is scheduled.

Note:

Under [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#), the appeal panel has authority to hear an appeal submitted by an individual if the individual satisfies the appeal panel that:

- the individual did not receive notice of the Department's decision, or
- the notice of decision was received later than when it was deemed to have been received.

Administrative Review

A Supervisor (or designate) completes an [Administrative Review](#) upon receipt of a **Notice of Appeal** document to SAM.

Scheduling the Appeal

If the appeal request is not withdrawn, the Appeals Secretariat schedules the appeal hearing date.

When the appeal hearing is scheduled, the Appeals Secretariat generates the Appeal Hearing Information Sheet.

- notifying the individual and Supervisor of the date, time and location of the appeal hearing
- instructing the individual to submit copies of any new information to the Appeal Secretariat

Preparing for the Appeal Hearing

The Supervisor reviews and documents all relevant information concerning the individual's situation and provides a fair and complete summary of the facts considered in making the decision under appeal.

If the Supervisor identifies information relating to accessibility concerns or security issues, the Supervisor should bring this to the appeal hearing. The Supervisor should communicate any such information by emailing the Appeals Secretariat.

Responsibilities of the Appellant

The individual:

- provides any new information to the Appeals Secretariat and program in advance of the hearing (presenting new information at the hearing that has not previously been reviewed may result in a new appeal)
- reviews documentation provided by the Supervisor,
- provides written consent if another person will be representing the individual at the appeal
- advises the appeal panel via the Appeals Secretariat:
 - if unable to attend the appeal hearing (individuals who cannot appear in person may request a written statement)
 - if an advocate or another individual will be attending the hearing to support or assist
 - if a lawyer will be attending the hearing, and/or
 - if an interpreter is required, as all hearings are conducted in English (individuals may request an interpreter)

Legal Support Related to an Appeal

Legal Services does **not** attend appeal hearings or make oral submissions for presentation in a hearing. Legal Services **may** assist with preparing the ARD and the Department's written arguments that support the appeal.

- the matter under appeal involves a potentially precedent-setting case, and
- the matter under appeal is of significant importance at a provincial level.

If Legal Services are needed, the Regional Executive Director is required to contact Legal Services.

- Executive Director requests for legal support can be sent to the Director of Legal Services
 - the subject line of the email should read: **Legal Assistance requested re: Income and Employment**
-

Informal and Administrative Review

Last updated on: Mar 31, 2025

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\), sections 43-48](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 73-74, 93-94 and 96-97](#)

INTENT

To describe the review processes that occur prior to an appeal.

POLICY

The Supervisor completes the Informal Review and/or Administrative Review and discusses the hearing.

Informal Review

Clients who do not agree with a decision regarding eligibility for assistance under [Part 2](#) of IESA/ original decision was made.

The Supervisor can informally review the decision and may vary or reverse it. If the Supervisor sections of IESA, associated Regulations and the policy used to make this decision. The Super

The Supervisor should attempt to resolve the situation (if possible) prior to an appeal being initiated [of Appeal](#) to the Appeals Secretariat and have the decision reviewed by the appeal panel.

Administrative Review

Upon receipt of a **Notice of Appeal** form, (or any form of written notice requesting an appeal) the Representative completes an Administrative Review of Decision (ARD) and enters this information

The Supervisor completes an ARD by examining the information:

- on the individual's file,
- provided by the worker,
- provided by the individual appealing, and
- provided in the **Notice of Appeal** form and/or the written submission prepared by the individual

The Supervisor completes an ARD in SAM and records this activity in [Compass Comments](#).

Timeline for Administrative Review

The Supervisor should complete the ARD within two business days. Supervisors must notify the

The Appeals Secretariat receives and enters the Notice of Appeal details into SAM to create the appeal. The Supervisor contacts the Appeals Secretariat and forwards the Notice of Appeal to the Appeals Secretariat with the individual.

Outcome of Administrative Review

The Supervisor may confirm, vary or reverse the original decision which will be documented in the ARD.

- If the Supervisor confirms or varies the decision, the appeal proceeds to the appeal panel
- If the Supervisor reverses the decision, the Appeals Secretariat will confirm with the individual.

Documenting the Administrative Review

The Supervisor enters the ARD in SAM within 14 calendar days of receiving the individual's Notice of Appeal.

In exceptional circumstances where the matter under appeal is complex, up to an additional seven days may be added. Examples of exceptional circumstances include:

- appealing more than one decision, or
- providing additional information that may impact the calculation of an overpayment.

The Supervisor must share with the Appeal Secretariat and record in Compass Comments if the appeal is exceptional.

Benefits Not Regulated by Legislation

If the decision under appeal is not legislated (not addressed in the IESA or Regulations), the Supervisor must:

1. specifies the applicable policy or directive in the ARD, and
2. includes a summary of the applicable policy or directive to substantiate the decision.

Benefits that are Specifically Regulated or Legislated

If the decision under appeal is legislated (addressed in the IESA or Regulations), the Supervisor must:

1. specifies the applicable section of IESA or the Regulation in the ARD,
2. includes a summary of the applicable IESA or Regulation section to substantiate the decision,
3. (if applicable) records in the ARD if they believe the appeal panel does not have authority to rule upon.

NOTE:

If an individual appeals the denial of a benefit that is issued under [Director's Approval](#), the Supervisor must:

1. includes a summary of the Area Manager/Regional Director's rationale for denial in the ARD,
2. records on the ARD that benefits issued by Director's Approval are under the jurisdiction of the Director and are not within the appeal panel's jurisdiction to rule upon.

Media Attendance at an Appeal Hearing

Last updated on: Jan 18, 2021

INTENT

To describe how Income Support handles situations where the Media is seeking to attend an Appeal Hearing.

POLICY

Prior to allowing media to attend an appeal hearing, the Department Representative must specify the following conditions:

- No cameras or recording devices are allowed, and
- Media may only attend the segment of the appeal hearing that relates directly to the individual's appeal.

If an individual requests that media be allowed to attend the appeal hearing, in advance of the appeal hearing, the Department Representative must schedule the hearing.

Communications:

- Advises whether an onsite media spokesperson is required;
- Provides a spokesperson to speak to the media on behalf of the Department, (if necessary);
- Decides which program and background materials (if any) may be provided to media representatives;
- Notifies the Minister as appropriate.

If an individual requests that media be allowed to attend the appeal hearing, at the time of the appeal hearing, the Department Representative must advise the individual of the consequences of a media representative being in attendance. The individual is advised that:

- Media attendance at the hearing will not change the appeal panel's ruling on the decision;
- Any information presented could become part of the media story, whether favorable or unfavorable;
- No third-party information can be presented or released to the media.

Note

Members of the appeal panel consult with the Appeals Secretariat regarding media presence at the appeal hearing.

The Supervisor should request an adjournment to consult with Communications regarding media attendance. If the Department Representative consults with Communications (and the appeal panel does not object), the hearing will proceed with media attendance.

Regardless of media attendance, the appeal hearing process and the Department's presentation of the appeal hearing remain the same.

Non-Attendance at Appeal

Last updated on: Mar 31, 2025

INTENT

To describe the process if there is non-attendance or abandonment of an appeal.

POLICY

Non-Attendance at the Appeal Hearing

If the individual does not attend a scheduled appeal hearing and has not notified the appeal panel:

- proceed with the appeal hearing and make a decision in the individual's absence, or
- choose not to proceed with the appeal hearing and ask the Appeals Secretariat to reschedule.

When an individual fails to attend a scheduled appeal hearing, a notation is made in the System. The individual is required to contact their office either to reschedule another hearing date or to withdraw the appeal.

The Appeals Secretariat contacts the individual, and documents the number and type of contact. An Appeal Hearing Letter is sent to the individual advising of the date, time and location of the rescheduled hearing.

Individuals that Fail to Respond to Appeal activities

If the individual:

- reschedules another hearing date with the Appeals Secretariat and does not attend the appeal hearing, or
- has not contacted the Appeals Secretariat and fails to appear at the rescheduled appeal hearing.

The department may request that the appeal panel:

- proceed with the appeal hearing and make a decision in the individual's absence, or
- consider the appeal to be abandoned and confirm the original decision.

It is within the appeal panel's discretion to reschedule another appeal hearing.

In all circumstances, the Director's Representative must be prepared to present to the appeal panel a record of the number of attempts made to contact the individual.

Appeal Considered Abandoned

If an individual does not attend a scheduled appeal hearing for a third time, the following may occur in their absence which:

- declares the appeal to be abandoned,

- confirms the department's original decision,
 - renders a Panel Decision to the individual advising that their appeal has been declared at
 - provides a copy of the Panel Decision to the Department.
-

Appeal Hearings

Last updated on: Jan 18, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, sections: 35 , 36.1, 37, and 43-48](#)

[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections: 73-74 , 92-94 and 97](#)

INTENT

To describe the different components and parties involved in an Income Support appeal.

POLICY

An Appeal Hearing is a quasi-judicial process where all parties to an appeal have equal opportunity to present the validity of any or all information presented.

Process during an Appeal Hearing

The person Chairing the hearing:

- makes introductions,
- explains the rules of the hearing,
- clarifies the decision being appealed,
- asks if anyone objects to the people on the panel and/or their right to rule on the decision
- asks if all parties received the information submitted and if they are ready to proceed, and
- Asks if there is any new information or documentation to be presented.

The Department Representative (Supervisor):

- explains the Department's original decision to refuse, change or cancel a benefit,
- should not withhold any relevant information,
- ensures that all relevant information concerning the individual's situation and the Department is presented,
- advises that a Department representative cannot advocate on behalf of the individual during the hearing.

After the Supervisor presents information on behalf of the Department, both the individual and the Supervisor will ask the individual for their comments.

The individual:

- is given the opportunity to provide information relevant to his/her appeal either verbally or in writing,
- should not withhold any relevant information.

After the individual presents their information, both the Supervisor and members of the Appeal I
The person chairing the Appeal Hearing asks if either the individual or the Department represen
The individual and the Department representative then have an opportunity to make final staten

Adjournments

The Department representative or the individual may request an adjournment if new informatior
The Department requires adequate opportunity to review new information, as the nature of the
Adjournments are until a specific date agreed upon by all participants.

After the Appeal Hearing

Last updated on: Jan 18, 2021

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act, Schedule, sections 43-48](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits Regulation, sections 93-97](#)

INTENT

To describe protocols for situations that may occur after an Appeal Hearing.

POLICY

A number of outcomes can occur as a result of a Citizen's Appeal Panel Hearing. The individual

The Appeal Panel may confirm, reverse or vary (change) the decision under appeal.

After the Appeal Hearing, the Appeal Panel:

- prepares and issues a Panel Decision on the matter under appeal,
- prepares the Appeal Report, including:
 - facts and/or evidence on which the Appeal Panel based its ruling, as presented by the individual,
 - justification for the decision, and
 - authority for the decision by citing the appropriate section(s) of the Act or Regulation
- sends the Appeal Report to the District Office and to the individual with a written decision

If the Appeal Panel reverses or varies the original decision, the Panel Decision document:

- records an itemized list of the specific benefits, goods and/or services awarded to the individual
- records any restrictions pertaining to cost, frequency, time limitations, etc.

If the Appeal Panel reverses or varies the original decision, the Department:

- schedules payment of benefits, and
- updates Compass Comments.

Challenge of Seniors, Community and Social Service Appeal Panel Decision

The Appeal Panel's ruling on a decision under appeal is final. However, if the individual is not satisfied with the decision, they may request a review by the Social Services Review Board.

- ask the Alberta Ombudsman's office to review the process used by the Appeal Panel to r
- Request a ruling from Court of King's Bench by filing a Judicial Review of the decision.

If the Department believes that the Appeal Panel has exceeded its authority, the Department m
filing a Judicial Review of the decision. Staff are asked to raise these concerns according to the

Benefits authorized by the Appeal Panel must be issued to the individual, pending outcome of t

Recovery of benefits authorized by the Appeal Panel can occur if Court of King's Bench quashe

Should the Department make application to have the Appeal Panel's ruling on the decisio
introduced as evidence at Court of King's Bench.

13 Overpayments, Underpayments, Debts & Recov

INTENT

To minimize the creation of Community and Social Services debts.

To ensure clients receive all the benefits for which they are eligible under the program.

- To recover benefits to which clients are not entitled, or benefits which are subject to repay
- The amount of the debt does not exceed the amount issued by Community and Social Se
- Clients must repay all benefits issued in specific situations where they would not have bee

To maximize the collection of Community and Social Services debt within existing legislation, w

- Community and Social Services collection activity must be professional, efficient and fair.
- Debts are collected as quickly as possible with the least administrative costs. The cost of
- Ensure procedures for the administration of agreements and orders, and the bankruptcy p
- Whenever possible, negotiation and conciliation are preferable to court action.

To ensure all clients are:

- Treated equitably.
- Advised of their right to appeal within 30 days of being notified of an assessed overpayme
- Provided adequate opportunity to provide documentation to support their case.
- Provided with clear information about the reason for their debt, how the debt will be repaic
- Provided with clear and complete information so that they understand their debt status at

POLICY

The policies and procedures for calculating overpayments apply to all delivery staff regardless c

Assessment and Notification of an Overpayment

Last updated on: Nov 13, 2024

Assessment and Notification of an Overpayment

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), sections 35 and 36.1](#)

[Limitations Act, Section 3\(1\)\(a\)](#)

INTENT

To recover benefits that a client or third party was not entitled to receive and to recover benefits of assessed overpayments in a manner that clarifies and preserves their right to appeal and pro

POLICY

Assessing an Overpayment

An overpayment may be assessed against an Income Support client or former client, a sponsor client's behalf within 24 months from the date the overpayment was discovered. Third Parties r

Clients are responsible to advise the Income Support program of any change in circumstances inaccurate information, an investigation and/or overpayment may occur.

If a potential overpayment is identified, but there is insufficient information to calculate the overp

An overpayment will be assessed against a client if:

- A client received a benefit that has not been used for its intended purpose
- A client received a benefit due to non-disclosure of a material fact or provision of false info
- A client received a benefit they were not entitled to receive.

An overpayment may be assessed against a third party or a sponsor if:

- A benefit received by a third party has not been used for its intended purpose,
- A benefit received by a third party that was received due to non-disclosure of a material fa
- A benefit received by a third party that the client was not entitled to receive, or
- A sponsor defaults on support obligations under a sponsorship agreement involving an In result of the duties arising from the sponsorship agreement.

A potential overpayment should be assessed within 24 months from the date it was discovered. date and processing exceptions.

Repayment Requirement

In appropriate circumstances, as described in the [Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay](#), the requirement to repay an amount or value that has been assessed as an overpayment (including

- The amount owing is already a debt due, owing to the Government of Alberta; or
- In the opinion of the director, the person received the benefit by fraud or wilful misrepresentation.

While the client's file is active, any debt to Seniors, Community and Social Services will be recovered. Once a file closes, arrangements must be made to pay their debt. Refer to the [Recovery of](#)

Notice of Overpayment

Whenever an overpayment is assessed, the department **must** issue written notification within 2

- That the client may provide documentation to support their position;
- Amount of the overpayment;
- Period of Assistance (dates) when the overpayment occurred;
- Reason for the overpayment;
- How the overpayment was calculated;
- Director (or delegate) decision to require or to exempt the client's requirement to repay all or part of the overpayment;
- Amount owing that is required to be repaid to the government of Alberta;
- Right to appeal the director (or delegate) decisions to assess the overpayment and to require repayment;
- Collection of an assessed overpayment will begin after the 30-day appeal period expires (including interest) on all or part of the overpayment.

Note

If a client chooses to repay an overpayment before it is assessed and/or becomes a debt

Overpayment Process

Last updated on: Nov 19, 2024

Overpayment Process

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\), Parts 6 and 9](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 99](#)
[Recovery Regulation](#)
[Limitations Act, Section 3\(1\)\(a\)](#)

INTENT

To outline the overpayment process from the initial identification of a potential overpayment to t

POLICY

Processing an overpayment involves three phases with multiple steps. A comprehensive under: the process. The following chart outlines the three phases of the process and who is responsibl

Phases	Respon
1. Identifying an Overpayment	
Identifying a potential overpayment	Front Li
Calculating an overpayment	Overpay
2. Overpayment Decisions	
Assessing an overpayment	Delegat
Determining the requirement to repay	Delegat
Notifying the client	Delegat
3. Becoming a Debt Due	
Convert to a permanent debt	Overpay

Phase 1 - Identifying an Overpayment

An overpayment occurs when a client:

- Received benefits to which they were not entitled due to non-disclosure of material fact, fa
- Did not use a benefit, supplemental benefit, health benefit, or training benefit, for its intent

A potential overpayment should be [assessed](#) within 24 months from the date it was discovered. There was a potential overpayment. Every circumstance is unique, but examples may include:

- the date a worker reviewed a report that identified a client had income that was not recorded
- the date a worker identified that benefits were calculated incorrectly,
- the date a client responded or provided information that demonstrated a potential overpayment
- the date a client identified to the program that their benefits are incorrect.

When a potential overpayment is identified and additional information is required to establish the overpayment, the program must request the information within 30 days. If no information is provided within 30 days, the program must assume the overpayment is correct.

An overpayment is calculated using the [Recoveries System](#).

Note

The client's ongoing eligibility must also be reviewed as soon as the potential overpayment is identified.

Refer to the [Total Ineligibility](#) policy to determine if medical benefits should be included in the overpayment calculation.

Refer to the [Overpayments as a Result of a Retroactive Payments](#) when a client receives retroactive payments.

This overpayment process is not followed for the following circumstances:

- [Repayment agreements](#) and court orders for repayment (i.e. restitution) become a permanent part of the client's record.
- [Sponsorship defaults](#) are entered into the Recoveries System by Treasury Board and Finance Canada.

The rates and policies in effect at the time the overpayment occurred **must** be used.

Earnings exemptions are not provided if the client **intentionally** did not report income or **intentionally** misrepresented income. For Seniors, Community and Social Services (SCSS), an earnings exemption is provided against the overpayment.

Provided there are no grounds to suspect fraud or willful misrepresentation, the director has discretion to waive the overpayment if:

- the value is determined to be less than \$50 for every Period of Assistance (POA) to a maximum of \$500.
- more than three years have elapsed between the final POA in which the overpayment occurred and the date of discovery.
- the program has not assessed the overpayment and more than 24 months have elapsed since the date of discovery.

Note

In general, new overpayments are not assessed against deceased clients. These overpayments are not assessed against deceased clients. For assistance with these cases refer to [Communicating with Delivery Supports](#).

If it is determined that an overpayment should not be assessed, COMPASS comments are required not being assessed.

Phase 2 - Overpayment Decisions

The delegated authority makes two concurrent decisions:

- assessing an overpayment, and
- determining the requirement to repay an assessed overpayment.

The director's authority to assess and determine the repayment requirement of an assessed overpayment is governed by [Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) policies. These decisions are

If fraud or wilful misrepresentation is suspected, the overpayment process stops until an [Investment](#) is accepted, wilful misrepresentation or fraud may still be suspected and should be indicated on the explanation of why the RFI was not accepted

The delegated authority for overpayment decisions is responsible for notifying the client of their

Note

A client may repay an overpayment at any time by following the [Voluntary Repayment of an Overpayment](#)

Phase 3 – Becoming a Debt Due

A client may appeal one or both of the decisions as described in the [Notice of Decision](#) policy.

If the client provides additional information that impacts the calculation or understanding of the debt, the delegated authority reviews the information and determines if this information changes the original decisions.

An assessed overpayment remains a temporary debt in the Recoveries System until:

- the appeal period has elapsed,
- the appeal has been disposed of by the Appeal Panel,
- the appeal panel upholds the Ministry's decision, or
- the appeal has been determined to be abandoned by the Appeal Panel.

Once the above scenarios have passed and the temporary debt is converted to a permanent debt, it is subject to monthly deductions. The [Recovery of Debt](#) policy describes the recovery rate and circumstances.

If a client chooses to pay a potential overpayment before it is entered into the Recoveries System, the delegated authority follows the [Voluntary Repayment of an Overpayment](#) policy. Any portion of an outstanding debt for closed files is the responsibility of the management of debts on closed files as well as the collection of these debts.

PROCEDURES

The Provincial Overpayment Tracker is designed to monitor the entire overpayment process including

when an overpayment converts to a debt due. The information collected is used for reporting and process with copies of letters and forms used should be saved to the client's file.

Phase 1 - Identifying an Overpayment

The Worker at the program delivery site who identified a potential overpayment:

1. _____
 - _____
 - _____
2. Completes a [Request for Investigation \(EMP0037\)](#) as described in the [Investigations](#) policy
3. Refers the potential overpayment to the overpayment team by entering the initial information

Note

Only if the EMP0037 is not accepted does the overpayment get referred to the overpayment team.

The Overpayment Worker:

_____ to create the Overpayment Notice _____

If 30 days has passed and the client has not responded to a Potential Overpayment Request, refer the client to the program.

Note

The Overpayment Notice explains the reason for the overpayment and must contain language that should include the values referenced and where they came from if applicable.

Income Services Investigation Unit (ISIU) Operational Supports processes overpayments that require

Phase 2 - Overpayment Decisions

The Overpayment Worker:

Note

If the Worker indicates that wilful misrepresentation or fraud is suspected, they must explain in 1

6. Moves to step 9, if the worker is delegated with the authority for the decisions or submit to supervisor for review and escalation, if required.

Exception

The Delegated Authority may request an Overpayment Notice from the Recoveries System to a client with an Overpayment.

The Supervisor:

- ensure policy has been accurately applied,
- verify the discovery date identified,
- confirm the accuracy of the calculation,
- validate the POAs impacted, and
- evaluate the recommendation regarding repayment.

Note

Any required revisions to the overpayment must be updated before any overpayment decisions

8. Submits the overpayment along with the required information to the appropriate Delega

The respective Delegated Authority:

The Overpayment Worker:

- making Compass Comments,
- saving the completed DS12200 and EMP13448 letter to the client's file,
- updating the Provincial Overpayment Tracker,
- if full repayment is not required adjusting the Overpayment Notice and entering Inter
- setting a reminder to convert the temporary debt to a permanent debt after at least 3

Note

If the client chooses to appeal one or both of the decisions and provides new information with a must be shared with the appropriate Delegated Authority to confirm or revise the initial decision issues a revised EMP13448 letter, resetting the time the client has to appeal the decisions.

Phase 3 - Becoming a Debt

Once the requirements have been met to change the debt to permanent in the Recoveries Syst

12. Prints and issues the Debt Notice from the Recoveries System which includes the Sta

Note

The Debt Notice must be printed to ensure the LISA system is updated.

13. Updates the Provincial Overpayment Tracker and records comments on the file.

Note

If either decision is changed at appeal, this change must be recorded in the Provincial Overpay

Delegated Authority for Overpayment Decisions

Last updated on: Mar 12, 2026

Delegated Authority for Overpayment Decisions

AUTHORITY

[*Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), section 35*](#)

INTENT

To establish delegated authority levels for making decisions about overpayment.

POLICY

An overpayment can be the result of various circumstances that may be attributed to the program.

- assessing an overpayment, and
- determining the requirement to repay an assessed overpayment.

These decisions are subject to review by an [Appeal Panel](#).

Before an overpayment is assessed, the delegated authority is responsible for confirming that the overpayment is assessed, the requirement to repay or exempt the requirement to repay an assessed overpayment suspected fraud or wilful misrepresentation based on the [Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) policy.

If any level of delegated authority is uncertain of what decision to make, they are encouraged to consult with their supervisor.

Levels of Delegated Authority

Level One (Worker)

Workers are authorized to assess and require repayment of overpayments that span up to and including the current month. Workers are also authorized to assess and require repayment of any overpayments that occurred as a result of a suspected fraud or wilful misrepresentation. Workers are not authorized to exempt the requirement to repay any portion of an assessed overpayment.

Level Two (Supervisor)

In addition to the authority of Level One, supervisors are authorized to assess and require repayment of overpayments that span up to and including the current month. Supervisors are also authorized to exempt the requirement to repay overpayments that span up to and including the current month in the [Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) policy.

Level Three (Manager)

In addition to the authority of Level Two, managers are authorized to assess and require repayment of overpayments that span up to and including the current month. In addition, managers are authorized to exempt the requirement to repay overpayments that span up to and including the current month in appropriate circumstances as described in the [Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) policy.

Level Four (Statutory Director)

In addition to the authority of Level Three, the statutory director is authorized to assess and require repayment of overpayments that span up to and including the current month. In addition, the statutory director is authorized to exempt the requirement to repay any overpayment that span up to and including the current month in the [Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) policy.

The following chart summarizes the delegated authority levels for overpayment decisions.

Delegated Authority Levels for Overpayment Decisions	
Level	Assess Overpayments
Level One (Worker)	Up to and including 2 POAs and any that occurred as a result of retroactive CDB payments regardless of the span or value.
Level Two (Supervisor)	Up to and including 6 POA
Level Three (Manager)	Up to and including 12 POA
Level Four (Statutory Director)	Any

Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay a

Last updated on: Apr 24, 2024

Criteria for Exempting the Requirement to Repay a

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), section 35](#)
[Recovery Regulation](#)

INTENT

To describe considerations to exempt a client from the requirement to repay in each instance and

POLICY

An overpayment can be the result of various circumstances that may be attributable to the program. In appropriate circumstances, the director may exempt a person from the requirement to repay an

- The amount owing is a [debt](#) due to the Government of Alberta; or
- In the opinion of the director, the person received the benefit by fraud or wilful misrepresentation

If the director suspects fraud or wilful misrepresentation, the overpayment cannot be exempted from repayment by staff. In situations where a worker suspects fraud, the overpayment is not considered for a repayment exemption.

In other cases, the exemption of repayment of an assessed overpayment can be considered under the [Overpayment Process](#) policies.

Note

Court ordered restitution, [repayment agreements](#) or overpayments as a result of a [sponsorship](#)

The following considerations are generally used by the Income Support program to determine whether or not the assessed overpayment may be considered as pure administrative error or other

- The extent of the program's role versus the client's role in causing the overpayment;
- Whether the client failed to fulfill the requirements of the program as outlined in the declaration of assets and liabilities;
- Whether the client provided false information with respect to their income, assets or personal circumstances;
- Whether the client failed to disclose a material fact in order to receive a benefit to which they were not entitled;
- Whether the client made a reasonable effort to advise the program of a change in circumstances;
- Whether the client was aware they were receiving benefits to which they were not entitled;
- Whether the client's disability or medical condition contributed to causing the overpayment;
- Whether the client materially benefited directly or indirectly from the overpayment.

“Pure administrative error” has specific parameters that the overpayment was caused solely by attributed to the actions/inactions of the client in any way.

Examples that would qualify for exemption under a pure administrative error include the following:

- A client notifies the program that they earned \$400 in monthly employment income. The worker is not notified.
- Two clients with the same name have their files mixed up and one client receives the other's payment. The client is notified about the error immediately.

Guidelines for decision-making on overpayments that result from retroactive lump-sum payments

Total Ineligibility

Last updated on: Nov 19, 2024

Total Ineligibility

POLICY

Clients may become ineligible for Income Support benefits for a variety of reasons. In some cases, clients may have the opportunity to present documentation to support their case and be advised of their right to appeal.

Common reasons for total ineligibility are outlined below (with limitations specified).

Reason and Limitation	
Reason	
Undeclared Asset(s)	
Undeclared Income	
Undeclared Partner(married/common-law)	
Duplicate Assistance	
Fraud Involvement Charges Laid	
Incarceration	

Present in Alberta

Unreported changes in circumstances and willful misrepresentation of information may result in
The [Income Support Recipients from Other Provinces and Territories](#) policy contains informatio
If a household has become ineligible, refer to the [Denying or Terminating Benefits](#) and [File Clos](#)

Assessment of an Overpayment

If after considering [eligibility impacts](#) a client is deemed totally ineligible, an overpayment includ
the Alberta Adult Health Benefits (AAHB) eligibility for [clients leaving Income Support](#).

An income exemption is not provided against unreported income.

The amount of the overpayment cannot exceed the amount of Income Support benefits issued.
offset the calculation of an overpayment.

PROCEDURES

If it is determined that a potential overpayment may have occurred, the [Overpayment Process](#) i:

Overpayments as a Result of Retroactive Payment

Last updated on: Nov 19, 2024

Overpayments as a Result of Retroactive Payment

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Supports Act \(IESA\), sections 14, 15, 16 and 35](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, Section 99 and Schedule 2](#)

INTENT

To ensure overpayments are assessed consistently by treating retroactive income as periodic payments.

POLICY

Program staff must assess an overpayment for each Period of Assistance (POA) that duplicates the result of a retroactive lumpsum payment that was intended for a POA during which the household was eligible for periodic payments.

The Criteria for [Exempting the Requirement to Repay an Assessed Overpayment](#) does **not** prohibit an overpayment if the retroactive (non-exempt) income issued from another program or source is not from the same program.

- An example of retroactive income from another program may include income from Worker's Compensation.
- An example of retroactive income from another source may include replacement income from a former employer.

When a client applies for financial benefits from another program, there may be a delay in approval of a lump sum payment. The retroactive payment may include income that the client was eligible to receive through periodic payments, is applied according to the [On-Going Assistance](#) policy; that income would not be included in a lumpsum payment. Income Support adjusts prior monthly benefit calculations to include the retroactive income. The ongoing income is also applied to the ongoing eligibility calculation for the POA immediately following the retroactive payment.

If a retroactive payment was intended prior to the first POA, the [Income and the First Benefit Period](#) income intended prior to the first POA is used to calculate the first POA eligibility and income in the first POA payment was not [Available Income](#) at intake.

Exception

The [Assignment of Benefits](#) process assigns Employment Insurance (EI) income from the same program. This usually results in an overpayment. If the client had not reported their EI application, there would be no overpayment.

An overpayment is calculated if a client receives a retroactive payment of non-exempt income that was intended for a POA. Program staff must apply retroactive income to a POA when the client received Income Support budget calculation.

Examples

1. Retroactive OAS eligibility effective March 2022 and client started on the Income Support budget calculation. The OAS benefits started being deducted from the household's monthly benefits or the household's budget calculation.

2. Retroactive CPP eligibility effective March 2022 and client started on the Income Support that the CPP benefits started being deducted from the household's monthly benefits or the
3. Retroactive CPP-D eligibility was effective March 2022 and client was eligible for AISH effective November 2021. An Income Support overpayment should be assessed from April 2022 to applied up to the POA that the CPP-D benefits started being deducted from the AISH client

Note

It is in the best interest of the client, when there is an overpayment as a result of a retroactive lump sum payment, to make to process these two overpayments simultaneously with one Overpayment Notice calculate two Notice of Assessed Overpayment (EMP13448) letters from the respective programs. If the program or source, and the amount that the client will receive is known, program staff should assess an overpayment after a retroactive payment is received.

However, if a signed EMP0976B is not in place, an overpayment is assessed. Program staff should refer to the Assessment and Notification of an Overpayment and [Overpayment](#)

Voluntary Repayment of an Overpayment

Last updated on: Mar 21, 2024

Voluntary Repayment of an Overpayment

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), sections 16\(1\) and \(4\), and sections 35\(1\) and \(5\)](#)

INTENT

To outline the process to ensure clients are aware of their rights if they choose to repay an overpayment.

POLICY

There may be extenuating circumstances where a client chooses to **voluntarily** repay an overpayment that has been assessed and/or declared a debt due. Staff must make a reasonable effort to ensure client understanding is imbedded in the [Notice of Overpayment](#) policy.

Before staff can accept a client's payment for an overpayment that has not yet been assessed,

Record the reason that the form was not completed in Compass Comments. Include that the client has a full understanding.

Set a Reminder in Compass to complete, at a later date, the policy requirement to sign the form.

Note

This policy is different from the [Repayment Agreements](#) section where payments are **not** voluntary.

By voluntarily agreeing to repay the amount, and signing the [Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver](#),

Program staff may accept payment once the client has been made aware of their rights and has signed the Agreement and Waiver, the client acknowledges they are waiving the following standards:

- To be notified in writing of the assessed overpayment, the amount they are required to repay; and
- To provide additional information that may impact the amount or value they are required to repay.

As the client is voluntarily choosing to repay the amount, and waiving the right to be notified in writing in the future, a written decision of the director will be provided confirming:

- The assessed overpayment and the amount or value they are required to repay; and,
- That the client has the right to appeal.

If the client reconsiders their choice to repay the overpayment after signing the Agreement and Waiver, no further information is available. The client will **not** have an opportunity to submit additional information for repayment is required.

Assessed Overpayment (30-day appeal period remains in force)

Clients who have received written notification that they are required to repay an assessed overpayment are **not** required to sign the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver**.

PROCEDURES

Accepting a Client's Voluntary Repayment of an Overpayment

After receiving notice of a potential overpayment, an individual may choose to bypass the overpayment process if the overpayment has not gone through the process imbedded in the [Overpayment Process](#) policy, 1

Before staff can accept a client's payment for an overpayment that has not yet been assessed,

In these situations, the following procedures are applied.

Staff at the reception desk:

1. Ask the person if they making a payment towards an overpayment or debt that applies to
2. Engage with the worker to confirm if the payment applies to:
 - A potential overpayment that has only been identified (overpayment is not yet assessed)
 - An assessed overpayment (client's 30-day appeal period is still in force); or
 - An established debt due.

The Worker completes the following tasks.

1. The worker must make every reasonable effort to inform the client of their rights under the [Process](#) policies before the client is asked to sign the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver**
 - If the 30-day period for a potential overpayment remains in force, the worker informs the client of the director decision that no overpayment has occurred or an exemption from repaying is in place.
 - The worker also reminds the client of their right to appeal the director's decision, which may result in the client being required to repay all or part of the amount.
2. The worker asks the client to sign the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver** and the Director's decision.
3. The worker signs the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver** under the Director's decision.
By voluntarily agreeing to repay the amount and signing the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver**, the worker may sign the **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver** as the director's delegate.
4. The worker enters the overpayment and updates it to permanent status in the Recoveries system. The worker ensures that the debt letter in Recoveries is **not** issued to the client until payment has been received.
5. The worker enters Compass Comments and Internal comments in Recoveries, documenting the overpayment.
 - All relevant information related to the overpayment (e.g., Amount, Period of Assistance, etc.)

- The amount and date of the client's voluntary payment; and,
- That the client has been made aware of their rights and has signed the **Voluntary R**

6. The worker ensures that the signed **Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver** is pl:

Once the Voluntary Repayment Agreement and Waiver is signed staff at the reception de

1. Provide a photo-copy of the signed Agreement and Waiver to the client;
2. Accept the client's payment;
3. Issue a receipt for the payment; and
4. Follow the Finance [cash handling procedure](#).

Client Reconsiders the Decision to Repay

A client may reconsider the decision to repay the overpayment after signing the **Voluntary Rep** review the overpayment and issue a decision, the following procedures apply.

The worker advises the client that:

1. The director (or delegate) will review this matter and confirm whether the overpayment sh
2. The decision of the director will be based on information available and no additional docur
3. The director (or delegate) will issue a decision letter advising the client of:
 - The assessed overpayment,
 - The amount required to be repaid,
 - The right to appeal.

The Worker:

1. Prepares appropriate background materials related to the overpayment for review by the (overpayment package).

The Supervisor:

1. Reviews the overpayment, and forwards applicable background material via an email to [S](#) notice of decision to the client (e.g., **Letter EMP12210 – Full Repayment Required, Lett Required**, as applicable).
2. Depending on the statutory director's decision, ensures that the correct notice of decision

3. If applicable, takes steps to issue payment of a credit balance to the client should the dire repaying all or part of the amount owing (refer to procedures under the [Credit Balance](#) pol
4. Ensures that the director's decision is documented in Compass Comments and Internal/E

Assessed Overpayment (30-day appeal period remains in force)

Clients who have already been notified of an assessed overpayment and who choose to repay **Agreement and Waiver.**

In these situations, the following procedures are applied.

Staff at the reception desk:

1. Accept the client's payment;
2. Issue a receipt for the payment; and
3. Follow the Finance [cash handling procedure](#).

The Worker:

1. Enters Compass Comments and Internal/External comments in Recoveries, indicating the
 2. Updates the overpayment to permanent status in the Recoveries System, transitioning the
-

Recoveries System

Last updated on: Apr 24, 2024

Recoveries System

POLICY

Entering an Overpayment in the Recoveries System

The Recoveries System is a web-based system used to calculate Seniors, Community and Soc

The worker enters the information in the OP/Debt Groups Summary screen to calculate a new c
IS/AISH/AAHB Debt Type will default to temporary status when first created.

Temporary status means the overpayment entered is not yet a permanent debt due to the gove
function, however notification will appear on the creator's homepage 40 days after the overpayr

Program staff **must** review the [Overpayment Process](#) policy to determine when an overpaymer
permanent debt for collection to begin.

Assignment of Overpayment

Normally an overpayment is assigned to the Head of Household. The Recoveries System attac

The system allows the worker to assign the overpayment to either the Head of Household, the p
may be appropriate to assign the overpayment to the partner).

Occasionally an overpayment is assigned to a non-client. In these circumstances Treasury Boa

Splitting an Overpayment

If both the Head of Household and the partner have undeclared income, it may be appropriate t
Household and the partner **must** not exceed:

- The total benefits issued, **or**
- The amount of the overpayment which would be assigned to one individual.

Rounding Income

As the Recoveries System does not automatically round cents to the nearest dollar amount, wo
the Recoveries System with a cents value less than 50 cents is rounded down to the nearest dc
rounded up to the next dollar amount.

If the client reports income of \$417.50 the amount entered and shown on the budget woul

Adjusting a Debt

A temporary debt may be edited (increased or decreased) before the status converts to a perm
when:

- an error was made in the previous calculation,

- new information is received,
- the delegated authority's decision impacts the amount that will be recovered, or
- the Appeal Panel has varied or reversed a decision.

A permanent debt cannot be increased without; creating a new temporary debt (overpayment), assessment.

Note

A second overpayment for overlapping Periods of Assistance (POA) cannot be created ur

Deleting an Existing Debt

An existing temporary debt may be deleted from the Recoveries System when:

- a potential overpayment is no longer being assessed,
- the delegated authority to assess an overpayment has determined that no repayment of a
- the appeal panel reverses the department's decision to assess an overpayment,

Note

The only reason a permanent debt may be considered for deletion would be a response to

Overpayment Notice

The worker must print the Overpayment Notice (EMP5510) from the Recoveries System where and includes comments explaining the reason for the overpayment. This notice must be saved i

Internal Comments

All comments related to overpayment calculations must be entered in **Internal Comments** in th

The following headings and information are defaulted by the Recoveries System:

- **Date Entered** defaults to the current date
- **Author** defaults to the person entering the overpayment/debt

The worker enters comments under the following headings:

- **Subject:** a one line summary of the text
- **Text:** a clear and concise explanation of activities or contact (i.e., Overpayment amount, r etc.)

Notice Comments

Comments included in the Overpayment Notice are used to outline the reason for the overpaym in the first person. For example, the worker should enter "you have been overpaid" instead of "ti

the content in the notification letter that is issued to the client.

Example

It is not appropriate to simply state “you received excess income”. The client must be told client is not given an earnings exemption because they deliberately failed to report employment.

The following headings and information is defaulted by the Recoveries system:

- **Date Entered** defaults to the current date
- **Author** defaults to the person entering the comment
- **Period(s) of Overpayment** defaults to the month(s) the overpayment occurred

The worker enters comments under the following headings:

- **Subject:** a one line reason for the overpayment
- **Text:** a clear and concise explanation as to why and when the overpayment occurred, how

Medical Benefits

If medical benefits **were excluded** in the initial determination and the worker wishes to **continue**, the worker manually deletes the appropriate medical need line(s) from the Edit OP/Debt Details screen if the

If medical benefits **were included** in the initial determination, all need/income lines (including medical

If the medical benefits **were excluded** in the initial determination and the worker now **wishes to**

If the medical benefits **were included** in the initial determination and now the worker **wishes to** Edit OP/Debt Details screen.

If after the adjustment is entered, the result is a [credit balance](#), the amount owing is issued

PROCEDURES

Creating a New Overpayment

The worker:

1. Reviews the procedures section in the [Overpayment Process](#) policy to ensure that the overpayment
2. Creates the overpayment as a temporary debt by clicking on the Op/Debt Group folder and

If an overpayment is being created for a non-client, TBF enters the overpayment as a Non-Client

Adjusting a Temporary Debt

The worker:

1. Edits the temporary debt based on the new or corrected information using the **Edit Debt** (

Note

If partial repayment is required, the temporary debt must be adjusted to reflect what needs

Notice from the Recoveries System must be printed and saved as a record of the full over

2. Enters new Notice Comment and Internal Comments to reflect the new information.

Converting an Overpayment to a Debt Due

Once the appeal period has elapsed (confirmed, varied or upheld), the appeal has been withdrawn

1. Converts the overpayment into a debt by changing the temporary or OP Pending status to
2. Prints and issues the applicable copy of the Debt Notice from the Recoveries System (wh
3. If the documents are returned, enters Internal Comments in the Recoveries System and r

Sometimes a client will make a payment at an Alberta Supports Centre without the worker entered into the repayment system (i.e., when the amount of a repayment agreement is unpaid) payment in order for the worker to enter or convert the overpayment to a permanent debt.

Decreasing a Permanent Debt

When it is determined that a permanent debt should be decreased, the worker:

1. Edits the permanent debt using the Edit Debt Group function and manually updates the status (not display as temporary status).
2. Prints two copies of the updated Statement of Debt (EMP2827). Sends one copy to the client, the other decreased and places the other copy on Section 1 of the client's file.
3. Enters new Notice Comments and Internal Comments to record the reason for the change
4. If the documents are returned, enters Internal Comments in the Recoveries System and r

Entering a Debt from a Repayment Agreement or a Restitution Order after a Fraud Conviction

If the client has signed a repayment agreement agreeing they have a debt or has been convicted of

1. Sets up the overpayment as temporary debt, but does not print the Overpayment Notice.
2. Converts the overpayment to a permanent debt and enters Internal Comments.
3. Prints a copy of the appropriate Debt Notice then issues to the client.
4. If the documents are returned, enters Internal Comments in the Recoveries System and r

If a court ordered repayment does not cover the entire overpayment amount, [the overpayment order](#) is established.

If there is a fraud conviction and the client has been ordered to pay restitution the Income Service

1. Enters the temporary debt showing the amount that needs to be paid under the court order. Sets the **Conviction** flag to **YES**
2. Immediately converts this temporary debt to permanent. Collection for this debt is not required.
3. Follows the Overpayment Process if there is a balance from the full overpayment amount in the Recoveries System. The R flag for this debt follows the standard [Recovery of Debt](#) policy.
4. Records all activity in the Recoveries System Comments and in Compass Comments.

Deleting an Existing Debt

The worker:

1. Enters Internal Comments in the Recoveries System and record the details of why the overpayment was retained.
2. Prints a copy of the Overpayment Notice from the Recoveries System to be retained as a permanent record.
3. Deletes the temporary debt from the Recoveries System.

LISA and CCD

Once a debt is entered on an **active file**, the Recoveries System downloads the:

- Debt amount to LISA
- **R Flag** change on LISA
- **Recovery Flag** change on CCD

Once a debt is entered on a **closed file**, the Recoveries System downloads the:

- Change to the **Recovery Flag** on CCD
 - Updated information to LISA if the file is reopened.
-

Underpayments

Last updated on: Nov 19, 2024

Underpayments

An underpayment occurs when:

- A client was not issued a benefit they were entitled to receive, **or**
- A client was issued less than were eligible for.

This occurs whether the underpayment was a result of inaccurate information, missing information, or a clerical error.

Once an underpayment is assessed, the worker determines how the underpayment will be credited:

- Issuing a lump sum payment,
- Reducing an existing debt to the Government of Alberta and/or
- Adjusting benefit eligibility for specific Periods of Assistance (POAs) offsetting an assessed overpayment.

Clients are responsible to provide Income Support with accurate information on their financial and personal information.

A resulting underpayment should be issued to the client as a lump sum payment, following the file being closed. If an underpayment is determined to exist on a closed file that has been closed for less than 12 months, the worker must determine if adding the benefit to the client's budget would have made the client eligible for ongoing benefits.

An underpayment may be used to reduce a potential overpayment, assessed overpayment, or a debt to the Government of Alberta before any remaining balance is used to offset an overpayment or debt due to the Government of Alberta before any remaining balance is used to offset an overpayment or debt due to the Government of Alberta.

An underpayment is applied to the earliest Period of Assistance (POA) in the Recoveries System. If there are no debts and temporary debts in the Recoveries System, there is still a balance owed to the client, and the underpayment is issued as a lump sum payment.

PROCEDURE

LISA automatically posts **Need Code 1887 Underpayment** to the **Scratch Pad**.

Active File Where No Overpayment or Debt Exists

The worker:

1. Checks the Scratch Pad to confirm that this underpayment has not already been issued.
2. _____Need Code 1887 Underpayment.
3. If the underpayment relates to an ongoing benefit entitlement, the client's budget is updated and the underpayment is issued.

4. Enter Compass Comments outlining the details of the underpayment and the applicable P

Active File Where an Overpayment or Debt Exists

The worker:

1. Checks the Scratch Pad to confirm that this underpayment has not already been issued.
2. Adjusts the overpayment or debt in the Recoveries System for the months the underpaym
3. _____
4. _____

- The amount of the underpayment being issued,
- The POA(s) for that the underpayment applies to, when it is being issued, and
- What benefit was underpaid or income was not received causing the underpayment.

Note

The Recoveries System must not be used to balance an overpayment or debt from month to mo
overpayment or debt for that month. It will not allow a [credit](#) in one month and debt in anothe

File Closed Less than 30 Days Prior

If the client would have been eligible for assistance if the underpayment had been issued, the w

1. Checks the Scratch Pad to confirm that this underpayment has not already been issued.
2. Re-opens the income support file and revises the LISA budget for the last POA for which i
3. Issues the underpayment using the need code for the benefit which was under issued.
4. Releases the benefit to the client as if the file had not been closed.
5. Records [Notes](#) in Compass indicating that the file closed in error and that the budget has

Closed File Where an Overpayment or Debt Due Exists

The worker attempts to contact the client using the last known contact information on file. If atte
send advising the client to contact the department regarding benefits for which they are eligible.

The worker:

1. Checks the Scratch Pad to confirm that this underpayment has not already been issued.
2. Enters the OP/Debt Groups Tab to adjust the overpayment.
3. Adjusts the overpayment or debt in the Recoveries System for the months the underpaym
Underpayment will reduce the outstanding amount of the debt.
4. If there remains a balance owing to the client, the worker follows the procedures for where

5. After adjusting the debt, enters comments in Compass and the Recoveries System using
 - The amount of the underpayment being issued,
 - The POA the underpayment applies to, when it is being issued, and
 - What benefit was underpaid, or income was not received.

Closed File Where no Overpayment or Debt Due Exists,

The worker attempts to contact the client using the last known contact information on file. If attempted, the worker sends advising the client to contact the department regarding benefits for which they are eligible.

If the client makes contact, the worker:

1. Explains the underpayment.
2. Opens the file or has the client's electronic file downloaded from the CCD to LISA.
3. Enters Function 1 – Eligibility Determination and Function 4 – Reopen Client and issues the Underpayment.
4. Allows the file to system close after having issued the benefit.
5. Enters Compass Comments.

If, after 30 days the worker is not able to make contact with the client, the worker:

1. Enters an alert on CCD, using Alert Code 29 Underpayment Owing, noting that the client is:
 - The reason,
 - The POA for which the client was underpaid, and
 - The amount owed to the client.
2. If the client re-applies in the future, explain to the client that they were previously underpaid.
3. If the applicant is deemed eligible for assistance, this underpayment will be added to the client's next payment.
4. If the applicant is deemed not eligible for assistance, issue the underpayment as a one-time payment.
5. Enters Compass Comments

The [Unclaimed Personal Property and Vested Property Act](#) requires that holders of abandoned property located in the state must register the property with the [program](#).

Every year the Income Support Program Area will review files with Alert Code 29 to identify underpaid property. When required worksites will be contacted and provided with information regarding the *Unclaimed Personal Property and Vested Property Act*.

Credit Balances

Last updated on: Nov 24, 2014

Credit Balances

POLICY

A Credit Balance occurs when **more** money is paid back to Seniors, Community and Social Services. Credit balances must be investigated and returned to the client if appropriate.

PROCEDURE

The Site Contact (at the Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre), responsible for **Clients with Outstanding Credit Balance** report monthly.

Active Files

The worker reviews the report and determines the reason for the credit balance.

Resolving a credit balance while the file is active ensures issues are resolved quickly and

If there is an outstanding overpayment not yet entered in the Recoveries System, enters the ne

If there is no outstanding debt:

1. Enters the amount of the credit balance in LISA **Client Budget** under need code **1888 Credit Balance**
2. Manually prints an [EMP 3270 Credit Balance Letter](#) and forwards it to the client.

If the credit balance was refunded under the wrong need code (e.g., **1818 Income Not Received**)

Note

Workers using need code **1818 Income Not Received** instead of need code **1888 Credit Balance** is the most common error preventing credit balance from clearing from the credit balance report

Closed Files

The worker reviews the report, investigates the reason for the credit balance and enters notes c

If a credit balance is owed to a client, the worker sends all their recommendations for the issuance of a SCSS.RecoverySystems@gov.ab.ca. Any credit balance adjustments will be shown on the **EM**

Note

Credit balances that meet the requirements of Alberta Treasury Board and Finance's **Unclaimed Personal Property and Vested Property Act** requires that government must register the property or asset with the **Unclaimed Property Pro**

Any questions regarding a credit balance on files can be directed to Financial Client Payments :

Determination of Debt

Last updated on: Apr 24, 2024

Determination of Debt

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), sections 16, Part 6 and Part 9](#)
[Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 99](#)
[Recovery Regulation](#)

INTENT

To describe a debt due to the Government of Alberta.

POLICY

A debt due, refers to an amount determined to be repayable to the Government of Alberta. An individual:

- Agrees to repay the amount (by signing a [repayment agreement](#));
- Is convicted of fraud and has been ordered to pay restitution;
- Has not filed an appeal on an assessed overpayment and the appeal period has expired and the debt is due;
- Has appealed an assessed overpayment and the Citizen's Appeal Panel has upheld the debt;
- Has appealed an assessed overpayment and the appeal panel has determined the appeal is successful.

A debt can also refer to third party amounts that are determined to be repayable to the department to pay for a service provided to the client.

Note

Debts incurred under the [Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act](#) can be collected.

A client's file **must not** be sent for destruction until the debt is paid in full.

The [Overpayment Process](#) and [Recovery System](#) policies describe the procedures to establish

Repayment Agreements

Last updated on: Sep 06, 2024

Repayment Agreements

AUTHORITY

[Income and Employment Support Act \(IESA\), section 16](#)
[Income Support, Training & Health Benefits Regulation, section 99](#)

POLICY

A Repayment Agreement is a signed/[attested](#) to agreement in which the client agrees to repay sign/attest to a Repayment Agreement as a condition of eligibility for an amount or value of assistance amount or value of assistance.

The amount listed on a Repayment Agreement becomes a debt immediately and does not go to

- an anticipated payment from another source, or
- an of the following benefits issued subject to repayment:
 - [Home repairs](#)
 - [Replacement Eye Glasses](#) beyond the optical agreement
 - [Relocation](#) costs if client returns within 1 year,
 - [Utility Arrears](#) (after first time),
 - [Utility Deposits](#) (after first time),
 - [Rental Arrears](#) (after first time),
 - [Child Care deposit and/or registration fees](#) (after first time),
 - [Utility reconnection](#) of each utility,
 - Duplicate benefits issued pending:
 - retroactive payments (e.g., Canada Pension Plan or Employment Insurance) [I
 - a Workers' Compensation Board settlement/payment,

- an insurance settlement [[IESA, section 16\(2\)](#)], or
- [Other Emergency Allowance](#) to meet an emergency need.

Signing the Repayment Agreement

By signing/attesting to a Repayment Agreement, the client indicates an agreement to repay. If the client receives a benefit.

Before signing/attesting to a Repayment agreement, clients must be informed of the following:

- the client is required to repay the benefit, and that the client has the [right to appeal](#) the repayment agreement.
- if the client does not sign/attest to the Repayment Agreement and wishes to appeal, the benefit will be assessed.

Anticipated Payments from another Source

Provided they meet all other eligibility requirements, clients in need of Income Support while awaiting a lump sum payment from the other source is received.

If information is received (e.g., from the client or a lawyer) that a client may receive funds from another source, the amount of duplicate payment that will result from the lump sum payment is known, a [Repayment Agreement](#) is issued.

If the client refuses to sign/attest to the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** the worker does not issue a Repayment Agreement. The client must sign/attest to the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** under IEA unit.

Household Members under 18 Years Old

When a household member younger than 18 years of age is awaiting income from another source:

- If the parent is also a claimant, the parent must complete a separate **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement**.
- If the child is younger than 18 years of age, but older than 12 years of age, the child must complete a **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement**.
- If the child is younger than 12 years of age, only the legal guardian is required to complete a **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement**.

Unknown Amount: Anticipated Payments from Another Source

There may be situations when a client anticipates a potential lump sum from another program or source. For example, this may occur when lump sums from the following sources are expected:

- Insurance settlements,
- Legal claims,

- Canada Pension Plan (CPP) benefits,
- Old Age Security (OAS) benefits, or
- Workers' Compensation Board (WCB) benefits/settlements.

The amount of the lump sum payment and the amount of anticipated duplicate payments that re these cases, there is insufficient information to determine the amount that will be required to be

However, clients are required to repay any duplicate assistance provided by the Income Support sum payment, the [Overpayments as a Result of Retroactive Payments](#) policy applies.

If the client received Income Support benefits for a period for which the department was unawa repay the lesser of the benefits received from the other source or the duplicate payments from I

Employment Insurance and Assignment of Benefits

An [INS3113 Assignment of Benefit](#) form is completed when Income Support benefits are issu

Note

Assignment of Benefit forms are required in the agreement with the federal government a form **must** have the client's signature.

PROCEDURE

Client Has Not Yet Received Income Support Benefits

If the client is expecting income from another source, and the **amount is known**, and has not y

1. advises the client they **must** complete an **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** agreeing t benefits are issued.

Note

The worker may contact Employment and Financial Services, Income Support, to discuss

2. requests the name of the client's legal counsel and a copy of the client's Statement of Cla

Note

All persons identified on the Statement of Claim must sign/attest to a separate **EMP0976E**

3. has the client completed the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** or provide verbal agree Assistance (POA) to be issued, and
4. if known, enters the amount or value of assistance on the **EMP0976B Repayment Agree**

Client Already in Receipt of Income Support Benefits

If the client has already been receiving Income Support benefits and Seniors, Community and S the **amount is known** (i.e., SCSS receives new information), the worker:

1. Advises the client that:

- they **must** complete an **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** agreeing to repay duplicate benefits are issued, and
- they may also **voluntarily** repay the Income Support benefits they received prior to

Note

The worker should contact Employment and Financial Services, Income Support, to discuss

2. requests the name of the client's legal counsel (if any) and a copy of the client's Statement

Note

All persons identified on the Statement of Claim must sign a separate **EMP0976B Repayment**

3. places further income support benefits on hold until the client signs/attests to the **EMP097**

Note

A reasonable amount of time can be given for the client to review their circumstances with

4. has the client completed the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** or provide verbal agreement issued,

5. enters the amount or value of assistance on the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement**, and

6. if the client **chooses** to repay **all** duplicate benefits they may receive, has the client completed agreeing to repay and one for the period since the department became aware of the other

Note

SCSS cannot terminate a client's benefits simply for refusing to voluntarily agree to repay or disclose a source of income.

Once Repayment Agreement(s) is Signed or Agreement is Recorded on "Witness", the worker

1. enters a [Reminder](#) in Compass for follow up in a reasonable amount of time (e.g., six months)
 2. if the amount in the Repayment Agreement is known (i.e., home repairs, utility arrears), then Internal Comments (i.e., starting POA, legal counsel, etc.),
 3. if the amount in the Repayment Agreement is **not** known (i.e., insurance settlements), the
- #### **Note**
- Procedures for entering the debt when the amount was not known at the time the Repayment
4. images the **EMP0976B Repayment Agreement** on **Section 1** of the client's income support
 5. if appropriate (i.e., if the client has a lawyer), mails the [EMP3972 Repayment Agreement](#) to the client's legal counsel advising the legal counsel to contact the Collections and Recoveries
 6. issues benefits until the settlement or retroactive payments are received.

Verification procedures must be in place to authenticate that the person whose agreement

When The Amount of Duplicate Payment from a Pending Lump Sum Payment Is Not Known

1. the worker advises the client that they are required to repay any duplicate assistance provided

2. enters a reminder in Compass for follow up in a reasonable amount of time (e.g., three months), and
 3. continues to issue Income Support benefits to the client, and
 4. when the client has received the lump-sum payment, the worker applies the [Overpayment](#)
-

Recovery of Debt

Last updated on: Apr 24, 2024

Recovery of Debt

POLICY

Once a debt has been determined and recorded in the Recoveries System as a permanent debt, the following methods:

- Entering a repayment agreement with the debtor (person who owes a debt);
- Deducting an amount from a future benefit(s);
- Forwarding a debt to a collection service of the Government of Alberta;
- Filing a certificate or restitution order with the Court of Queen's Bench; or
- Bringing an action in debt (a debt action is a civil claim for a sum of money).

The collection amount is not determined until it is decided that a debt is due or the amount has been agreed upon by the parties, or former sponsors debts are collected through a centralized collection service for the C

Debtors who are active Income Support clients default to a preset Recovery Rate, recovered through their circumstances. Arrangements may include payment in full or a large payment towards a debt.

Recovery Rate

The recovery rate is the amount paid towards a debt each month. For active Income Support clients:

1 adult in household (no employment earnings exemption)
2 adults in household (no employment earnings exemption)
1 adult in household (employment earnings exemption)
2 adults in household (employment earnings exemption)

Adjusting the Recovery Rate

The maximum recovery rate must not exceed 10% of the household unit's Core Benefits as outlined in the Income Support Act.

The recovery rate may be **decreased** to \$10.00 with the following considerations:

- Is the client experiencing financial hardship?
- Is the client receiving all the benefits for which their dependent children are eligible?

- Is the client reasonably able to modify their living expenses now or in the future to no longer
- If at intake, are the benefits being prorated?

The only circumstance to reduce the recovery rate below \$10 is to prevent file closure.

The ongoing recovery rate may be **increased** to a maximum of 10% of the household unit's Co exist:

- The worker and client have negotiated a higher recovery rate, **or**
- The client has previously been found guilty of fraudulently obtaining benefits, **or**
- The client has misrepresented their circumstances on more than one occasion.

Note

If a client has received a retroactive or lumpsum payment from another program, arranger

Any rationale for decreasing or increasing the recovery rate must be entered in [Compass Comr](#) reviewed to determine if the adjusted rate should continue beyond 6 months.

The first time a debt occurs because a client misrepresented their circumstances; the worker ac notification should be entered in Compass Comments and Recoveries System Internal Comme

If an agreement on the repayment amount is not reached, the client must be advised of their rig

Note

A file **cannot** close as a result of a recovery deduction. LISA has a default program to ens

If the rate of recovery is reduced, the worker enters the reason for the reduction the duration an the Recoveries system.

Recovery (R) Flags

The **R Flag** in the Client Budget on the LISA system indicates the recovery status of a debt on a System to LISA the day after a debt is made permanent or an existing debt on a closed file dow reduced from the default deduction rate due to negotiation or a decision by the Appeal Panel.

There are five options for R Flags on LISA:

1. Blank R Flag: no debt exists.
2. R Flag 0: recoverable balance was repaid, no deductions are being taken off.
3. R Flag 1: defaulted monthly deductions are being taken off an active client's benefits and
4. R Flag 2: the recovery rate has been adjusted (increased or decreased) from the defaulte
5. R Flag 3: recovery action is suspended (e.g. due to Appeal Panel's direction). This will stc

Notification of Debt with the Government of Alberta

Regardless of whether the client's file is active or closed, they must be notified of their debt with Statement of Debt and provides the following debt information:

- All debts with Seniors, Community and Social Services
- All payments made
- Any adjustments made
- The current outstanding balance owing to Seniors, Community and Social Services.

The Statement of Debt is produced when an overpayment is determined to be a debt repayable client requests, etc.). It can be given to a client at any time, including at the client's request.

PROCEDURES

The procedures for an overpayment becoming a debt for Active and Closed files is described in

If a worker knows a client's file is closing, they should:

1. Attempt to call the client to discuss the collection process on a closed file.
2. Advise the client:
 - They will receive a letter informing them of their outstanding debt with the Government and Social Services, where to send payments or who to contact regarding payment
 - To continue making payments they can afford on their debt to avoid being pursued f
 - They may be referred to a collection agency if they do not make monthly payments c

Note

If the client's outstanding balance is \$100 or less, LISA will not print an Outstanding Debt

Adjusting the Recovery Rate

When one of the above conditions is met for adjusting a recovery rate, the worker will:

1. Enter the following in the Recoveries System Internal Comments and Compass Comment
 - The reason for adjusting the recovery rate in accordance with policy,
and
 - The expected duration of the varied recovery rate.
2. Change the **R Flag** in LISA and enters the new amount of the recovery deduction.
3. Enter a **6-month [Reminder](#)** to ensure the client's circumstances continue to warrant the c

4. Advise the client of the decision to adjust their recovery rate and send the client a letter with
 - The reason for the increase or decrease in their recovery rate, **and**
 - The amount of the new recovery deduction, **and**
 - Their right to appeal the amount of their new recovery deduction.

Third Party Debtors are not necessarily clients with an active Personal Identification Number (PIN). They may have been a defaulted sponsor or received payment under another circumstance. The client, at the discretion of the worker, may be advised of the decision to adjust their recovery rate.

When a worker is advised of a third-party overpayment:

1. The worker confirms the accuracy of the information and determine the amount of the overpayment.
2. As the overpayment can only be entered into the Non-IS Debt Group portfolio by Treasury Board and Finance:
 - The amount of the overpayment,
 - The reason for the overpayment, and
 - The right to appeal.

Note

The worker's name and phone number are included in the letter in case the third-party overpayment is not received.

3. Once the appeal period has elapsed or the appeal has been concluded by the Citizen's Advice Bureau, the worker should advise the client to send the payment to:
Alberta Supports Centre or by mailing payment directly to:
Treasury Board and Finance
Collections and Recoveries Branch
PO Box 11417
Edmonton AB T5J 3E4
- Note**
The Alberta Supports Centre receiving the payment is responsible to issue a receipt to the client.
4. The worker sends the information requested on the [Treasury Board and Finance Third Party Overpayment Form](#) at TBF.Recoveries@gov.ab.ca.
5. Treasury Board and Finance enters the overpayment as a Non-IS Debt Group in the Recovery System.
6. All collection activities will be pursued in the same manner as debts on closed files.

Debt Payments at an Alberta Supports Centre

If a person chooses to pay their debt at an Alberta Supports Centre, the person who receives the payment should:

1. Ask the person if they are making payment towards an Income Support debt.
2. Accept the payment.
3. Issue the person a receipt.

4. Follow the Finance [cash handling procedure](#).

When Amounts Were Not Known (i.e., not entered in Recoveries System) and Payment is

When a payment is received for any of the following reasons:

- A lump sum payment is made (i.e., an insurance claim, WCB).
- Benefits are returned from a client or third party.

The worker:

1. Determines if any duplicate payment has occurred or what benefits were not needed, for \
2. Determines if the payment or a portion of the payment is for the prior fiscal year or the cur

Payments pertaining to a prior fiscal year are applied against Prior Year Revenue. Any pa
budget (return of benefits) which will be used to offset expenditures for the current year.

Payment for prior fiscal year

- The worker will enter the entire debt in the Recoveries System.
- Staff will enter the payment on the cash blotter and appropriate payment code which will t

Payment or the portion of the payment pertaining to the current fiscal year

- The worker will **not** make an entry in the Recoveries System.
- Staff will enter the payment **or the portion of the payment pertaining to the current fis**
current year expenditure.

Example

A client receives an insurance settlement of \$3,000 in which \$2,000 is related to benefits receiv
April 1st.

The \$2,000 is set up by the worker in the Recoveries System. The cash blotter will show one e
which is to be applied against the current year expenditure code.

Note

Any related documents will be forwarded to the current worker, if the file is still active, or tl

Workers may need to enter a debt on a file they do not have access to. The assigned worker o

Client Registered with Maintenance Enforcement P

Last updated on: Mar 04, 2016

Client Registered with Maintenance Enforcement POLICY

For overpayments where MEP involvement exists, the amount of the overpayment must reflect

A file closure reason "Order/Agreement-MEP-Crown/Special Handle" in **Compass Comments** the money is directed to the Crown. When an overpayment occurs, Community and Social Serv with MEP. The Recoveries System uses this information to automatically calculate the **Maximu**

A **Compass Comments** may be entered on a closed file for a period the Income Support file w existing or future recovery.

PROCEDURES

When an overpayment occurs, and MEP involvement exists, the worker:

1. Views **Internal Comments** on the Recoveries System, and/or reviews **Compass Comm** MEP.
2. If the **Internal Comments** indicates there is a MEP agreement in place with a file closure required to get information from MEP:
 - Client, dependent, and respondent names as listed in **Compass Comments**
 - MEP account number (if available)
 - Client's birth date
 - File number
 - Period of the overpayment
 - Date of requestIf the **Internal Comments** indicates there is a MEP agreement in place with a file cl is required to get information from MEP:
3. The worker requests confirmation of each monthly amount being paid or owing to the Cro
Option 1
 - Sending a request (containing the information in Step 2) to the assigned contact sta System (MIMS). The regional contact person will provide a screen print from MIMS Crown, **or****Option 2**
 - Sending an e-mail with the subject line stating Community and Social Services Assi

at alberta.mep@gov.ab.ca requesting the required information. The worker must provide information in Step 2).

Note

MEP normally sends a response within 15 working days.

4. The worker reviews the MEP information received.
 - Enters the overpayment,
 - Enters the details of the Crown claim through the **3rd Party Collectors** tab, and
 - Adjusts the overpayment just entered by reloading the Pay History (to bring in the amount in the Recoveries System):
 - Enters the amount of the claim being directed to the Crown through the **3rd Party Collectors**
 - Edits the debt by reloading the Pay History (to bring in the amount in the 3rd Party Collectors)
 - Enters an Internal Comment indicating that the debt has been adjusted to account for the overpayment.
5. Ensures the appropriate notification is mailed to the client, and
6. Ensures a copy of the MEP screen print(s) or email and the notification, including comments, is provided to the client.

When a **Compass Comment** is received indicating there is an order/agreement with payments in the Recoveries System, the worker:

1. Enters the following under the **Internal Comments** in the Recoveries System:
 - **Subject:** MEP Involvement.
 - **Comments:** Funds directed to the Crown (include the amount being paid or owing, if applicable).

Note

Prior to October 25, 2015, CSS communicated this information to the SFSC on a CSS 24-hour cycle.

Write Off and Suspension of Debts

Last updated on: Nov 19, 2024

Write Off and Suspension of Debts

AUTHORITY

The [Financial Administration Act](#) provides authority for the collection of revenue payable to the
POLICY

When all efforts at collection **on closed files** are ineffective, the debt is considered not collectible and a write-off of all or part of the amount owing. This authority has been delegated to:

- The Director of Financial Operations for individual debts of \$5,000 or less.
- The Executive Director of Finance for individual debts exceeding \$5,000.

The identification of debts for permanent write-off is the responsibility of Financial Operations.

Debt write-offs are divided into two classes – permanent write-offs and suspensions.

Permanent Write-Offs

The following are the criteria for a permanent write-off:

- Balance is \$500 or less with no payment activity for more than one year.
- Balance is greater than \$500 with no payment activity for more than two years.
- Ministerial request to cease collection activity on compassionate grounds.
- Repayment of debt would cause the debtor undue hardship.

When approval is given for a permanent write-off the Collections and Recoveries Branch removes the debt.

Suspensions

Debts are considered for suspension on when:

- The debt does not meet any of the criteria for permanent write-off.
- Collection is deferred due to temporary financial hardship.

A person whose debt is suspended is not advised their debt is cancelled as the debt remains as is. The debt is not actively pursued for collection; however, they are subject to collection if the client's financial situation improves.

Caveats, Agreements, Orders and Bankruptcy

Last updated on: Sep 02, 2022

Caveats, Agreements, Orders and Bankruptcy

POLICY

The Collections and Recoveries Branch of Financial Operations is responsible for the administration of the bankruptcy process, as these require detailed knowledge of financial matters.

Caveats

Prior to September 1, 2002, caveats were registered against a client's property when home repayment was issued by [repayment](#). Existing caveats are not affected.

A caveat registered with Land Titles may be postponed when the client or the client's lawyer registers a postponed caveat when the new financing arrangements have been made.

If a caveat remains in effect, the entire client file must be retained and no document destruction

Once registered with Land Titles, a caveat must **not** be discharged until the department's claim

- Received, or
- Placed in trust for the department.

Bankruptcies

When received, bankruptcy documents must be immediately forwarded to the Collections and Financial Operations Branch.

Note

This may stop further automatic monthly cheque deductions from occurring on an active file.

If a portion of the debt occurred after the assignment date, then automatic cheque deductions will continue on the bankruptcy.

In cases where there is a Fraud conviction the debt is exempt from bankruptcy. The debt is collected by the Bankruptcy Trustee.

Orders and Registered Agreements

An Order (active or closed file) previously registered with Land Titles may be postponed when the client registers new financing. Land Titles automatically restores a postponed registration when the new financing is registered.

An **EMP 0976B Repayment Agreement** or Order registered at Land Titles must be discharged

The **RC10601 Recovery Agreements to be Discharged** report prints from the Recovery System. The report is available to the Collections and Recoveries Branch for follow up.

PROCEDURE

All requests for the postponement or discharge of a caveat; notification of foreclosure; or the po forwarded by Seniors, Community and Social Services staff or the client directly to the Collectio

Alberta Seniors, Community and Social Services
Revenue and Operations Unit
Financial Policy, Operations and Procurement
5th Floor, Forestry Building
9920 108 St NW
T5K 2M4
Fax: (780) 422-6649

Postponement of a Caveat, Agreement or Order

When the request is received, the Collections and Recoveries Branch:

1. Contacts the Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre to forward the file o
2. Reviews the client's file to ensure if client was granted postponement in the past (a secon
3. If postponement is granted, prepares postponement documents.
4. Forwards postponement documents to the client or the client's representative.

Discharge of a Caveat or Notification of Foreclosure

When the request is received, the Collections and Recoveries Branch:

1. Obtains client's consent in writing (unless the client is deceased).
2. Contacts the Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre to forward the file.
3. Determines the Department's claim.
4. Forwards the appropriate documents to either the client or the client's representative (i.e.,

The client or client's representative takes the discharge document to Land Title.

When the discharge document is received from Land Titles, the Collections and Recoveries Br

1. Updates CCD to change the **Caveat flag** to **N**.
2. Files the discharge document on Section 1 of the client's file.
3. Returns the file to the Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre.

Discharge of an Agreement or Order

When the **RC10601 Recovery Agreements to be Discharged** report is received, Collections s

1. Contacts the Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre to forward the file.
2. Prepares the Recovery Agreement Discharge documents.

3. Forwards the discharge documents either to the client or the client's representative.

When the discharge document is received from Land Titles, Collections staff:

1. Files the discharge document on Section **1** of the client's file.
 2. Returns the file to the owning Seniors, Community and Social Services Service Centre.
-

14 Administrative Procedures

Abbreviations Used in this Manual

Last updated on: Mar 31, 2025

Abbreviations Used in this Manual

AAHB	Alberta Adult Health Benefit
AADL	Alberta Aids to Daily Living
AAO	Alberta Association of Optometrists
ABC	Alberta Blue Cross
ACB	Alberta Child Benefit
ACHB	Alberta Child Health Benefit
ACHBC	Alberta Child Health Benefit Card
ADA	Alberta Dental Association
ADM	Assistant Deputy Minister
ADSC	Alberta Dental Service Corporation
AFA	Accountability Framework Agreement
AFSA	Alberta Funeral Service Association
AHCIP	Alberta Health Care Insurance Plan
AH	Alberta Health
AHRDA	Aboriginal Human Resources Development Agreement
AIMS	Appeals Information Management System
AISH	Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped
AJC	Alberta Job Corps

ALIS	Alberta Learning Information System
AOB	Assignment of Benefits
AR	Action Request
ARCD	Alberta Rehabilitation Council for the Disabled
AS	Administrative Support
ASBP	Alberta Seniors Benefit Program
BF	Bring Forward
BFE	Barriers to Full Employment
CAD	College of Alberta Denturists
CCB	Canada Child Benefit
CCD	Central Client Directory
CCP	Central Cheque Processing (cheque)
CCTB	Canada Child Tax Benefit Program
CDA	Canadian Dental Association
CDAS	Client Direction Administrative Support
CDB	Child Disability Benefit
CDOC	Central District Office Cheque
CEC	Career Employment Consultant
CFS	Child Financial Support
CFSA	Child and Family Service Authority
CIC	Citizenship and Immigration Canada
CIS	Certificate of Indian Status Card
CNIB	Canadian National Institute for the Blind
CPP	Canada Pension Plan

CPP-D	Canada Pension Plan Disability
CPP-R	Canada Pension Plan Retirement
CRA	Canada Revenue Agency
CRC	Client Reporting Card
CSA	Client Support Assessment
CSA	Child Supplement Allowance
CSD	Common Service Delivery
CSS	Child Support Services
CT	Client Type
CTB	Child Tax Benefit
CUP	Children of Unwed Parents
CYS	Children and Youth Services
DATS	Disabled Adult Transportation System
DBL	Drug Benefit List
DC	Disaster Services Cheque
DM	Deputy Minister or District Manager
DO	District Office
DOB	Date of Birth
DOC	District Office Cheque
DRES	Disability Related Employment Supports
DV	Disaster Services Voucher
EA	Employability Assessment
EE	Earnings Exemption

EI	Employment Insurance
EOI	End of Involvement
EP	Employment Plan
ESL	English as a Second Language
ESP	Employment Skills Program
ET	Executive Team
ETW	Expected to Work
FCB	Federal Child Benefit
FOIP	Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act
FOP	Fine Option Program
FP	Financial Processing
FLA	Foundational Learning Assistance
F/T	Full Time
FV	Full Verification
GIC	Guaranteed Investment Certificate
GIS	Guaranteed Income Supplement
GST	Goods and Services Tax
HBC	Health Benefits Card
HD	Handwritten District Office Cheque
HH	Head of Household
HQ	Headquarters
HRSDC	Human Resources and Skills Development Canada (associated with Service
HT	Household Unit Type
ID	Identification

IFDAA	Independent Funeral Directors Association of Alberta
IESA	Income and Employment Supports Act
IIR	International and Intergovernmental Relations
IMAGIS	Integrated Management Alberta Government Information System
IS	Income Support
ISP	Income Support Program
ISHTB	Income Support, Training and Health Benefits
ISS	Income Support Supervisor
ISCC	Income Support Contact Centre
IT	Information Technology
LAN	Local Area Network
LMDA	Labour Market Development Agreement
LDOC	Local District Office Cheque
LIRA	Locked-in Retirement Accounts
LISA	Local Income Support Application
MC	Main Payment (processed before cut-off and printed centrally)
MD	Main Payment (Processed after cut-off and printed centrally or at the Comm
MEP	Maintenance Enforcement Program
MLA	Member of the Legislative Assembly
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MP	Member of Parliament
NAJC	Northern Alberta Job Corps
NCB	National Child Benefit Program

NCBS	National Child Benefit Supplement
OAS	Old Age Security
OPG	Office of the Public Guardian
PAA	Pharmacists Association of Alberta
PCard	Procurement Card
PDD	Person with Developmental Disabilities
PGO	Permanent Guardianship Order
PHN	Personal Health Number
PID	Personal Identification
POA	Period of Assistance
P/T	Part Time
PV	Partial Verification
PVS	Private Vocational School
QPP	Quebec Pension Plan
RAPAR	Recoveries, Administrative Penalties and Appeals Regulation
RAT	Residential Addictions Treatment
RCD	Resources for Children with Disabilities
RCMP	Royal Canadian Mounted Police
RESP	Registered Educational Savings Plan
RRAP	Residential Rehabilitation Assistance Program
RR-AS	Records Room – Administrative Support
RRIF	Registered Retirement Income Funds
RRSP	Registered Retirement Savings Plan
RWA	Ready Willing and Able

SA	Service Alberta
SAM	System for Appeals Management
SC	Service Centres
S/D	Separated/Divorced
SDP	Skills Development Program
SF	Students Finance
SFAA	Student Financial Assistance Act
SFSC	Support and Financial Services Coordinator
SIN	Social Insurance Number
SIS	Skills Investment Strategy
SMART	Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant and Timely (Investment Plan)
SP	Service Plan
S/P	Spouse/Partner
SU	Supplemental Payment
TGO	Temporary Guardianship Order
TOJ	Training on the Job
VC	Contract Voucher
VH	Handwritten Voucher
VR	Regular Voucher
WCB	Workers' Compensation Board

Annual Review

Last updated on: Jan 20, 2026

INTENT

The annual review process is necessary for clients who are not required to report their circumst

Clients Needing an Annual Review

The worker completes an annual review of the client's circumstances to verify the ongoing eligi

- the client's finances are managed by the Public Trustee, **or**
- the client is exempt from monthly reporting for a year, **or**
- when the worker wishes to review the client's circumstances after the client has been exe

Diary Date

The worker enters a diary date one year from the beginning of the initial monthly reporting exen
client's file is opened on July 1, 2023, the diary date is 24/07/01. When a client's file is opened 1

The worker enters the appropriate diary date for:

- a client whose administration of finances is taken over by the Public Trustee, and/or
- a client who is exempt from monthly reporting for a year.

Diary Date Caseload Report

Clients with a selected diary date are listed on the **PZB 01 Diary Date Caseload** report.

The IT Site Contact selects the diary date three months in advance, prints the **PZB 01 Diary Da**

Each month the IT Site Contact will:

1. Use Function 31 – Diary Date Caseload Listing
 1. Enter desired Printer (FSS printer)
 2. Enter desired unit or * for all units
 3. Enter desired caseload or * for all caseloads
 4. Enter desired Diary Date
 5. Enter X for all except aish/ahb Household Type
 6. Enter I or A to print the report Immediately or After hours

When the client's name is listed on the **PZB 01 Diary Date Caseload** report (three months before

1. reviews the report, and
2. records on the report where the [EMP0110 Annual Report](#) is to be mailed (e.g., client, financial

The unit Administrative Support mails the **EMP0110 Annual Report** according to the directions

Documentation

When the **EMP0110 Annual Report** is returned, the worker reviews the report and:

1. requests further information or substantiation, such as providing a current Notice of Assessment from either the recipient, Financial Administrator, Public Trustee, Public Guardian, agency
2. revises information in **Client File** function 7 or **Client Budget** function 9 as necessary,
3. changes the **Diary Date in Client File** function 7 to the next year, if eligible for further benefit

Note

Updating the Diary Date changes the client **File Status** from **Returned** to **Approved**.

4. ensures the **Cheque Release** flag is **Y** in **Payment Information** function 10, and
5. records any additional relevant information in Compass Comments.

Overdue Annual Reviews

Recipients whose annual review is overdue are listed on the **MRR 08 Client File Set to Return**

1. The IT Site Contact distributes the **MRR 08 Client File Set to Returned – Annual Overdue**
2. The worker may confirm the recipient was sent an annual report by checking the **PZB 01**
3. The worker must complete the required documentation for all Annual Reviews. See **Docu**

LISA sets the client File Status to **Returned** if the annual review is overdue and the diary date has

If the file is to be closed, the worker:

1. records the reason for closure in Compass Comments, and
2. manually closes the file.

If the file is not to be closed due to exceptional circumstances, the worker:

1. requests the Supervisor's approval, and
2. documents the reasons for continued benefits in Compass Comments.

The Supervisor records approval of continued benefits on the **EMP1086 Approval Log**.

If the annual review is still overdue the following month, the client File Status will show **Returne**

Note

The **EMP0110 Annual Report** notifies the recipient their file will close if they do not return reports are not returned.

Change to Reporting Requirement

The worker may cancel the reporting exemption period at any time if circumstances change. If t

- ensures that the client is informed of monthly reporting requirement in advance so that be
- creates an Automated Reporting for Clients (ARC) profile, including security questions, for
 - Each ARC account requires three security questions to be answered in the event the [EMP14878 Automated Reporting for Clients \(ARC\) Security Questions](#) form ma account.
- provides the client with their file number and their ARC PIN,
- advises the client to keep all documentation used to report in case they are audited,
- may send the [EMP14856 Change to Reporting Requirement Annual to ARC Letter](#) to
- removes the annual review diary date, and
- ensures the cheque release flag in LISA is set to "N."

Note

The [EMP14879 Automated Reporting for Clients \(ARC\) Telephone Reporting Overvi](#)
[EMP14947 Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQ\) Automated Reporting for Clients \(AR](#)
reporting by ARC.

Application Process

INTENT

Last updated on: Dec 04, 2007

INTENT

The objectives of the intake process:

- To provide an effective and efficient assessment of applicant's needs.
- To determine each applicant's eligibility for Income Support benefits.
- To issue benefits in an expedient manner.
- To make referrals to other resources.
- To assist applicants to develop an **Individual Plan** to achieve their potential for self-suffic

POLICY

- [Client Direction](#)
 - [Career and Employment Consultant \(CEC\)](#)
 - [Administrative Support \(AS\) Staff](#)
 - [Income Support Supervisor \(ISS\)](#)
 - [Intake Summary](#)
 - [Income Support Contact Centre \(ISCC\)](#)
-

Client Direction

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

-

This section is under development and will be circulated to the field when completed. Continue

Career and Employment Consultant (CEC)

Last updated on: Apr 30, 2026

INTENT

To outline the Career and Employment Consultant (CEC) intake process.

POLICY

The worker completes a thorough assessment of the applicant's:

- financial circumstances,
- household circumstances,
- health factors,
- employment and education history, **and**
- training plans, if applicable.

The worker uses the assessment to determine the following:

- benefit eligibility,
- core benefit level,
- client type, **and**
- the appropriate initial support services and employment planning required to assist the ap

The worker:

- advises the applicant (and spouse/partner) of their rights and responsibilities,
- advises the applicant (and spouse/partner) of the requirement to access all income they a Canada Child Benefit (CCB) or quarterly Goods and Services Tax (GST) Credits through sends out an Income Tax Notice of Assessment (NOA). Clients must submit their NOA an
- issues initial benefits, if appropriate,
- advises ineligible applicants of alternate resources, **and**
- advises ineligible applicants of their [right to appeal](#), the appeal process and the time limit

Alternate Financial Resources

While determining eligibility for Income Support benefits, the worker examines alternate resources including:

- liquidation of [assets](#) above exemption levels (i.e. bonds, pensions, RRSP's, etc.),
- Alberta Aids to Daily Living,
- Alberta Blue Cross premium reduction if the applicant only has medical needs,
- [Alberta Child Health Benefit](#),
- family and friends,
- application for early retirement Canada Pension Plan (CPP) pension at age 60 but only if income may decrease if they switch to CPP early retirement benefits,
- CPP Credit Splitting for clients who have been separated from a spouse/partner for 12 months together can be divided equally between them,
- Workers' Compensation Board (WCB) for benefits and for retraining if the applicant can no longer work,
- student funding for applicants who want to pursue education under the *Student Financial Services Act*,
- benefits through Section B of the applicant's motor vehicle insurance policy (an applicant's insurance company, **or**
- community resources.

PROCEDURE

Interview

To prepare for the application interview, the worker reviews the following documents to determine eligibility:

- [EMP3428 Income Support Application](#)
- **closed file if on the imaged system**

The worker may view all previous payments made to or on behalf of a client for each period of 12 months by selecting **Payment History** option 8.

The worker reviews all alerts on [CCD](#), and if appropriate, follows through, updates, adds or deletes information.

The worker consults with:

- the supervisor to discuss difficult case decisions or to request approval as required by policy,
- when necessary, the previous Alberta Supports Centre (i.e. to discuss a [non-compliance](#) alert).

The worker explains the intake purpose and process and conducts a personal interview with the client.

For application interviews conducted via telephone, the worker:

1. gathers as much information from the applicant as possible,
2. enters the data in **Eligibility Determination (ED)** function **1** to generate the **EMP2503 Eligibility Determination** spoken to by the worker.

Note

The worker will review the Declaration of the **EMP3428 Income Support Application** with the applicant for accuracy of information.

3. records the information that was used to authenticate the individual in [Compass Comments](#)
4. sets a reminder to review the file at a later date to ensure that if the household receives or
5. Once a decision is made, the worker may send the [EMP14927 Income Support Application](#)

Application Withdrawn

If an application is withdrawn, the application process ends and a new application is required to

An application may be withdrawn due to the following reasons:

- the worker is unable to contact the applicant to complete an assessment interview, **or**
- the applicant requests that the application be withdrawn.

The worker may send an [EMP13560 Income Support Application Withdrawal Letter](#) if they are processing an application withdrawal. This letter will notify the applicant that the application has been withdrawn.

Language Interpreters

Applicants who speak English as a second language may need interpreter services to interpret and confirm and records the following information about the interpreter in Compass Comments:

- first and last name
- phone number
- address

Verification

The worker gathers [personal identification](#) and verifies the applicant's personal circumstances,

The file can remain in hold status in **ED** while the worker is waiting for substantiating documents.

Eligibility Determination

The [worker enters all required information](#) in **ED** function **1** for all applicants, including one-time

Eligible Applicant

If the applicant is eligible, the worker enters all additional required information into:

- **Add Client** function **3** for new clients, **or**
- **Reopen Client** function **4** for clients with closed files.

Ineligible Applicant

If the applicant is ineligible, the worker:

1. enters all required information on the **Rejection/Referral** screen in **ED** function **1**,
2. explains the following clearly to the applicant:
 - why the applicant is ineligible for Income Support benefits,
 - what other resources are available to assist the applicant, and
 - the appeal process and timelines to appeal.
3. assists the applicant with referrals to other resources, as required,
4. records the [Intake Summary](#) information in Compass Comments, **and**
5. provides a [File Closure Letter](#) when requested.

Reassessment

If an ineligible applicant re-applies, the worker determines if a change in circumstance has occurred.

If the applicant's circumstances have not changed and they remain ineligible, the worker records:

- the reason for ineligibility on the **Rejection/Referral** screen in **ED** function, **and**
- the reason why the applicant was not granted a formal interview in the Intake Summary in

If the decision has not previously been appealed, the worker advises the applicant of their right to appeal.

If the applicant's circumstances have changed and they are eligible, normal intake procedures apply.

File Date

When adding a client, the worker enters the date benefits begin in the **Application Date** field.

When reopening a file, the worker enters the date benefits begin in the **Reopen Date** field.

The worker backdates an application only if the client is [eligible for a benefit](#) before the date the determines the client is eligible for rent from February 1, 2011. The CEC enters 20110201 in the 15, the worker must enter 20110215 in the **Application Date** or **Reopen Date** field.

Workers do not back date in order to avoid completing **ED** function 1.

The worker may take an application from an applicant who is not in need or who does not qualify the applicant does not need assistance until the first of the month but makes application five days does **not** result in a delay in benefits.

One-Time Issue Applicants (Client Types 81 and 82)

For one-time issues, the worker enters information in the mandatory fields in **Add Client** function screen allows the worker to create a cheque or voucher without going through the full budget approval.

If drug coverage **only** is provided, the worker enters need code **1901 Prescription Drugs**, issue and records the reason in Compass Comments. When the cheque prints LISA will void the Health

One-Time Issue Recipient

If a recipient who is receiving benefits as a transient or resident one-time issue requests further ongoing benefits. The worker must:

1. use **Client File** function 7 to update:
 - Alberta Health status, medical card, medical coverage, client type, education, occupation
 - any other information that has changed
2. update the budget on **Client Budget** function 9.

Unit and Caseload Assignment

The worker enters the financial worker's unit and caseload.

If the cheque is to go to the Intake unit for sorting and releasing, the worker assigns the file to the financial worker.

All files must be assigned to a Support and Financial Services Coordinator (SFSC) caseload within

Budget

The worker creates the proper number of budgets to the roll over cycle (until a MC payment) for the client. Function 9 is [accessed directly from the last screen](#) in **Client File** function 7.

The worker determines the appropriate [method of payment](#).

Outstanding Recovery at Intake

If a recovery is indicated for the applicant or spouse/partner on CCD, the worker informs the client

recovery rate may be varied. The client **must** be informed of the new recovery rate.

If the closed file is still on LISA, the recovery deduction will be deducted from the first month's b

If the first benefit period is prorated the recovery rate may be decreased.

If the closed file is not on LISA the recovery deduction will not commence until the next benefit j

Note

When a reopen is downloaded from CCD to LISA it does not include the outstanding reco
file is downloaded and does not allow the entry of the recovery deduction if the outstandin

Repayment at Intake

Specific Income Support benefits may be issued at intake subject to repayment.

Underpayment at Intake

An underpayment from a previous period of assistance may be issued to a client at intake.

Individual Planning

The Worker:

- informs the client of appropriate department programs and services available (i.e. Career
- identifies appropriate external resources and provides information to assist with the referr
- assists clients in completing their [Individual Plan](#).

Client Education

The worker:

- provides their worker's name, title, phone number and address,
- explains Core Essential rates are based on the assumption that households with children
- explains [Direct Deposit](#) policy and identifies exemptions,
- explains the purpose of the Automated Reporting for Clients (ARC) and how to enter infor
- advises the client that unless they are exempted from monthly reporting, they will receive but they do not complete and return the CRC,
- explains that the Director has the rights to any adult or child support for that person or the
- explains the [Employment Insurance Assignment of Benefit Process](#), if applicable,
- advises of information sharing (data matching) arrangements with other organizations incl Inter-provincial Data Matches, Alberta Justice Data Match, **and**

- provides debt education.

Note

The *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* requires the applicant be provided about the collection of the information.

Completing Documents

EMP2068 Signature Verification

The worker discusses whether the client is able to cash a cheque or whether they require an **EI**

Note

A [list of all financial institutions and credit unions](#) that have signed the [Indemnity Agreement](#) Finance.

EMP3428 Income Support Application

The worker:

- reviews the completed **EMP3428 Income Support Application** with the applicant,
- explains the meaning of the Declaration to ensure the applicant (and spouse/partner) fully
- has the applicant (and spouse/partner) read and sign the Declaration Section 9 of the **EM**
- provides a copy of Section 9 Declaration and Acknowledgement of the **EMP3428 Income** witnessed.

Note

The worker is not required to witness the applicant and their spouse/partner signing the **E** that they:

- witnessed the applicant and their spouse/partner read the Declaration, **or**
- the worker read the Declaration to the applicant and their spouse/partner.

In addition, the worker has the “appropriate person” (applicant, spouse partner and dependent c

1. The [EMP3428A Schedule A – Child Support Services](#) form is signed when required to **Services** form may be completed by obtaining the client’s (and spouse/partner if applicab
 - verbally review and complete the entire form including the Freedom of Information a
 - receive acknowledgement that the client consents, understands and agrees with the
 - physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client, **and**

- enter a Compass Comment attesting that the form, including the FOIP Statement and with the information.

The signed form is then imaged to the client's electronic file.

Note

The **EMP3428A Schedule A - Child Support Services** form has been incorporated with application determines if an **EMP3428A Schedule A - Child Support Services** form is required. It does not require client or worker signature as the Freedom of Information and Privacy (FOIP) **Services** form are incorporated with the online Income Support Application Declaration and

When reviewing the **EMP3428A Schedule A – Child Support Services** form, the worker:

- asks the client/applicant:
 - if the parent(s) are aware and consent to the child being added to the client/ap
 - the reason(s) why the child is placed with Income Support client/applicant and
 - of the anticipated duration of the placement with the client/applicant,
 - of the parent's ability and willingness to pay child support, and
 - about the resources available for the child (e.g. Canada Pension Plan Orphan's
 - records the information in [Compass Comments](#),
 - advises the client/applicant to apply for the CCB on behalf of the child,
 - refers any child protection concerns to Child and Family Services, and
 - completes referral to [Child Support Services](#) through LISA.
1. The [EMP3428C - Declaration of 18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent Child](#) form is signed and
Support Application. The **EMP3428C - Declaration of 18- and 19-Year-Old Dependent**
place of physical signature(s), the worker may:
 - verbally review and complete the entire form with the client and dependent child,
 - receive acknowledgement that the client and dependent consent, understand and agree
 - physically or electronically sign and date the form on behalf of the client and dependent
 - enter a Compass Comment attesting that the declaration was read to the client and with the information.

Note

When a spouse/partner is not able to attend the application interview for valid reasons (i.e. illness, travel, etc.), the applicant must provide a written statement from the spouse/partner explaining the reasons for their absence. The statement should be signed and dated by the spouse/partner and should be submitted with the application. If the spouse/partner is unable to provide a statement, the applicant must provide a written statement explaining the reasons for their spouse/partner's absence. The statement should be signed and dated by the applicant and should be submitted with the application.

- ### Note

When it is not feasible for transients or stranded Albertans to attend the [Service Centre](#) to complete

- ## Issuing a Second Cheque at Intake

If a client applies for benefits **before** the cut-off date, **or** the client expects income or circumstar

- ## Exemption of Client Reporting

- enters the information in LISA on the last budget created by rollover. The worker uses fun
 - enters the CRC Date Received.

- enters the CRC Exempt End Date, **and**
- sets the Release Cheque flag to “Y”.

The exemption month entered on LISA in the “CRC Exempt End Date” field, will be the ne

Example

If a March 2011 date is entered, the client will automatically receive a CRC attached to the to March 31, 2011 reporting period. The client reports on ARC rather than completing and

1. places a reminder in Compass the month prior to the Exempt End Date to review whether continue until either the Exempt End Date passes or until the worker manually changes it. End Date passes, **and**
2. reviews the **CRC Exemption Report** when printed and follows up for a review of the mon

Note

If Household Type (HT) changes, the worker will see a message on the Client File Screen exemption is applicable, and if it is necessary to re-enter the information in LISA.

Substantiating Information

The worker advises the applicant of their responsibility to provide all required substantiating info

The worker informs the applicant they have a period of time to present missing documents whic

- they do not possess, **and**
- are not essential to determine their budget, **and**
- are not essential to determine their identity.

The worker informs the applicant that failure to provide the documents within the specified time

Other Documents

The worker completes other documents depending on the applicant’s circumstances. Some exa

- [EMP0207 Medical Report](#)
- [EMP0509 Income Support Financial Administrator Appointment](#)
- **EMP1976 Drug Authorization**
- **EMP2240 Signature Verification Working Copy**

If the applicant requests a copy of the **EMP3428 Income Support Application** the worker prov

If the applicant is ineligible and requests a copy of the **EMP3428 Income Support Application**

Verification of Assistance Letter

When requested by the client, the worker may complete an [EMP2470 Verification of Assistan](#) client's monthly benefit rate. The worker provides the original letter directly to the client and ret

Intake Summary

The worker records the Intake Summary information in Compass Comments. The Intake Summ

EMP2409 Financial Document Control

The worker completes the **EMP2409 Financial Document Control** if the applicant's DOC is to

Issuing to Active Clients in Other Service Centers

When a client from another Alberta Supports Centre requests benefits, but is not moving, the w

1. consults with the owning service center, allowing the client to discuss circumstances with

The client's financial worker at the owning Alberta Supports Centre:

1. advises what benefits, if any, are to be issued.

If benefits are issued, the worker:

1. uses the **Issue to Active in Other Office** function **67** to enter information in the mandator
 2. issues benefits by manually completing an **EMP0018 Purchase Authorization and Invoi**
 3. forwards the **District Office Copy** of the voucher and any supporting documentation to th
-

Administrative Support (AS) Staff

Last updated on: Apr 01, 2006

Note

This section is under development and will be circulated to the field when completed. Continue

Income Support Supervisor (ISS)

Last updated on: Mar 31, 2025

POLICY

The Supervisor makes sure staff are fulfilling the intake process objectives of:

- providing an effective and efficient assessment,
- determining each applicant's eligibility for Income Support benefits,
- issuing benefits in an expedient manner,
- making referrals to other resources, and
- assisting applicants to develop a Service Plan to achieve their potential for self-sufficiency

Team Commitment

The Supervisor facilitates and supports the development of team commitment among the staff.

Administration

The Supervisor ensures the administrative system supports the staff in fulfilling their responsibilities.

Case Consultation

The Supervisor provides case consultation and authorizations designated to the Supervisor level.

Basis for Benefits

The Supervisor makes sure eligibility decisions are:

- based on the *Income and Employment Supports Act*, Regulations and Policy,
- administered according to the Program Procedures.

Restricted File

For clients who are working in the Service Centre or who have relatives or close friends working in the Service Centre:

- restricts access to client files on LISA, CCD and Compass,
- makes sure any paper documents are filed in confidence.

Cover-Off

The Supervisor arranges for cover-off and re-assignment of duties for roles as required.

Statistics

The Supervisor collects and reviews statistics to assist with monitoring the overall workload and performance.

Appeals

The Supervisor responds to applicant and client appeals by:

- attempting to resolve the issue with the applicant or client,
 - consulting with the appropriate Supervisor at the alternate office when necessary,
 - completing the Administrative Review of Decision (ARD),
 - working with the Appeals Secretariate to schedule hearings at the earliest opportunity,
 - ensuring all relevant information concerning the client's situation and the department's position is provided to the appeal panel,
 - attending the appeal panel hearing when necessary, and
 - seeking legal representation when necessary.
-

Intake Summary

Last updated on: Aug 13, 2024

POLICY

The worker completes an Intake Summary and records all relevant information in the appropriate section.

The sections in the tables below are to be used as a guideline when assessing all Income Support applications. Workers should use the sections to organize intake summary comments in Compass.

The worker only records information used to determine eligibility or ineligibility that is not recorded elsewhere in the system.

Assessment of Presenting Circumstances

Relevant historical, current and future factors.

Section	Intake Summary
Family	
Health	
Employment/Training	
Income	

Assets	
Other Information	

Eligibility Decision and Action to be Taken

Section	Information
Eligibility	Eligible • The n • Reaso

	• Reaso • Indica
	Not Eligible • The re or per • Indica • Provic
Action to be Taken	• Outlin circun • Any o

Income Support Contact Centre (ISCC)

Last updated on: Oct 27, 2023

POLICY

The ISCC is a province wide service that provides information and emergency services to Alberta clients and Community and Social Services staff.

Alberta Supports Income Support Contact Centre

Phone: 1-866-644-5135  (toll free) or 780-644-5135  (Edmonton area)

[Email](#)

During business hours, ISCC Advisors provide:

- General information about Income Support programs and services.
- Referrals to community agencies and other government departments.
- Verification of Canada Child Benefit eligibility for Income Support program applicants/recipients.
- Client verifications from other provinces regarding Income Support applications from outside Alberta.
- General information on the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped program.

The ISCC provides emergency and essential Income Support services **by telephone only** to clients from Friday, weekends and holidays.

The ISCC also provides after hours services to active AISH clients and can issue emergency services.

People requiring services outside of normal operating hours are provided benefits **only** if the circumstances are:

- Are beyond the client's control, **and**
- Create serious health risk, **and**
- Cannot wait until the next working day.

Benefits are intended to meet the needs of that person only until the next working day and are limited to:

- [Emergent core essentials](#)
- [Temporary shelter](#)
- [Transportation](#)
- [Emergency medical needs](#)

Benefits beyond those listed above require approval from an Income Support Supervisor or manager. Centrally Delivered Services has authority to approve emergency payments issued by ISCC staff.

PROCEDURE

In all situations, if the system(s) is down at the time of registration, enter the information as soon as possible.

Inactive Clients

If the applicant is eligible for a one-time issue, the advisor will:

1. Search on CCD for any record of client.
2. Request specific identifying information (i.e., SIN, Alberta Health Care or Driver's License).
3. Record these numbers on the [EMP 3560 After Hours Eligibility Form](#).
4. Issue benefits by a [manual voucher](#).
5. Manually complete the **EMP 2004 Notice of Eligibility**.
6. Read the declaration to the applicant, initial each statement read and sign the front on behalf of the advisor.
7. Key data into LISA as required.

If eligible and the applicant has a file closed **within the last two years**, the advisor will:

1. Request the electronic file from LISA by phone, or from CCD by using **Request for File Data**.
Note
Requests for electronic files from LISA usually occur the next working day during regular business hours.
2. Issue appropriate benefits.
3. Ensure all payments are entered in the system.
4. Record in [Compass Comments](#) and on the **EMP 3560 After Hours Eligibility Form** the type of file.
5. Record the **HRE 0018 Voucher** and **HRE 1976 Drug Authorization** on the [EMP 2211Voucher](#).
6. Use **Transfer Client** function **14** to transfer the electronic file to the office with the closed file.
7. Forward all documents to the district office with the closed paper file.

If eligible and the applicant has a pending file on LISA, a non-service file on CCD, no previous file on LISA, the advisor will:

1. Request the electronic file from LISA by phone, or from CCD by using **Request for File Data**.
2. Issue the appropriate benefits.

3. Ensure the client is registered on CCD if no previous file exists.
4. Ensure all payments are entered in the system.
5. Record in [Compass Comments](#) or on the **EMP 3560 After Hours Eligibility Form** that the
6. Retain all documentation at the ISCC unit.

Note

If the client contacts a Service Centre for ongoing benefits, the Service Centre will request

When an applicant with a closed file is denied benefits, the advisor will:

1. Enter into Compass Comments the following:
 - The benefit was denied,
 - The reason why, and
 - That the client was advised of their right to appeal, or
 - That the client was advised of their right to request a review by the [Health Benefits E](#)
2. Print the information recorded in **Eligibility Determination** function 1.
3. Forward all documents to the district office where a closed paper file exists, **or**
4. Retain the documents at the Alberta Supports ISCC if the applicant has no file or their file

Note

The ISCC will retain these documents for 12 months before they are sent for disposal as c

Active Clients

The advisor will:

1. Determine eligibility.
2. Access the file by function **67 – Issue to Active in Other Office**.
3. Key in mandatory fields in the **Client Details** screen.
4. Key in details of the voucher and enters details in Compass Comments.
5. Issue benefits by manual voucher(s).
6. Forward the "client file" copy of the voucher(s) and any supporting documentation to the c

Note

For case management purposes, the assigned worker at the owning Service Centre will re amount.

When a benefit is denied, the advisor will:

1. Enter into Compass Comments the following:
 - The benefit was denied,
 - The reason why, and
 - That the client was advised of their right to appeal, or
 - That the client was advised of their right to request a review by the Health Benefits E

Active AISH Clients

When an active AISH client contacts the ISCC to request an emergency or supplementary benefit:

1. Refer the client to their AISH worker, if the request is made during regular business hours
 2. Issue any benefits the client may be eligible for under the AISH program, if after hours.
-

Attestation

Last updated on: Mar 13, 2025

INTENT

This policy is intended to assist staff interacting with Albertans who may be required to sign a document.

POLICY

When an applicant, client, cohabitating partner and/or financial administrator is required to sign a document, the staff member must be able to verbally attest to understanding and agreeing to the information and terms on the document.

NOTE:

This process **does not** apply to consents with the federal government, documents requiring a signature of a government official, or documents requiring a signature of a legal representative.

- Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) Consent, including the bottom section on the [Income Support Consent](#)
- [Alberta Adult Health Benefit Enrollment and Renewal - Schedule D](#)
- [INS 3113 Assignment of Benefit](#)
- [EMP 2544 Denial of Spouse/Partner \(Declaration\)](#)
- [EMP 0151 A Statutory Declaration](#)

PROCEDURES

The following procedures outline the steps for obtaining a verbal agreement on forms when it is requested, the worker:

1. completes the form and reads the entire form to the signer,
2. ensures the signer understands the form and what signing the document means,
3. asks the signer, "Do you understand and agree to the terms read to you?"
 - Once the newly signer agrees, in lieu of the signature, writes the following note and

"Attestation: This form was read to the signer in its entirety. The signer stated

1. signs the Income Support form with their name on the line designated for 'Director (or delegate)'
2. advises the signer that a copy of the completed form will be mailed to them for their records
3. makes a copy of the form, which is sent to the client,

4. files the original with the attestation on the client file, and
5. adds a Compass Comment indicating that the verbal approval was obtained using the foll

“A verbal agreement was received for (**indicate form name**) on (**fill in date**). A copy has

For Repayment Agreements add the following:

“(Name) has agreed to repay \$ (**fill in amount**) for (**fill in reason**).”

CCD

Alerts

Last updated on: Aug 01, 2010

Purpose

An alert is a critical message on CCD that staff must review before dealing with the client. The alert can be placed by anyone, even a person who has never been a client.

Used By

Site contacts, workers, Fraud Investigators, supervisors and managers.

Using Alerts

Whenever staff receive information that should become an alert, they must enter it on CCD. When an alert is entered, staff must:

- check the alert,
- follow-up appropriately, **and**
- pass the alert along to other staff who will work with the client.

The text that appears on the screen gives:

- a brief summary of the situation, and
- the requesting office sufficient information to act without having to call the office that placed the alert.

Alerts are placed to provide:

- information about concerns on closed files if the client should re-apply,
- other offices and after-hours workers with critical information, or
- information about individuals who have not been clients but who may apply in the future, and

Types of Alerts

Alerts are used only when the worker decides information about a client should be known to other staff as text.

Only staff from the designated areas place alerts. For example, Fraud Investigators place the information in the Fraud section and has been set by Headquarters. Some alerts are indefinite and some are time limited (e.g., until the Community and Social Services office staff or until the file is purged from CCD).

At the time a file is reopened, all alerts on CCD are reviewed by the CEC to determine if the ale

- deleted
- extended
- updated

If the alert is extended or updated, the CEC:

1. replaces the current alert date with the date of review.

If there is enough space on the **ALERT DETAIL** screen, the CEC:

1. identifies the name of the person doing the update.

The date on all alerts should be the same or later than the last reopen date. If the date indicates

1. notifies their supervisor.

The supervisor:

1. contacts the supervisor of the worker who did not delete or update the alert appropriately

Alerts cannot be placed for reasons other than those listed.

01 Approach With Caution

A client poses a threat to departmental staff. The client may have previously threatened or assa

This alert remains on CCD until a worker or supervisor manually deletes the alert or the file is p

02 Health Concerns

There are three types of health concerns alerts:

1. A client is a known prescription drug abuser. After-hours workers are alerted about issuing
2. A client requires urgent medical attention and whereabouts of the client are unknown.
3. A client is suicidal.

This alert remains on CCD until a worker or supervisor manually deletes the alert or the file is p

03 Eligibility Concerns

There are three types of eligibility concerns alerts:

1. A client may be collecting Income Support in another province.
2. A client may be receiving undeclared income.
3. A client has been assessed ineligible in one office and there is concern they may appear i

This alert remains on CCD for three to four months unless a worker or supervisor manually dele

04 Out of Province Income Support Concerns

Another province is advising staff they have concerns about a client who may apply for assistar

This alert remains on CCD for three to four months unless a worker or supervisor manually dele

05 Out of Province Child Welfare Concerns

Another province advises staff about Child Welfare concerns for a client who has limited finance
staff places the alert.

This alert remains on CCD for three to four months unless a worker or supervisor manually dele

06 Child Welfare Concerns

Alberta Children and Family Services advises staff that they have child welfare concerns about

Service Centre, Regional Office or Headquarters staff places the alert.

This alert remains on CCD for three to four months unless a worker or supervisor manually dele

07 Indigenous Organization

A client is being provided Income Support services by an Indigenous organization.

This alert is placed by Indigenous organizations who have signed agreements to provide off-res
alert. The alert text contains the band name and/or band number of the organization delivering i
by the organization, the date the organization closed the file and a contact name and phone num

This alert remains on CCD indefinitely.

08 AISH Asset Limit Exceeded

This alert code is placed when an applicant is denied AISH benefits due to excess assets as we

This alert is placed by the AISH worker.

This alert remains on CCD indefinitely unless an AISH worker or supervisor manually deletes th

09 Child Support Services Learner

This alert is placed by Learner Income Support Office (LISO) staff when a PID is created on CC
before a CSS referral reaches TOMIS. The alert ensures the system does not delete the PID.

This alert remains on CCD for 12 months, at which time it is automatically deleted by the system

21 Investigation

A closed file is under investigation and the Fraud Investigator has a specific concern. The text c

This alert is placed by the Fraud Investigation staff.

This alert remains on CCD until the worker manually deletes the alert when the file is reopened

23 Non-Compliance

A file is to be closed or was closed because the client has not followed through with the **Individ**

This alert is placed by the worker.

This alert remains on CCD for 6 to 7 months unless the worker manually deletes the alert.

24 Student Funding

This alert is automatically placed on clients who are funded through the Shared Service Agreeen

“This client has been approved for funding 200x/xx/xx to 200x/xx/xx. If the client reapplies for In student or a labour market training participant, all funding needs are met through Seniors, Com Alberta Labour. If the applicant applies during periods of non-enrolment (e.g., summer break) a for continued student funding for the next academic year.”

The alert may be updated with additional comments in the remaining space, if required.

This alert remains on CCD for 12 to 13 months unless the worker manually deletes the alert, i.e

25 Relocation

If the client returns to Alberta and receives Income Support benefits within 12 months of receiving costs ([Income Support, Training and Health Benefits \(ISTHB\) Regulation, section 7](#)).

This alert is placed by the worker when benefits under **Need Code 1833** are issued in excess o

This alert remains on CCD for 12 to 13 months unless the worker manually deletes the alert. Th

26 Recovery

In rare situations the **Minister** has the authority to suspend recovery deductions.

If a client's [recovery](#) deduction is suspended, the text of this alert explains the reason for the **R**

The worker places the alert when entering an **R Flag 3**. The worker removes the alert when the

27 Sponsored Immigrants

The worker must place an alert **only** for sponsored immigrants (family class) where sponsorship

This alert remains on CCD indefinitely.

The worker puts the following information on the alert.

- name (surname, first name, middle name) of the sponsor,
- Sponsorship Number as identified on the **IMM 1000 Record of Landing** or the **IMM 5292**
- terms of the Sponsorship Agreement

28 Non-Compliant Child Support Services

To alert a worker that clients previously on Income Support were non-compliant with Child Support

This alert is placed by the worker when notified by Child Support Services that a client has not filed ([/ESA](#)), [section 6\(2\)\(d\)](#)).

This alert remains on CCD for 12 months unless the worker manually deletes the alert (e.g., the client no longer exists).

29 Underpayment Owing

This alert is placed on CCD when there is:

- an underpayment owing to a client, **and**
- the file is closed, **and**
- the worker is unable to locate the client.

This alert remains on CCD indefinitely unless the worker manually deletes the alert. The worker

Placing an Alert

Service Centre or Regional Office staff enter alerts directly on the **CCD ALERT** screen.

Note

Workers **do not** need supervisor approval before entering alerts on CCD. Workers **must** document

The worker enters alerts in CCD as soon as possible to maximize their effectiveness. However, workers should not overstate situations. The alerts should be based on facts and written as if the client were to go through the situation.

Reviewing Alerts

When a worker re-opens a file that has an alert, the worker:

1. reviews the alert text to determine if the circumstances that caused the alert are still valid.

If the alert should remain, even after the file is re-opened, the worker:

1. changes on the **ALERT TEXT** screen the original date of the alert to the date of the review.

If the alert is no longer needed, the worker:

1. deletes the alert.

Deleting an Alert

There is an automatic purge of some alerts from CCD as indicated in the description of each alert.

Automatic Purges

If staff have not deleted these alerts from CCD, many of the alerts are automatically purged at the end of the fiscal year.

Manual Purges

Alerts remain on CCD until:

- the required action is completed and the worker deletes the alert, or
 - the time of reopening a file. The worker reviews the alert and is satisfied the alert is no longer
-

Codes

Last updated on: Oct 19, 2007

The codes in this section do not appear in LISA.

A two-digit code identifying the reason for an alert being placed

01	Approach with caution
02	Health concerns
03	Eligibility concerns
04	Out-of-Province IS concerns
05	Out-of-Province CW concerns
06	Child Welfare Concerns
07	Aboriginal Organizations
08	AISH Asset Limit Exceeded

Alias Type

A two-digit code identifying the reason(s) for more than one name being registered for the client

00	Registered Name
01	Not Specified
02	Maiden Name
03	Partner/Spouse Surname
04	Different/Shortened Given Name
05	Alternative Spelling
06	Registered Indian
07	Previous Legal Name

Electronic File

A one digit code identifying the system location of the client's electronic file

1	LISA site
2	CCD (mainframe)

File Current Status

A one letter code identifying the current status of the client's file

A	Active
C	Closed
N	Non-Service
P	Pending

Involvement Role

A two letter code identifying the role of each registered person in relation to a specific file

GD	Guardian of Child in Need (historical information only)
HH	Head of Household
PT	Parent of Child in Need (historical information only)
SP	Spouse/Partner

Involvement Status

A one letter code identifying the status of a registered person's involvement in relation to a spec

A	Active
C	Closed
D	Deleted from Active File
N	Non-Service

P	Pending
---	---------

Restrict Authority

A one-digit code identifying the extent to which access to the electronic file information is restricted

1	Caseload
2	Unit
3	District Office
4	Region
5	Province

Restricted

A one letter code appearing after the file number if a file is restricted, to remind the viewer the file is restricted

R	Restricted
---	------------

File Discrepancies between LISA and CCD

Last updated on: Sep 28, 2012

INTENT

To ensure correction of discrepancies between Local Income Support Application (LISA) and C

POLICY

The report **SREP3710-1 File Numbers Active on LISA and Inactive on CCD** identifies discrep
discrepancies exist. This report prints by unit and caseload.

It is imperative that this report, when received is acted upon **immediately** to correct any errors :

Note

Errors must be corrected prior to system closures on the 10th of each month.

Once the report is received, the worker reviews the information on both LISA and CCD as the s

1. **Files Where Status, Application, Reopen and Closure Dates Now Match on LISA and**
No further action is required.
2. **Files Where LISA and CCD Match but there is a Difference in the Application/Reope**
If both LISA and CCD are active but LISA has been closed and reopened without the prev
different, the worker investigates further to determine the reason for the difference and if a
3. **Files Where the LISA and CCD Status is Still Different:**
A condition exists that is preventing the data from successfully transmitting from LISA to C
 - If the LISA file status is Waiting (W) the worker gets either the Income Support Supe
approve the file status to enable it to transmit to the mainframe (CCD).
 - If the LISA file status is Returned (R) or Approved (A), the worker investigates for a |
Exception report (LISA function 85) and takes corrective action to enable the file to t

Note

The **SREP3710-1 File Numbers Active on LISA and Inactive on CCD** report is retained
records scheduling authority outlined in the [Data Control Manual](#).

Duplicate Persons

Last updated on: Jun 28, 2019

Definition

A person is duplicated on the system when two person profiles and two Person Identifiers (PID)

- A client is only able to provide limited information and the worker is unable to perform a th
- A client unintentionally gives incorrect or incomplete information.
- A client intentionally provides false or misleading information for the purpose of obtaining
- A worker does not perform a complete person search even though the information is avail
- A worker does not review or ignores the Central Client Directory (CCD) Duplicate Person
- A worker enters information incorrectly.
- A worker previously entered incomplete or incorrect information and the next worker perfo instead of using a partial given name).

Rationale

Whenever a worker adds a person or updates the **Person Profile** on CCD, the system comparison matches occurs, the system will warn the worker that there is a possible duplicate person:

- If new SIN matches SIN already on the system.
- If new Personal Health Number (PHN) matches PHN already on the system.
- If surname and given initial, birthdate, and gender all match for some other person.

Workers must make every effort to avoid creating duplicate persons because:

- A client can only have one PID **and**
- Duplicate assistance may occur if a client has two PIDs.

If duplicate persons are created, the responsible Service Centre staff:

- Correct the information if the persons are different persons **or**
- Request Service Alberta's Office of the Corporate Chief Information Officer (OCCIO) CCD
- If the persons are the same person, review the files to determine if an overpayment has o

How to Avoid Creating Duplicate Persons

1. Enter information onto CCD directly from personal identification documents. If the client has the SIN card.
2. If the search by SIN does not indicate a duplicate, but the client states they have received aliases. The [LISA User Guide, Chapter 5 - Client Registration CCD](#), has information on this.
3. When the **Central Client Directory Duplicate Person** screen appears ensure the message is read.

If a worker recognizes a New Person Registration as a duplicate:

- before the file number is generated or the new person was added to LISA **and**
- before transmission to CCD

the worker should still request a PID Merge

Identifying Duplicate Persons

Duplicate persons may be identified in a variety of ways:

- The workers may encounter a duplicate while doing a person search
- The CEC (or other similarly delegated position) may encounter a duplicate while doing an
- The worker may receive a **SCCP 2490-01 Duplicates Identified By Daily Upload** report
- OCCIO CCD staff may become aware of a duplicate through exception reports including the report
- Fraud staff may become aware of a duplicate as a result of a report from the community contact

Service Centre staff are responsible to take action to assist in correcting duplicates they have identified. This includes receiving a **Daily Upload** report, OCCIO CCD staff or Fraud staff.

SCCP 2490-01 Duplicates Identified By Daily Upload

The **SCCP 2490-01 Duplicates Identified By Daily Upload** is a CCD report which is generated daily. The report is received at the Service Centre the day after the change is made. The IT Site Contact

Correcting Duplicates

Workers take the following steps if they receive a **SCCP 2490-01 Duplicates Identified By Daily Upload** report, to correct a duplicate which has been identified by other means.

Note

In most cases, a match occurs on two persons. However, in some cases, more than two persons are identified as duplicates.

1. Review the file and the personal ID of their client to determine if an error was made and the necessary corrections on the LISA database. This will cause the correction to transmit to the LISA database.
2. If the worker is unable to determine if an error was made or whether the persons are the same person:
 - Reviews the file of the matching client, if the file is active on their caseload or closed
 - Contacts the worker for the matching client, if the file is active, and asks that worker to determine if the file is the same person
 - Requests the file from storage if the file is closed more than two years and reviews the file to determine if the file is the same person
 - Follows step 5 if the file is closed in another Service Centre.
3. If one of the workers determines an error was made, the worker with the incorrect information corrects the duplicate.
4. If, after reviewing the personal ID on both files, the workers determine the persons are the same person:
 - Make a Comment in [Compass](#) on their respective files they believe the persons are the same person
 - Advise the Site Contact to notify the OCCIO CCD staff that a PID merge is required
PID, DOB, SIN, Alberta Health Care Number (PHN) and Aliases
 - It is the site staff's responsibility to ensure the appropriate documentation is on file for the persons, but will question the Site Contact if they have any concerns about the documentation
 - The Site Contact sends Forward merge requests to the OCCIO CCD staff Info
If the matching client's file is closed in another Service Centre, the worker:
 - Makes a Comment in [Compass](#) that the matching client's file is not accessible and provides the file number

Note

If both persons are active on a file and they are clearly the same person, benefits are not merged.

PID Merge and Files

OCCIO CCD staff merge PIDs when duplicates are determined to be the same person. Once the PIDs have been merged, OCCIO CCD staff send the appropriate Service Centre the appropriate documents. Documents in Imaging will need to be manually updated by a Supervisor. Each document is updated. If the person was Head of Household on one file and spouse on another:

- The workers review the files to determine if an overpayment or if fraud has occurred
- The worker with the active file calculates an overpayment or makes a fraud referral
- If the person was Head of Household on both files, the worker:
 - Requests the file for the invalid file.
- If any part of an invalid file is closed more than two years the worker retrieves the file. Merging them with the valid file is to ensure that only one file exists for the same person.

- Reviews the files to determine if an overpayment has occurred or if fraud has occurred.
- If an overpayment has occurred:
 1. The worker enters the debt in the Recoveries system.
 2. The AS staff chronologically merge the valid and invalid files according to RMA.
 3. The AS staff indicate on the **NCN0787H Client File Label** or **EMP 355b File Label** and record the name and file number of the person who was merged onto the file.

If fraud is suspected:

- The worker makes a referral to Investigation and Review.
 - The AS staff do not merge the files but store the intact invalid file with the valid file in one file.
 - The AS staff indicate on the **NCN0787H Client File Label** or **EMP 355b File Label** on both files and record the name and file number of the duplicate person.
 - When the Investigator advises the worker that the investigation is completed, the worker closes the case according to Records Management standards.
 - The AS staff indicate on the **NCN0787H Client File Label** or **EMP 355b File Label** in the valid file and record the name and file number of the person who was merged onto the file.
-

File Closures

Last updated on: Aug 13, 2024

INTENT

To ensure information about a client's circumstances leading to file closure is recorded. To ensure

POLICY

The closure date is always the last date of the month in which the client received Income Support (is September 30).

If a cheque is cancelled and no further benefits are issued, the file remains active on the system until the system is closed.

The Supervisor mediates and resolves any closure concerns that may occur between the worker and the client.

Note:

The Supervisor will review and approve file closures based on non-compliance or non-financial

PROCEDURES

Closure Due to Financial Ineligibility

The worker determines whether a client's file will be closed because of the client's financial ineligibility.

1. Notifies the client of the closure verbally and, when requested by the client, in [writing](#). In this notification, the worker informs the client about the appeal process and time limits for appeal.

An individual receives notification when a worker notifies them:

1. Verbally, on the date that the conversation with the worker takes place; or,
2. In writing, on the date that the notice is presented to the individual by the worker; or,
3. As outlined in [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#).

2. Enters the circumstances leading to file closure in [Compass Comments](#).

3. Ensures the _____

4. Informs any other worker involved with the file.

Closure Due to Non-Compliance

The worker determines whether a client's file will be closed because of the client's [non-compliance](#).

1. Notifies the client of the closure verbally and when requested [in writing](#). In this notification

appeal process and time limits for appeal. An individual receives notification when the worker notified then:

1. Verbally, on the date that the conversation with the worker takes place; or,
2. In writing, on the date that the notice is presented to the individual by the worker; or,
3. As outlined in [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#).

2. Enters the circumstances leading to file closure in [Compass Comments](#).
3. Ensures the **Release Cheque** flag is **N** on **CRC Processing** function **5**.
4. Places [Alert Code 23 Non-Compliance](#) on CCD.
5. Informs any other worker involved with the file.

Closure Due to Non-Financial Reasons

When the worker has reason to terminate Income Support benefits for non-financial reasons other than the worker's failure to comply with the requirements of the Act, the worker must provide written notice to the individual.

1. Normally gives the client 30-days [written notice](#). In this notification the worker is required to provide the individual with the time limits for appeal.

An individual receives notification when the worker notified then:

1. Verbally, on the date that the conversation with the worker takes place; or,
2. In writing, on the date that the notice is presented to the individual by the worker; or,
3. As outlined in [IESA, section 45\(3\)](#).

2. Enters the circumstances leading to file closure in [Compass](#) Comments.
3. _____
4. _____

Closure Reason Codes

16 System Closure: entered by system for all system closures.

17 Duplicate File on CCD: a duplicate file was registered on CCD and opened on LISA; **do not**

18 Manual Closure by Worker: the worker has closed the file manually because a System Closure was entered.

System Closures: LISA automatically closes the following files on or about the tenth of every month:

- No benefits for the previous month have been issued,

- There are no unapproved handwritten payments,
- There are no PIM (Permanent Interface Module) fatals,
- The application or reopen date is before the last day of the previous calendar month,
- The client file status is not Waiting, **and**
- There was no “activity” on the client file during the 24 hours prior to system closure. Activity includes:
 - changing information on the Client File and then pressing **Enter** or
 - entering a date in **CRC Processing** and then pressing **Enter**.

The worker must not create any unnecessary activity on the file to prevent a system closure.

Entering comments on the **CRC** screen does not prevent a system closure.

Active Cases Report

After system closures are completed, the worker receives a monthly **SSR 04 Active Cases Wh** issued.

The worker reviews the report and determines the reason for no system closure. If the client **Fil** manually closes the file.

Manual Closures

The worker must manually close files which missed system closures and for which benefits are

1. Ensures the manual completion of the recovery letter [EMP2562 Outstanding Debt to Go](#)
2. Uses **Close File** function **13** to close the appropriate clients. When the system defaults th pressing **Enter**.

Note:

Closure reason 17 Duplicate File on CCD is only used if advised by HQ.

After File Closures

All files closed by LISA and the worker are listed on the **SSR 01 Closures Report**. The IT Site

The worker reviews the **SSR 01 Closures Report** and completes any outstanding work on files

Unit Administrative Support

The Unit AS staff:

1. Pulls all files listed on the **SSR 01 Closures Report**.
2. Prints a copy of the **EMP 2562 Outstanding Debt to Government of Alberta** for files wh
3. Files the **EMP 2427 LISA Update** on Section **1** of the client’s electronic file.

File Creation and Structure

Last updated on: Jan 14, 2025

INTENT

- To minimize paper documentation on the Income Support file.
- To aid in the creation of new files and develop consistent filing practices on active files.

POLICY

Introduction

Files are created in a manner that ensures information on the new file does not duplicate information (Compass). File structure must be consistent in all offices.

File Creation

Upon completion of the intake process, the Career and Employment Consultant (CEC) compile: (AS) staff for file creation.

Note

Most of the following forms are for internal use and are not available to the public from the

Active Files

When creating a new volume, the following original documents will be placed on the new volume

- The most recent photo ID for the head of household and the spouse/partner, if applicable;
- The most recent application (i.e., **EMP3428 Income Support Application** or **EMP2004 N**
- The most recent medical or specialized assessment; and
- The most recent direct deposit form.

Note

All other original documentation is to remain in chronological order on the volume it was o

File Sections

Upon receipt of required documents, the AS staff will file the documents according to the followi

Section One: Eligibility and Legal Documents

Documents that are eligibility related or are legal in nature. Examples of documents filed in this

- [Personal Identification documents](#)

- Applications:
 - [EMP2004 Notice of Eligibility](#) or Income Support HRE1528 (previous version c
 - [EMP3428 Income Support Application](#) and all other related schedules (includin
[Renewal](#))
 - [EMP3854 Application for Emergency Prescription Drugs](#)
- Immigration Documents:
 - **IMM1000 Record of Landing**
 - **IMM5545 Application for a Verification of Status (VOS) or Replacement of an Immigration Document**
 - [EMP13574 Family Class/Request for Non-Family Class Immigration Request fo](#)
- Legal Documents:
 - [EMP2544 Denial of Spouse/ Partner](#)
 - [AAS13391 Consent to Release Information](#)
 - Repayment Agreements including Assignment of Benefits, Overpayment letter, and
 - [EMP0509 Financial Administrator Appointment](#)

Section Two: Payment Documents

Documents associated with the issuance of benefits. Examples of documents filed in this section

- [EMP0110 Annual Report Income Support](#)
- [EMP0151A Statutory Declaration](#) (Loss of cheque)
- [EMP2443 Income Support Direct Deposit Registration](#) (Income Support)

Section Three: Case Planning Documents

Documents related to case planning.

Section Four: Substantiation/ Verification Documents

Documents associated with substantiation and verification and any documents not listed in other

- Medical Documentation:
 - Medical Notes/ documentation supports current client category

- Specialized Assessments (Psycho-Educational, Occupational, etc.)
- [EMP0207 Income Support Medical Report](#)
- Other documents including special diet, medical transportation, additional shelter or other related medical benefits, **only if policy requires written**
- Income Verification:
 - Notice of Eligibility for Canada Pension Plan or Canada Pension Plan – Disability
- Health Benefit Exception Committee Decision
- [EMP3118 Consent to the Release of Utility Information](#)

FILE MAINTENANCE

Procedures

The administrative staff restructures and maintains client files as follows:

- The most recent of all new and reopened client files are filed according to the above ident
 - Client files are filed in alphabetical order by surname.
 - Documents are filed in chronological order (most recent on top).
 - Client files are only restructured to meet these filing practices whenever a new volume is c
-

File Review

Last updated on: Jun 04, 2024

File Review

INTENT

The purpose of file review policy is:

- to ensure information about a client's circumstance remains accurate, and up-to-date in the
- to provide a consistent practice and timeframe for completion of file reviews.

File Review Requirements

All client files are reviewed to validate the correct application of program policy, and operational accurate and that clients are receiving the benefits and supports they need.

Income Support will ensure that client file reviews are completed on a regular basis. If necessary, years. This process may require dedicated resources to ensure a complete review of files that are entitled to benefits to which they are entitled.

The file review process supports program integrity objectives, and provides an opportunity to re-evaluate and levels of assistance they need. A thorough file review supports case management objectives across categories or programs.

POLICY

File Review by Worker

A file review is completed by an Income Support worker when the client file has been open for 12 months.

File Review by Worker PROCEDURE

For workers undertaking file review, the following steps must be undertaken:

1. Completion of the [File Review Checklist](#) , using the [File Review Checklist Form Completion](#)
Key client documents in each file should have the PID entered, categorized, and documented.
2. As per the checklist if information in the file is inconsistent or is missing, the worker contact the client.
The worker must also
 1. Place a Reminder on Compass with the anticipated date the information or documents are needed.
 2. Enter Comments in Compass with client contact details, information or documentation.

If no information is needed to update the file, the worker contacts the client and inquires as to whether the benefit amounts are correct and documents this in Compass. The worker also provides feedback to the client.

3. Once the file review is complete, the worker creates a Reminder in Compass to review the file in 12 months.

4. The completed file review checklist form is imaged to file.

File Review by Supervisor

Income Support supervisors must complete a minimum of one file per month, for each of their s and consistently.

These files should be selected at random each month.

In addition, supervisors should also review one worker completed file review for each of their st:

File Review by Supervisor PROCEDURE

For supervisors undertaking file reviews, the following steps must be undertaken:

1. Using the file review checklist the Supervisor completes a file review as per the steps abo
2. Reviews Compass comments, appropriate substantiation, and file information to ensure o
3. If information in the file or system is missing the Supervisor informs the worker to follow up

File Closure (Eligibility issues, missing key documentation)

Refer to the [File Closures](#) policy for additional information on how to proceed, when:

- The worker has made every effort to contact the client with no success, and/or
 - It is determined that the client is [no longer eligible](#) for IS following completion of the file re
-

File Review Checklist Completion Instructions

Last updated on: Mar 21, 2023

INTENT

Files are reviewed for compliance with program and operational processes and to ensure client

Introduction

The [File Review Checklist](#) supports the reviewer (worker and supervisor) to assess compliance

The checklist complements other administrative and system-based processes (i.e., LISA and C

The checklist may also be used to support worker training as it identifies essential areas of Incc and how they are referenced in Income Support Policy.

File Review Checklist

[Personal and Family Information](#) – Ensure **Identification** is on file for all members of the house signature for client and partner and appropriate identification for any dependent children.

[EMP 0509 Financial Administrator Appointment](#) (if applicable) – Check that the **Financial Admini**
[Administrator](#) is appointed without consent, ensure correct documentation is on file.

[Financial Administrator](#) Identification (if applicable) – Check that a copy of picture identification i

[Client Categories/Types](#) - Review the **Client Type** to verify the client type is up-to-date and acc
update the client type in LISA and ensure consecutive budgets are corrected. Advise the client

[Medical Coverage Code](#) – Ensure that the correct **medical coverage code** is on the client's file
dependents is correct.

Contact and [Address Verification](#) – Check that the contact information (phone, email and mailin
documentation on file. Review Comments to see if client meets residency criteria (check for hos

[Notice of Eligibility for Income Support Application Form](#) (signed/current) – Ensure the most rec

[EMP 2941 Request to Disclose Personal Information](#) – Ensure any valid **consent to release** in

[Persons with Immigration Status](#) - Check for immigration status and if appropriate, confirmation

Banking and Financial Review:

[Direct Deposit](#) – If the client uses **direct deposit**, check that the [EMP2443 Direct Deposit Regis](#)
banking information matches the information in LISA. Ensure second level reviewer documenta
on file.

[CRC and ARC process](#) – **ARC** reporting is confirmed and set up. If exempt from reporting, conf

[Asset Verification](#) –Verify all of the asset details are entered in Compass comments and that th

[Income Verification](#) - Confirm all income has been reported in Compass comments and that sub Notice of Assessment (NOA) from Canada Revenue Agency to confirm information on NOA is i accessed all available income such as federal incentives like Canada Child Benefit, quarterly G

Budget Review:

[Core Essential](#) - Review current and go-forward budget and adjust if required based on file infor

[Core Shelter](#) - Review current and go-forward budget and adjust if required based on file inform

[Supplementary Benefits](#) - Review current and go-forward budget, adjust if required based on fil accurately recorded on LISA budget screens.

[Third-Party Payments](#) - When applicable, ensure the required consents are noted on file and th 6-month reviews are on file.

[Recovery Rate](#) - When applicable, review recovery rate in LISA. If adjusted from the default rate recovery rate more than 12-months ago it is recommended that staff discuss current circumstar reviewed again in 12-months. If the adjustment to the recovery rate is not needed reset the amc

Case Management Review:

[Individual Plan](#) - Ensure there is an up-to-date Individual Pan, update when necessary and/or re

[CCD Alerts](#) - Check CCD for alerts. Ensure high priority comments are in Compass which state reviewed to ensure they are still relevant.

Medical Documentation - If applicable, verify the medical documentation is on file. Note any cha

During the file review process, an Income Support Worker may initiate a review of medical eligil medical condition and/or prognosis for employability have occurred (either from the documenta those changes may affect the client's ongoing eligibility for Income Support benefits. More infor

Comments and Reminders – Complete File Review Comment in Compass. Review all Reminde

Note: Once review is complete, indicate the next planned file review date in comments a

File Transfers

Introduction

Last updated on: Sep 20, 2024

INTENT

To coordinate the transfer of electronic files between offices.

POLICY

Clients should receive services at the office they approach.

The electronic files for active cases are to be located at the same office.

- A client's electronic file can be viewed within minutes.

When a file is transferred between Income Support and AISH, please refer to [Client Sub-](#)

Active Files

When a client with an active file moves and contacts a new office, the client is referred to an ap updates the areas of the file that changed in the relocation process. Administrative Support staf

Clients can request a file transfer by any of the following methods:

- notes or letters,
- emails,
- phone calls, or
- an office visit

Note:

If it is not practical to meet in person, the file transfer request and process should take pla

Calgary and Edmonton Urban Offices

The Calgary and Edmonton office may choose to have prearranged all transfers within their owi

1. The client reports their new circumstances to their owning office.
2. The owning office issues benefits for the client's new circumstances.
3. The owning office provides the client with contact information for the new office, and instru
4. The client contacts the new office to confirm their move.
5. The new office requests the client's electronic file before issuing further benefits.

6. If the client contacts the owning office in the following month, they are referred back to the

Closed Files

When an applicant with a closed file at another office, reapplies for benefits, the new office asks:

If the applicant is eligible, the office confirms if a paper file exists, due to:

- pending litigation, a FOIP request, or an audit. In accordance with Records Management | the new office is required to request the closed volumes.
- Files closed for two years or more with outstanding recoveries or overpayments must also

Closed files that are reopened to receive a [One-Time Issue](#) are an exception. If a file has been closed over two years, One-Time issues are located at the office responsible for the original closure.

File transfer procedures for One-Time issues are the same for both the Income Support Contact Center and the field office. When a client is re-assessed by a worker, Regular intake and file transfer procedures are followed.

File Concerns

Files are **not** sent back when there is a concern about file quality. The Income Support Supervisor consults with the supervisor at the other office. If the concern is not resolved, the supervisor should bring the matter to the attention of their counterpart at the other office.

Appeals

If a transfer is requested during an [appeal](#), the ISS at both offices consult to determine:

- The impact of the appeal on the transfer, **and**
- **Who will take responsibility** for the appeal by considering factors such as:
 - if the client wants to continue with the appeal following their move,
 - if the move has an impact on the matter under appeal,
 - if a date has been set for an Appeal Panel hearing, and
 - the distance from the client's new residence to the Appeal Panel hearing the appeal

Appeal Panel Decision

If the department's decision is reversed by an Appeal Panel, the new office:

1. requests the electronic file, and
 2. issues benefits to the client.
-

File Transfer Procedures

Last updated on: Sep 20, 2024

INTENT

To identify the procedures necessary to ensure files are [transferred](#) effectively between offices.

Note:

For file transfer procedures between Income Support and AISH, see [Client Sub-Type 43](#).

Electronic File Location

CCD

Client information is available on CCD for **all** files, active, pending, and closed.

LISA

Client information is available on LISA for:

- active files,
- files closed three months or less,
- files closed more than three months that have been downloaded to LISA pending a reopening,
- pending files.

Compass

Client information is available on Compass for files that are active, pending and closed.

Imaging

Documents for the client file are stored electronically in the Imaging system.

Mobius

Client historical information may also be available on Mobius.

Download Office

The download office is an office that has downloaded the electronic file from CCD within the last 30 days and has returned it to CCD.

Pending File

A pending file is a file that has been registered on CCD, but never opened on LISA. The sending office is responsible for ensuring the file is opened on LISA.

Non-Service File

A non-service file is a pending file that was purged from LISA and returned to CCD. The requesting office is responsible for ensuring the file is opened on LISA.

on LISA, after the download.

Active Files	
The New Office	When a client re the client re The Admin 1. confir 2. phone numb 3. recor T01 I The worker 1. chang 2. deter benef 3. enters 4. comp electr 5. uses t when infor
The Owning Office	When an of The AS: • transf

Closed Files	
Ineligible Clients	If a client wi CCD / LISA The Worker

	1. review 2. image
Eligible Client	If a client wi The worker : 1. confir 20 (ck 2. determ 3. update 4. compl client 5. uses tl when : inform
Intakes (remote)	1. If the o Applic 2. AS wi 14 fro than 3 3. CEC v

Reports
DTI01 Outstanding Transferred In Report Reconciliation

Problems and Solutions When Transferring Files	
How to action your F14 RPA-99 Bot Request that has been Rejected	Do not create a duplicate request, instead make s 1. Go to the REJECTED email in your Inbox SharePoint site. 2. Identify the error stated in the body of the e 3. At the upper left corner – Click on EDIT A 4. Make the necessary corrections. 5. Select RETRY under STATUS. 6. Click SAVE.
Electronic File is Not Downloaded	The electronic CCD file is not downloaded if inaccur displayed. The Site Contact receives the SCCP 2390 The Client Direction staff: 1. consults with the Site Contact, 2. corrects the information, and 3. uses the Request For File Download, functio
Wrong File Downloaded From CCD	If the worker is in Eligibility Determination functio 1. record this information in Compass Comment 2. leaves the file information to purge, and 3. requests the AS download the correct file.

Wrong File Transferred in From LISA	If the worker is in Eligibility Determination function 1. requests the file to be transferred back notifying
Wrong File Brought in and Information Is Entered on The Client File	If the worker has entered information in Client File 1. the worker stops entering information and informs 2. the Site Contact contacts LISA / CCD Support
Electronic File Not Received by Requesting Office	The Records Room staff at the owning office cannot determine if the file was received 1. If the electronic file was sent to the wrong office • contacts that office and requests a transfer 2. If the file was sent to the right office but not received • informs the Site Contact, and • the Site Contact: • contacts LISA / CCD Support email
File Transfers cannot occur until the next business day when: • a payment was generated the same day, • an outstanding PIM reject (Permanent Interface Module is the link between LISA and CCD, • if there is an unapproved manual cheque or voucher, or • until 24 hours after LISA system file closures.	In these situations Records Room staff at the sending office 1. asks appropriate staff to take corrective action or voucher, and 2. informs the requesting office the file will be transferred

Closed and Pending Files on LISA

Last updated on: Sep 19, 2025

Requesting Alberta Supports Centre	
All Clients	The CI 1. a
Ineligible Clients	The CI 1. i
Eligible Clients	The CI 1. i 2. i 3. i 4. c 5. i The SF 1. c

Closed and Non-Service Files on CCD

Last updated on: Sep 20, 2024

Requesting Office	
All Clients	The CI 1. 3
Ineligible Clients	The CI 1. 3
Eligible Clients	The CI 1. 1 2. 3 3. 3 4. 6 The SI 1. 6